Figure 1.226. Ginseng Root (Renshen)

GINSENG (REN SHEN)

As a magical plant, Ginseng (Figure 1.226) was believed to mysteriously rise from the ground at night, glowing, and flitting around the forest floor. The root of the plant sometimes resembles that of a human figure, giving rise to its magical correspondence to the human body.

- **Protection:** Burning Ginseng root or powder as an incense is believed to ward off evil, break hexes or curses, and repel negative spirits.

  In ancient China, the Ginseng Root was sometimes used in Love Magic Rituals and in Hexing Doll Magic, commonly substituted for the body of the intended victim.
- **Love:** Ginseng is believed to be a powerful lust-provoking aphrodisiac. It is highly regarded as a stimulant and general tonic that promotes sexual potency, lust, vitality, and long life. To attract love, fill a red or pink flannel bag with a lock of your own hair, a heart-shaped piece of sun-dried lemon peel, and a piece of dried Ginseng root. Consecrate and charge it, then wear it on a gold chain around your neck.

GENTIAN (HUANG LONG DAN)

Gentian is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mars (Figure 1.227).

- **Protection:** When added to any incense or sachet, Gentian greatly increases the formula's energetic power. Gentian is also used to break hexes and stop curses.
- **Love:** Gentian is often added to love baths and sachets.

Figure 1.227. Gentian
Huang Long Dan (Gentiana lutea)

Figure 1.228. Goldenrod
(Solidago odora)

GOLDENROD

Goldenrod is also known as Aaron's Rod (Figure 1.228). Goldenrod is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus.

- **Visions:** Goldenrod is sometimes used to induce prophetic dreams. For example, it was once said that if you desired to see your future love, all you had to do was to carry a piece of Goldenrod with you. Your future love would then appear on the following day.
- **Divination:** When held in the hand, a Goldenrod flower nods in the direction of hidden or lost objects.
- **Prosperity:** It was once believed that if Goldenrod springs up suddenly near the house door, unexpected good fortune will soon rain upon the family living there.
- **Weather Magic:** Because of its connection to the Elemental realm, Goldenrod is used in Weather Magic rituals in order to create Storms.

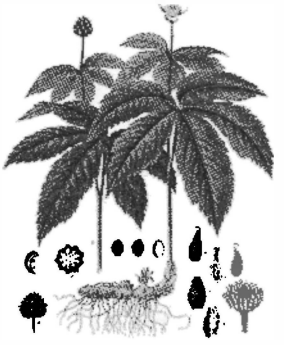


Figure 1.229. Goldenseal
(Huan Lien)

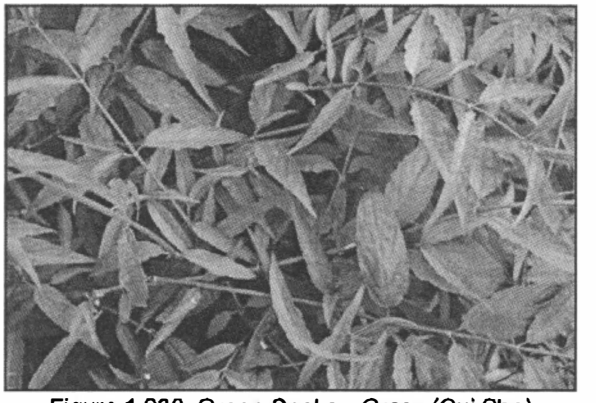


Figure 1.230. Green Snake - Grass (Cui She)

GOLDEN SEAL (HUAN LIEN)

Golden Seal is also known as Huan Lien (Coptis Root).According to ancient Han Dynasty (206 B.C.-220 A.D.) texts, "Huan Lien is fed to every child for the first three days of its life, for the purpose of strengthening its Shen and assisting the souls in becoming properly coordinated (Figure 1.229).

GREEN SNAKE GRASS (CUI SHE)

Also known as Snake Grass, this special medicinal herb belongs to the family of Acanthaceae (Figure 1.230). It is well known for its anti-snake and anti-scorpion venom healing benefit, especially among folk healers. It is traditionally used for stuffing Daoist Altar Statues.

When researched, the plant's extract exhibits antityphoid and anti-fungal activities. It is traditionally used as a powerful drug for clearing away evil-heat, expelling superficial evils, and diminishing inflammation. It is also very effective when used to treat upper respiratory tract infections.

GUM MASTIC

Gum Mastic is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun (Figure 1.231).

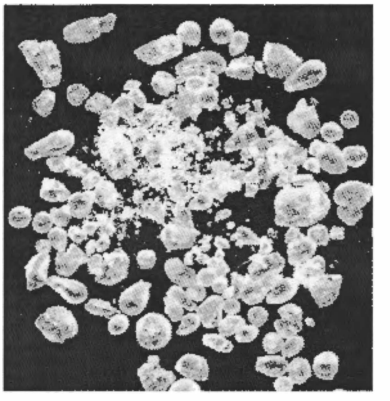


Figure 1.231. Gum Mastic
(Pistacia lentiscus)

- **Protection:** Gum Mastic is blended together with other herbs and is burned as an incense during exorcisms in order to cause spirit entities to become visible.
- **Visions:** Gum Mastic is used to strengthen a magical formula and is also used to increase psychic power.
- **Love:** Priests in the Middle East dissolve Gum Mastic and add it to their lust potions.

Figure 1.232. Heather
(Calluna spp.)

HEATHER

Heather is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus (Figure 1.232).

- **Summoning:** Heather has also long been used to conjure spirits and ghosts.
- **Protection:** Heather is said to be good for protection, and it was carried in order to guard against rape and other violent crimes.
- **Weather Magic:** When combined with Fern and burned outside, Heather is said to attract rain. Other magical traditions will dip Heather and Fern together into water and then sprinkle it around the area surrounding the outside altar in order to conjure rain.

HEAVENLY HEMP (TIAN MA)

Heavenly Hemp (Gastrodia elata Blume), refers to the tuber of an orchid (Figure 1.233). It was originally listed in the ancient *Shennong Bencao Jing* (written in 100 A.D.), and was later classified by Tao Hong as a "Superior Herb," meaning that it could be taken for a long time to protect the health and prolong life. Gastrodia has been included in the Chinese Materia Medica, and over the centuries, many Daoist priests have attributed Gastrodia to possessing magical properties (such as giving strength and virility, improving circulation and memory, and expelling all kinds of poisons from the body). It is also used for stuffing Daoist Altar Statues.

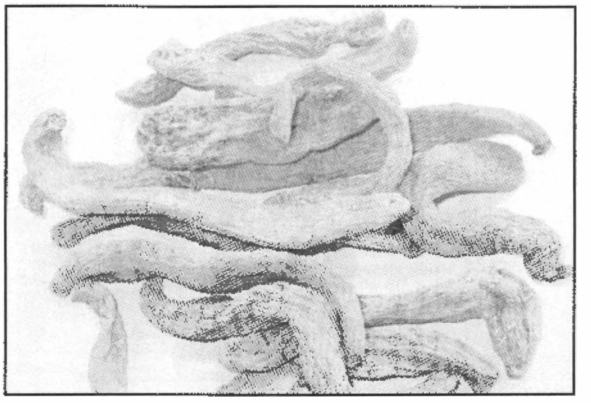


Figure 1.233. Heavenly Hemp (Tian Ma)

Figure 1.234. Heliotrope
(Heliotropium europaeum)

HELIOTROPE

Heliotrope is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun (Figure 1.234).

- **Invisibility:** Heliotrope was sometimes used in ancient times to cause the priest to become invisible. This required the priest to fill a small Bloodstone horn (container) with Heliotrope and then wear or carry it in order for his or her actions to go unnoticed. The flower was sometimes carried or worn to ward off unwanted sexual advances.
- **Exorcism:** Heliotrope is often used in exorcism incenses and formulas.
- **Visions:** When placed beneath the pillow, Heliotrope is said to induce prophetic dreams. This technique of inducing clairvoyant visions for finding lost objects is especially useful if a

Figure 1.235. Hemlock
(Conium maculatum)

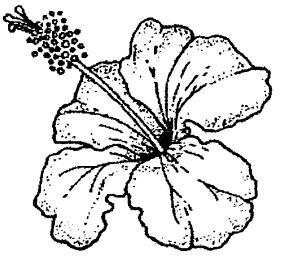


Figure 1.236. Hibiscus Flower
Zhu Jin Hua (Hibiscus spp.)

priest has been robbed (the image of the thief will appear in a dream).

- **Prosperity:** When placed in the pocket or purse, Heliotrope is said to attract money and wealth.
- **Healing:** Heliotrope is a common ingredient in healing sachets.

HEMLOCK

At one time Hemlock was used as a sedative, but because of its toxicity, it is no longer recommended for domestic use (Figure 1.235). Hemlock is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Saturn.

This deadly poisonous plant is also known as Herb Bennet, Spotted Corobane, Musquash Root, Beaver Poison, Poison Parsley, and Spotted Hemlock. All parts of hemlock, especially it's fruits are considered lethal. Hemlock works to paralyze the muscles, therefore in magic, if you wish to paralyze a situation, a bit of hemlock could be used. Hemlock's reaction time is a few hours and is a fast acting banishing plant.

- **Purification:** At one time, Hemlock juice was rubbed into magical knives and swords in order to empower and purify them before use.
- **Hexing and Cursing:** Hemlock is considered to be one of the foremost hexing agents, and it is considered to be good for ritually paralyzing a situation. It can also be added to any magical oil or incense to reverse its energetic property (e.g., transforming a person's "lucky" oil to "deny good luck" oil). Its flowers are sometimes used in spells in order to cause impotence in men and to destroy their sex drive.
- **Visions:** Hemlock is a poisonous plant, and was once used in magic in order to induce Soul (astral) Projection.

HIBISCUS FLOWER (ZHU JIN HUA)

Hibiscus Flower is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus (Figure 1.236).

- **Visions:** Hibiscus Flower is sometimes used in order to induce dreams and enhance psychic ability. It is also used in divination rituals.
- **Love:** Hibiscus Flower is sometimes used as an aphrodisiac and is a common ingredient in love spells. Because Hibiscus Flower activates the energy of the Second and Fourth Chakras, sometimes elixirs are given to women in order to free any blockages in their sexual energy. Indication: frigidity.
- **Healing:** Hibiscus Flower soothes the nerves, and it is considered to be an antispasmodic. Tea made from Hibiscus Flower is said to aid digestion and sweeten breath.

Figure 1.237. Honeysuckle
Jin Yin Hua (Lonicera caprifolium)

Figure 1.238. Horehound
(Marrubium vulgare)

HONEYSUCKLE FLOWER (JIN YIN HUA)

Honeysuckle Flower is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Earth Element, and its planetary correspondence is Jupiter (Figure 1.237).

- **Visions:** Lightly crushing Honeysuckle Flowers and rubbing them on the forehead is said to heighten psychic powers. It awakens the Sixth (Third Eye) and Seventh (Crown) Chakras, and it brings the spirit realm to light. Honeysuckle Flower Tea is also used to induce prophetic dreams and is sometimes used in order to assist an individual in letting go of the past.
- **Prosperity:** Honeysuckle Flower is widely used in prosperity spells.
- **Love:** Traditionally, Honeysuckle Flower symbolizes the "bonds of love," and it is excellent in love charms when working on problems of infidelity.
- **Healing:** Honeysuckle Flower strengthens the mind and memory and is said to balance the right and left sides of the brain. Honeysuckle Flower also strengthens and brings flexibility to the body. It helps heal sore throats, headaches, and asthma.

  An excellent formula used for treating eye infections combines one part Honeysuckle Flower flower with one part Chrysanthemum Flower. After making an infusion, half of the tea is saved and used as an eye wash, while the half of the tea is sipped as an eye restoring tea.

HOREHOUND

Horehound is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mercury (Figure 1.238).

- **Protection:** Horehound can be carried or burned as an incense for protection. In ancient times, flowering Horehound was traditionally gathered and tied with a ribbon, then hung in the home in order to keep the house free of negative energies. Horehound is used in protective sachets, and is carried to guard against sorcery and fascination. Horehound is also ground into powder (while speaking banishing incantations) and then scattered as an exorcism herb.
- **Healing:** Drinking an infusion of Horehound is said to clear the mind and promote quick thinking. It is also known to strengthen the priest's mental powers. When mixed with Ash leaves and placed in a bowl of water, Horehound releases healing energy and should be a common healing tool placed in the room of a convalescing patient. It is used to treat asthma, coughs, colds, bronchitis, sore throats, and skin irritations. Also used as a diaphoretic, diuretic, expectorant, laxative, stimulant, and stomachic.

Figure 1.239. He Shou Wu
(Polygonum multiflorum)

He Shou Wu

According to ancient Han Dynasty (206 B.C.-220 A.D.) texts, "The root and the fruit of the He Shou Wu (Polygonum multiflorum) are supposed to resemble the human shape (Figure 1.239), and for that reason are so helpful in all diseases caused by the separating of man's spirits."

He Shou Wu (also known as Foti) is sometimes called "Wild Seedling," "Mating Vine," "Night Mating Plant," and "Earth Fairy." It has male and female varieties: the male is colored yellow-white, the female is colored yellow-red. They mate at night and should be harvested from the end of spring to mid-summer or early fall. The tuberous root of this plant can have various forms, from human to turtle. The root is considered to be a medicine and is good for increasing energy, darkening hair, improving complexion, and providing long term benefits such as growth of tendons and bones, bone marrow, longevity and others.

In ancient China, the Ho Shou Wu Root was sometimes used in Love Magic Rituals and in Hexing Doll Magic, commonly substituted for the body of the intended victim.

Figure 1.240. Huang Bai
(Phellodendri Cortex)

Figure 1.241. Jasmine Flower
Zhi Zi Hua (Gardenia Jasminoides Ellis)

Huang Bai (Phellodendri Cortex)

The Huang Bai (Figure 1.240) is generally used in the treatment of meningitis (i.e., the inflammation of the membranes of the brain or spinal cord).

In Daoist sorcery, 30% Huang Bai is combined along with 40% Borneol and 30% Alum when making Talismanic Paper. These three combined herbs were traditionally mixed during the paper creating process in order to help activate the spells and contain the magical incantations that were projected through the priest's calligraphy pen and through the Daoist priest's Breath Incantations.

Jasmine Flower (Zhi Zi Hua)

Jasmine Flower is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Moon (Figure 1.241).

- **Visions:** Jasmine Flower is said to induce lucid dreams, enhance astral projection, open the Forth (heart) Chakra, and stimulate clarity of thought. Jasmine Flower will also cause prophetic dreams if burned in the bedroom, and the flowers can be smelled to induce lucid dreaming. To use as a tea, pour 1 cup of boiling water over 1 tsp. of herb, cover and steep for 3-5 minutes.

Figure 1.242. Jet (Mei Jing)

- **Prosperity:** Jasmine Flowers are believed to draw wealth and money if carried, burned, or worn for that purpose.

  One ancient Chinese ritual used to draw a rich spouse into your life, required the seeker to place a jar of uncooked rice, dried Jasmine flowers, and a dried orange peel under the bed. Each night, the seeker is to shake the jar and visualize them self marrying a rich spouse. The seeker is to continue this ritual every night until the marriage is consummated. Then, the seeker is to empty the contents of the jar into a moving stream to ensure that love and prosperity continues to flow within the marriage.
- **Love:** Jasmine is essentially a seduction herb, though many priests consider it to be more sexual than romantic. It is used in rituals to attract love and sometimes made into teas and used as an aphrodisiac. In love recipes, it is used lightly in combination with other ingredients unless the priest intends to produce pure animal passion. Dried Jasmine Flowers are traditionally added to sachets and other love formulas.
- **Healing:** Jasmine Flower is said to alleviate depression and tension. It is also used during childbirth.

JET (MEI JING)

Jet is composed of carbonized wood or lignite coal (Figure 1.242).

- **Protection:** Jet is used to ward off evil, especially psychic attacks, and is used to protect its owner from demon or spirit possession. It was also believed to be able to increase intuition and absorb any illness or negative energy, and remove fears and depression. The ancient Chinese used Jet as a protective talisman against illness and harm caused from psychic and physical attacks.

Figure 1.243. Lavender
Xun Yi Cao (Lavendula angustifolia)

In ancient times, burning powered Jet as an incense was believed to be an effective way of breaking a very strong curse delivered from a hostile priest. The smoke of Jet was believed to banish all forms of the destructive energies.

LAVENDER (XUN YI CAO)

Lavender is an aromatic plant that grows one to two feet high. It has strong erect stems, gray-green leaves, and very aromatic flowers (Figure 1.243). Lavender is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mercury.

- **Purification:** Lavender is commonly added to purification baths. It has an ancient reputation for being an anaphrodisiac (a substance that inhibits sexual arousal). In ancient times, when individuals needed help keeping their vows of chastity, they would often wear garlands made out of Lavender.

  Lavender flowers and buds are sometimes burned or smouldered in order to induce sleep and rest, and they may also be scattered around the house to maintain an air of peaceful tranquility.
- **Protection:** Lavender is sometimes burned with Rue in order to cleanse, protect, and shield a person, place, or thing from toxic energy and negativity.
- **Visions:** Lavender is considered a valuable stimulant for energizing and activating the psychic and visionary senses. It can also be used in visionary work, dream magic, or as an incense for meditation (i.e., it activates the Crown Chakra). Because it is the "flower of the Elementals," in ancient times, Lavender was sometimes carried in order to assist the

Figure 1.244. Lemon Balm
(Melissa officinalis)

priest in seeing ghosts and was also worn to protect the priest against the evil eye.

- **Love:** Lavender is a traditional ingredient in love spells and sachets. It is also sometimes used for uncrossing (reversing and removing) love hexes. Lavender is particularly effective in helping with marital problems or relationships. It is believed to help soothe problems between parents and children and is considered to be an excellent protecting herb for babies and small children.
- **Healing:** Lavender is used for treating headaches, insomnia, joint pain, arthritis, burns, insect bites, acne, and eczema. It is also believed to help reduce scarring.

  Lavender can be combined with Rose and Lemon and used for healing a broken relationship or mixed with Chamomile and drunk as a tea to treat insomnia.

Lemon Balm

A member of the Bo He (mint) family, Lemon Balm commonly grows 1 to 2 feet in height, has a wide saw-toothed leaves, and exhibits a characteristic lemon scent when crushed (Figure 1.244). Lemon Balm is often used in magical spells in order to ensure their success. Lemon Balm is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Moon.

- **Love:** Lemon Balm was sometimes carried in order to find a love. In order to influence love, Lemon Balm was soaked in wine for several hours, strained, and then shared with the lover.
- **Healing:** Lemon Balm is often used in healing incenses and sachets. It was sometimes drunk as an infusion in order to soothe the emotional pains after a relationship ended.

Figure 1.245. Lemongrass
(Cymbopogon citratus)

Lemongrass

In ancient times, Lemongrass was planted around the home and in the garden in order to repel snakes (Figure 1.245). Lemongrass is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mercury.

- **Purification:** As an incense, Lemongrass is burned for strength and purification. Put a handful of leaves in a mesh bag and place under the tap water for a purification bath. Lemongrass is often mixed with Sage and Copal Resin to make smudge sticks used in purification rituals.
- **Hexing:** Lemongrass is an excellent herb to add into a "Power" formula that is used for general ritual work. It can also be used as a hexing herb, and in such cases it is primarily aimed at making the victim's life complicated and full of problems.
- **Protection:** Lemongrass is carried it in a sachet or charm in order to attract a mate and to bring honesty to the relationships.
- **Visions:** Lemongrass is calming, and is good for deepening states of meditation or trance. An infusion of Lemongrass is commonly used to aid in developing psychic powers.
- **Love:** Lemongrass is said to increase lust and makes others lust after you. Therefore, Lemongrass is commonly use in lust potions in order to attract and keep a lover.

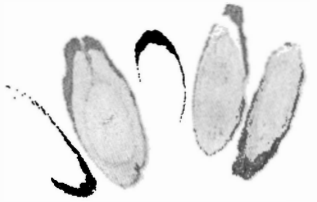


Figure 1.246. Licorice Root
Gan Cao (Glycyrrhiza glabra)

LICORICE ROOT (GAN CAO)

This magical herb is also known as Glycyrrhiza uralensis Fisch, and Licorice Root (Figure 1.246).

Since ancient times, Chinese Licorice Root has been used for energetically harmonizing the other ingredients in an herbal formula. It is also traditionally used as a "carrying agent," to lead and conduct the healing energy of the other herbs in the formula throughout the Twelve Primary Channels.

When Licorice Root is placed inside an Altar Statue, it is traditionally used for Protection Magic. In ancient times, Licorice Root was sometimes buried in the tombs of the deceased, in order to protect the Soul on its journey. It was also placed in magical amulets in order to expel toxins, poisons, and negative energy from the body. The same energy that created an energetic barrier around the magical practitioner, also provided a protective field around the Altar Statue.

Licorice Root is also used in making erotic incense. It is specifically used for heightening body awareness and acts as an aphrodisiac. It is commonly used in Daoist Sex Magic, and the root is often chewed for increasing sexual potency.

- **Protection:** When Licorice Root is placed inside an Altar Statue, it is traditionally used for Protection Magic. In ancient times, Licorice Root was sometimes buried in the tombs of the deceased, in order to protect the Soul on it's journey. It was also placed in magical amulets in order to expel toxins, poisons, and negative energy from the body. The same energy that created an energetic barrier around the magical practitioner, also provided a protective field around the Altar Statue.
- **Healing:** In Chinese Medicine, it has been used since ancient times for energetically harmonizing the other herbal ingredients in a formula, as well as to help carry the healing energy of the formula throughout the Twelve Primary Channels.
- **Sex Magic:** Licorice Root is also used in making erotic incense. It is specifically used for heightening body awareness and acts as an aphrodisiac. It is commonly used in Daoist Sex Magic, and the root is often chewed for increasing sexual potency.

Figure 1.247. Lilac Flower
Ding Xiang Hua (Syringa vulgaris)

LILAC FLOWER (DING XIANG HUA)

Lilac Flower tends to promote the positive energetic aspects of the specific herbs that it is used or combined with (Figure 1.247). Lilac Flower is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus.

- **Protection:** Lilac Flower can be used for protection and warding off evil, and it is excellent for uncrossing (reversing hexes). Lilac is a popular herb used in most banishing rituals.
- **Visions:** Lilac Flower aids mental and psychic powers and is good for clairvoyance in general. It is sometimes used to call in the good spirits in a seance. Lilac Flower is also good for inducing "far memory" and recalling past lives.
- **Healing:** Clinically, Lilac Flower benefits the spinal column. It produces antibodies for spinal column inflammations, cleanses and replaces spinal fluid, eases paralysis associated with a pinched nerve in the spinal column, and disperses solidification of the vertebrae that occurs in various diseases. Because it works immediately, a Lilac Flower elixir should be given by a bonesetter (chiropractor or osteopath) just before doing a spinal adjustment. Lilac Flower elixirs also relax the muscles, and can be used to benefit the patient of any type of bodywork.

Figure 1.248. Ling Xiang Cao
(Lysimachia foenum-graecum)

Figure 1.249. Magnolia Flower
Wang Chun Yu Lan (Magnolia biondii)

Ling Xiang Cao (Lysimachia)

This magical herb is also known as Lysimachia foenum-graecum (Figure 1.248).

- **Meditation:** Ling Xiang Cao is used in making meditation incense. It is specifically used for awakening the mind and calming the spirit, and it places the priest into a deep reflective state.

Magnolia (Wang Chun Yu Lan)

This magical herb is also known as Magnolia biondii Pamp (Figure 1.249).

- **Meditation:** Magnolia is used as an incense and is burned in order to enhance meditation and increase psychic awareness.
- **Love:** In ancient China, after Match-making Rituals had confirmed the identities of the new life-long partners, Magnolia flowers (fresh or dried) were sometimes placed underneath the beds of the two candidates in order to bring about a smooth harmonious transition in their marriage.

Mandrake (Du Shen Qie)

Mandrake is known for having a rootstock resembling a human form. Sometimes known as the "Priests' Root," this fibrous rootstock sprouts into a round stem that forks at the top to yield two yellow-green leaves (Figure 1.250). Mandrake is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mercury.

Mandrake Root was introduced to China sometime before the late 13th century. The traditional method for harvesting Mandrake in ancient China was as follows:

A shaft was first dug into the earth until the root of the plant was reached. Dogs were then used to bring the plant to the surface, but they were poisoned by the aroma of the plant and died. The plant was then concealed in the ground for a year, after which it was taken out and dried.

A very small dose of the Mandrake is used to rob a man of all feelings for three days, during which time he will seem to be dead. The root could also be used to either bring about the death of a hated rival or mixed with a secret combination of herbs to place the rival into a coma. The priest would then steal the rival's spirit soul, imprison it in a gourd, and use it as a "spirit slave."

To activate a dried Mandrake root (i.e., to bring its powers out of hibernation), place it in some prominent location in the house and leave it there undisturbed for three days. Then place it in warm water and leave overnight. Afterwards, the root is activated and may be used in any magical practice. The water in which the root has bathed can be sprinkled at the windows and doors of the house to protect it, or onto people to purify them.

- **Hexing Dolls:** Mandrake root has long served as a poppet in hexing doll magic. However, its extreme scarcity and high cost usually force the priest to look for substitutes (e.g., Ash Roots, Briony Root, etc.).
- **Protection:** There is an ancient saying that states, "where there is Mandrake, demons cannot reside." Therefore, Mandrake root was commonly used in all forms of exorcism. The root can be soaked in water or brewed in a tea

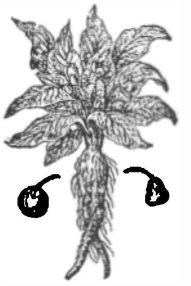


Figure 1.250. Mandrake
Du Shen Qie (Atropa mandragora)

Figure 1.251. Marigold Flower
Jin Zhan Hua (Calendula officinalis)

and sprinkled around the home or temple to protect from evil spirits or black magic.

It was also believed that a whole Mandrake root placed on the mantel in the home would give the house protection, fertility, and prosperity. Mandrake was also hung on the headboard for protection against ghosts and spirit entities during sleep.

- **Visions:** It is said that the scent of the Mandrake causes sleep. Mandrake also acts as a hallucinogen when brewed as a tea. It provides great potential as a visionary herb, empowering the priest's visions and propelling them into manifestation.
- **Prosperity:** It was believed that money placed beside a Mandrake root (especially silver coins) was sure to double.
- **Love:** Mandrake is sometimes carried in order to attract love, and the root is said to increase fertility in woman when carried. Two Mandrake roots are sometimes bound together in a ritual with a red cord, in order to create a permanent bond between a man and woman.
- **Courage:** Mandrake intensifies the magic of any spell. To charge Mandrake root with your personal power, sleep with it for three nights during the full moon, the root can then be carried as a talisman to increase courage.
- **Healing:** Mandrake was sometimes worn in order to prevent contraction of illnesses.

MARIGOLD FLOWER (JIN ZHAN HUA)

Marigold Flower is also known as "Bride of the Sun" and "Calendula." Marigold Flower should be gathered at noon (Figure 1.251). Marigold Flower is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun.

- **Purification:** A solution of crushed Marigold Flowers can also be used to thoroughly wash the floor of a residence in order to dispose it of evil magic. This purification solution is especially used if the inhabitants have tracked "graveyard dirt" into the house (spreading sadness, agitation, restlessness, and heavy feelings throughout the home). The "graveyard dirt" is usually placed on the victim's porch by a malevolent priest. This allows the priest (ghosts and summoned spirit entities) direct access into the victim's home.
- **Protection:** In ancient times, garlands of Marigold Flowers were strung on the doorposts of homes in order to stop evil from entering the house. Additionally, a solution of crushed Marigold Flowers can also be used to thoroughly wash the floor of a residence in order to dispose it of evil magic, especially if the inhabitants have tracked "graveyard dirt" into the home.

It is said that when Marigold Flowers are carried in your pocket, it will help justice to smile favorably upon you in court and give you the advantage in all business or legal affairs.

Marigold Flowers are also used for protection in legal matters (i.e., legal difficulties surrounding money) and can be carried into court for justice to elicit a favorable discission. Because it has a mild, gentle action,

Marigold Flowers can be add to a bath in order to win admiration and respect from others. The flowers can also be placed under the bed to protect a priest from harm while he or she sleeps.

- **Soul Retrieval:** Marigold Flowers are said to soothe and uplift the soul, and is sometimes used in "Soul Retrievals" in order to "call back" the patient's soul.
- **Visions:** Marigold Flowers are said to induce prophesy, open the psychic senses so that the priest can "see magical creatures," and increase clairvoyance and lucid dreaming. In ancient times Marigold Flowers were crushed in a mortar while speaking incantations; the resulting powder was then sprinkled under the pillow at night in order to promote clairvoyant dreams. The flowers can also be place under the bed to induce prophetic dreams.

  Marigold Flower also increases ones ability to hear what is spoken on clairvoyant levels, strengthens ones ability to intuitively understand lay or academic information, increases ones insight into the mechanics of physics, and helps one develop psychic abilities.
- **Prosperity:** It is said that when Marigold Flower is added to your bath water, it will help in winning the respect and admiration of those you meet.
- **Love:** Marigold Flower is sometimes added to love sachets.
- **Healing:** Marigold Flower is used in natural antifungal, antiseptic, and antibacterial treatments. It is sometimes used to ease inflammations (e.g., viral, inner ear, pancreatic, and tendon inflammations), and treat genetic deterioration of the spinal column. Elixirs can be used to stimulate the pituitary gland and activate certain antibiotic properties in the thymus gland. It can also be used to open and cleanse the nasal passages, due to stimulating the chakric point located in the center of the ear lobe.

MARJORAM (BO HE SHAN)

Marjoram is also known as Bo He Shan ("Mountain Mint") and "Joy of the Mountain"

Figure 1.252. Marjoram
Bo He Shan (Origanum majorana)

(Figure 1.252). Marjoram is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mercury.

- **Protection:** When placed around the house (a little in each room and replaced monthly) or carried, Marjoram shields against evil and protects against ill intent and negativity.

  When placed inside a coffin with the deceased, or grown on top of his or her grave, Marjoram is said to safely deliver the soul to the Underworld.

  Marjoram also energetically opens the chakras in the centers of the feet and enhances the priest's ability to work with Earth Qi.
- **Dreaming:** Marjoram improves the ability to experience lucid dreaming. It also enhances the ability to understand the expressed emotions experienced within the dreams.
- **Love:** Marjoram is said to be protective, especially in matters of love. It is often used in love spells or love and friendship charms, and it may also be added to food to strengthen love.

MISTLETOE (BAI GUO HU JI SHENG)

A semi-parasitic shrub, Mistletoe grows in 6 inch to 4 foot diameter clusters that root themselves into the branches of other trees; it has thick oblong leaves and produces yellow flowers and white waxy, glutinous berries (Figure 1.253). Mistletoe is said to lose its power once it touches the ground.

Mistletoe is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and

Figure 1.253. Mistletoe
Bai Guo Hu Ji Sheng (Viscum album)

its planetary correspondence is the Sun.

- **Protection:** Mistletoe is an excellent all purpose magical herb, and it is reputed to protect the bearer from priests who shape-shift. In ancient times, Mistletoe was placed in cradles to protect children from being stolen by the fairies and replaced with changelings. It has long been used to banish evil and protect against sorcery and witchcraft. Mistletoe was also carried or worn for good luck during hunting. Throughout the centuries, Mistletoe has been used for protection against lightning, disease, misfortune of every kind, and fires. Mistletoe can be burned as an incense for exorcism or carried as an amulet to protect against misfortune.
- **Invisibility:** In ancient times, Mistletoe was worn around the neck to enable the priest to become invisible.
- **Visions:** Laid near the bedroom door, placed beneath the pillow, or hung at the headboard, Mistletoe is said to give restful sleep and beautiful dreams.
- **Love:** Although used in many love recipes, Mistletoe is considered to be a commanding/compelling herb. It is sometimes used in love magic and fertility spells. In ancient times, women carried Mistletoe in order to aid in conception.
- **Healing:** A ring carved of Mistletoe wood is said to ward off sicknesses when worn, and the plant will cure fresh wounds quickly when carried (do not apply it to the wound).

Figure 1.254. Mock Lemon
Chinese Perfume Plant (Aglaia odorata Lour)

Figure 1.255. Motherwort
Yi Mu Cao (Leonurus cardiaca)

MOCK LEMON

Also known as Chinese Perfume Plant, this magical herb is famous for its sweet perfume fragrance (Figure 1.254). It is commonly combined with other herbs and burned as an incense during Sex Magic rituals.

MOTHERWORT (YI MU CAO)

Motherwort has several hollow grooved stems that produce downy leaves occurring opposite each other along each stem (Figure 1.255).

- **Protection:** Motherwort is commonly used for protection, especially against hostile magic. It also strengthens the wearer's energetic field and helps banish depression.
- **Healing:** Motherwort is one of the very best herbs for driving melancholy away from the heart and making the mind cheerful again. To use as a tea, pour 1 cup of boiling water over 1 tsp. of Motherwort, cover and steep 3-5 minutes (not to be used during pregnancy).

In ancient Chinese Medicine, Motherwort ("Benefit Mother Herb") was used to enter

into the heart, liver, and urinary bladder channels. It was used clinically to reduce abdominal masses, reduce abdominal swelling, treat systemic edema, and treat gynecological problems (by invigorating the blood and regulating the menses).

MOUSE-EAR

This small plant has leafy creeping runners that spread out into dense patches; its leaves form basal rosettes and it sends up four to fifteen inch stems topped with yellow flower-heads (Figure 1.256). Mouse-ear was widely used in ancient alchemy together with other herbs such as Moonwart in order to accomplish the crucial step of solidifying Mercury.

- **Purification:** In ancient times, Mouse-ear was used in certain rituals for consecrating magical tools of edged iron or steel.
- **Protection:** Mouse-ear can be used to banish hostility, quarreling, and the threat of violence. It is traditionally used to dispel hostile magic.

Figure 1.256. Mouse-ear (Hieracium pilosella)

Figure 1.257. Mugwort Ai Ye (Folium Artemisiae Argyi)

MUGWORT (AI YE)

Mugwort, also known as Artemisia or Pai Ai, grows from one to five feet in height and has downy grooved stems and alternate pinnate leaves. It is commonly found along roadsides and in areas where the soil has been disturbed (Figure 1.257). Mugwort is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Earth Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus.

- **Protection:** Mugwort is considered to be a highly protective plant. Its leaves were traditionally harvested in June and its root was gathered in the Autumn. Mugwort is said to be strongest when picked on one of the three nights of the full moon.

  In ancient times, Mugwort was said to protect travellers from fatigue, sunstroke, wild animals, and evil spirits. It was commonly placed inside the shoes for protection and to prevent fatigue on long journeys. A branch of Mugwort was also kept in the house and smoked in the fireplace in order to dispel hostile magic and drive away evil spirits. In ancient times Mugwort was sometimes put over the door in order to prevent a house from being struck by lightning.

  In ancient times, Mugwort was attached to doors and gates because its ragged leaves resemble tiger paws which were believed to provide protection. Its aroma is also believed to repel insects.

  In Daoist magic, Marshal General Tianpeng (Figure 1.258) is the manifestation of "Heavenly Mugwort." He is a green-skinned, multi-headed, multi-armed, fierce-looking martial deity, equipped with a variety of magical weapons and demon subjugating tools, including his famous "Magic Seal." He wears armor, a crown, has bronze fangs, iron claws, and is a deification of the Air Element of the East. He is also one of the four Celestial Marshal Generals who are responsible for fending off evil. When summoned to cut down demons, he arrives riding on a dragon, holding an imperial bell in one hand and brandishing a sword or a large axe in the other hand.

When performing exorcism to remove a spirit entity from a victim, Mugwort smoke is sometimes used in conjunction with the Thirteen Ghost Points. When performing this magic ritual, certain Daoist priests will project their Qi and Shen through the Mugwort smoke while speaking banishing incantations.

Additionally, sometimes the patient's Wind Gate (Fengfu GV-16) area, located at the base of the skull, is "anointed" with Holy Water created from an Mugwort tincture.

- **Visions:** Mugwort is sometimes used as a visionary herb (placed in a dream pillow to bring about prophetic dreams of future events), and it is also known to increase clairvoyance, enhance the priest's energetic awareness, and augment his or her psychic powers. Mugwort is said to sometimes facilitate Soul (astral) Travel and dream interpretation.

In ancient China, Mugwort was said to induce lucid dreams, and was traditionally placed next to the bed. Sometimes a "dream pillow" was made by stuffing 8 ounces of the dried Mugwort into a piece of cotton. Other times, the Mugwort was made into a tea in order to induce spirit dreams. Because the taste of this tea is very bitter, some priests would sometimes add relaxing herbs such as Chamomile and Lavender in order to try to reduce its bitter flavor.

A standard dosage is half an ounce of the herb steeped in two cups of water for 15 minutes, one half cup taken twice a day. Unless recommended by a herbalist, this dosage should be taken no more than once a week.

- **Scrying:** In ancient times, Mugwort tea was consumed before divination. The magical tea could also be used to wash the priest's crystal ball and magic mirror to increase clarity.

Mugwort leaves were known to be beneficial for summoning spirits and were therefore used for observing spirit manifestations. It was also believed that fresh Mugwort leaves rubbed on the surface of a magic mirror or crystal ball would strengthen their divination abilities. For example, the leaves of Mugwort could be placed around the base of the crystal ball and magic mirror (or underneath them) in order to aid the scrying. Sometimes Mugwort was also burned with White Sandalwood or Wormwood during the scrying ritual.

Figure 1.258. Marshal General Tianpeng

- **Healing:** Mugwort is a symbol for longevity because of its medicinal properties. It opens and purifies circulatory channels. In ancient Chinese Medicine, Mugwort (the leaf) was used to enter into the spleen, liver, and kidney channels in order to warm the womb, pacify the fetus, stop menstrual bleeding, alleviate abdominal pain, and disperse Cold. It also strengthens the uterus, eases painful menstrual cramping, and is excellent for strengthening the life force in the fetus.

Mugwort can be used to treat brain damage from any cause. It can be used to rechannel energy into the left-brain (if damaged) in order to restore function. Helps a person enter the alpha state & opens certain psychic faculties such as telepathy. Acts a general tonic for all the subtle bodies, channels, acupuncture points and seven chakras.

Caution: Large doses of Mugwort must be avoided as it is used medicinally for the treatment of stomach and nerve problems, and it should not to be taken in pregnancy or when breast-feeding. Additionally, Mugwort may cause an allergic reaction in certain individuals.

Figure 1.259. Mullein
(Verbascum thapus)

MULLEIN

Mullein is also known as "Aaron's Rod." In ancient time, priests used oil lamps to illuminate their magical spells and rites, and the downy leaves and stems of the mullein often provided the wicks. Graveyard Dust (used in certain magical spells when a matter needs to be "laid to rest") can be substituted with powdered Mullein leaves (Figure 1.259). Mullein is considered to be Feminine in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Saturn.

- **Purification:** Mullein is used for cleansing the altar space before and after performing rituals. It is also used for cleansing and purifying ritual tools.
- **Summoning:** Mullein is sometimes used in order to invoke spirits.
- **Protection:** Mullein is said to offer protection from wild animals, protection from evil spirits, and protection from sorcery. In India, Mullein is regarded as the most potent safeguard against evil spirits and magic, and it is traditionally hung over doorways, inside windows, and carried in sachets to banish demons and all negativity. Mullein is sometimes stuffed into a small pillow or placed beneath a pillow to guard against nightmares. It is also used in exorcism rituals.
- **Divination:** Fresh Mullein leaves are sometimes rubbed onto scrying tools in order to aid divination.
- **Love:** Mullein is sometimes carried in order to obtain love from the opposite sex. In certain magical traditions, it is used in love divinations.
- **Healing:** It is believed that if a few leaves of Mullein are placed in the shoe, it will keep one from catching a cold. Mullein is useful as an expectorant to clear and heal the lungs; it also stops diarrhea, and is used to soothe hemorrhoids.

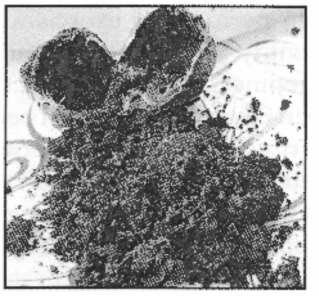


Figure 1.560. She Xiang (Musk Deer)

MUSK (DEER GLAND)

Musk comes from the wild Musk Deer (Figure 1.260), which ranges throughout China and much of Mongolia.

The musk is produced in the "musk pod," a gland located in a pouch or sac under the abdomen of the male musk deer. Traditionally, the musk pod is harvested, dried in the open air, and then cut open, revealing a small, oval-shaped kernel. The main chemical compound in musk is muscone, which gives musk its distinctive, persistent odor.

In Daoist Magic, Deer Musk corresponds to the Yang (masculine) Divine Energy, and represents the subliminal, psychological aspect of this energetic sphere. It also represents the spiritual principle of Divine Wisdom, although we experience it as a stimulant to the libido, its dynamic outpouring of energy also corresponds with the Third Eye, and is associated with deep meditation.

In ancient Daoist magical tradition, Deer Musk is among the few scents that are used to connect a disciple to the highest valued consciousness, including creative genius, awakened spiritual energy, magical transformation, and stimulated libido.

Deer Musk is also identified with the Earth aspect of Saturn, and working with spirit entities. According to ancient Daoist belief, Deer Musk renders its handler invisible to the lower energies of certain individuals. Among its many magical qualities are increased health, vitality, longevity, and sexual potency. Traditionally, it is considered to be most powerful when used in Love Potions, Aphrodisiacs, and Sex Magic. When Deer Musk is carried around for stimulating sexual appeal, it mixes with the handler's own pheromones, making him or her extremely attractive.

Figure 1.261. Myrrh Resin
Mo Yao Shu Zhi (Commiphora myrrha)

Figure 1.262. Nettle
Xun Ma (Urtica dioica)

MYRRH RESIN (MO YAO SHU ZHI)

Myrrh is a yellowish brown colored resin of the Commiphora tree, native to Arabia and Eastern Africa (Figure 1.261). Myrrh is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Moon.

- **Purification:** Myrrh is used to purify, bless, and consecrate objects such as amulets, talismans, charms, and magical tools. When burned, Myrrh purifies and raises the environment's energetic field, bringing peace, healing, and blessings to the area. Myrrh also increases the magical power of any other incense it is being burned with, and it is traditionally used as an aid for meditation and contemplation. Rarely burned alone, Myrrh is usually used in conjunction with other resins.
- **Protection:** Myrrh (Yin) is commonly used in conjunction with Frankincense Resin (Yang) or other resins in exorcisms and banishing rituals.
- **Healing:** Myrrh is sometimes included in healing incenses and sachets. It can be burned to gain wisdom when mourning the loss of a loved one.

NETTLE (QIAN MA)

The Nettle plant can grow up to five feet in height and resembles an unusually large Mint (Bo He). Sometimes known as "Stinging Nettle," this herb has four to eight inch opposite saw-toothed leaves that sting to the touch (Figure 1.262). Nettle is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mars.

- **Purification:** Nettle is recommend for use in purification baths because it is considered to be "more carnivorous" than other herbs, and so will work more efficiently.
- **Protection:** Nettle is widely known for its protective powers. It is commonly used to remove a curse and send it back to its owner. This can be accomplished through either stuffing a hexing doll with Nettle or simply carrying some Nettle in a sachet. It is also said that, sprinkling Nettle around the house will keep evil out and to send it back. Nettle is sometimes thrown onto a fire in order to avert danger, held in the hand to ward off ghosts, carried with Yarrow to allay fear, and worn as an amulet to keep negativity far away.
- **Love:** Nettle has sometimes been used as a lust-inducing herb.
- **Healing:** A pot of freshly cut Nettle placed beneath the bed of a sick individual is said to aid in the patient's recovery. Nettle is considered to be an antidote for many poisons. It is highly nutritious for anemia, skin disorders, and allergies, and it restores health, works as an expectorant, and stops bleeding.

Nettle can be used to tonify the kidneys, lungs, and nervous system. An elixir is commonly used to treat asthma, neural inflammations, and scarring in the inner lung tissues.

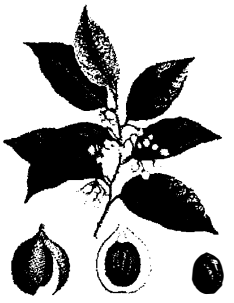


Figure 1.263. Nutmeg
Rou Dou Kou (Myristica fragrans)

Figure 1.264. Orrisroot
(Iris germanica var.florentina)

NUTMEG (ROU DOU KOU)

Nutmeg is a medium sized (one half inch to one inch in diameter) aromatic seed produced by the evergreen tree Myristica fragrans (Figure 1.263). Nutmeg is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Jupiter.

- **Visions:** Nutmeg is said to aid meditation, stimulate psychic powers, increase Clairvoyance, bring visions, and improve the intellect. It is often used in divination. Its major energetic properties allows for the increased acceleration a person's vibrational resonance, creating a stronger spiritual attunement to ones higher self. This elevated energetic connection allows the priest the ability to draw on deeper insights and profound wisdom derived from his or her past and future lives.
- **Prosperity:** Nutmeg is sometimes used in financial spells. It may also be carried as a good luck charm in order to attract prosperity.
- **Healing:** Because Nutmeg calms the mind and body, it is used in treating insomnia. It is also good for the intestinal tract and reproductive organ, and is said to reverse impotency and hair loss. Nutmeg can be dangerous if taken internally, but used as a seasoning is fine.

ORRISROOT

Orrisroot refers to the fragrant rootstock of any of three varieties of European Irises (Figure 1.264). Orrisroot is a focusing herb, and it is used to focus the power of other herbs it is combined with. Orrisroot is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus.

- **Protection:** Orrisroot is used for protection from evil spirits by hanging the roots and leaves of the plant inside of the doors and windows of the house. Orrisroot is also added to the bath for personal protection.
- **Divination:** When using Orrisroot for divination, certain magical traditions will attach a small piece of the root (other traditions use the entire root) to a string, cord, or piece of yarn and use it as a pendulum to derive the answers to questions.
- **Love:** Orrisroot is used for attracting love. It is sometimes called "love drawing powder," and has long been used in charms, amulets, sachets, incenses, and baths to find and hold love. The whole root can be carried, or the powder may be sprinkled on sheets, clothing, around the house, or on the body to attract love.

Figure 1.265. Parsley
Ou Qin (Petroselinum crispum)

Figure 1.266. Patchouli
Dao Shou Xiang (Pogostemon cablin)

Figure 1.267. Peppermint
Bo He (Mentha spp.)

PARSLEY (OU QIN)

Parsley is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mercury (Figure 1.265).

- **Purification:** Parsley is often used in purification baths, and it is also used to stop all misfortune.
- **Protection:** In ancient times it was said that if the priest picked Parsley while uttering a hexing spell against another person, that person would be dead within the week.

  Parsley refreshes, renews, and removes negativity or fear from an area. When placed in a room, it can tone down and alleviate poltergeist activity. It is interesting to note, that the custom of placing a sprig of Parsley on a plate of cooked meat arouse from the belief the herb could appease the spirits of the dead animals.
- **Healing:** It is said that eating fresh Parsley aids in reducing blood pressure.

PATCHOULI (DAO SHOU XIANG)

Patchouli is an herb of power and manifestation, and it is commonly used for materializing one's wishes. Its job is to make things happen, to bring results quickly and powerfully (Figure 1.266). Patchouli is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Earth Element, and its planetary correspondence is Saturn.

- **Hexing:** It is said that Patchouli has no conscience of it's own, so it can often be substituted for "Graveyard Dust" and used in Hexes.
- **Prosperity:** Because of its rich earthy smell, Patchouli is commonly used in prosperity spells and potions. It is often added to money formulas, and it may be sprinkled directly onto money, inside purses, or inside wallets.
- **Love:** Patchouli is also used on a fertility talisman and as an aphrodisiac (used for lust or sensuality rather than love).

PEPPERMINT (BO HE)

Peppermint is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature, and is used in Daoist magic in order to is used to create change and get things moving. Peppermint is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mercury (Figure 1.267).

- **Purification:** Peppermint is used in purification spells and formulas, and its presence raises the energetic vibrations of an area. When used to rid an area of evil, a priest will first consecrate the Peppermint using salt water. The priest will then use a sprinkler (made from twigs of Peppermint, Marjoram, and Rosemary) and proceed through the area purifying each corner. Peppermint is

also excellent for cleansing furniture, walls, or floorboards of any evil or negativity (i.e., steep the herb in the washing water).

- **Summoning:** Peppermint is sometimes used to conjure benevolent spirit entities. It is said that spirits love the scent of Peppermint, and a small dish set out will tend to attract them.
- **Protection:** Because Peppermint incense naturally possesses a strong protective power, it is sometimes burned in banishing rituals and in exorcisms. Peppermint is commonly placed in the home as a protective herb, and it is also used in travel spells.
- **Visions:** Peppermint is said to be excellent for stimulating the psychic senses and for studying. When placed beneath a pillow, Peppermint promotes sleep and enhances visionary dreams. It is said to sometimes offer the priest glimpses of the future in his or her dreams.
- **Prosperity:** Peppermint is often used in money and prosperity spells. One method of using Peppermint to attract money requires the priests to place a few leaves of Peppermint in their purses or wallets, or to rub the Peppermint where money is being kept.
- **Love:** Peppermint is sometimes used to provoke lust and increase sexual desire. It is a common additive to love incenses.
- **Healing:** Peppermint can be used in healing and purification baths. It is also very useful as a tea for treating conditions of stomach upset, heartburn and nausea, and it is also used to ease congestion during a cold or flu.

PERIWINKLE

Periwinkle is also known as "Priest's Violet" (Figure 1.268). In ancient times, it was believed to be unlucky to remove Periwinkle from a graveyard. To do so would incur the wrath of the ghosts that haunted the place. This herb is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus.

Figure 1.268. Periwinkle (Vinca minor)

- **Protection:** Periwinkle is sometimes used for protection against evil influences (i.e., when hung around doors and windows). In ancient times it was also carried to obtain grace and was believed to protect against snakes and poison.
- **Mind Magic:** Periwinkle enhances many capacities of the Sixth (Third Eye) chakra. It energetically integrates the conscious, subconscious, and superconscious minds; specifically integrating the conscious mind with the superconscious. This energetically cleanses the subconscious mind and puts it into proper order regarding the conscious mind's particular pattern of spiritual growth. In ancient times, Periwinkle was sometimes used in magical rituals to restore lost memory.

  Periwinkle stimulates and strengthens the Eighth through Twelfth Chakras and increases the energetic availability of magical powers contained within the tissues (specifically those magical powers generated from the lower Fourth to the upper Twelfth Chakras).
- **Prosperity:** Periwinkle is sometimes used to attract money.
- **Love:** Periwinkle is used in love and lust spells.
- **Healing:** Periwinkle strengthens the liver channel and deepens the energetic awareness of the body's Hun and spirit body.

Figure 1.269. Plantain
(Plantago spp. lanceolata)

Figure 1.270. Poppy
Ying Su Ke (Papaver spp.)

PLANTAIN

The Lanceolata variety of Plantain has a base of long semi upright leaves and flower stalks that grow from six to thirty inches high (Figure 1.269). Plantain is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Earth Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus. In order to maximize its power, Plantain should be gathered during the last quarter of the Moon cycle.

- **Protection:** Plantain is used for its protective properties. It is said that Plantain will attract helpful spirits and protect the priest against malevolent spirit entities. It can also be placed under the pillow in order to drive away nightmares and evil spirits. In ancient times, it was believed to protect against animal bites.

POPPY SEEDS (YING SU KE)

Poppy Seed is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Moon (Figure 1.290).

- **Protection:** Poppy Seeds can be used as a charm against those victims who have become bewitched into love.
- **Spirit Communication:** Poppy Seeds improves the communication with all spirit entities, particularly those of the water world. It creates a deeper relaxed state, which enhances the understanding of the spiritual laws and internal relationships connecting the priest to all environmental plants, animals, and the land in general. It also reveals the purpose of these magical realms, existing within the priest's immediate location. Drinking a Poppy Seed elixir allows the priest to experience a finer attunement to the Earth's geopathic zones, and exposes the underlying energetic principles of Feng Shui.
- **Visions:** Poppy Seeds are sometimes taken to induce clairvoyant dreams and visions, and they are related to most dark moon activities.
- **Prosperity:** It is said that Poppy Seeds can be used to attract luck and money. In ancient times, priests would carry the seeds or the dried seed pod as a prosperity charm.
- **Love:** There is a long tradition of eating Poppy Seeds as a fertility charm. Poppy Seeds are also added to food and sachets in order to induce love.

Figure 1.271. Qian Li Yan
(Eyes That See 1,000 Miles)

Figure 1.272. Resurrection Lily
Jiao Ye Shan Nai (Kaempferia angustifolia)

QIAN LI YAN (EYES THAT SEE 1,000 MILES)

The term "Qian Li Yan" ("Eyes that See a Thousand Li"), is an ancient saying used in to describe the magical effects that Mongolian Thyme had on a shaman's spirit eyes (Figure 1.271). In Daoist Magic, Mongolian Thyme is sometimes used to induce psychic vision (it is said that if you wear Mongolian Thyme, you will be able to see Nature Spirits). It is also used to help the Daoist priest energetically attune himself to the future lives of his patients, and to project and observe past or future events when performing magical divinations.

Mongolian Thyme cleanses and renews the spirit, and calls divine forces to one's side. It is said that submerging oneself in a bath containing Mongolian Thyme Oil is sometimes needed for serious purification, especially after having performed an Exorcism, or when coming in contact with a malevolent spirit of the dead, or a rotting dead corpse.

Mongolian Thyme is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus. It is also used to cleanse and renew the spirit, and calls divine forces to one's side.

Because it is used to remove all sorrows and ills of the past year, it is often burned in magic rituals as an incense, for the purification of the magical space.

When added to magical elixirs, Mongolian Thyme is generally used in combination with other magical ingredients (i.e., primarily used to amplify the magical powers of other herbs).When Mongolian Thyme is placed inside an Altar Statue, it is traditionally used for Protection Magic, especially from the negative energy of others.

RESURRECTION LILY (JIAO YE SHAN NAI)

This magical herb is also known as Kaempferia galanga L., Resurrection Lily and Sand Ginger (Figure 1.272).

- **Protection:** Resurrection Lily is specifically used as an incense and burned for protection, breaking spells, and removing curses.

Figure 1.273. Rose Flower
Mei Gui (Rosa spp.)

ROSE FLOWER (MEI GUI)

Rose Flower is said to have high energetic frequency, attracting the highest spiritual energies from within ourselves, and the surrounding environment (Figure 1.273). Rose Flower is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus.

- **Protection:** Rose petals are added to fast-luck and protection formulas. The petals are sometimes sprinkled around the house to calm stress and soothe household upheavals.
- **Visions:** Rose petal tea is sometimes drunk before going to bed in order to induce prophetic dreams.
- **Love:** Because it awakens love and inspiration, Rose petal incense is used in all forms of love enchantments, and it possesses the strongest love vibration of any magical incense. Due to the flower's association with the emotions, Rose petals have long been used in love spells and mixtures (what you mix with the Rose petals with determines the kind of love you manifest). Rose petals or Rose water (distilled from the petals) may be added to the bath water to attract love. Scattering Rose petals on the altar enhances the power of a love spell. Rose hips are sometimes strung like beads and worn on the body to attract love.
- **Healing:** Rose hips are very high in Vitamin C. Rose hips also contain A, B, E, and K, organic acids, and pectin, and they have a high concentration of iron. Helps clear away headaches, dizziness, mouth sores and menstrual cramps. Heart and nerve tonic.

Figure 1.274. Rosemary
(Rosmarinus officinalis)

ROSEMARY

Rosemary is a commonly cultivated evergreen plant that usually has upright stems and grows up to six feet high; the aromatic leaves sit opposite each other along the stem (Figure 1.274). Rosemary is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun.

- **Purification:** Rosemary is considered to be one of the oldest incenses. When burned, it emits a powerful cleansing and purifying energetic field. It is therefore often used prior to performing magical rituals. Rosemary is also used in purification baths, and infusions of this herb are commonly used to wash the hands prior to undertaking healing work. Rosemary is generally added to most purification bath sachets.
- **Protection:** An incense made out of Rosemary has substantial protective powers that can be used to banish nightmares and hostile spirits. It is sometimes placed under a pillow to ensure a good night's sleep and to drive away nightmares, or placed under the bed to guard against all forms of harm while sleeping. When hung over doors, Rosemary is said to keep thieves away.

  Rosemary has a long history of being used to counter evil spells and intercept their powers. A sprig of Rosemary (fresh or dried) can be hung inside the home to dispel witchcraft and evil sorcery. It can also be carried in a red sachet for protection.
- **Binding:** Rosemary binds things (or people) together in a loving, gentle manner.

- **Mind Magic:** Rosemary stimulates the pineal gland, Baihui, and the Seventh Chakra. Taken as a magical elixir, it is considered to be a liquid ambrosia, bringing the priest such experiences as a deep state of inner peace or ecstasy. It also enhances an individual's creativity, brings clarity of mind.
- **Visions:** Rosemary can be used in dream pillows in order to induce lucid dreams and visions, and it aids in controlling out-of-body experiences.
- **Love:** Rosemary is use in love and lust incenses and potions.
- **Healing:** Rosemary and Juniper are burned together as a healing and recuperative incense. Rosemary is sometimes used as a circulatory, digestive, and nerve stimulant. It is said to heal headaches, depression, and halitosis. A tea of Rosemary is traditionally used to strengthen the memory and cause the mind to be alert.
- **Sea Magic:** Rosemary has an important magical link to the Moon, and through it, to the ocean and specific energies of the sea. The name of this herb translates to "Dew of the Sea," and its native habitat is the sea cliffs. Therefore, Rosemary is often used in sea rituals.

RUE

Rue has a branched pale green stem and alternate, pinnate, fleshy leaves that have little oblong leaflets of their own (Figure 1.275). Rue is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mars.

- **Purification:** Because Rue guards against negative energies and gets things moving in a positive direction, it is often used in consecration rituals. Rue is also used for the purification of ritual spaces and magical tools.
- **Protection:** Rue energizes the minor chakras of the fingers and the toes. It also increases the energy of the higher subtle bodies, particularly the spirit body.

Figure 1.275. Rue
(Ruta graveolens)

In ancient times, Rue was considered a reliable defense against priests and their spells. It is a highly protective herb when used against hostile magic and is excellent when combined with other herbs for breaking curses. The leaves are commonly used in exorcisms and purification rituals. Like Asafoetida, Rue is used to banish hostile spirits and can be burnt as an incense when performing specific defensive rituals.

Rue is also known as the "Herb of Grace," and it was added to healing incenses, banishing mixtures, hexing dolls, and baths in order to breaks hexes and curses. Rue was believed to be so powerful against conditions such as "soul loss," that it was constantly used in magical spells and formulas. It was even sometimes hung at the door or placed in sachets as protection from the "evil eye." A sprig of fresh Rue is used as a sprinkler to distribute salt water throughout the house to clear negativity. Rue is also said to protect an individual against ill health caused from negative energies.

- **Visions:** Because it energetically aligns the Eighth through Twelfth Chakras, Rue is believed to bestow "second sight."
- **Love:** Rue has sometimes been used for love and fertility charms since ancient times. Also, an infusion of Rue is sometimes used to wash the floors to protect the home or burned to clear the head where love is confused.

Figure 1.276. Sage
Dan Shen (Radix Salviae Miltiorrhizae)

SAGE (DAN SHEN)

Sage is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is Jupiter (Figure 1.276).

- **Purification:** Sage is the main ingredient used in smudging and is often burned in order to consecrate a ritual space. It absorbs negativity and misfortune, and it is used to purify sacred spaces and ritual tools. Sage is also good to take while fasting, especially on tomato juice. It aligns the spiritual body so that the psycho-spiritual dynamics of the priest can flow more freely. As the psycho-spiritual dynamics of the priest become activated, he or she tends to become philosophically more active, developing an interest in spiritual matters. As the priest spiritually awakens, his or her psychic faculties, especially mediumistic abilities, also awaken and great joy is manifested.
- **Protection:** Sage protects against all forms of evil. It is powerful and especially good when moving into a new home (i.e., walk the smoke to the four corners of the room to repel and rid negative energies and influences). In ancient times, Sage was placed inside a small horn and worn in order to guard against the "evil eye."
- **Prosperity:** Sage is used in countless money spells to attract wealth.
- **Healing:** Sage is a common ingredient in countless healing spells. It awakens the Third and Fourth chakras, and tonifies and cleanses the body's channel system. It promotes wisdom and aids in healing the body, mind, and spirit. Sage is commonly used to heal wounds, aid digestion, ease muscle and joint pain, and treat colds and fever. Red Sage was used in ancient Chinese medicine to invigorate blood, clear heat, and remove stagnation, and it was said to enter into the body's heart, pericardium, and liver channels. Sage can be ingested in order to augment the digestive system. It acts as a laxative and stimulates autolysis (i.e., the enzymatic digestion of the cells).

Figure 1.277. Saint John's Wort
(Hypericum perforatum)

SAINT JOHN'S WORT

Saint John's Wort is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun (Figure 1.277).

- **Protection:** St. John's Wort is used for protection against evil spells and hexes. It was also burned in exorcistic rituals in order to banish evil spirits and demons. When the flowers and the leaves are placed in a jar and hung by a window, they are said to protect against thunderbolts, fire, and evil spirits, and also to prevent nightmares.

  St. John's Wort was traditionally gathered on Midsummer's Eve. It was then dried over fires and passed through the altar smoke in order to purify it. After that, it was then hung in the house as a form of energetic protection against ghosts, evil spirits, demons, and malevolent priests.

  In ancient times, it was said that if St. John's Wort was worn as an amulet and drank as a tea, it would strengthen a soldier's courage and conviction, making him invincible.
- **Visions:** St. John's Wort is said to open the priest's spirit to divine guidance, and it can be used to assist the priest in out-of-body experiences.
- **Spirit Travel:** St. John's Wort energetically moves spirit projections and soul travel beyond the lower spiritual realms, and assists

the priest in experiencing visionary states. It slightly improves memory, and eases cluttered dreams and nightmares that can occur when the soul's energetic forces do not properly separate from the physical body during sleep.

- **Healing:** St. John's Wort is understood to be an ideal combination of Water and Fire, and the ultimate healing essence. It is said to easily absorb and ground negative energies. It also works quickly to reverse negativity and quiet animosity or arguments existing between people. It is sometimes used as a tea to treat depression, and its leaves are woven into in a necklace in order to ward off sickness caused by tension.

SANDALWOOD (TAN XIANG)

There are two varieties of Sandalwood, white and red, both are used for magical purposes. White Sandalwood is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, its planetary correspondence is the Moon, and it is given as an offering for spiritual guidance (Figure 1.278). Red Sandalwood is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is used in Earth Magic, Love Magic and Prosperity Magic.

The scents of both Frankincense Resin and White Sandalwood have some of the highest vibrations inherent in any plant. They are said to resonate with the higher spiritual aspects of our inner-self, and with Celestial Immortals of the highest order.

It is interesting to note that in ancient times, if an individual was buried in a Sandalwood coffin, he could be dug up many years later and his features could still be observed exactly as he looked the day that he died. Sandalwood coffins preserve the body. However, within a few seconds in the open air, the body would dissolve into a pile of dust.

Figure 1.278. Sandalwood
Tan Xiang (santalum album)

- **Purification:** White Sandalwood is used as an incense in purification rituals, and is burned in order to clean the altar space. When burned, it emits very powerful spiritual vibrations, and is often used as a base ingredient in incense used for protection and healing,. It is also used in Sex Magic during full moon rituals (i.e., when mixed with Frankincense Resin).
- **Summoning:** When mixed with Lavender, White Sandalwood makes an incense designed to conjure spirits.
- **Protection:** Because it acts as a deflective shield, White Sandalwood has a long history of use in protection (removing or banishing evil spirits and hexes), as well as in summoning and conjuring spirits. White Sandalwood incense is almost always burned during exorcisms. White Sandalwood beads are considered to be protective, and they promote a spiritual awareness when worn. White Sandalwood powder can be scattered throughout an area in order to clear it of any negative energy.
- **Visions:** White Sandalwood is often used to stimulate clairvoyance and help induce visions.

Figure 1.279. Hai Ma (Sea Horse)

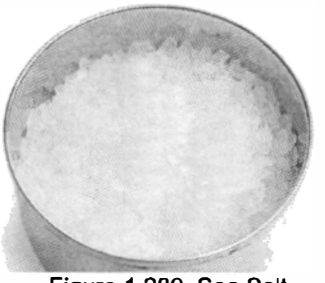


Figure 1.280. Sea Salt
Yan (Sodium chloride)

SEA HORSE (HAI MA)

The Sea Horse is a form of Pipe Fish or Sea Dragon (Figure 1.279). It is therefore associated with the Water Element. When used in Chinese Medicine, it helps to stimulate the Liver and Kidney Channels, increase Yang Qi, and Invigorate the Blood. In Daoist Magic, the Sea Horse corresponds to the magical realm of Scaly Creatures, and is sometimes used in order to represent the magical powers of the Dragon. Traditionally, the priest would place a special type of dried Sea Horse at the base of the statue, facing the direction of the East.

SEA SALT (YAN)

Sea Salt (Sodium chloride) has a long history of use in magical rituals for purification, protection, and blessing (Figure 1.280). When sea salt is placed on magical altars it is used to represent purity. Among spell-casters working in Daoist folk-magic traditions, it is commonplace to lay down a pinch of Sea Salt in each corner of a room before casting a spell.

Chinese folklore recounts the discovery of Sea Salt. Sea Salt production has been important in China for millennia. In 2700 B.C. the earliest known treatise on pharmacology was published in China, called the *Beng Zao Gan Mu*. A major portion of this writing was devoted to a discussion of more than 40 kinds of Sea Salt, including descriptions of two methods of extracting Sea Salt and putting it in usable form.

During the Xia Dynasty (2205-1600 B.C.) the Chinese emperor Xia Yu levied one of the first known taxes in 2200 B.C.; he taxed salt. The imperial government, realizing that everyone needed to consume salt, made salt taxes a major revenue source. In Tibet, Marco Polo noted that tiny cakes of salt were pressed with images of the Grand Khan and used as coins.

- **Purification:** Because ritual cleaning is an important facet of folk-magic, salt is a common ingredient used in certain spells that focus on magical protection from evil (especially breaking the energetic work of an enemy). This type of protective magic is accomplished through the use of ritual salt baths and salt floor washes.

  It is said that all life comes from the sea (i.e., we begin our lives as human fetuses submerged in amniotic fluid). In certain magical traditions it is taught that, salt is the solidified tears of God. God was so saddened by the spiritual and physical pollution overrunning the Earth that his tears formed the great oceans and seas. Because salt is derived from the emotion of God, a combination of water and salt are used by certain priests to clear all forms of negativity--even hatred.

  One type of "purification bath" used to remove a curse requires the priest to dissolve nine teaspoons of Sea Salt and a small amount of Saltpeter in hot bath water. The priest will undress and then bathe in the salt water purification mixture nine times. While soaking in the bath water, the priest will begin to rub from his or her body from the face downwards. Always use a downward stroking pattern in order to remove any impurities and toxic energy (i.e., never wash using upward strokes). After completing the nine ritual washes, take

Figure 1.281. Shun Feng Er (Ears That Hear The Wind)

Figure 1.282. Slippery Elm (Ulmus fulva)

the water and throw it towards the sunrise (before the Sun crests the horizon).

- **Protection:** Salt is said to repel evil spirits, and many believe that sprinkling Salt onto spilled oil has the power to drive away and exorcise evil. Sometimes, Black Salt is sprinkled on doorways in order to keep away undesirable influences.

  In certain magical traditions, when the intention of a spell is directed primarily for protection, salt may be used alone or combined with other herbal ingredients. For more aggressive spells against enemies (such as a Crossing Hex), salt may be added to energetically aggressive herbs such as Cayenne Pepper, Sulphur, and Bluestone.

  In certain magical traditions of Latin America, salt is used to prepare a very important magical formula called "Rattlesnake Salt," which is believed to lengthen the priest's life and to also provide protection for the home or place of business.

Shun Feng Er (Ears That Hear The Wind)

The term "Shun Feng Er" ("Ears That Hear The Wind"), is an ancient saying used to describe the effects that the Chinese Lobelia Herb had on a Daoist shaman when performing Weather Magic (Figure 1.281). It is considered to be an Element of Water, and it has the ability to facilitate a dreamy, relaxed state of mind. In Daoist Magic, Shun Feng Er is traditionally combined with other herbs and used for Altar Purification and Divination Rituals.

The primary uses for Chinese Lobelia can include the following:

- **Weather Magic:** By throwing the dried herb into the Wind while speaking a special magical incantations, or burning it during a magic ritual, the priest can summon the spirits of the Heavens (Sky) and ask for the manifestations of different types of weather.
- **Healing:** Sometimes known as Shun Feng Qi, the Chinese Lobelia Herb is commonly used in Chinese Medicine for treating snake-bites poisoning, centipede-bite poisoning, and bee or scorpion stings.
- **Love Magic:** It can be used for either initiating a love connection or creating a separation.
- **Nature Spirits:** It can be used for summoning or invoking Nature Spirits.

Slippery Elm

Slippery Elm is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is Saturn (Figure 1.282).

- **Protection:** Slippery Elm is a highly focused protection herb especially effective at controlling gossip or slander. Priests in one magical tradition will burn Slippery Elm and throw into its fire a yellow knotted cord to stop gossip and backbiting.

Figure 1.283. Solomon's Seal
Yu Zhu (Polygonatum officinale)

SOLOMON'S SEAL (YU ZHU)

Sometimes known as "Huang Jing" ("Yellow Essence"), Solomon's Seal is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Saturn (Figure 1.283).

- **Protection:** Solomon's Seal is used for protection and exorcism, and an infusion of the roots is sometimes sprinkled about an area to ward off evil. It is also considered to be an uncrossing herb, and therefore is sometimes used to reverse hexes and other malevolent magical spells.
- **Visions:** Solomon's Seal is said to stimulate psychic perceptions, initiate hunches, intuitions, and prophetic dreams.

STAR ANISE (BA JIAO)

This magical herb is also known as Illicium verum Hook. f. (Figure 1.284).

- **Meditation:** Star Anise is used in making incense. It is used for enhancing meditation and increasing psychic awareness. It has a sweet smell and is relaxing in nature.
- **Protection:** Sometimes Star Anise is placed on the altar to give the altar power; one flower is placed to each of the four directions.

STAR ANISE SEEDS (BA JIAO)

Anise Seeds (Bājiǎo - meaning "eight-horn" or "eight-corners") is associated with the Wood / Air Element, and its planetary correspondence is Jupiter (Figure 1.285).

- **Summoning:** Anise Seeds can be used to increase the strength of a priest's spells, and it is sometimes used to call forth spirits in order to aid in magical rituals.

Figure 1.284. Star Anise
(Ba Jiao)

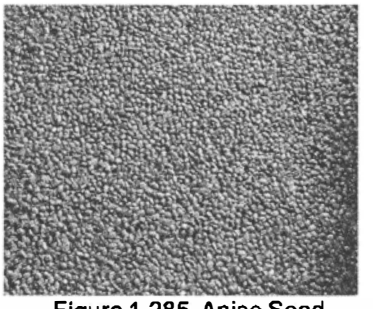


Figure 1.285. Anise Seed
Ba Jiao (Anisi stell. Fructus, Illicium verum)

- **Protection:** Anise Seeds are sometimes used in the construction of protection and meditation incenses. This herb is specifically used to drive off obsessing spirits, especially those that focus on disrupting the emotional self. In ancient times, Anise was used in "dream pillows" in order to ward off disturbing dreams and to offer protection to the spiritual body when entering into the dreaming state.

  Fresh anise leaves placed in a room will drive off evil, and they are sometimes placed around the magic circle to protect the magician from evil spirits. It also averts the "Evil Eye." Filling a small pillowcase with Anise seeds and sleeping on it is said to ensure that you have no nightmares.

  Anise is also carried as a good luck charm, and the seeds make excellent pendulums. The tree is often grown near Buddhist temples where it is revered.
- **Invisibility:** Anise Seeds can be used to make oneself invisible to the spirit world when used as a tincture after taking a cleansing bath. First boil the herb as a tea, and then apply

Figure 1.286. Chinese Sweet Gum
Feng Shu (Liquidambar formosana)

Figure 1.287. Thistle
Da Ji (Cephalanoplos Setosum)

the tincture externally over your naked body after taking a bath or shower (do not place the tincture onto your eyes, face, or head).

- **Visions:** Anise raises the priest's vibrations to the highest possible psychic level. The seeds (mixed with Camphor) are burned as incense to increase psychic powers, and they are also worn as beads for the same purpose. Anise is said to be good for any type of clairvoyance, divination, or mental training exercises. It is also good for astral travel, dreams, scrying, and meditation. It is often used in Aromatherapy as an incense that is burned while meditating. Additionally, Anisette (liquor made out of Anise) is used during Voodoo initiations to anoint the disciple's head.
- **Love:** Anise seeds were carried in order to avert evil or strengthen passion, or just for good luck.
- **Healing:** Good for bringing about changes in attitude (re-focusing), Anise is commonly carried in a sachet and used to stabilize the emotions, clear depression, and uplift and balance the Shen (allowing the conscious self to attune with the higher self). Anise seed is also used in purification baths, especially with Bay Leaves. A stimulant and diuretic, Anise promotes digestion and relieves flatulence.

Sweet Gum (Feng Shu)

Similar to that of a maple tree, the large Sweet Gum tree produces a fragrant gum resembling liquid amber. Sometimes known as copalm balsam, this clear, reddish, or yellow colored resin is used primarily in making magical incense (Figure 1.286). Because this turpentine like resin has a sweet, fragrant, pleasant smell, it is used in creating Offering incense smoke.

Thistle (Da Ji)

Thistle is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mars (Figure 1.287).

- **Purification:** It is said that a bowl of Thistle placed in a room will strengthen the energy and renew the vitality of all who are in the room.
- **Summoning:** In order to call spirits, Thistle is placed in boiling water. The water is then removed from the fire and the priest sits or lies beside it. As the steam rises, the priest will conjure the spirits, ask their questions and listen to their answers.
- **Protection:** Thistle can be burned as an incense or scattered on the floors for protection and to exorcise evil. It can also used to counteract hexing. When carried, Thistle blossom is said to protect against evil. In ancient times, it was believed that when thrown onto a fire, Thistle would deflect lightning away from the house. Hexing dolls are sometimes stuffed with Thistle in order to protect an individual and to counter a curse.
- **Healing:** Thistle is said to drive out melancholy when worn or carried.

Figure 1.288. Thyme
Bai Li Xiang (Thymus vulgaris)

Figure 1.289. Tormentil
(Potentill tormentilla)

THYME (BAI LI XIANG)

Thyme is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus (Figure 1.288).

- **Purification:** Thyme is burned as an incense for the purification of magical spaces prior to rituals. Thyme is considered to be a house blessing herb. Thyme is often mixed with Marjoram (especially in Spring) to create a magical cleansing bath. This purification bath is used to remove all sorrows and ills of the past year. For this reason Thyme is often burned or carried in healing rituals as well.

  Because it cleanses and renews the spirit, and calls divine forces to one's side, a bath containing Thyme Oil is sometimes used for serious purification, especially after performing an exorcism, or having come in contact with death.
- **Protection:** Thyme can be used for protection, especially from the negative energy of others. When added to magical elixirs, Thyme is generally used in combination with other magical ingredient (i.e., it is primarily used to amplify the magical powers other essences).
- **Visions:** Thyme is sometimes used to induce psychic vision (it is said that if you wear Thyme you will be able to see Nature Spirits). Thyme is also useful in past-life therapies, as it can help the priest energetically attune to future lives and project into the past or future.
- **Healing:** Thyme is burned as an incense in order to encourage health. It is also used in healing spells. The aroma is said to revitalize strength and courage. When placed beneath a pillow, Thyme is said to ensure a peaceful sleep. Clinically, Thyme can be used to accelerate healing. It helps govern the body's natural metabolic processes and helps initiate a balances between the body's anabolic and catabolic processes. Additionally, Thyme slightly benefits the thymus gland.

TORMENTIL

Tormentil is a commanding herb (i.e., often used to command respect) that can be used for good or ill (Figure 1.289). Traditionally, it is used equally in cursing and protection (and is also frequently used in matters of love). For example, an infusion of Tormentil is drunk in order to give protection, or is served to a loved one to keep their love. Tormentil is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun.

- **Protection:** In ancient times, priests would traditionally drink an infusion made out of Tormentil in order to guard themselves against permanent possession by spirits. The plant was sometimes hung in the home to drive away evil.
- **Love:** Tormentil is sometimes carried in order to attract love.

Figure 1.290. Turmeric
Yu Jin (Cucurma longa)

Figure 1.291. Valerian
Xie Cao (Valeriana officinalis)

TURMERIC (YU JIN)

Turmeric, (Goldenseal) is used in purification and in Dream Magic (Figure 1.290).

- **Purification:** Yu Jin can be scattered on the floor to purify, consecrate, and protect a magic circle, or it can be mixed with salt water and sprinkled around the altar in order to purify the area.
- **Summon:** It is said that Yu Jin purifies a space because spirits are drawn to its heat. It can therefore also be used to lead and control spirits.
- **Visions:** Yu Jin tea has been also shown to enhance dream imagery, increase vividness, prolong REM periods, and initiate dream recall. In order to make an effective Tormentil tea, add about half a teaspoon of the orange powdery ground root into hot water and mix thoroughly. The ground Yu Jin root is also steeped in hot water and drank as a tea to increase life expectancy and clear the mind.

VALERIAN (XIE CAO)

Valerian can sometimes be substituted for "Graveyard Dust" (Figure 1.291). Valerian is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus.

- **Purification:** Valerian can be used as a consecrating incense to cleans the altar space. Priests in certain magical traditions will drink Valerian tea daily (in moderate doses) during times of purification.
- **Protection:** When powdered, Valerian can be used in protective sachets. It can also be thrown onto burning charcoal or wooden fire pits to remove or banish evil spirits and hexes. It is sometimes hung in a home in order to guard against lightning, or placed in pillows to aid falling asleep.
- **Visions:** Valerian aids psychic powers, is used for Dream Magic, and is sometimes used in order to induce visions and initiate Soul (astral) Projection.
- **Love:** Valerian root can be added to love sachets or used in love spells and mixtures. It is especially used to soothe and settle tension or calm quarrelling in a relationship.
- **Healing:** Valerian is sometimes used to combat anxiety and depression, as well as relieve panic attacks and tension headaches. Valerian is also sometimes used as a muscle relaxant and as a tranquilizer.

VERVAIN

Vervain is one of the best herbs for magical purposes in general, and it can be put to use in nearly any kind of magic ritual. It may also be added to any neutral magic preparation for increasing its effect. Any part of the plant may be carried as a personal amulet (Figure 1.292). Vervain is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Earth Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus.

- **Purification:** Vervain is commonly used in the ritual cleansing of sacred spaces, in magical

Figure 1.292. Vervain
(Verbena officinalis)

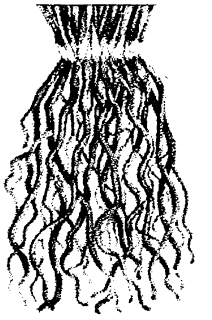


Figure 1.293. Vetivert
(Andropogon zizanioides)

cleansing baths, and in purification incenses. It not only purifies the altar space, but also powerfully charges the area and immediately raises the consciousness of all who enter into the sacred space.

- **Summoning:** It is said that a crown of Vervain placed on the head will protect a priest while he or she is invoking spirit entities.
- **Protection:** Vervain is said to ease the burden of the soul and drive away evil spirits. It is commonly used to protect against all forms of enchantment (i.e., when burnt it dispels unrequited love). An infusion of Vervain is sometimes sprinkled around the home to chase off evil spirits or malignant energies. In ancient times, it was hung over the bed in order to prevent nightmares.

  It is said that Vervain will clear a space of Nature spirits if they are weak, or it can cause an area the immediately become uncomfortable for certain types of spirit entities.
- **Visions:** Vervain has a particular magical power that is of great use in visionary work. It is believed that if the juice is smeared on the body, the priest will be allowed to see into the future.
- **Prosperity:** Vervain is also an excellent herb for prosperity charms and spells, as it brings good luck and inspiration. If it is buried in the garden or placed in the house, it is said that wealth will flow and plants will thrive.
- **Love:** Vervain is a common ingredient in love mixtures. It has a reputation as an aphrodisiac and is used in many magical traditions in the construction of love charms. Vervain is also said to turn enemies into friends. The dried herb is scattered around the home as a peace-bringer and is also worn to calm the emotions.
- **Healing:** Vervain is sometimes used to combat nervous exhaustion, paranoia, insomnia, and depression.

VETIVERT

Technically considered to be a power herb, Vetivert may be used to strengthen hexing formulas. However, one of Vetivert greatest abilities is its magical power to un-cross a hex (Figure 1.293). Vetivert is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Earth Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus.

- **Protection:** Vetivert root is burned to overcome evil spells, and it is excellent for uncrossing (reversing hexes). It is sometimes added to Protection Sachets and is believed to "knot up" any enemy who conspires against you.
- **Prosperity:** Vetivert is also used in money spells and formulas, and it can be carried in order to attract luck and burned in anti-theft incenses.
- **Love:** Vetivert is also used in love powders, sachets, and incenses, and it is added to the bath water in a sachet in order to make yourself attractive to the opposite sex.

Figure 1.294. Bai She (White Tongue)

Figure 1.295. Wormwood
Yang Ai (Artemisia absinthium)

WHITE TONGUE (BAI SHE)

Also known as "Bai Hua She She Cao" (Oldenlandia Corymbosa) this herb was not mentioned in the classic herbals, but has been a popular folk medicine that was later reported in books and medical records after the Chinese revolution. Bai Hua She She Cao is known as the common weed (Figure 1.294), used for treating the venomous bite of a viper. Because of the appearance of the leaves, it is sometimes called "She Cao" ("Tongue Weed"); referring to the long thin leaves of the herb that are shaped like a snake's tongue.

It is extensively used in modern Chinese Medicine for the treatment of viral infections, and used as a preventive measure against toxic heat diseases.

What is special about the Oldenlandia Corymbosa herb, is that it has auto-fluorescence abilities. Meaning, that its biological structures possess the natural ability to emit light. According to modern research, in a few cases, auto-fluorescence actually illuminated the structures of interest. This herb is commonly used when stuffing Daoist Altar Statues.

WORMWOOD (YANG AI)

Wormwood is often used in initiation rites and tests of courage (Figure 1.295). According to ancient magical traditions, Wormwood is said to counteract the effects of poisoning by Hemlock and Toadstools. Wormwood is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature; it is associated with the Fire Element, and its planetary correspondence is Mars.

- **Summoning:** Wormwood burned in graveyards is said to make the spirits of the dead rise and speak. It also enables the dead to be released from the physical realm, so that they may find peace.
- **Protection:** Wormwood is sometimes burned to gain protection from rogue spirit entities. When carried, the herb is said to protect the priest from bewitchment.
- **Visions:** Wormwood is burned to aid in developing psychic power or mixed with White Sandalwood to summon spirits.
- **Divination:** Wormwood is used in divination and clairvoyance incenses.
- **Love:** Wormwood is sometimes used in love potions, and it is made into an alcoholic beverage called "Absinthe." Although this dangerous liqueur is now banned in many countries, its reputation as a love stimulant lingers.

YARROW (SHI)

Yarrow usually grows in clusters and can be easily identified by its soft feathery leaves occurring in alternation along a single stem. Yarrow usually grows between one and two feet tall but can occasionally be shorter in heigth, and may be smooth-or rough-textured (Figure 1.296). Yarrow blossoms are very small, with two separate, distinct male (Yang) and female (Yin) flowers. The yellow centered female flowers are surrounded by five white Male petals (each one of which is considered a male flower). Yarrow is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Venus.

Figure 1.296. Yarrow
Shi (Achillea millefolium)

Yarrow is called "Shi" in Chinese and is said to grow in exceptionally plentiful amounts at the grave of Confucius. According to a Chinese legend, one hundred Yarrow stalks grew from a single root. When the plant was a thousand years old, three hundred stalks had grown from the root. Such was the power of this plant that wolves, tigers, and poisonous plants would never be found near it.

In ancient China, stalks from a closely related species (Achillea sibirica) are the source of the famous "stalks of divination" used in consulting the Yi-Jing (Book of Changes). These stalks were sold in parcels of sixty-four, and their length was very important. For the Son of Heaven (the emperor) the stalks were nine feet in length; for feudal princes, seven feet; for high dignitaries and government officials, five feet long; and for graduates of the imperial boards, three feet.

- **Protection:** Yarrow offers protection from negative influences such as radioactive fallout and thought forms (i.e., from psychic attacks or extreme emotionalism). Pink Yarrow is better for protection against negative emotions, while White Yarrow offers better protection against radiation.

  When applied externally, Yarrow can be used to strengthen the body's channel system, enhance the body's Wei Qi field (aura), and balance the body's upper and lower electromagnetic poles.

  If a priest ingests Yarrow over a long period of time, he or she said to gradually develop telepathy and the ability to levitate. It can also be used internally to energetically stabilize priests working with emotionally disturbed people, so that they do not become too empathic with those individuals.

  Yarrow is sometimes used to exorcise evil, and when worn, it protects the wearer from negativity. When held in the hand, Yarrow is said to stop all fear and grant courage. When carried as a sachet or amulet, it is said to repel all negative influences.

  Yarrow was strewn across the threshold of a house to keep out evil influences and was worn to guard against evil spells. In ancient times, people sometimes tied sprigs of Yarrow to a baby's crib in order to protect the infant from priests who might try to steal the child's soul.
- **Visions:** Yarrow is said to promotes pleasant dreams, and a tea brewed from its leaves can be drunk in order to increase clairvoyant powers. Its twigs were used in ancient China for divination.
- **Love:** Yarrow is often carried to bring love and attract friends. It is often used in wedding decorations to ensure a long lasting marriage, and is therefore used in many love spells and in constructing love charms. It is said that a bunch of dried Yarrow hung over the bed or used in wedding decorations ensures a love lasting at least seven years. Carrying Yarrow not only brings love, but it also attracts any friends and distant relations whom you wish to contact.
- **Healing:** Yarrow is considered to be a common weed with uncommon healing powers. It is used to dispel melancholy, negativity, lingering sorrow, and depression, and it was also said to be useful in improving respiration, skin, and muscle tone. If taken over a long period of time, Yarrow was believed to increase intelligence. Yarrow is also a good remedy for colds (i.e., it opens the pores and purifies the blood).

VISIONARY PLANTS

The energetic action of "visionary plants" is the ability to induce the visual images of the energetic and spiritual realm. The hallucinations are usually so complex that a clear-cut definition and classification of them has not yet been found. Traditionally, psychoactive plants are divided into five categories: Excitantia, Inebriantia, Hypnotica, Euphorica, and Phantastica.

None of these plants has stirred deeper interest than the Phantastica. These plants "bring about evident cerebral excitation in the form of hallucinations, illusions, and visions (followed by unconsciousness or other symptoms of altered cerebral functioning).

Differing from the other psychotropic drugs (which act normally only to calm or to stimulate), these hallucinogens act on the central nervous system to bring about a dream-like state marked by extreme alteration in the sphere of experience, perceptions of reality, changes of space and time, and of the consciousness. They invariably induce a series of visual hallucinations, often in kaleidoscopic movement, and usually in rather indescribably brilliant and rich colors, frequently accompanied by auditory and other hallucinations and a variety of synesthesias.

A psychotomimetic is a "substance which produces changes in thought, perception, and mood, occurring alone or in conjunction with each other, without causing major disturbances of the autonomic nervous system (i.e., clouding of consciousness or other serious disability)." High doses generally elicit hallucinations, disorientation, memory disturbance, hyper-excitation or stupor, and even narcosis (occur only when excessive dosages are administered). Nearly all of these hallucinogenic substances are derived from the Plant Kingdom or else are chemically related to naturally occurring compounds.

HISTORY

Many of these visual effects are so unearthly, so unreal, that most, if not all, of the hallucinogenic plants acquired in primitive societies often become viewed as sacred (i.e., the object of direct worship). In almost all primitive cultures, sickness and death are believed to be due to interference from supernatural realms. For this reason, the psychic effects of drugs are often far more important in primitive medicinal practices than the purely physical ones.

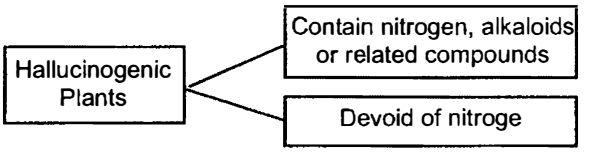


Figure 1.297. Visionary Plants

Consequently, hallucinogens above all other plants are found closely connected with Daoist magic and ancient sorcery, especially in the treatment of disease and death, and in relation to religious observances.

Hallucinogens occur widely separated in the Plant Kingdom, concentrated especially in two unrelated areas of the vegetal world. While most are spermatophytes, some of the biologically, chemically, and sociologically most fascinating are found amongst the cryptogams, especially the fungi. In tropical countries, a hot Sun, humid air, and teeming soil, give extraordinary energy to vegetable life. The natives of these regions often recognize the existence of potent herbs unknown to the European practitioner.

Chemically, hallucinogenic plants may be separated into two groups (Figure 1.297):

- Those that have active organic constituents that contain nitrogen, most of which are alkaloids or related compounds
- Those that have active organic constituents that are devoid of nitrogen.

THE USE OF PSYCHOACTIVE PLANTS

It is an excepted fact in ancient magical practices, that the mind is not generated by the physical brain. Rather, the mind is viewed as something above and beyond the physical body, that is aware of reality at a far deeper level then most individual's experience. The brain simply acts as a "reducing valve," filtering out those impressions that are not currently useful for everyday survival. Psychedelic substances such as psychoactive plants and many spiritual disciplines (i.e., those that incorporate deep meditative states) all assist the individual in reducing the efficiency of the brain as a filter. This allows more energetic impressions of the mind-at-large to be received. Far from being hallucinatory, these energetic impressions are experienced by priests as indirect glimpses of reality, flowing in to the mind at levels that an individual cannot normally access.

Sacred plants should always be approached with due respect and should never be taken simply for pure entertainment value. Drug-induced visionary journeys can have a profound impact on the psyche, sometimes with long lasting effects. It is recommended that no-one attempt such a journey without the guidance and support of an experienced priest or shaman. In traditional societies it is customary to undergo a cleansing process prior to engaging in any kind of trance or visionary work. Utmost importance is placed on mental, emotional, and physical preparation and purification to ensure a beneficial outcome of the ritual. Failure to undergo these preparations lays the disciple wide open for a trip into the energetic realms of hell or worse (sometimes causing lasting effects of mental derangement and paranoia). Sacred plants only provide the key to other dimensions, but what is to be found there depends on the mental and psychological state of the initiate.

The Daoists of ancient China seem to have made use of the fly-agaric mushroom, and often make reference to the "Divine Mushroom of Immortality." The writings of ancient China are full of many references to other psychoactive fungi. There is even an ancient Daoist work called "On the Planting and Cultivation of Magic Mushrooms."

Hallucinogenic species of Panaeolus or Pholiota have been identified as the fungi referred to in early Chinese accounts as Xiao Qun or "Laughing Mushroom." Magic Mushrooms such as Fu-ling (a parasitic fungus that grows on the roots of the pine tree) and Polyporus cocos or Poria (Pachyma) cocos are also considered to be an "Immortal Medicine" in ancient Chinese tradition. The ancient Chinese Buddhist text called the Tripitaka (Da Zang) contains an account of a sage taking refuge in the mountains in order to meditate and consume mushroom elixirs.

Hemp fiber has been found to date as far back as 4000 BC in ancient China. It was described as Ma-fen (Hemp-fruit) in China where a legendary emperor of 2000 BC said "If taken to excess, it will cause you to see devils. If taken over a long time it makes one communicate with spirits and lightens one's body." Chinese Emperor Shen-Nung in 2737 BC recommended it for a variety of uses (from treating malaria to absent-mindedness). A Daoist priest in 500 BC noted that Cannabis "was employed by necromancers, in combination with Ginseng to set forward time and reveal future events."

SPIRITUAL AWAKENING THROUGH HERBS

In Sanskrit, the method of "Awakening through Herbs" is called "Aushadhi." Any Awakening achieved in this manner, can (under the right circumstances), replicate the third level of realization with the ability of obtaining the power of transformation. The power and experience of an "Herbal Awakening" can be initiated very quickly, although it can also be an extremely risky and unreliable method. Therefore, it is written in ancient texts that the herbs used to awaken this energetic potentiality should only be obtained and administered through the protection and guidance of a qualified master. The reason for such restrictions is that there are certain herbs that only awaken the body's Yin and there are others that only awaken the body's Yang; additionally, there are also certain mind awakening herbs that can suppress either or both Yin and Yang states.

In the *Yoga Sutras of Patanjali* (Chapter IV, verse 1), it states: "The power of Siddhis (spiritual attainments) can come because of previous Karma and genetics, from herbs (Aushadhis), the use of Mantras, the kindling of the psychic fire (Kundalini), and / or from Samadhi (spiritual enlightenment)."

Using the powers of the Siddhis a person can become capable of flying in the skies and traveling from one place to another in just a few seconds. Although there are several occasions of individuals flying reported in the Sutras of classical Buddhism and Zen, the Venerable Pindola Bharadvaja is probably the person most commonly cited.

Plants listed in this section are those which have a long history of use by the ancient Daoists for their mind altering properties.

- Amanita muscaria
- Cannabis sativa
- Datura
- Lagochilus Inebrians
- Mitragyna Speciosa
- Nymphaea Caerulea
- Ololiuqui
- Papaver Somniferum
- Peganum harmala

According to one ancient shaman tradition, the method of "Awakening through Herbs" is divided into three separate categories: Mushrooms, Plants, and Cactus. These are described as follows:

MUSHROOMS

The use of hallucinogenic mushrooms and Puffballs is very ancient and an integral part of ancient Chinese mysticism. Sometimes known as Ling Zhi (Magic Mushroom), Yin Zhi (Concealed Mushroom), and Zhi Cao (Mushroom Plants), these special types of mushrooms were said to grow spontaneously in mystical places or on special mountains that also produce precious minerals.

The term "Zhi" refers to a variety of supernatural substances, often described as magical plants, fungi, or abnormal outgrowths.

From earliest times, hallucinogenic mushrooms have been worshipped by certain primitive cultures scattered from Mexico to Borneo and Siberia. The visions are staggering in their subjective impact. They are no shadowy, uncertain sights; you are spellbound, held in awe by feelings of wonder and reverence. You experience an overflowing sense of empathy and "oneness" towards those who are sharing the mushrooms and the spiritual experience with you.

The ancient Daoist priests believed that the magic mushrooms opened the gates to another plane of existence, to both the past and future, as well as to the various Heavenly realms and Celestial Immortals. Through accessing these esoteric realms, the priest was able to receive various answers to the grave questions that haunted him.

The magic mushrooms allowed the priest to obtain the ability of learning how to handle spiritual powers. They enabled him to fly within the energetic and spiritual realms, as well as transform his cultivated Qi into the magical image of any energetic pattern.

In ancient China, many priests associate these special types of mushrooms with female divine beings, and considered them to be auspicious omens sent by Heaven. It was believed that ingesting them would confer longevity and immortality to the degree equivalent to that of an alchemical elixir.

The ancient Daoist Master Ge Hong was known to distinguish five categories of mushrooms based on their shape. Each category was said to include more than 100 varieties. The five categories of mushroom described the following:

Figure 1.298. "Zhi-Mushrooms of Immortality" (Left to Right) Red Jade, China Root, Zho Spirit with Female Guardian, and Metal Essence)

- The Stone Mushroom (Shi Zhi)
- The Wood Mushroom (Mu Zhi)
- The Plant Mushroom (Cao Zhi)
- The Flesh Mushroom (Rou Zhi)
- The Mushroom Mushroom (Jun Zhi)

According to Master Ge Hong, "Unless the deities and spirits of a mountain agree to disclose the location of this special mushroom, one could even step right over them without seeing them." Additionally, ascending into one of the sacred mountains in order to collect the Magic Mushrooms required a priest to perform preliminary purification rites, Qigong and Shengong meditations, as well as Star Stepping Pattern known as the "Steps of Yu."

It is interesting to note that these special mushrooms were known for their ability to continuously radiate light. For example, according to Ge Hong, the Shi Xiang Zhi (Stone - Elephant Mushroom) yielded a light "visible by night at 100 feet;" The Qi Ming Jiu Quang Zhi (7 Brilliancies and 9 Radiances Mushroom) issued a brightness at night that resembled the light of the stars. It was said that these special lights were visible at 100 feet, and each beam could be clearly distinguished from the others, extending outward without merging with the others.

According to the Shangqing text, the *Ming jian Yaojing (The Essential Scriptures of the Bright Mirror)*, the best Magic Mushrooms are those growing above deposits of cinnabar, gold, malachite and realgar. This ancient text further describes how to plant these minerals in the four directions of a mountain region at the solstices and equinoxes so that they would generate these special mushrooms.

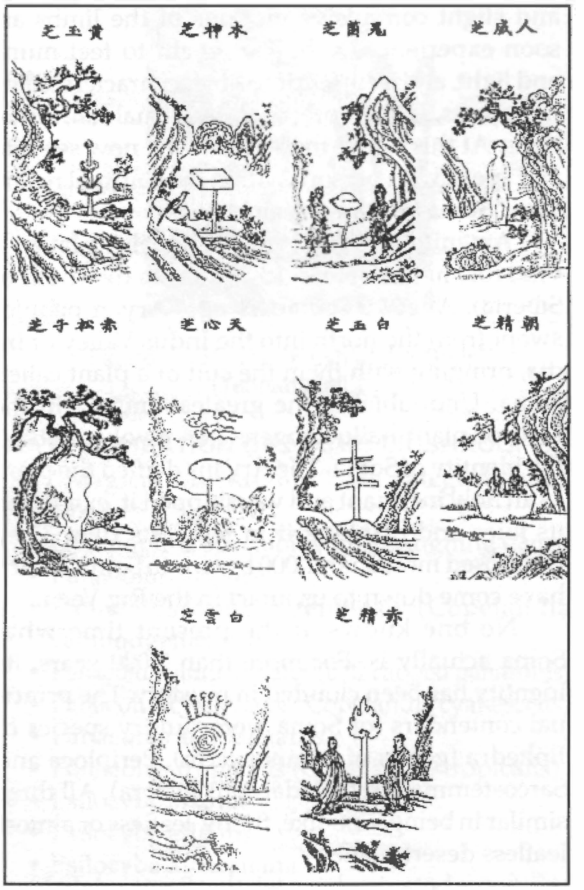


Figure 1.299. "Mushrooms of Immortality" (Zhi Mushrooms)

According to the ancient Daoist text, *The Catalog of Mushrooms of Immortality,* there are 127 mushrooms or "Herbs of Long Life."

The Zhi fungus plays an important role in the Maoshan Daoist tradition. There are numerous texts concerning Zhi listed in the Song () Bibliographies. These important texts included several illustrations, along with magical powers ascribed to these special fungus (Figure 1.298 and Figure 1.299).

It is said that there were five kinds of Zhi mushrooms growing on Maoshan.

AMANITA MUSCARIA

This herb is considered to be Yang, Masculine in nature, its Element corresponds to Air, and its planetary correspondence is Mercury (Figure 1.300). It is said that this herb is like a strong but detached man, and is to be approached and treated with respect.

Figure 1.300. "Fly Agaic" (Amanita Muscaria)

In ancient China, Flying Agaric (Amanita Muscaria) was also known as the "Miracle Working Zhi," "Mushroom of the Spirits," "Miraculous Mushroom," and "Auspicious Mushroom." It is the oldest and most widespread in use of the hallucinogenic mushrooms. It grows throughout the north-temperate parts of both hemispheres, although it has long been recognized as a toxic plant. It was extensively used as an hallucinogenic agent in Siberia.

The Daoists of ancient China seem to have made use of the fly-agaric mushroom, and often make reference to it as the "Divine Mushroom of Immortality." The writings of ancient China overflow with many other references to psychoactive fungi, and there is even an ancient Daoist work called *"On the Planting and Cultivation of Magic Mushrooms."*

The Chinese Buddhist text called the Tripitaka (Da Zang) contains an account of a sage taking refuge in the mountains in order to meditate and consume mushroom elixirs. Additionally, there are frescoes decorating the Koguryo tombs of Korea that depict Daoist Immortals and their female consorts (known as Jade Girls), picking "magic mushrooms."

A twelfth-century Chinese official berated the followers of a Manichaean religion for consuming the fly-agaric mushrooms as part of their religious observances.

Harvesting

Amanita muscaria was usually not taken fresh; they were collected in the hottest seasons and hung up by a string in the air to dry. Some

varieties of this mushroom dry naturally (either by themselves, or on the ground) and are said to be far more narcotic than those artificially preserved. Small deep colored specimens, thickly covered with warts, are also said to be more powerful than those of a larger size and paler color.

Ingestion

Generally, only male shaman ate the fly agaric. The method of using the mushroom varied significantly amongst the various ancient tribes. Traditionally, the women moistened and softened the agarics in their mouth, then rolled them by hand into small sausage-like shapes, and gave them to the men to swallow. The hot, burning taste often induced vomiting, so they were usually swallowed whole.

There is much diversity of opinion concerning the length of the induced intoxication. Usually the effects of three or four dried or smoked mushrooms might last from four hours to a full day. The condition of the mushrooms when gathered, their treatment after collection, and the way in which they are ingested all significantly influenced the length and strength of the intoxication. An average dose was three mushrooms-often one large one and two smaller ones; however, when a longer and more powerful effect was desired, sometimes up to ten or twelve mushrooms were ingested.

Some shamans chewed the plant and held it in their mouth for a long time before swallowing it. Other means of using the agaric involved adding it to teas, alcoholic elixirs, or soups; or steeping it in juice of the Bog Wortle Berry (Vaccinium Uliginosum), or the Willow-herb (Epilobium Angustifolium).

The ancient shamans believed that the spirits of the mushroom often play practical jokes on a person under their influence, but they also guide him to other realms or guard him from harm in this world.

As with all drugs, the physical and mental condition of the individual greatly influenced the intoxicating effects of Amanita Muscaria. The intoxication sets in usually about an hour after ingestion of the mushrooms. Twitching, trembling, and slight convulsive motions of the limbs are soon experienced. The feet begin to feel numb and light, and a euphoric feeling, characterized by happiness, is then preceded by visual hallucinations. At this point, the shaman can now see into and speak with persons within the spiritual realm.

The "Soma" of the Aryans

Amanita muscaria may have also played a vital role in Indian magic (i.e., far to the south of Siberia). About 3,500 years ago, Aryan peoples swept from the north into the Indus Valley of India, bringing with them the cult of a plant called Soma. Undoubtedly the greatest enigma in the field of plant hallucinogens has revolved about the identity of Soma. The Aryans deified the plant as an holy inebriant and worshipped it, extracting its juice and drinking it in religious rites. They composed more than 1,000 hymns to Soma, which have come down to us intact in the Rig Veda.

No one knows at the present time what Soma actually is. For more than 2,000 years, its identity has been clouded in mystery. The principal contenders for Soma were sundry species of Ephedra (genus of gymnosperm), Periploca and Sarcostemma (asclepiadaceous genera). All three similar in being vine-like, fleshy, leafless or almost leafless desert plants.

Some botanists have felt that Soma might have been cannabis, others that it was wholly mythical and never was derived from a plant. However, to some anthropologists, the true soma was a mushroom, the fly agaric (Amanita muscaria). This identification appears to be the first species that satisfies all of the many intricately interlocking pieces of indirect evidence.

THE MUSHROOMS OF MEXICO

One of the several important native religious cults that the Spanish conquerors found in Mexico was one in which intoxicating mushrooms were consumed much as a sacrament. These mushrooms were so revered that the Aztecs called them Teonanacatl or "Flesh of the Gods" (Figure 1.301). The natives ate the mushroom Teonanacatl with honey and it "caused the individual to see visions, feel a faintness of heart, and be provoked to lust."

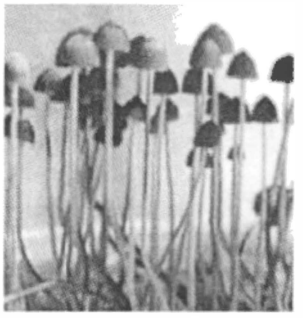


Figure 1.301. The "Flesh of the Gods" (Teonanacatl)

CATEGORIZATION OF MAGIC MUSHROOMS

"Magical Mushrooms" are categorized as follows:

- Gymnopilus spectabilis (Big Laughing Gym)
- Panaeolus bispora
- Panaeolus cambodgeniensis (Copelandia cambodgeniensis)
- Panaeolus campanulatus (bell-capped panaeolus)
- Panaeolus cyanescens (Copelandia cyanescens)
- Panaeolus subbalteatus
- Panaeolus tropicalis (Copelandia tropicalis)
- Psilocybe arcana
- Psilocybe atlantis
- Psilocybe australiana
- Psilocybe aztecorum
- Psilocybe azurescens
- Psilocybe baeocystis (potent psilocybe)
- Psilocybe bohemica
- Psilocybe coprophila
- Psilocybe crobulus
- Psilocybe cubensis (Cubes, Stropharia cubensis)
- Psilocybe cyanescens (Wavy Caps)
- Psilocybe hoogshagenii
- Psilocybe mexicana
- Psilocybe muscorum
- Psilocybe pelliculosa (Conifer Psilocybe)
- Psilocybe samuiensis
- Psilocybe semilanceata (Liberty Cap)
- Psilocybe subaeruginosa
- Psilocybe subcubensis
- Psilocybe tampanensis
- Psilocybe weilii

Figure 1.302. Belladonna (Atropa belladonna)

PLANTS

The use of hallucinogenic "Spirit Plants" is very ancient and an integral part of ancient Chinese mysticism. From earliest times, hallucinogenic plants have been highly valued In the traditions of every culture for their nourishing, healing, and transformative properties. The most powerful plants—those known to transport the human mind into other dimensions of consciousness—have traditionally been regarded as sacred. The most common of these plants are described as follows:

BELLADONNA (DIAN KAI)

This herb is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence is Saturn. Belladonna (also known as "Deadly Nightshade" and "Eye of Newt") is high toxic. In ancient times, certain magical traditions used it to induce Spirit Travel (Traveling Clairvoyance), Soul Traveling (Astral Projection), and to promote psychic visions. It is believed to be one of the herbal ingredient in the legendary "Flying" ointments used by witches of Western magic (Figure 1.302). The berries can be crushed and added to incense formula or herbal ointments in order to stimulate clairvoyant powers.

The berries can also be sprinkled outside on the home in order to ward off evil spirits and demonic entities. However, when using it in banishing rituals, keep in mind it's toxicity level (i.e., Belladonna's reaction time is several hours to several days).

CANNABIS (MA)

This herb is considered to be Feminine in nature, its Element corresponds to Water, and its planetary correspondence is Saturn (Figure 1.303).

Cannabis, Marijuana, or Hemp (as was commonly named), has been used for thousands of years for its magical properties. It was once widely used in Daoist magic, and was part of many herbal incense formulae used to induce visions and for scrying (the smoke was believed to open the priest's psychic senses). Both Mugwort (Ai Ye) and Hemp (Ma) were prescribed to be burned together before a magic mirror in order to gain visions. Hemp was also added to meditation incenses.

Scourges made of Hemp were used in China as imitation snakes, which were beat against the beds of the sick to drive away the malicious, illness causing demons.

Its psychotropic effects were known by the ancient Mao Shan Zheng Yi Daoist sect, who often used it as an aid to divination, and it also played an important part in many traditional love spells.

The Mao Shan Daoists feature cannabis as a deity named "Ma Ku" (translated as "Miss Hemp" or the "Hemp Lady"). She appears in the literature which emerged from ancient Mao Shan Daoism. In ancient China, the Upper Clarity School of Daoism worshipped cannabis, or at least personified it as one of the countless myriads of Immortal figures that populated the dream-world of Mao Shan. The few references to Ma Ku in ancient works always associate her with the dilation of time-sense, a psychotropic effect noted by all cannabis users.

According to Professor Michael Saso, the sacred scriptures of the Mao Shan "Upper Clarity" sect were revealed under the influence of a "hemp-laced incense" (which may refer to the archaic Siberian technique of the smoke-filled tent). The ancient Mao Shan tradition emphasized neither the "philosophical" Daoism of the *Daodejing* and *Zhuangzi*, nor the "communal" Daoism of the anarchic Yellow Turbans and the Zhang Family. Instead, it developed a highly individualized magical practice based on Shengong training. The Mao Shan or Shang Qing ("Upper Clarity") adept focused on meditations based on "aimless wandering" in a world of imagination that was shared by all initiates and codified in elaborate fantasy-geographies of mountains, grottoes, undersea cities, distant island utopias, the Hollow Earth, the cloud-palaces of the skies, and outer space. As alchemists, the Mao Shan adepts made free use of various drugs to enhance their visualizations, including mysterious and magical mushrooms, herbs, and mineral preparations.

Figure 1.303. Hemp (Cannabis sativa)

Hemp appears in very early Chinese pharmacopoeias, in ancient Chinese medicine, Huo Ma Ren ("Fire Hemp Seeds") were commonly used to treat Large Intestine, Spleen, and Stomach disorders, as well as to clear heat, and mildly tonify the body's Yin.

According to the Daoist pharmacologist Tao Hongjing (wrote the first commentaries to the Shangqing Canon), "The magicians (Shujia) say that if one consumes Hemp-seeds along with ginseng, it will give the individual preternatural knowledge of events in the future."And, according to the Wuzangjing ("Five Viscera Classic"), "If you wish to command demonic apparitions to present themselves you should constantly eat the inflorescences of the hemp plant."

It is important to note that due to its association with the destructive properties of the planet Saturn, certain schools of Chinese sorcery specifically consider cannabis to be extremely damaging to the cultivation and mastering of a priest's energetic and spiritual powers.

Figure 1.304. Calea Zachatechi

Figure 1.305. Datura Inoxa

CALEA ZACHATECHI

Although not Chinese in origin (i.e., Oaxaca, Mexico), Calea Zachatechi is known as "the Aztec Dream Herb" and "Bitter Grass," and is a herbal plant used by the Oaxaca Chontal Indian shaman priests for Oneiromancy (a form of divination based on dreams). The Indian shamans claim that it clarifies the senses, creates a general sense of well being and induces spectacular dreams (Figure 1.304). It has been scientifically demonstrated that extracts of Calea Zachatechi increase reaction times, frequency, and recollection of dreams.

Calea does not automatically increase the frequency of the priest's lucid dreams. Instead, the dreams usually become more realistic and memorable to the priest. A controlled sleep study showed that ingesting Calea tea before bedtime increased the number of dreams recalled. This phenomenon is the result of Calea activating the "Memory Continuity Facilitator" in the brain which prevents the mental "jumping around" from place and time that can occur while in the dream state.

As a side effect, Calea can also produce feelings of well-being that can continue for one or more days. At lower doses, Calea produces a mild euphoric feeling that is similar to cannabis. At all dosage levels, mental clarity and time lagging is usually experienced. Currently there are no noted side effects from using Calea. It can be either smoked or made into a tea.

Traditionally, the tea is first drunk slowly. Then the priest lies down in a quiet place and smokes one or two cigarettes made from the crushed leaves of the Calea plant. More leaves are usually then placed under the priest's pillow before he or she falls asleep. The result of this practice is an oneirogenic entry into the landscape of lucid and rather vivid, sometimes significant, dreams. The side effects can result in feelings of mild euphoria and heightened waking clarity.

- **Shaman Formulae:** One formulae used in shamanic dreamwork combines the use of Calea Zacatechi, Salvia Divinorum, Valerian, and the leaves of a mild sedative called Kratom (Mitragyna speciosa) to induce consistently vivid dreams. The mechanisms by which these oneirogens facilitate lucid dreaming and provoke this intense imagery is still not known.

DATURA (MAN TUOLE)

Datura (also known as Jimson Weed, Stink weed, Ghost Flower, and Devil's Apple) is considered to be Feminine in nature, its Element corresponds to Water, and its planetary correspondence is Saturn (Figure 1.305). In ancient China, Datura was valued for its magical and medical properties. The ancient Daoists referred to the Datura plant as the "flower of one of the Pole Stars." According to one legend, messengers from this star could be recognized because they always carry a Datura flower.

All parts of the Datura plant (i.e., roots, leaves, flowers, and seeds) are used in magical practices. However, it is highly poisonous and should be handled with gloves (it is known to cause skin irritation).

In Summoning Rituals, Datura can be combined with Beech Bark and sprinkled on an altar in order to communicate with friendly spirits.

It was customary for the ancient Mao Shan Daoists to mix Datura (Man Tuole) with Cannabis (Ma) in rice wine, and drink it as a magical elixir. Other times, it was Sun-dried, mixed with White Jasmine Root, and ground into a fine powder. The powder was then placed into a small glass of wine and used as an intoxicant.

It was also said that the Datura plant absorbed the energetic and emotional properties of the individual who harvested it (e.g., if the individual was laughing or crying when they were harvesting the plant, anyone who drank the magical elixir would suddenly begin to laugh or cry). Therefore certain precautions were taken during the time of harvesting and preparation of the Datura magical elixirs.

Another type of Datura (Datura Metel), was mixed with Cannabis (Ma) and commonly smoked to induce visions. The Yang energy of the Datura is combined with the Yin energy of the Cannabis and signifies the perfect blended duality of Yang and Yin. This magical combination allowed the Daoist mystic to enter into the infinite realm of the Wuji and commune with the celestial immortals.

One vision inducing type of Datura (Datura Ceratocaula) blooms at night, starting about early evening and typically closing around noon the following day. It is regarded as a "sister" plant of Ololuiqui (a vision inducing Morning-Glory), and is commonly used for Soul Travel, Spirit Travel, to induce visionary trances, Shape-shifting, divination, discovering lost or stolen objects, and diagnosing the causes of diseases (especially if Black Magic was suspected).

A tea made from the Datura roots, leaves, and even the prickly seed pod of the plant was given to the Daoist initiate to drink in order to see visions. The herb Datura has been used to hex and to break hexes, to produce sleep and induce dreams, and for protection from evil spirits. It has also been used for Divination, to find one's totem animal (in shaman traditions), to allow one to see ghosts, for communing with birds, for long hunts and strength, for sharper vision, for sorcery, and for increasing supernatural powers.

Like other tropane-containing plants that have been historically used for "Flying Ointments," Datura has been used in certain rituals related to inducing the ability to fly (Soul Travel) through eating, drinking and sometimes wearing and absorbing an ointment. Datura is still widely used in the Caribbean for the same or similar reasons, and is called the "herbe aux sorciers" (herb of the priests) among the various French speaking islanders. On the English speaking islands, Jamaica for example, those who practice the spellcraft "Obeah" are also known to incorporate almost interchangeably with Datura another Nightshade herb they call Branched Calalue.

The tea from Datura is extremely hallucinogenic. The hallucinogenic effects are reported to be stronger than Peyote, Psyillicibin, or LSD. However, Datura is also very toxic and can cause permanent psychosis. Solanaceous plants such as Sacred Datura contain relatively high concentrations of tropane alkaloids, primarily Atropine, Hyoscyamine, and Scopolamine, the primary alkaloid being Scopolamine. It is apparently Scopolamine that produces the hallucinogenic effects. It induces an intoxication followed by narcosis in which hallucinations occur during the transition state between consciousness and sleep.

When Datura is used in a Native American ritual, it is always under the guidance of an individual of certain tribal spiritual resolve such as a Medicine person or tribal elder. These experts on the use of the plant know what other plants to add in order to neutralize the harmful effects. They also know how much to administer and when and where to pick the plants (such as age, season, time of year, whether under a full moon or no moon at all, etc.). Chemical constituents and levels vary greatly from plant to plant, time of year, and from one area to another just generally, but especially so if the plants are obtained through ritual or from an energy spot known for having special powers (i.e., holy places, Energetic Vortexes, or sacred grounds). The plants are very toxic, poisonous, and often lethal, especially if consumed in quantities unmetered by someone not versed in their safe administration. They can, however, when properly dealt with, produce the end result sought after, and quite adequately so, in the spiritual realm.

There are a number of species of Datura. However, Datura Innoxia, Datura Metaloides, and Datura Wrightii are the types usually applied to the name Sacred Datura. Ancient shamans believed that a shaman-priest has an ally contained in the Sacred Datura plant. However, the priest had to grow his own patch, not only in the sense that the plants were his private property, but in the sense that they were personally identified with him.

Datura has long been used in shamanic practices (e.g., Divination and Soul Projection) and religious rites, and the Aztecs considered the plant to be sacred. Datura is sometimes used in magic to break spells (by sprinkling it around the home). It is also used to protect the priest against evil spirits. Datura is extremely poisonous, and skin may be irritated simply by touching it. One magical tradition would use Datura to treat insomnia by placing Datura leaves into a pair of shoes, and then setting the shoes under the bed, with the toes pointing toward the nearest wall.

Datura can also be used in Counter-Hexing. In order to counter a curse, place the seeds in a bowl on top of something belonging to the person you want to affect. Speak a counter-course, energetically activate the seeds, then hide the bowl in a dark place. It is important to note that this type of protection magic will not work, unless the victim is actively seeking to harm you.

LAGOCHILUS INEBRIANS (INEBRIATING MINT)

This herb is considered to be Masculine in nature, its Element corresponds to Air, and its planetary correspondence is Mercury (Figure 1.306). Lagochilus inebrians (also known as Turkistan Mint and Inebriating Mint) is a member of the mint family Labiatae, native from central Asia to Iran and Afghanistan. It is a narrow endemic species of the Uzbekistan flora, and there are only a few places where it grows. It is rare and little known even within its small native region. As a result of its scarcity and also because of strict state control, it is virtually never seen in the outside world.

It has long been used for its intoxicating and sedative properties by Tajik, Tartar, Turkoman, and Uzbek tribesman (traditionally consumed as a tea). Ancient tribes in Central Asia used Lagochilus inebrians during their shamanic rituals, special feasts, and holidays.

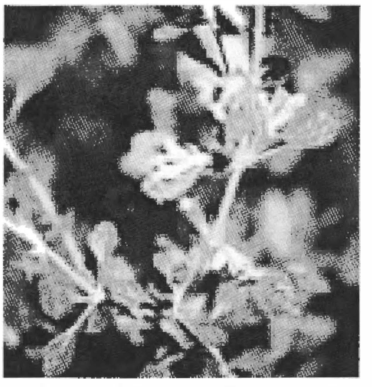


Figure 1.306. Inebriating Mint (Lagochilus Inebrians)

Figure 1.307. Kratom (Mitragyna Speciosa)

In the clinic, Lagochilus inebrians is used for its hypotensive properties (i.e. it lowers blood pressure). This makes it useful for various medical conditions and procedures, but it also means that it could be dangerous for people with hypotension. There are over 30 species of Lagochilus.

MITRAGYNA SPECIOSA (KRATOM)

Recently there has been a lot of controversy about Kratom (Figure 1.307). Over 25 alkaloids have been isolated from Kratom; the principle one being mitragynine, an indole alkaloid superficially resembling yohimbine (found in Yohimbe bark). In addition to being used as a narcotic in its own right, it is often used to moderate and beat addiction to Opium. Some shamans use Kratom to prolong sexual intercourse.

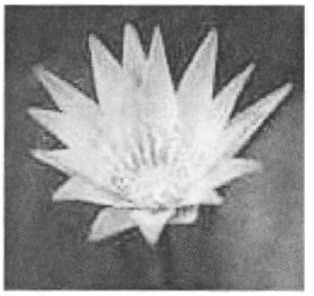


Figure 1.308. Blue Lotus (Nymphaea Caerulea)

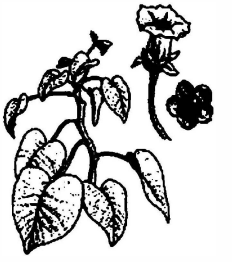


Figure 1.309. Morning Glory (Ololiuqui)

Researchers have found that there are different strains of kratom plants that can vary tremendously, for example:

- Kratom from Thailand is a high-quality red-veined strain. The foliage is crushed to small pieces, but not completely powdered.
- Kratom from Malaysia is another red-veined Kratom that has been finely powdered. This isn't quite as high-quality as the Thailand Kratom, but is a great value for finely powdered kratom.
- Kratom from Hawaii is commonly farm grown on the Big Island. These are mostly whole dried leaves.
- Kratom that comes from Indonesia is the highest-quality. It is finely powdered and is about 25% more potent smelling than the Thailand strain.

NYMPHAEA CAERULEA (BLUE LOTUS)

This herb is considered to be Feminine in nature, its Element corresponds to Water, and its planetary correspondence is the Moon (Figure 1.308). In ancient China, the Nymphaea Caerulea was held in very high esteem by both Daoist and Buddhist priests who used it as a visionary plant. When the Nymphaea Caerulea (Blue Lotus) was smoked or drank after being soaked in water or wine, it acted as an intoxicant.

Blue Lotus is an extremely rare plant and was at one time viewed as a symbol for the origins of life. Most religious traditions believed that the world was originally covered by water and darkness. According to one ancient legend, the Blue Lotus sprang up from the water and opened its petals to reveal a young god, a Divine Child. Light streamed from the Divine Child and banished universal darkness. This child god was the Creator, the Sun God, the source of all life.

OLOLIUQUI (MORNING GLORY)

This herb is considered to be Masculine in nature, its Element corresponds to Water, and its planetary correspondence is Saturn (Figure 1.309). Ololiuqui is a vision-inducing Morning-Glory, commonly employed in sacred rituals. It is a twinning herb with thin, green, cordate leaves, slender, green terete stems, long white flowers, and round seeds.

The seeds contain ergine, an ergoline alkaloid similar in structure to LSD. The Nahuatl word ololiuhqui means "round thing", and refers to the small, brown, oval seeds of the morning glory, not the plant itself, which is called coaxihuitl (snake-plant), in Nahuatl, and hiedra or bejuco in the Spanish language. The seeds, in Spanish, are sometimes called semilla de la Virgen (little seeds of the Virgin Mary).

What is known in the western world, is that the properties of Ololiuqui can be as sensational as those of magic mushrooms and Peyote. Further experiments have proven that a hallucinogenic state can be attained; one first encounters a certain level of listlessness and increased visual sensitivity, eventually feeling relaxed, getting visions, and being able to bring back memories from one's childhood.

Because of the extremely fine line between effective and lethal doses, the ground seeds are only to be ingested by experienced persons. By weight, ololiuqui seeds are in general twice as powerful as morning glory. This info on Erowid

Figure 1.310. Opium Poppy
(Papaver Somniferum)

Figure 1.311. Peganum Harmala

and these dosages for regular Morning glory may help you figure out the most suitable dose. However, as mentioned earlier, they should only be taken under the strict guidance of a qualified master or medicine shaman.

Light	50 - 100 seeds	1.5 - 3 g
Common	100 - 250 seeds	3 - 6 g
Strong	250 - 400 seeds	6 - 10 g
Heavy	400 + seeds	10 + g

PAPAVER SOMNIFERUM (OPIUM POPPY)

This herb is considered to be Feminine in nature, its Element corresponds to Water, and its planetary correspondence is the Moon (Figure 1.310). The Papaver Somniferum is the type of poppy from which opium and all refined opiates (i.e., morphine, thebaine, codeine, papaverine, and noscapine) are extracted. The use of Papaver Somniferum (Opium Poppy) spread throughout Europe by 2000 BC. By the Tang Dynasty (618-907 A.D.) it was widely cultivated in Arabia, India, and China.

Opium Poppy flower pods grow from a lettuce-like base, atop a single stalk, sometimes extending over four feet tall. The Papaver Somniferum flowers are beautiful and grow in numerous gardens worldwide. The pods are very popular in dried flower arrangements, and the seeds are commonly used in baking.

Historically, the Papaver Somniferum (Opium Poppy) plant was cultivated in the ancient civilizations of Persia, Egypt and Mesopotamia. Archaeological evidence and fossilized Papver somniferum seeds suggest that Neanderthal man may have used the opium poppy over thirty thousand years ago. The first known written reference to the Papaver somniferum Opium poppy appears in a Sumerian text dated around 4,000 BC. The flower was known as hul gil, plant of joy. Papaver somniferum has also been variously called the Sacred Anchor Of Life, Milk Of Paradise, the Hand Of God, and Destroyer Of Grief.

PEGANUM HARMALA

This is a perennial herb is native to the deserts of Northern Africa, Western Asia, and South-Eastern Europe (Figure 1.311). Growing from a perennial woody rottock, Peganum Harmala is a bright-green, densely foliaged, herbaceous succulent. Although it's smooth many-branched stems may have a spread of four feet or more, the plant is rarely over two feet tall and generally appears round and bushy in habit. Its leaves are two inches long, born singly and finely divided into long narrow segments.

Each year between June and August, Peganum Harmala produces many single white conspicuous flowers. Measuring one to one and one-half inches across, these relatively large and showy blooms have five oblong-elliptic petals as well as five narrow sepals of slightly longer length. Each flower has the potential to develop into a fruit--a leathery, three-valved seed capsule that stands erect on its stalk. Each capsule measures about three-eighths of an inch in diameter and contains more than fifty dark-brown, angular seeds.

When administered in seed form, the harmala alkaloids are serotoninntagonists, CNS stimulants, hallucinogens, and extremely potent short-term MAO inhibitors. A small dose (25.50 milligrams) is a CNS stimulant. It increases mental activity and produces a pleasant dreamy state for several hours. The larger doses (200 milligrams up to 750 milligrams) yield the hallucinogenic effects. The experience usually begins within one hour and often lasts six hours or more hours.

SALVIA DIVINORUM

Salvia Divinorum, also known as Diviner's Sage, Magic Mint, María Pastora, Sage of the Seers, or simply by the genus name Salvia, is a powerful psychoactive herb. It is a member of the sage genus and the Lamiaceae (mint) family and it grows to well over a meter in height, has large green leaves, hollow square stems with occasional white and purple flowers (Figure 1.312). The Latin name Salvia Divinorum literally translates to "sage of the seers." The genus name Salvia is derived from the Latin salvare, meaning "to heal" or "to save."

Figure 1.312. Salvia Divinorum

Salvia Divinorum has been used for centuries in Mexico for shamanism, healing, divination, prediction, meditation and searches for the divine. The plant is found in isolated, shaded and moist plots in the Sierra Madre Mountains in Oaxaca, Mexico. In this region it is used by Mazatec priests and shamans in different rituals. The plant is mostly used when a shaman feels that they needed to sojourn into the supernatural world in order to discover the cause of a patient's illness. After ingesting the herb, the shaman entered into a visionary trance that allowed him to see what steps have to be taken to cure the patient.

Salvia Divinorum is thought to be a cultigen. Its primary psychoactive constituent is a diterpenoid known as salvinorin A (a potent k-Opioid receptor agonist). Salvinorin A is unique in that it is the only naturally occurring substance known to induce a visionary state this way. Salvia divinorum can be chewed or smoked to produce experiences ranging from uncontrollable laughter to much more intense and profoundly altered states. The duration is much shorter than for some other more well known psychedelics (normally 30 - 45 minutes), and the effects of smoked Salvia typically lasting for only a few minutes (normally 5 - 15 minutes). The most commonly reported aftereffects include an increased feeling of insight and improved mood, and a sense of calmness and increased sense of connection with nature. Salvia divinorum is not considered to be toxic or addictive.

CACTUS

A cactus is any species that found in the family Cactaceae. This family contains nearly 1,500 plant species. Cacti are typically residents of deserts or areas were water is scarce or practically non-existent for part of the time.

Some species of cacti are hallucinogenic and some are not. The cause of this psychoactive ability in the cacti can sometimes be linked to mescaline, which is found in the Lophophora Williamsii, Opuntia Cylindrical (Prickly Pear), and the San Pedro Cactus (Trichocereus Pachoni). However, very few of the other hallucinogenic cacti actually contain mescaline. Instead, they contain other compounds, including hordenine and N-methyltyramine.

LOPHOPHORA WILLIAMSII (PEYOTE)

The use of the hallucinogenic cactus Peyote (Lophophora Williamsii) is popular among native American shamans; and it is commonly employed in sacred rituals. This spineless, tufted, blue-green, button-like cactus, known commonly as Peyote and botanically as Lophophora Williamsii, is the most famous of the hallucinogenic cacti (Figure 1.313). It grows wild from Central Mexico to Northern Texas. It is known as the "Protector of Man," and is used in order to assist the initiate in seeing beings as liquid colors (enhancing the ability to see auras).

About half an hour after ingesting the buttons the first effects are felt. There is a feeling of strange intoxication and shifting consciousness with minor perceptual changes. There may also be strong physical effects, including respiratory pressure, muscle tension (especially face and neck muscles), and queasiness or possible nausea. Any unpleasant sensations should disappear within an hour. After this the state of altered consciousness begins to manifest itself. The experience may vary with the individual, but among the possible occurrences are feelings of inner tranquillity, oneness with life, heightened awareness, and rapid thought flow. During the next several hours these effects will deepen and become more visual. Colors may become more intense. Halos and auras may appear about things. Objects may

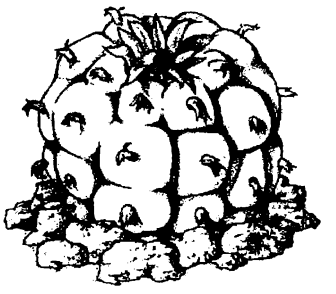


Figure 1.313. Peyote (Lophophora Williamsii)

seem larger, smaller , closer or more distant than they actually are. Often persons will notice little or no changes in visual perception while beholding the world about them, but upon closing their eyes they will see on their mind-screen wildly colorful and constant changing patterns. After several more hours the intensity of the experience gradually relaxes. Thought becomes less rapid and diffuse, and more ordered. During the first part of the ceremony, participants submit to the feeling and let the peyote teach them. During the latter part of the ritual the mind turns to thoughtful contemplation and understanding with the conscious intellect what the peyote has taught the subconscious mind.

The entire experience may last from 6 to 12 hours, depending upon the individual and the amount of the plant consumed. After all the peyote effects have passed there is no comedown. One is likely to feel pleasantly relaxed and much at peace with the world. Although there is usually no desire for food during the experience one would probably have a wholesome appetite afterwards.

Types of Peyote

There are two forms of peyote: Peyote of the Gods and Peyote of the Goddess. Both types of Peyote are described as follows:

- Peyote of the Gods: This plant is larger, more potent, and more bitter than the other.
- Peyote of the Goddess: This plant is smaller, more palatable, but milder.

The difference between the two forms may be due solely to how old the plants are. Alkaloids tend to accumulate in these cacti with age. It is

possible, however, that the Goddess Peyote is a different species.

Methods of Use

The most common method of use is simply to chew up and swallow the fresh or dried buttons after removing the tufts and sand. This is the way it is almost always done at Indian ceremonies. Most people find the taste of this cactus unbearably bitter. The Indians, however, believe that if one's heart is pure, the bitterness will not be tasted. Many have found that by not cringing from the taste, but rather letting one's senses plunge directly to the center of the bitterness, a sort of separation from the offensive flavor is experienced. One is aware of the bitterness, but it no longer disturbs him. This is similar to the practice of bringing one's consciousness to the center of pain so that detachment may occur.

People who cannot endure the bitterness of Peyote often drink unsweetened grapefruit juice while chewing it. The acids in the juice somewhat neutralize some of the bitter bases in the Peyote. Another method is to grind the dried buttons in a pepper grinder and pack the pulverized material into OOO capsules, which are then swallowed and washed down with warm water. This is an effective method but it can take 20 capsules or more to get a 350mg dose of mescaline. Often people will boil the buttons in water for several hours to make a concentrated tea.

During the Peyote ceremony, Indians encourage vomiting rather than restraint if the urge presents itself. Throwing up, they believe, is a purging of both physical and spiritual ills. Most tribes fast for at least a day before taking peyote. This can also help to minimize gastric distress. One should not have eaten for at least 6 hours before taking peyote.

TRICHOCEREUS PACHANOI (SAN PEDRO CACTUS)

The San Pedro (Saint Peter) cactus is the name given to psychoactive species of the genus Trichocereus (T. pachanoi, T. peruvianus) which comprises about thirty species, mainly found in the Andes (Figure 1.314). Archaeological evidence reveals that this special cactus is undoubtedly one

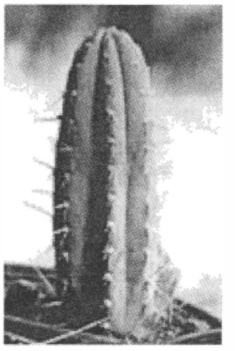


Figure 1.314. San Pedro Cactus (Trichocereus Pachanoi)

of the most ancient of the magical plants. The use of the hallucinogenic San Pedro cactus has been a continuous tradition in Peru for over 3,000 years. The earliest depiction of the magical plant, is a carving which shows a mythological being holding the San Pedro Cactus. Popular to the Chavín culture (1400-400 BC) of Peru, carvings of this special cactus have been found in an ancient temple at Chavín de Huantar in the Northern Peruvian Highlands, dating as far back as 1300 BC.

It is interesting to note, that the cactus was later given the name "San Pedro," due to the influence of the Roman Catholic Church; according to the Christian belief that "St. Peter holds the keys to Heaven."

The San Pedro is a large columnar cactus that grows up to heights of twenty feet and it contains mescaline, as does the well-known peyote cactus. The San Pedro cactus has also been found to have other psychoactive alkaloids. The mescaline seems to be most highly concentrated in the skin, which can be peeled, dried and made into a powder for consumption.

The usual native preparation of the cactus involves boiling slices of the stem in water for a number of hours (usually up to seven). Then, once cooled, the resulting liquid is drunk. Sometimes the San Pedro is used in conjunction with other psychoactive plants, such as coca, tobacco, Brugmansia and Anadenanthera. Additionally, powdered bones and cemetery dust are sometimes used to ensure the magical effectiveness of the brew.

According to ancient teachings, shamans categorized four special types of San Pedro Cactus, distinguishing them by the specific number of "ribs" positioned on the outside of the plant. The most rare, and considered to be the most potent, were the "four ribbed" cactus. These special plants were believed to have powerful supernatural influence due to the representation of the Five Elements manifested within the plants physical structure:

- Wood Element: Left Side, East
- Fire Element: Front Side, South
- Metal Element: Right Side, West
- Water Element: Back Side, North
- Earth Element: Middle, Center

The extended four ribs also represented the four primary directions of the Postnatal Bagua (Eight Trigram) configuration. Which allowed the priest to travel "four main roads" through the various spirit realms: Heaven (Air), Earth, Fire, and Water (Underworld).

When utilizing the San Pedro Cactus as a shaman drug for divination, curing spirit induced insanity, or for combating various forms of witchcraft (i.e., love spells and hexes), the magical elixir and was traditionally to be ingested, and the special magical ritual performed during the peak time of a full moon. It was believed that during this peak Yin time, that the priest could more easily enter into the spirit world and the various realms of the Underworld.

Many of the sacred plants known to and used by ancient shamans were collected near sacred pools, mountains, deserts, and forests. Therefore, before entering into these sacred locations, the priest first had to undergo a series of cleansing and purification rituals. The ancient Daoists believed that each sacred area had its own type of guardian, responsible for protecting not only the area and plant species, but also the knowledge and spiritual portals connected to the specific area and its plants. Therefore, in order to visit these various spirit realms and access the supernatural powers associated with that plant species (i.e., visionary and divination powers), the priest had to first appease the plant guardian. These special guardians, were also responsible for "awakening" each plants magical influence on the body's Jing (Essence), Qi (Energy), and Shen (Spirit, Mind, Thoughts and Feelings).

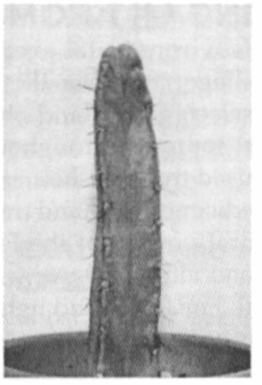


Figure 1.315. Trichocereus Bridgessi

Once ingested by the priest, the "awakened" drug would eventually begin to produce drowsiness, and a dreamy, euphoric state of mind. Then, the priest would experience a light numbness within his body, followed by a state of tranquility. Next came a feeling of detachment. Suddenly, a great vision would emerge, along with a clearing of all of faculties. A type of visual force then awakened, and all of the senses, including the sixth sense emerge, projecting the priest across all barriers of time and matter.

According to ancient tradition, the magic of the San Pedro Cactus goes far beyond the magical applications of curing the spirit and divination practice. It is also taught that San Pedro, can be used to energetically guard houses, like a spirit watchdog. When magically activated and empowered as a guardian, it is said that San Pedro is capable of forcing intruding spirits to flee in terror.

TRICHOCEREUS BRIDGESSI

The Trichocereus bridgessi has a long tradition of shamanic use throughout its homeland in the high Bolivian deserts (Figure 1.315). It is perhaps the most powerful, magical, and least used of the Trichicereus cacti. Trichocereus bridgesii is unique in its appearance with its long menacing spines, and it is often kept indoors because of its powerful, protective spirit.

GATHERING QI FROM PLANTS

Earth Qi (environmental energy) saturates all types of foliage, allowing the Daoist priest the ability to select, gather, and absorb Qi from many botanical sources. Throughout history, the Chinese have used trees, bushes, and flowers for healing and medicine. Plants and trees absorb and retain the natural powers of the Five Elements: Space (sound and vibration), Air (environmental gases and aura), Fire (color and light), Water, and Earth (minerals of the soil). These Five Elements uniquely combine their various powers in order to create the energy of the plant. When the celestial energy (gathered from the Sun, Moon, and Stars) vibrating within a tree or plant is activated by the ever-changing environmental energy brought about through the natural transformations created via the 4 seasons, the result is a powerful and invigorating living energy source.

Flowers, for example, can be used in order to express or initiate an emotional state. The ancient Daoists believed that each flower manifests its own energetic potential, depending on the specific color, shape and season it represented. Flowers and plants are also excellent for transferring Qi, especially when they are if full bloom and healthy. In China, flowers are commonly divided into the four seasons:

- **Spring:** Iris or magnolia
- **Summer:** Peony or lotus
- **Autumn:** Chrysanthemum
- **Winter:** Plum blossom and bamboo

When cultivating the natural energy of a plant or tree, the ancient Daoists believed that the best time for absorbing the magical Ling Qi was either during the hours of sunrise (Mao: 5:00 - 7:00 am.) when the energy is rushing upwards to meet the Sun, or during noontime (Wu: 11:00 a.m. – 1:00 p.m.) when the ascending energy is at its peak.

THE HEALING POWER OF TREES, BUSHES, AND FLOWERS

The plant kingdom contains many varieties and shapes, including trees, bushes, plants, vines, and fungus. Also included within this study are the annual and perennial growing cycles of flowers and fruits. Each of the plants have their own energetic fields, depending on the type of plant and its growing habits.

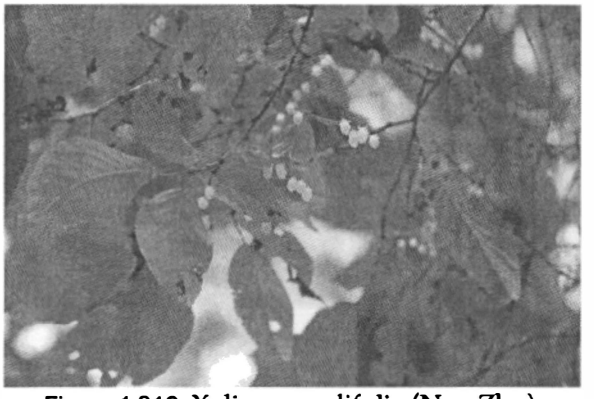


Figure 1.316. Xolisma ovalifolia (Nan Zhu)

In China, most traditional Daoist monasteries and temples have their own gardens. These gardens are abundant with healthy herbal trees, plants, and beautiful flowers from which the monks draw energy.

Any combination of healthy plant energies can be absorbed by the priest to purify, balance, or increase specific aspects of his or her Jing, Qi, or Shen. The purpose and intention of gathering energy from trees and plants can also be directed to focus on any particular internal organ, tissue, or energetic system of the body. Each type of foliage has its own unique strengths and qualities, allowing the priest the ability to work with any of the varying energetic properties of the available tree, plant or flower.

The ancient Mao Shan Daoist priests were devoted in the preparation of an herbal food-stuff (drug) held in high regard throughout ancient China. Known as "Qing Jing" (Blue/Green Germ), this deep blue herbal mixture consisted of non-glutinous rice infused with the leaves and stems of Xolisma ovalifolia or Nan Zhu (Figure.1.316). It was said that this precious concoction was valued as an almost supernatural nutrient. It was said to dispel the causes of disease and injuries, and to provide both euphoria and understanding, as well as a sense on bodily lightness (bordering on levitation)

DIFFERENT TYPES OF PLANT QI

It is important to note that the same variety of tree or plant will have either minor or major variances regarding its energetic potential depending on the region of the country where it is growing. This difference in energetic potential is due to the diverse

environmental influences affecting each plant. We in the West, for example, have many different varieties of plants and trees similar to those in Asia. However, the energetic continental differences alter the quality and quantity of Qi in each plant or herb, and thus the energetic quality of a species of plant in the West may differ greatly from a similar species in Asia. This same principle applies to Asian plants and medicines that have been grown and cultivated in the West.

This energetic difference is brought about by factors such as the various Qi fields produced by each region's altitude, soil quality and mineral content, water, air quality, and the amount of exposure to the energy of the Sun. Thus, even herbs of the same species, grown in different countries, can have different effects on the body's energetic system, slightly altering their clinical potential.

This also applies to distinct varieties of trees or plants that are related to one another but are native to different areas. For example:

- American Ginseng is sweet, slightly bitter, and cold; it enters the body affecting the Heart, Lung, and Kidney Channels, and is considered to be Yin.
- Siberian Ginseng is sweet, slightly bitter, and slightly warm; it enters the body affecting the Lung and Spleen Channels, and is considered to be Yang.
- Korean Ginseng is sweet, slightly bitter, and hot; and is considered to be the most Yang of these three varieties of Ginseng.

PLANTS AND THE FIVE ELEMENTS

The energetic nature of all plants can be further categorized into one of the Five Elements. Each specific Element manifests through certain natural characteristics, described as follows:

- **Wood Element:** These are columnar plants, that manifest through climbing and upward-growing energetic patterns.
- **Fire Element:** These are cylindrical growing plants, that manifest through pointed leaves and thorns.
- **Earth Element:** These plants remain wide and low to the ground. Their leaves or branches point downward.
- **Metal Element:** These plants have ball-shaped patterns, and grow in round or half-round shapes.
- **Water Element:** These plants have irregular growing patterns with wavy leaves.

Additionally, trees, plants, and flowers have different color bases, each are associated with the different Five Element colors. For example, the color base for a pine tree is green/blue, and thus it tends to be one of the most powerful trees used for the tonification of the Liver. This is fitting, since pine trees tend to radiate a great deal of Qi.

ABSORBING EARTH QI THROUGH TREES, BUSHES, AND FLOWERS

One of the most popular cleansing techniques used in Daoist alchemy can be performed from either a lying, sitting, or standing posture (usually in a Wuji posture) while in front of a natural object such as a tree or herbal plant (flower, bush, etc.).

- To cleanse the body's energy, extend both hands towards the plant as if to embrace it (it does not matter if the plant or tree is actually being touched). Upon inhalation, begin to guide the energy from the plant into your torso through the Laogong (Pc-8) points at the center of your palms and the Baihui (GV-20) point at the top of your head. Absorb this energy deep into your body. Once the body is fully saturated with Qi, exhale through the mouth and guide the Turbid Qi down the legs and out the body through the Yongquan (Kd-1) points at the bottom of the feet.
- Continue to guide the Turbid Qi downward through the Earth into the root system of the plant or tree. Then inhale through the nose and absorb the purified energy from the upper part of the plant or tree, leading it down your body through the top of your head. Continue this process until you feel totally cleansed. Remember to synchronize breathing in through your nose as you focus on absorbing the Earth Qi from the plant or tree and exhaling through the mouth as you focus on dispersing and releasing the Turbid Qi.

Once the priest has connected with a tree, plant, or flower, he or she can modify the above exercise to achieve the following:

- Remove stagnation from the internal organs and channels
- Stabilize and replenish any depleted energy within the body
- Tonify and nourish the internal organs, Blood, nervous system, etc.
- Balance and regulate specific Five Element energies within the tissues

Gathering Energy from Bushes

Bushes are another extremely effective source for gathering and ingesting different forms of healing energy. Similar to trees, each bush has its own energetic properties and can cause a specific reaction in the body's energetic field. Bushes, however, are not as powerful as trees when used as an energy source for gathering massive quantities of Qi. Besides having brightly colored leaves and flowers, another sign that the plant is suitable for the priest to begin cultivation with is the presence of a pleasing or attractive smell.

Generally, several different meditations are used in order to cultivate and absorb the energy from a specific tree or plant. One example is the Five Element Cultivation Method, described as follows:

- **Purification:** First perform "Pulling Down the Heavens," the "One Through Ten Meditation" and "The Three Invocations" to cleanse the three bodies (physical, energetic and spirit body) of any Toxic Qi. This purification action must be performed before attempting to energetically connect, cultivate, and absorb any of the plant's energetic field.
- **Earth Element:** After receiving permission, energetically envelop and connect with the plant. Focus your intention into the plant's root system. Feel into the plants connection and interaction with the Earth, soil, and minerals.
- **Water Element:** Next, allow your energy to envelope and flow over and through the plant like a watery mist. Imagine and feel this energetic mist rushing up the plants root system, energetically surging through its trunk, stem, branches, leaves and flowers.
- **Fire Element:** Expand your energy from within the plant's core and extend the Qi outward, through the plant's energetic field, into your own energy field. Imagine and feel that you are completely filling your Three Bodies with the plant's energetic pulse, vibration, color, and light. Continue this focused intention until the plant's energized field overflows your body and expands your three Wei Qi (aura) fields.
- **Wood (Air) Element:** Begin to focus your intention on the plant's respiration. Feel your breath fuse with the energetic respiration of the plant. Merge, fuse, and breath the environmental gases and plant's aura fields into your Three Bodies.
- **Metal (Space) Element:** Relax, and fall into the infinite space pulsing within the energetic field of the plant. Feel the pulsating life-force of the plant's energetic field. Imagine and visualize that you are completely immersed in the plants energetic field.

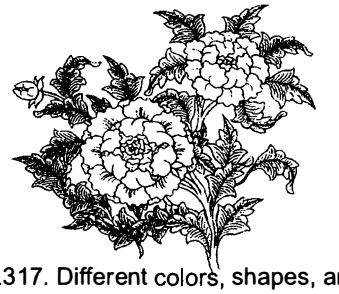


Figure 1.317. Different colors, shapes, and sizes of flowers can affect the emotions, causing the individual's spirit to open.
(Inspired from the original artwork of Robert Beer)

Gathering Energy from Flowers

The gift of flowers has had a long history in soothing emotional pain and bringing relief to patients and loved ones. Flowers are generally considered to be a universal symbol of love, compassion, and beauty. When they blossom, they provide the sweet fragrance of health, vitality, and healing. Essentially, flowers are the plant's sexual organs, and within their short season of blossoming they produce an abundance of fruit, which thus sustains the cycle of nature.

Flowers have a unique and specific effect on the human nervous system. Different colors, shapes, and sizes of flowers can affect the emotions, causing different aspects of the individual's spirit to open and flourish (Figure 1.317). Each color can be absorbed into the body in order to facilitate the stimulation of internal organ energy.

Cultivation Techniques from Power Plants and Flowers

The ancient mystics used the energetic powers of certain plants in order to enhance their skills in sorcery. For example, Blackthorn was believed to contain the energetic property for coercion, forced control, and channeling destructive power.

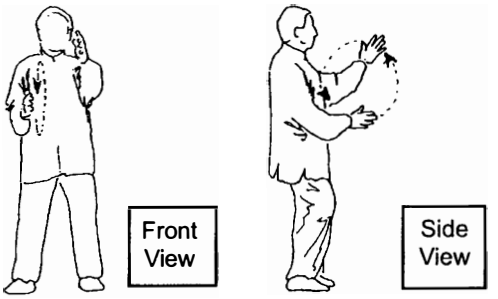


Figure 1.318. Keep the left hand stationary while the right hand circle rotates in a counterclockwise direction, gathering the plant's Qi into the body

These techniques used for the cultivation, absorption, and regulation of Earth Qi begin by having the disciple face a plant or flower. In the following meditation, disciples are taught how to absorb Qi from various types of foliage by inhaling and drawing the Earth Qi from plants into their body.

The energy is then guided down the mystic's chest and into the Lower Dantian. When using the following exercise to cultivate and absorb energy from the Earth, it is advisable to gather and cultivate the Earth energy early in the morning when the Qi is fresh, just before the Sun crests the horizon:

- Begin by facing a power plant (small tree, herbal shrub, or flower) and begin to gather its vibrant energy and colors while standing in a Wuji posture.
- Raise both hands and extend them a few inches away from the foliage, with the palms facing each other. Both arms should be bent at the elbows with the shoulders relaxed and sunk. As the palms face the bush, they should be slightly curved and never locked.

  Important Note: If your hands feel comfortable then proceed to the next step; however, if your hands feel numb or begin to hurt, usually this is a signal that it is necessary to try another plant, one that is more open to an energetic exchange.
- Focus your intention forward into the plant, and imagine it as an enormous sphere of energy, emitting a particular color or light (depending on the type of plant). Wait until you can feel the sensation of the plant's energy filling your hands. Feel a connection developing between your Heart, Middle Dantian, Lower Dantian, and the plant before proceeding to the next stage.

Figure 1.319. Move the right hand on top of the plant in a counterclockwise direction until a strong sensation of the plant's energy field is felt. (Inspired from the original artwork of Robert Beer)

- Imagine that the plant's energy is slowly gathering between your hands and the body. When both hands are full, without touching the plant, begin rolling the energy of the plant towards your Heart and Middle Dantian area, keeping the mind's intention focused on the center of each palm (Figure 1.318). Roll the plant's energy with the right hand first, while keeping the left hand stationary, and still enveloped within the plant's energy field. Imagine the energy in the rotating hand and the energy in the Lower Dantian blending naturally into one energy, simultaneously rotating and rolling together both internally and externally. After completing several rotations switch hands and repeat the process.
- Next, place the right hand about a foot above the plant, with the left hand facing its body (branches, stems and leaves) from the side. Begin to move the right hand on top of the plant in a counterclockwise direction until a strong sensation of the plant's energy field is felt. The counterclockwise circular rotation will cause the plant's Qi to rush from its roots, deep within the Earth, and flow up into your palm (Figure 1.319).
- Then begin to slowly move your right hand up and down above the plant using the "Bellows Palm" technique to draw the plant's Qi into your Lower Dantian. After completing several rotations switch hands and repeat the process (Figure 1.320).

Figure 1.320. Slowly move the right hand up and down above the plant using the "Bellows Palm" technique to draw the plant's Qi into your Lower Dantian. (Inspired from the original artwork of Robert Beer)

- End the exercise with "Pulling Down the Heavens" and return to the Wuji posture, allowing the gathered Qi to sink and return into the Lower Dantian.

PRECAUTIONS

Beginning disciples should be monitored regularly to prevent Qi deviations, which may occur while absorbing Qi in through the pores. For best results, choose a quiet, safe, and healthy environment. Select bushes or flowers with a stable root, or thick vibrant foliage. The color is also very important; the leaves and flowers should be bright, full, and healthy.

Because the body's internal energy matches that of the external environment, it is important to avoid selecting any area which is unpleasant or unhealthy. Avoid any bush or flower that is sick, dying, has lost its color, or has just been pruned. Sick bushes or flowers can pass along their suffering into the unexperienced disciple who tries to cultivate the plant's life-force. It is important not to meditate in front of any bush or flower that has parasites or that has been poisoned or polluted, since such vegetation will induce an impure energetic resonation within the Daoist mystic's body.

When absorbing Qi into the Lower Dantian from the bush or flower, if any discomfort or resistance is felt, stop immediately. Using bushes or flowers, whether for cleansing the body or absorbing energy, is forbidden at night because their oxygen production diminishes after the Sun has set.

Trees and bushes that contain brightly colored songbirds are traditionally considered to be very healthy. The ancient Daoists believed that birds were the messengers of Heaven, consequently, the more beautiful and melodic the bird, the better the potential for the gathering of Qi. However, if there are rarely any birds around the training area, it is important to look for any energetic problems such as the presence of pathogenic Qi.

SUFFUMIGATION

A "Suffumigation" is the magical incense burned by mystics and priests in order to attract spirit entities and help them materialize. Various plants were used in suffumigation formulas, including anise, dried carnation flowers, Amaranth flowers, gardenia petals, Dittany of Crete, Frankincense Resin, heather, pipsissewa, sweetgrass, and Wormwood.

The following are some examples of different Suffumigation formulae:

- Dittany, in particular, was considered an excellent base; spirits would appear in the center of the smoke.
- Balm of Gilead was also burned as a material basis for spirits.
- White Sandalwood is very commonly combined with other herbs for conjuring spirits. Wormwood, mixed with White Sandalwood, should be burned while in a graveyard. This will cause the spirits of the dead there to rise and speak.
- Crushed willow bark with White Sandalwood should be burned outdoors during the waning moon for conjuring.
- White Sandalwood and Frankincense Resin is burned during seances.
- Lavender is also mixed with White Sandalwood for spirit summoning.
- An incense used for summoning reluctant spirits of the dead consists of three parts Wormwood and one part Solomon's Seal.
- An incense used for summoning spirits that were in a depressed state when they died consists of three parts Wormwood and one part vervain. This is also good for summoning spirits who are not aware that they are

dead. This will not only call them, but will also lighten their mood.

- The ancient Greeks believed that Wormwood should be burned on a fire of privet (an evergreen shrub related to the olive) in order to summon the dead, since a fire of privet was thought to open the doors of the Underworld.
- Although Asafoetida destroys the spirit manifestations when throw into the fire, I've also found additional information that states that Asafoetida can be used to draw in negative spirits.

A recipe taken from a seventeenth century manuscript, "The Secret of Secrets," gives the following recipe for calling spirits:

"To raise spirits suddenly, mix a legume of aloes, pepperweed, red musk, and saffron with the blood of a plover (shorebird, related to the sandpiper). If it is fumigated in a graveyard (around the tombs or graves of the dead) it will cause the spirits and ghosts of the dead to gather together."

Other spirit offerings used, especially if seeking blessings from the spirits, include Lilac Flower, Peppermint, and purple heather. Pipsissewa is blended with Rose petals and violets to draw benevolent spirits. Althea Root is considered a "spirit puller." It is placed on the altar fire and can be used to summons benevolent spirits to a ceremony.

Solomon's Seal was used as an offering to Elementals when asking for their assistance. Bladderwrack was used specifically to summon Water Spirits. Broom is used to call forth the Spirits of the Air. In ancient times, the priest would travel to the top of a mountain, throw the ground up branches and flowers of the Broom shrub up into the air in order to "Raise the Winds" and summon the Spirits of the Air. When the winds needed to be calmed, the priest would then burn the Broom branches and flowers and bury the ashes.

Tea made from Dandelion root and placed beside the bed while still steaming was used in ancient times to summons spirits. In certain magical traditions, the mystic would boil some Thistle, then remove it from heat, and then sit beside it as the steam rises to get the spirits to answer his or her questions.

MEDITATION FOR ABSORBING THE PLANT'S ESSENCE

The Kidneys serve as the internal root source of all the body's Qi, or vital energy. In this sense, the Kidneys are like the batteries that provide constant nourishing power to all the other organs. When the other organs become weak or compromised by excess or deficient Qi, poor diet, external stress factors, and disease, they will "borrow" reserve Qi from the Kidneys. And, like Water nourishing fertile fields, the Kidneys will provide this reserve power in abundance – at least for a while.

Jing (Essence), is like a precious elixir; it is a vital, vibrant, liquid light energy that is the most physical form of Qi. Jing is like the fuel that keeps the Kidney energy strong, vibrant, and capable of supporting and sustaining healthy activity amongst the other organs. When the vital essence becomes depleted, our energy and vital capacity diminish as well.

The following meditation exercise is used by Daoist mystics in order to absorb the hidden magical power elixirs inherent within the various trees and plants of the forest.

EXTRACTING THE ESSENCE FROM STILLNESS

The following meditation is used by Daoist priests to absorb the essence of a plant into his body.

- Find a quiet, secluded place within the forest (a place where you won't be disturbed by any people or pets). Begin by standing in a Wuji posture, and perform the "One Through Ten Meditation" and "Three Invocations."
- Next, remain in a state of quiet solitude for several minutes, taking time to focus on deep Natural Breaths. Relax and allow your body, mind, and spirit to settle.
- Imagine and feel that all around you is a sea of vibrant, microscopic beads of precious vital elixir. Even though some individuals cannot see this vaporous elixir, it is always possible to sense its presence (much like we can't "see" the humidity in the air, but we feel it). Take some time to focus on this image and feeling.
- Now, as you stand immersed in this energetic field of healing elixir, start synchronizing the image with your breath by imagining that as you inhale you can feel this elixir being absorbed into your skin, through your muscles, and into

the bones. Make sure you are using and including all of the body's bone structure and not just the ribs or spine. Remember that the Kidneys and the Water Element rule the bones, and that Jing (Essence) is very important in the development and health of bones. This is why the bones are the best place for absorbing and storing the environmental plant Jing.

- After each inhale and "absorption," feel that the bones are becoming activated and begin to "humm" as you exhale. This energetic process occurs when the environmental Jing containing the plant's Ling Shen actually enters into the bones.
- After a certain period of time you will feel as if all of the bones have become completely filled. At this point, shift your attention and focus to the Kidneys. Feel the Kidneys begin to activate, and envision in your mind's eye a gently glowing white light emanating from them.
- With each inhalation, imagine and feel the Kidneys absorbing the Jing energy that is overflowing from the bones. Imagine that they are filling and expanding slightly with each inhalation.
- As you exhale, imagine and feel the Kidneys relax, and experience the Jing energy "sinking" into the Kidneys with the relaxation of each exhale.
- Repeat this process for several minutes. Then imagine and feel the light inside the Kidneys transforming to a luminescent royal blue color as the Kidneys begin to glow brighter and brighter.
- Once you feel that the Kidneys are "full" of Jing, disengage from the imagery and gently place your palms, one on top of the other, on the Lower Dantian.
- Make eight clockwise circles around the navel with your hands, while affirming to yourself that you have absorbed this healing elixir from the energetic mist released from the trees and plants of the forest that surrounds you, and that it is now stored within your Kidneys.
- Once you have done this, stand or sit peacefully for a few moments and enjoy the wonderful serenity and peace that you are feeling. Just relax and breathe. When you are ready, open your eyes and slowly get up and go about your normal activities. The key to making sure these exercises are safe is to relax while practicing.

DAOIST PLANT MEDICINE

During China's Six Dynasties (220-280 A.D.), maintaining health by means of diet, herbal prescriptions, and physical exercise was the main concern of the doctor for his or her patient. As a result of this interest, two types of medical literature developed in ancient China: books that focused on nourishing life and books that focused on the classics of diet.

Traditionally, when treating a patient, a Daoist priest would also prescribe herbs along with Qi emission therapy, Qigong meditations, and Qigong exercises. The herbal prescriptions, meditations, and exercises would all vary, according to the patient's specific condition, constitution, and illness.

Today in modern China, the ancient Daoist skill of using Qi Emission therapy in conjunction with herbal remedies has became an extremely popular clinical application. This is due to the overwhelming success rate resulting from the combination of self-applied Medical Qigong therapy (Daoist exercises and meditations) in conjunction with modern drug therapy. Extensive research has shown that this combination is far superior to that of drug therapy alone. This data was reported in numerous clinical studies on patients, with diseases ranging from hypertension to cancer.

Qi emission causes the body to relax, and it promotes the flow of Qi, Blood, oxygen, and nutrients to all cells of the body. It also promotes the removal of waste products from the body's cells. Modern research has confirmed the fact that Medical Qigong also promotes drug uptake by the cells and tissues by means of increased microcirculation within the body's circulatory system. This increased energy flow through the body's microcirculation is used in the clinic in order to nourish the patient's diseased or stressed tissues.

There were several techniques used by the ancient Daoist to diagnose and treat patients by absorbing and then utalizing the energetic effects of a specific herb or herbal formula. The following are two examples:

Figure 1.321. A Daoist priest testing the efficacy of a specific loose Herb for his patient.

DIAGNOSIS

This magical technique was initiated in order to verify how the patient's body would be affected by a certain plant or herbal prescription. This ancient Daoist magical technique was similar in effect to the modern diagnostic techniques used in Applied Kinesiology.

- **Absorption:** To begin with, the priest would hold a specific plant or herbal prescription in his or her left hand. Next, the priest would absorbed the energetic effects of the specific medicine into his or her body. By extending his or her intention and feeling intuition into the plant or bottle that contained the specific herbal prescription, the priest could connect with the plant spirit that was responsible for initiating the healing (Figure 1.321).
- **Diagnosis:** Next, the priest would extend his or her energy into the patient's body and began absorbing the patient's Qi. In this type of magical application, the energetic properties and treatment compatibility of the patient's body and those of the herb were both diagnosed and reported to either be effective or ineffective in treatment application.

TREATMENT

Another example of a treatment technique used in ancient China by Daoist priests to treat patients using plant magic is described as follows:

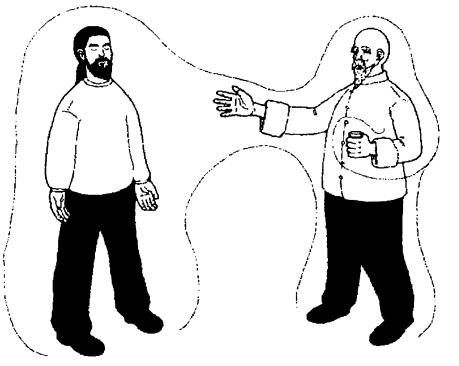


Figure 1.322. A Qigong Doctor emits the energy of specific patent herbal medicine into his patient.

- **Absorption:** To begin with, the priest would hold a specific plant or herbal prescription in his or her left hand. The priest would then begin to energetically feel, ingest, and absorb the medicinal and energetic properties of the plant into his or her Lower Dantian.
- **Projection:** After the priest had embodied the specific energetic nature of the specific plant or herbal prescription, he or she would start to project the plant's specific healing qualities into the patient's body for treatment. In this type of magical application, the energetic properties of the plant or herbal prescription was sometimes combined with a specific imagined color in order to enhance the herb's tonification effect. The priest would then project the combined energy of the plant and its enhanced imagined color into the patient's body, targeting a specific internal organ (Figure 1.322).

USE OF COLOR AND HERBS TO TONIFY ORGANS

Another magical technique used by the ancient Daoist for treating a patient was to combine Qi Emission therapy along with specific colors in order to tonify a specific internal organ. This type of tonification therapy was used to energetically effect, strengthen, and increase the herbs potency before projecting its energy into the patient's body (or brewing it into a tincture). The following are a few examples of some of the herbs used by the ancient Daoists for organ tonification in combination with Qi Emission Therapy.

Figure 1.323. Gou Qi Zi
(Lycium barbarum) is used for Tonifying Liver Blood.
(Inspired from the original artwork of Lilian Lai Bensky)

To Tonify the Liver (Gou Qi Zi)

The green color is combined with the specific energetic Liver Blood tonification qualities of Gou Qi Zi *(Lycium barbarum)* and is projected into the patient's Liver (Figure 1.323). This herb is used to treat Liver and Kidney Deficiency. Symptoms of Liver and Kidney Deficiency manifest as patterns of Yin and Blood Deficiency, sore back and legs, low-grade abdominal pain, nocturnal emission, impotence, or wasting and thirsting disorders. Gou Qi Zi's energy enters the patient's Liver, Lung and Kidney Channels. It benefits the Essence, brightens the eyes, enriches the Yin, and moistens the Lungs.

To Tonify the Heart (Long Yan Rou)

The red color is combined with the specific energetic Heart Qi and Blood tonification qualities of Long Yan Rou *(Arillus euphoriae longanae)* and is projected into the patient's Heart (Figure 1.324). This herb is used to treat Heart and Spleen Deficiency. Symptoms of Heart and Spleen Deficiency manifest as insomnia, Heart palpitations, forgetfulness, or dizziness. Long Yan Rou's energy enters the patient's Heart and Spleen Channels, nourishes the Blood, and calms the Shen.

Figure 1.324. Long Yan Rou
(Arillus euphoriae longanae) is used for Tonifying Heart Qi and Blood. (Inspired from the original artwork of Lilian Lai Bensky)

Figure 1.325. Huang Qi
(Radix astragali membranaceus) is used for Tonifying Spleen Qi. (Inspired from the original artwork of Lilian Lai Bensky)

To Tonify the Spleen (Huang Qi)

The yellow color is combined with the specific energetic Spleen Qi tonification qualities of Huang Qi *(Radix astragali membranaceus)* and is projected into the patient's Spleen (Figure 1.325). This herb is used to treat Spleen Deficiency. Symptoms of Spleen Deficiency include fatigue, lack of appetite, diarrhea, uterine bleeding, or prolapse disorders (e.g., Stomach, Uterus, and rectum). Huang Qi's energy enters the patient's Lung and Spleen Channels, raises the Yang Qi of the Spleen and Stomach, augments the Wei Qi, Tonifies Qi and Blood, and stabilizes the Exterior.

Figure 1.326. Shan Yao (Radix diocoreae oppositae) is used for Tonifying Lung Qi and Lung Yin. (Inspired from the original artwork of Lilian Lai Bensky)

TO TONIFY THE LUNGS (SHAN YAO)

The white color is combined with the specific energetic Lung Qi and Lung Yin tonification qualities of Shan Yao (*Radix diocoreae oppositae*) and is projected into the patient's Lungs (Figure 1.326). This herb is used to treat Lung Deficiency. Symptoms of Lung Deficiency manifest as chronic cough or wheezing. Shan Yao's energy enters the patient's Lung, Spleen, and Kidney Channels, and it also moistens, therefore benefitting both the Yin and Yang of the Lungs and Kidneys. Additionally, Shan Yao can also be used to Tonify the Spleen and Stomach.

TO TONIFY THE KIDNEYS

Tonification of the Kidneys is aimed at strengthening Kidney Yin, Kidney Yang, or both Kidney Yin and Yang, described as follows:

- **Han Lian Cao:** The midnight blue and black color is combined with the specific energetic Kidney Yin tonification qualities of Han Lian Cao (*Herba ecliptae prostratae*) and is projected into the patient's Kidneys (Figure 1.327). This herb is used to nourish and Tonify Liver and Kidney Yin. Symptoms of Liver and Kidney Yin Deficiency manifest as dizziness, blurred vision, vertigo, or premature graying. Han Lian Cao's energy enters the patient's Kidney and Liver Channels, Cools the Blood, and stops bleeding (due to Heat in the Blood).
- **Du Zhong:** The flame blue color is combined with the specific energetic Kidney Yang tonification qualities of Du Zhong (*Cortex eucommiae ulmoidis*) and is projected into the patient's Kidneys (Figure 1.328). This herb is used to treat Kidney Deficiency. Symptoms of Kidney Deficiency manifest as weak knees, sore or painful lower back and knees, fatigue, frequent urination, and edema. Du Zhong's energy enters the patient's Kidney and Liver Channels, Tonifies the Kidney and Liver organs, strengthens the sinews and bones, and promotes circulation (by smoothing the flow of Qi and Blood).

Figure 1.327. Han Lian Cao (Herba ecliptae prostratae) is used for Tonifying Kidney Yin. (Inspired from the original artwork of Lilian Lai Bensky)

Figure 1.328. Du Zhong (Cortex eucommiae ulmoidis) is used for Tonifying Kidney Yang. (Inspired from the original artwork of Lilian Lai Bensky)

QI EMMISSION, HERBAL TEAS AND SOUPS

Herbal teas and soups are water-based herbal formulas traditionally prepared from raw or processed herbal ingredients. These are traditionally ingested for the treatment of internal and external disorders of both acute and chronic natures.

In ancient China, Daoist priests would combine Qi Emission Therapy with the production of herbal teas and soups. This was practiced in order to enhance digestive absorption and increase the tissue energizing ability of the herbs, thus augmenting their healing potential.

Qi Emmission, Herbal Tinctures and Wines

Tinctures and wines are both alcohol-based herbal formulas. Tinctures are concentrated alcohol-based formulas prepared from raw herbs and are used internally. Wines are traditionally applied externally to alleviate pain, or ingested as a tonic, depending on the specific formula and the disease being treated.

In ancient China, Daoist priests would combine Qi Emission Therapy with the production of herbal tinctures and wines. This was practiced in order to enhance both external and internal absorption, thereby increasing the herbs healing potential.

Qi Emmission, Herbal Oils, Balms, and Liniments

Oils, balms, and liniments are oil-based herbal formulas usually applied externally for the treatment of muscle, tendon, and ligament trauma, or to alleviate pain, disperse Excess Qi, or draw Qi into specific areas for tonification.

In ancient China, Daoist priests would combine Qi Emission Therapy with the production of herbal oils, balms and liniments to enhance Qi and Blood flow. This was practiced in order to aid the herbs' assimilation and tissue energizing ability and increase the herbs' healing potential.

Qi Emmission, Herbal Compresses, Powers and Pills

Compresses, powders, and pills consist of herbs that have been pulverized into a paste, powder, or poultice and are then applied externally for the treatment of acute or chronic injuries. They can also be formed into crackers, cakes, pastries, and honey based candies for ingestion, used for internal organ tonification and the rebalancing of the body's energy systems. Pills are herbs specifically prepared from traditional formulas, rolled into little balls, and orally ingested for the treatment of internal disorders.

In ancient China, Daoist priests would combine Qi Emission Therapy with the production of herbal compresses, powers and pills. This was practised in order to aid the herbs' energizing ability, and to increase the herbs' healing potential.

Introduction to Herbal Healing and Traumatology

In ancient China, a Daoist priest eventually retreated from the public in order to enter into a time of meditative isolation. This meditative practice was essentially in order to practice advance forms of magical alchemy. Traditionally, a priest either sought the refuge of certain monasteries or mountainous caves in order to practice this training.

When practicing in mountainous regions, the risk of encountering wild animals, robbers, poisonous plants, disease, and other various forms of sickness often placed the Daoist hermits at risk. If the priest suddenly became sick or injured, it could mean the sudden termination of his or her magical practice. Depending on the initial trauma, any sustain injury to the tendons, ligaments, bones, internal organs, soft tissues, etc., could initially affect the body's entire systemic functions, resulting in motor impairment, or in severe cases death.

All injuries to the skin, muscles, tendons, ligaments, and bones are considered external. If the Qi, blood, channel pathways, collaterals, or major organs are damaged, the injury is considered internal. In Chinese traumatology, both internal and external injuries are considered to be related. This is because, through mutual interaction, external injuries affect the internal components, and internal damage affects the external areas.

Therefore, in order insure that the priest remained healthy and self-sufficient, herbal healing and traumatology was traditionally taught to the young disciples before they ventured into the high mountainous regions.

In ancient China, the study of natural medicine was also instrumental in maintaining the physiological balance of the metabolism and in restoring the body's energy balance. Herb formulas which were used to heal the body, as well as supplement a Yin and Yang balance of the body's Qi and blood were considered to be powerful magical remedies and were usually kept in secret.

HERBAL FORMULA

External herbal formulas include powders, pastes, plasters, oils, and liniments (most liniments are composed of liquors, oils, or oil paste bases). These external formula are commonly applied to an injured area of the body and are constructed according to the body's specific needs. For example, herbal oils, pastes, and plasters are generally designed to warm the body's channels and disperse stagnations and are sometimes used to disperse wind, cold, and damp invasion from the joints, tendons, and bones.

The following are several ancient and modern herbal formula used in Chinese traumatology. Please keep in mind that several of these herbal prescriptions are generic, and that it is a good idea to first consult an herbalist for balancing each formula according to your specific constitution before taking them.

HERBAL POWDERS AND PILLS

In this type of herbal treatment, medicinal herbs are first ground into powder. The powdered herbs are then sprinkled directly onto an open wound, or combined with other herbs and either formed into pills or applied as a paste medicine.

- **Dragon's Breath Herbal Pill:** This herbal remedy is used as a tonic. It is designed to tone the body's nervous system, stimulate the brain and respiratory system, and influence psychic perception. It is generally taken before strenuous martial training or before practicing prolonged standing Qigong and Shengong meditations.

  The following are two types of Dragon's Breath formulas. The first is the Yang (hot) formula, which will usually be taken by beginning students who have weak Qi. The formula helps to build and invigorate the Qi and blood. Because of its hot nature it is not recommended for practitioners with high blood pressure.

  The second Dragon's Breath mixture is the Yin (cool) formula. It is to be taken by students who have built up strong Qi and want to continue tonification.

Yang Formula Herbs		Yin Formula Herbs	
2 oz.	He Shou Wu	1 oz.	Golden Seal
1.5 oz.	Gotu Kola	1 oz.	Chen Pi
1 oz.	Cayenne	2 oz.	He Shou Wu
1 oz.	Guarana	1.5 oz.	Comfrey
2 oz.	Siberian Ginseng	1.5 oz.	Gotu Kola
1 oz.	Costus Root	1 oz.	Guarana
4 oz.	Dang Shen	1 oz.	Licorice Root

In ancient China, these herbal formula were traditionally mixed in a clay bowl, then combined with honey, and eventually wrapped in yellow wax paper for keeping. In modern times, the herbs are still mixed together in a nonmetallic bowl, and placed inside 00x capsules. The herbs are then stored in an airtight container and kept away from the sunlight. The herbal prescription will normally last up to one year. Generally, two capsules are taken with a glass of water, one hour before workout.

Contraindication: Because of their strong effect on the major internal organs, it is advisable to not take more than three capsules at a time.

- **Shou Gong San:** This herbal remedy was originally introduced by a monk named Zhan Hua during the Qing Dynasty (1644-1911 A.D.). It is taken after training in order to regulate the Qi and blood.

  Grind the following herbs into a fine powder. Then place the powder into a bottle and store in a cool dry place. After each practice, take 1-3 grams to the powder with a cup of warm water.

3 Grams Fructus Citri Seu Ponciri (Fried)
3 Grams Ligum Dalbergiae Odoriferae
3 Grams Semen Persicae
6 Grams Exocarpium Citri Grandis
6 Grams Lignum Aquilariae
6 Grams Flos Carthami Tinctorii
9 Grams Radix Angelicae Sinensis

- **Yunnan Pai Yao:** Yunnan Pai Yao is a very effective patented powdered herbal formula used to stop external and internal hemorrhaging. It arrests bleeding and speeds coagulation. Yunnan Pai Yao can be used for incised wounds, gunshot wounds, bruises and contusions, nosebleeds, bloody urine, etc. It can also be used on severe skin rashes.

Yunnan Pai Yao comes in two forms, capsule and bottled. It is recommended that Yunnan Pai Yao be taken internally four times a day with warm water. Each bottle or blister pack of Yunnan Pai Yao comes with a small red emergency pill that is taken in case of extreme blood loss.

- **Raw Tienchi Powder:** Tienchi powder stops bleeding and is used for treatment of various kinds of hemorrhaging such as nosebleed, discharge of bloody urine, external and internal traumatic hemorrhage, contusion, and blood clots. Tienchi powder is the main ingredient in most "hit pills."

  For internal usage, take three to five grams twice daily with warm water. For external usage, sprinkle directly on affected area to arrest bleeding. Be sure that you use the raw Tienchi, not the steamed Tienchi on external wounds.
- **Sai Mei An:** This is a very effective patented powdered herbal formula, that can be used either to stop bleeding or in treatment of burns and blisters.
- **Zi Bu Dan:** This is a very effective powdered herbal formula, that can be used in the treatment of traumatic head injuries resulting in unconsciousness or semi-consciousness. After consciousness is regained, the patient will sometimes experience headache, slurred speech, and insomnia. The following herbal formula is used to help the patient heal faster by opening the orifices, dispelling wind, and calming the Shen.
  0.05% Calculus Bovis
  0.1% Cinnamomum Camphora
  0.1% Moschus
  1.5% Benzionum
  1% Cornu Rhinoceri Asiatica
  1% Carapax Eretmochelyas
  1% Succinum
  1% Cinnabaris
  1% Rh Curcumae Longae
- **Kang Gu Zheng Sheng Pian:** Kang Gu Zheng Sheng Pian "Combat Bone Hyperplasia Pill" is a tonic used to strengthen the Yang Qi, tonify the liver and kidneys, fortify the tendons, bone and marrow, and relieve pain. This is a recently patented formula used specifically for vertebral calcification following injury or in spontaneous multiplicative spondylitis (inflammation of one or more vertebrae). A bottle of Kang Gu Zheng Sheng Pian carries one hundred tablets. Take six tablets, three times a day.
- **Tien Da Wan (Bruise Hit Pills) #1:** Tien Da Wan literally means "bruise hit pills," and is important for terminating internal and external bleeding. When used for contused wounds and bruises, it is extremely effective in increasing the white blood cell count, increasing the phagocytic action on body infections. It will reestablish the circulation of Qi and blood, thus reducing swelling and pain while breaking up blood stagnation. This medicine should be taken immediately after an injury. If the injury is not treated at once, blood clots will form in the body's tissues and begin obstructing the fascia movement. This obstruction can result in Qi and blood stagnation. Additionally, when there is internal bleeding, it is important to not eat any hot or spicy food.

  Mix the following herbs in a nonmetal bowl and place them into 100x capsules. Store them in an airtight container, away from the sun. The herbs will last up to one year. Take one capsule before each meal when used for healing.
  .25 oz. Dragon's Blood Resin
  .5 oz. Hemlock Parsley
  1 oz. Yunnan Pai Yao
  1 oz. Frankincense
  1 oz. Scaly Anteater
  1 oz. Myrrh
  2 oz. Tien Qi Powder

  This hit pill is to be taken immediately after the injury has occurred, before any type of external treatment is applied. This pill will help keep the blood from stagnating, reduce swelling, and relieve pain.
- **Tien Da Wan (Bruise Hit Pill) #2:** The following herbal formula is from my personal friends, the Ho family, who own the Great China Herb Co. in San Francisco, California. After construction, this pill is generally very large. In cases of severe blood stagnation, the hit pill is to be taken with rice wine. The wine will help increase the blood vitalizing

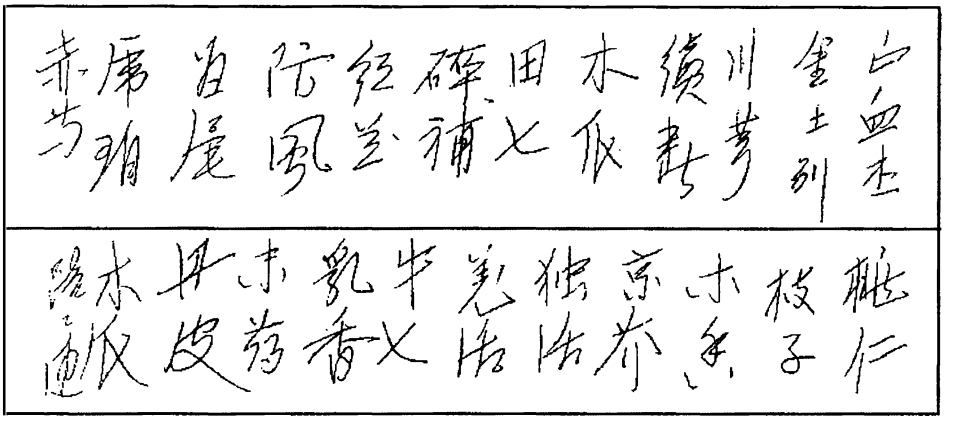


Figure 1.329. Tien Da Wan (Bruise Hit Pill)

properties of the medicine. It should be taken immediately after receiving an injury.

In order to construct this particular hit pill, powder and mix two parts of the following herbs (Figure 1.329) to one part honey. Place the mixture into a non-metallic bowl and roll the herbs into little balls. Next, place the herbal balls onto a cookie sheet and bake in the oven on a low fire. Remove the herbs, wrap them in wax paper, and store in a cool place.

- **Tien Da Wan (Bruise Hit Pills) #3:** This pill is used in order to activated the blood, remove stagnation, and strengthen the bones and tendons. In cases of severe blood stagnation, the pills should be take with rice wine. The wine will help increase the blood vitalizing properties of the medicine. The pill should be taken immediately after receiving a traumatic injury. Take 2 to 4 pills a day.

In order to construct this particular Tien Da Wan formula, grind the following herbs into a fine powder, add Saccharum Granorum (Yi Tang: barley malt sugar) in order to form a thick paste. Then roll the herbs into little balls, place them onto a cookie sheet and bake them in the oven on a low fire. Remove them from the oven, wrap them in wax paper, and store them in a cool place.

1% Sanguis Draconis
1% Eupolyphaga Sinensis
1% Myrrha
1% Rx Angelica Sinensis
1% Rx Ligustici Wallichi
2% Gummi Olibanum
2% H Ephedra
2% Pyritum

PATENTED HIT PILLS

The following is a list of popular hit pills.

- **Hsiung Tan Tieh Ta Wan (Bear Gall Bladder Trauma Injury Pill):** This popular hit pill is used by many Chinese martial arts schools. It is to be taken internally for all types of traumatic injuries. These pills may also be dissolved in rice wine and made into a hot wine for external applications and compresses.
- **Qih Koo Tieh Shang Wan (Muscle & Bone Traumatic Injury Pill):** This popular hit pill is also used by many Chinese martial arts schools. It is used for the treatment of acute traumatic injuries such as fractures, sprains, strains, and most wounds caused from fighting.
- **Qih Shang Wan:** This popular hit pill can be crushed into powder and externally applied to an open wound in order to stop bleeding. Not only will it reduce swelling, relax the tendons, and loosen the ligaments, but it will also promote the growth of muscular tissue.
- **Tieh Ta Yao Wang (Musk & Bear Balm Preparation):** This popular hit pill comes from the Shaolin Priests in the Kuang-Hsiao Temple. It can be used for all kinds of traumas, injuries, fractures, and over-fatigue. It is used to eliminate swelling, kill pain, and relax and activate the tendons.

Herbal Poultice (Herbal Paste)

In herbal traumatology, an herbal poultice is commonly used to stimulate Qi and blood circulation, dissolve bruises, reduce swelling and inflammation, and alleviate pain.

In order to construct a medical paste, the herbs are first ground into a powder. Then, the herbs are mixed with a "combining base," used to hold the ingredients together. Some examples of a combining base include sugar, egg white, oil, water, liquor, vinegar, or Vaseline. Once contained, the herbal paste is placed onto mulberry papers.

The construction, use, and changing of an herbal paste depends on the extent of the injury that is being treated, and the type of weather. For example, the application of sugar (Saccharum Granorum or Yi Tang: barley malt sugar) is commonly used to solidify and protect the wounded area (the usual ratio of sugar to herbal mixture is 3 to 1). However, sugar paste is easily spoiled when exposed to the hot sun or to areas where there is high humidity (due to rain). When the injury that is being treated is to an open wound, the herbs are usually mixed with oil in order to give the formula a smooth, nourishing effect.

Normally, the herbal paste is changed every two days. However, in the later stages of heal, the paste can remain on the wounded area for extended periods of time. When the herbal paste is mixed with water and liquor, it should be changes more frequently due to the alcohol's ability to evaporate.

The following are popular herbal paste formula:

- **Ching Wan Hung:** Herbal treatment used for treating first and second-degree burns consists of medicinal herbs that have been ground into powder. The powdered herbs are then either sprinkled directly onto the burn area, or they are combined with other herbs and applied as a form of paste medicine.

  Ching Wan Hung is the best patented herbal burn ointment I have ever found, and it can be used on all sorts of burns, scalds, blisters, abrasions, cuts, and scratches. It promotes circulation of blood and Qi, stops pain, cools heat, and promotes tissue growth.
- **San Shi Fu Yao:** The San Shi Fu Yao herbal paste formula is used for the external treatment of traumatic injury to the tendons resulting in blood stagnation and swelling. It will dispel the blood stagnation, arrest the pain, strengthen the bones and tendons, and dispel cold and damp from the injured area.

  In order to construct the San Shi Fu Yao herbal paste, grind the following herbs into a fine powder, add Saccharum Granorum (Yi Tang: barley malt sugar) to form the paste, and then apply externally.

  0.06% Licorice
  0.08% F Forsythiae
  1% Rx Angelica Sinensis (whole)
  1% Rx Acanthopanacis Radicis
  1% F Chaenomelis
  1% Rx Salviae Miltiorrhizae
  1% Rx Notopterygii
  1% Rx Paeoniae
  1% Rx Angelica
  1% Rh Curcumae Longae
  1% Angelica Tuhou
  1% Rx Ligustici Wallichi
  2% Rx Trichosanthis
  2% Rx Achyranthis
  2% Rx Clematidis
  2% Rx Stephaniae
  2% Rx Sileris
  2% S Strychnos
  8% F Vitex Negundo
  8% Rx Vitex Negundo
- **Su Jin Huo Luo Yan:** This herbal paste is used for the external treatment of traumatic injury to the tendons, resulting in pain and swelling. Su Jin Huo Luo Yan is commonly used to treat the tendons after a dislocation. It will activate the blood, arrest the pain, strengthen the tendons, and activate the channels in the injured tissue area.

  In order to construct the Su Jin Huo Luo Yan herbal formula, grind the following herbs into a fine powder, add Saccharum Granorum (Yi Tang: barley malt sugar) to form the paste, and then apply externally.

  1% Rx Paeoniae Rubra
  1% F Carthami
  1% Rh Arisaematis
  1.5% Pollen Typhae

1.5% F Inulae
1.5% Lignum Sappan
2% Rx Notopterygii
2% Rx Aconiti Carmichaeli
2% Angelica Tuhou
2% Pinelliae (Raw)
2% F Gardeniae (Raw)
2% Rh Rhei(Raw)
2% F Chaenomelis
2% F Liquidambaris

- **Ji Gu Xu Jin:** This herbal paste is used for the external treatment of traumatic injury to the tendons with pain and swelling. Ji Gu Xu Jin is commonly used to treat the tendons after a dislocation. It will activate the blood, arrest the pain, strengthen the tendons, and activate the channels in the injured tissue area.

  In order to construct the Ji Gu Xu Jin herbal formula, grind the following herbs into a fine powder, add Saccharum Granorum (Yi Tang: barley malt sugar) to form the paste, and then apply externally.

  2% Rh Drymariae
  2% F Carthami
  2% Eupolyphaga Sinensis
  2% Myrrha
  3% Rx Paeoniae Rubra
  3% Rx Notopterygii
  3% Gummi Olibanum
  3% Rx Schizonepatae
  3% Pyritum
  3% Cx Acanthopanacis Radicis
  3% Rx Dipsaci
  3% Sileris
  3%Spina Gleditsiae
  3% Uarix Rubiae
  4% Borax
  4% Sanguis Draconis
  4% Rh Bletillae

- **Bone-Knitting Paste:** In order to make the Bone-Knitting Paste, grind the following herbs into a fine powder. Then mix them with egg whites until the formula reaches the consistency of a thick pudding. The egg white will break down the cell walls and help release the healing essence of the herbs.

  Apply the poultice to the wounded area, cover it with wax paper, and then wrap with an Ace bandage. Keep the poultice on the wound for one to two days. You should always make sure that the bones are set before applying the poultice. Adjust the tendons first, then set the bones.

  2.75 oz. Rheum officinale
  2.75 oz. Phellodendron Amurense
  2.75 oz. Scutellaria Bailkalensis

- **Gu Sui Bu (Mender of Shattered Bones):** This herbal paste promotes the mending of the bones and sinews. Gu Sui Bu is especially useful in treating injuries to the ligaments, tendons, and other connective tissues. Connective tissue does not have a large supply of blood and therefore requires a very long time to heal. There is little or no western medicine available to help this type of healing process. However, Gu Sui Bu has been found to work extremely well in helping to repair damaged connective tissue.

  Because it is a patented medicine, you can buy Gu Sui Bu in powdered form and mix with warm water until it forms a thick paste. Warm the affected tissue area with a hot compress and then apply a very thick (minimum one-half inch) layer of the Gu Sui Bu paste. You may want to add honey to the mixture in order to help it adhere to the skin. Then wrap the injured tissue with plastic wrap and leave the paste on the area for twenty-four hours. You may need to loosen the wrap periodically in order to allow the skin to breathe.

- **Tiger Balm:** The application of Tiger Balm is commonly used to move the Qi, quicken the blood, dispels stasis, and arrest muscular aches or pains. It is also used by those individuals who prefer a balm to an oil. There are three types of patented balm medicine generally accessible to the pubic: White Tiger Balm, which is mild and should be used on the face; Red Tiger Balm, which is strong and should be used on the body; and Essential Balm, which is very strong.

HERBAL PLASTERS

Herbal plasters are commonly used for treating external injuries (i.e. bruises and sprains), and are specifically formulated to strengthen the bones, tendons and connective tissue, as well as activate Qi and blood flow. Traditionally, herbal plasters are used in acute sprains with swelling or in cases of bone fractures after the swelling has reduced.

In order to make an herbal plaster, herbs are first ground into powder and then fried with oil until they form a paste. The advantage of pasted medicines are that it has a sticky property which allows it to become attached to an injured area.

There are many types of herbal plasters available commercially. The following are five different plasters that cover a wide range of ailments from mild muscle stiffness to bruising and connective tissue damage. It is important to note that you may sometimes have to cut the plaster in order to allow for freedom of movement.

- **Hua Tuo Anti-Contusion Rheumatism Plaster:** This is a mild plaster used for muscular aches, rheumatic pains, lower backache, and arthritis pain. It is excellent for the treatment of stiff neck and shoulders. Before applying, first clean the affected area with warm water and dry the skin thoroughly. Then remove the plaster from the sheet and stick it to the affected area. You may leave the plaster it in place for up to twenty-four hours. Do not place the herbal plaster onto any area where there is broken skin.
- **Musk & Tiger Bone Plaster:** This plaster is a bit hotter and stronger than the "Hua Tuo" plaster. It has a warm nature and is used to relieve swelling and disperse bruises. Before applying, first clean the affected area with warm water and dry the skin thoroughly. Then remove the plaster from the sheet and stick it to the affected area. You may leave the plaster it in place for up to twenty-four hours. Do not place the herbal plaster onto any area where there is broken skin.
- **Plaster for Bruise and Analgesic (Yang Cheng Brand):** This plaster has alternating heating and cooling properties and is used for mild inflammation and swelling. It is larger in size than the Musk & Tiger Bone plaster and is used to promote the flow of Qi and blood to the affected area. Before applying, first clean the affected area with warm water and dry the skin thoroughly. Then remove the plaster from the sheet and stick it to the affected area. You may leave the plaster it in place for up to twenty-four hours.

  Fair skinned individuals may experience some minor skin irritation from the Yang Cheng Brand of plaster. In order to avoid irritation, add a thin coating of sesame oil to the skin before applying the plaster; the plaster will not be quite as adhesive but this will minimize the irritation. Do not place the herbal plaster onto any area where there is broken skin.
- **Kou Pi Plasters ("Dog Skin" Plasters):** Kou Pi plasters are used for severe sprains, strains, and contusions especially in the lower and middle back areas. The herbs in this plaster are suspended in a gummy base. The Kou Pi plaster must first be warmed in a toaster oven on a very low temperature until the gummy base becomes sticky. After being applied, the plaster can be left on the injured area for two or three days. Do not place the herbal plaster onto any area where there is broken skin.
- **Tieh Ta Wan Ying Kao:** This is an herbal plaster used for soft tissue injuries and most "closed" types of bone fractures. Its main action is to stimulate the circulation of blood, disperse clotting, and unite fractures and tendons. Beware of using this ointment on overly sensitive skin. For application, spread the ointment evenly on a gauze cloth, then wrap the gauze around the injured area being treated. Do not place the herbal plaster onto any area where there is broken skin.

10%	Myrrh
10%	Borneol
12%	Mastic
13%	Sappan Wood
15%	Calamus Gum
40%	Tien Chu Huang

EXTERNAL COMPRESSES

Treatment with herbal compresses are used in order to stimulate the blood circulation and dissolve bruises. Herbal compresses are also used in order to reduce swelling and alleviate pain.

- Use equal amounts of fresh Pai-Chu Shu sprouts and gardenia, crushed with a little flour and brandy, and then apply as an extrenal herbal compress.
- Use one ounce of Wood Sorrel (Oxalix Corniculata), crush it into a poultice, and then apply as an extrenal herbal compress.
- Crush Myriogyne Minuta, mix it with 50% wine, and then apply as an extrenal herbal compress.
- Pulverize fresh Pinellia, mix with white wine to form a poultice, and then apply as an extrenal herbal compress.

HERBAL OILS

In Chinese traumatology, herbal oils are sometimes used to moves the Qi, quicken the blood, dispels stasis, and stop muscular pain. To experience sore muscles and minor muscles aches and pains in the beginning stages of physical practice is common. Therefore, several herbal remedies were developed in order to relieve the disciples sore muscles and muscle spasms.

- **Kwan Loong Medicated Oil:** This is an excellent oil used for temporary relief of minor muscular aches and pains due to exertion and fatigue, minor muscular strains, and minor pains due to arthritis. For cold symptoms, Kwan Loong Medicated Oil can be applied to the chest and back. For frontal headaches, Kwan Loong Medicated Oil is applied to the forehead and temples.
- **Po Sum On Medicated Oil:** Po Sum On has the same uses as Kwan Loong Oil, and it is useful for treating aches and pains in the joints caused by traumatic injury. It is also an excellent oil to use on the face and back of the head.

HERBAL TEAS

These following herbal teas are ingested in order to internally stimulate blood circulation, dissolve bruises, reduce swelling, and alleviate pain.

- **Eye Bright:** Mix two parts Chrysanthemum with one part Honeysuckle. This herbal formula can either be drunk to treat an eye infection, or use externally as an eye wash for irritation or infection of eyes (after they have been poked).
- **Ba Zhen Tang:** This herbal remedy is used as a tonic that provides a natural Yin-Yang balance. It is designed to tone the body's nervous system, stimulate the brain and respiratory system, and influence psychic perception. It is generally taken before strenuous martial training or before practicing prolonged standing Qigong and Shengong meditations.

  To prepare this formula, place the following herbs in four cups of water and boil the formula down to one cup. Pour off the liquid and drink one cup a day after eating food. The same herbs can be used for two consecutive days. On the second day, boil three and one half cups of water down to one cup, then drink after a meal.

  3 Grams Shen Qiang
  6 Grams Gau Cao
  9 Grams Chuan Xiang
  9 Grams Bai Shao Yao
  10 Grams Ren Shen
  12 Grams Shu He Sheng Hua
  12 Grams Fu Ling
  12 Grams Bai Zhu
  12 Grams Dang Gui
  5 pcs Da Zao (prepared)

HERBAL SOUPS

These herbal soups are commonly used for treating internal injuries.

- **Qing Shen Tang (Purify the Spirit Soup):** This is a cooling soup, used to remove toxic heat from the body, disperse blood stagnation and swelling, and cool the blood. It is also used when a severe traumatic injury has caused high fever, thirst, and semi-consciousness. In order to create the Qing Shen Tang formula, mix the following herbs listed below in water to form a tea or soup. Drink two cups a day or as needed.

  3 Grams Licorice
  3 Grams Rx Rahmanniae (Raw)
  3 Grams Rx Scutellariae
  3 Grams Rh Coptdis

3 Grams F Forsythiae
3 Grams F Gardemiae
6 Grams S Persicae
9 Grams Rx Paeoniae Rubra
9 Grams Cx Mountain Radicis
9 Grams Rx Angelica Sinensis
12 Grams Rx Ligustici Wallichi

- **Xin Xiang Xu Duan Tang:** This soup is used for treating bone fractures (after the bone has been set). The soup is deigned in order to stop pain, strengthen the bones and tendons, and to activate Qi and blood flow. It is commonly ingested during the acute and intermediate stages of bone fractures (when the initial swelling has subsided and the pain has decreased, but the tendons and bones are still tender and not healed). In order to create the Xin Xiang Xu Duan Tang formula, mix the following herbs listed below in water to form a tea or soup. Drink two cups a day or as needed.
  3 Grams Myrrha
  3 Grams Gummi Olibanum
  6 Grams S Persicae
  6 Grams F Lycopi
  6 Grams Rx Salvae Miltiorrhizae
  6 Grams Eupolyphaga Sinensis
  6 Grams Rx Corydalis
  10 Grams Lignum Sappan
  10 Grams Rx Dipsaci
  12 Grams Rx Angelica Sinensis (Tail)
  12 Grams Pyritum
  12 Grams Rh Drymariae
  12 Grams Rm Mori
- **Xu Gu Huo Xue Tang:** This soup is used in the later stages healing for strengthening the bones and tendons. The soup is deigned in order to stop internal bleeding, disperse stagnation, reconnect bone tissue, tonify Qi and blood, and strengthen the liver, kidneys, spleen and stomach organs. It is commonly ingested when recovering from traumatic injury (i.e. sprains and fractures), during the later stages of healing. In order to create the Xu Gu Huo Xue Tang formula, mix the following herbs listed below in water to form a tea or soup. Drink two cups a day or as needed.
  6 Grams Myrrha
  6 Grams Gummi Olibanum
  6 Grams F Carthami
  6 Grams Eupolyphaga Sinensis
  10 Grams Rx Paeoniae Alba
  10 Grams Rx Paeoniae Rubra
  10 Grams Pyritum
  12 Grams Rx Angelica Sinensis (Tail)
  12 Grams Rh Drymariae
  12 Grams Rx Dipsaci
  15 Grams Rx Rahmanniae (Raw)
- **Su Jin Huo Xue Tang:** This soup is used for loosening the tendons. It activates the channels and remove wind and damp invasion (resulting in stiffness and atrophy of the joints). It is commonly used in post traumatic tendon and bone injuries, after the initial swelling has subsided. In order to create the Su Jin Huo Xue Tang formula, mix the following herbs listed below in water to form a tea or soup. Drink two cups a day or as needed.
  5 Grams Paricarpium Citr. Viride
  6 Grams Rx Notopterygii
  6 Grams H Schizopetae
  6 Grams F Carthami
  6 Grams F Aurantii
  9 Grams Angelica Tuhou
  9 Grams Rx Sileris
  9 Grams Rx Archyranthis Bidentatae
  9 Grams Cx Acanthopanacis
  9 Grams Cx Eucommiae
  12 Grams Rx Angelica Sinensis
  12 Grams Rx Dipsaci
- **Bai Long Tang (White Dragon Soup):** Bai Long Tang is an excellent herbal antispasmodic soup used for relief and prevention of muscle contractions and spasms. In order to create the Bai Long Tang formula, mix the following herbs listed below in water to form a tea or soup. Drink two cups a day or as needed.
  2 oz. Skullcap
  1 oz. Myrrh
  1 oz. Skunk Cabbage
  1 oz. Black Cohosh
  1 oz. Valerian
  1 oz. Lobelia
  1 oz. Cayenne

INTERNAL WINES

An herbal formula that is considered to be a "liquor" is generally composed of medicinal herbs combined with either wine or vinegar (usually combined at a 8 to 2 ratio) as its base. The following herbal wines are either used as tonics or for the treatment of post-traumatic injuries.

- **Dragon's Breath Herbal Wine:** This is a special formula that was traditionally used before fighting or completing a very heavy workout. The formula is designed to resists fatigue for two and one half to three hours. In order to make this herbal formula, the herbs are to be first ground into powder and then kept in a small clay bowl until they are ready for use. Then, when ingesting, the priest will simply add one tablespoon of the powdered herbs to a shot of rice wine one half hour before workout time.

  .22 oz. Shou Wu
  .22 oz. Ran Tong
  .33 oz. Xi Kui
  .44 oz. Niu-Qih
  .55 oz. Tiger Bone
  .55 oz. Cheng Qih
  2.0 oz. Bai-Ben-er

- **Fu Gu Mu Gua Jai:** This herbal remedy is used for treating post-traumatic injuries. It is especially useful when there is numbness, pain, and atrophy in the tendons and bones. Place the following herbs in rice wine (17% alcohol or higher) for seven days. Then add Saccharum Granorum (Yi Tang: barley malt sugar) to one cup of the wine and drink. Fu Gu Mu Gua Jai will activate the blood, dispel wind, strengthen the bones, and loosen and strengthen the tendons.

  15 Grams Rx Gentianae Macrophyllae
  15 Grams Rx Sileris
  30 Grams Os Tigeris (bake with vinegar)
  30 Grams Rx Ligustici Wallichi
  30 Grams Rx Angelica Sinensis
  30 Grams Cx Acanthopanacis Radicis
  30 Grams Rx Dipsaci
  30 Grams Rh Gastrodiae
  30 Grams F Carthami
  30 Grams Rx Archyranthis Bidentatae
  30 Grams Rh Litseae
  60 Grams Rh Polygonati
  90 Grams F Chaenomelis
  120 Grams Rm Mori
  1,000 Grams Saccharum Granorum
  10,000 Grams Rice Wine

- **Tzepao Sanpien Extract:** Tzepao Sanpien Extract (Priceless Treasures Three Whip Extract) is a patented tonic used to tonify the Qi and blood. It is especially useful in tonifying Yin Qi. It also helps to strengthen the kidneys and lung Qi, as well as tonify the body's Wei (protective) Qi. Similar to the other aforementioned tonic herbs listed, it can also be taken during long periods of time, and it is excellent in countering fatigue.

  Tzepao Sanpien Extract comes in small vials. One or two vials should be taken daily with water.

- **Shou Wu Chih:** Shou Wu Chih is an alcohol based patented tonic herb which is used to "regulate" the Qi and blood, as well as strengthen the kidney and liver functions.

  Since the liver is responsible for supplying nutrition to the tendons and ligaments and the kidneys are responsible for bone formation, Shou Wu Chih strengthens the tendons, ligaments, and bones. It also calms the nervous system and is used to increase sperm in men.

  Taken two to three times per day in a cup of warm or hot water (the warm water helps elevate the metabolic rate of the body). Shou Wu Qih will also increase the body's blood and vitality. It is especially good to take before bed as it helps deepen the sleep.

EXTERNAL WINES

In Herbal Traumatology, one of the most popular alcohol based herbal wine formula used in the treatment of internal hemorrhage, inflammation, sprains, dislocations, swelling, and blood clotting is commonly referred to as Tieh Da Yao. Tien Da Yao literally means "bruise hit medicine," and its powerful ingredients are combined in order to activating move the body's blood circulation, relax the muscles and sinews, and disperse Qi and Blood stagnation.

Application

Tien Da Yao is applied externally, directly on the injured area, immediately upon bruising. While massage the hit wine into the tissues, the movement of the hands should always flow toward the direction of the heart.

For the treatment of a hemorrhage, inflammation, swelling, or infection ulceration, rinse the injured area of the body first with cool boiled water to remove any form of dirt. Then dry the injured area, and apply the Tieh Da Yao with a cotton ball three to four times daily. You can also soak several cotton balls with Tieh Da Yao and set the cotton balls on the area to be treated. Next, wrap the area with Saran Wrap (used to hold the cotton balls in place). Then, place a heat lamp or hot water bottle onto the injured tissue area.

For sprains of tendons and ligaments, and for internal injuries resulting in aching, swelling, blood-clotting, and joint stiffening, apply Tieh Ta Yao directly to the affected area and gently massage the tissues along the tendons and ligaments. Next, soak several cotton balls with Tieh Da Yao and set the cotton balls on the area to be treated. Wrap the area with Saran Wrap (used to hold the cotton balls in place). Then, place a heat lamp or hot water bottle onto the injured tissue area.

- **Tieh Da Yao Jin (Bruise Hit Medicine Wine):** Place the following herbs (i.e., from one of the following five formulas listed below) in a large nonmetallic cooking pot and fill the pot with a fifth of rice wine, vodka, or whisky. Next, place the pot on a low fire and simmer the herbs for about 3.5 hours. Remove the herbs from the heat and pour the entire contents into a one gallon glass container along with three quarters of a gallon of rice wine, vodka, or whisky. Seal the jar airtight and bury it in a hole two feet deep for at least two months. After digging up the Tieh Da Yao Jin, store it in a dark place away from the sun. If you do not remove the herbs from the liquid the hit wine will keep indefinitely, and it will become more potent each year.

Contraindication: Tieh Da Yao is for external use only. Never apply the hit medicine to an area where there is surface bleeding.

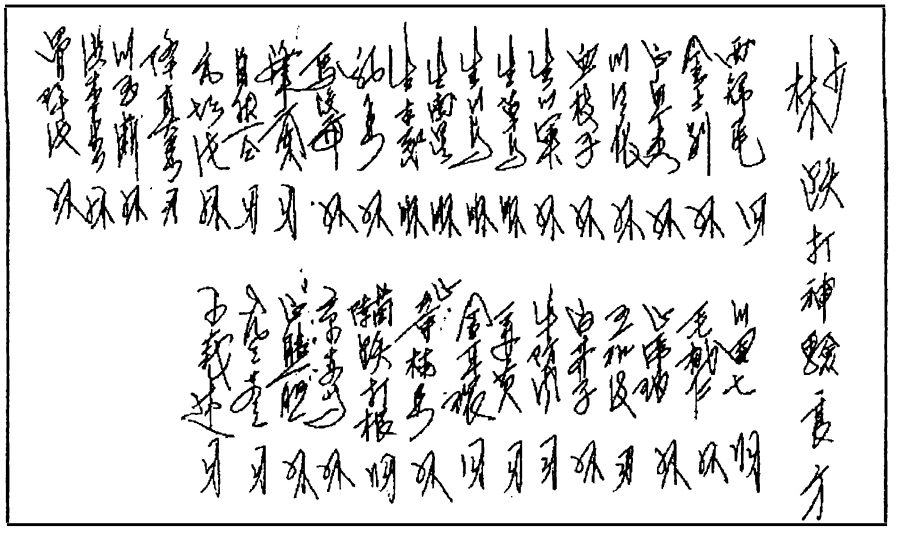
Tieh Da Yao Formula A

3% Frankincense
3% Peachwood
4% Jack Been
5% Valerian
5% Tan Shen
5% Chang Bark
5% Pai-Niu Tan
5% Tang-Kuei
5% Mo-Yao
10% Hu-Chang
10% Arnica
10% Jen-Shen
10% Tien Qi Root
10% Chuan-Shan-Qia

Tieh Da Yao Formula B

.06 oz. Flos Caryophylli
.06 oz. Manis Tetrdactyla Radice
.06 oz. Rhizoma Sparganii
.06 oz. Duchesnea Indica Opisthoplatiae
.06 oz. Lignum Aquilariae
.06 oz. Ramulus Cinnamoni Zedoariae Cassiae
.06 oz. Radix Clemetidis
.06 oz. Gledista Officinialis
.06 oz. Flos Carthami Tinctorii
.11 oz. Fructus Foeniculi Vulgarii
.11 oz. Sulphur
.11 oz. Myrrh
.11 oz. Herba Asari cum
.11 oz. Eupolyphagae seu
.11 oz. Mastix
.11 oz. Anemone Altaica Fischer
.11 oz. Rhizoma Rhei
.22 oz. Aconite
.22 oz. Semen Plantaginis
.22 oz. Herba Lycopi Lucidi
.22 oz. Cortex Eucommiae Qinensis Ulmoidis
.22 oz. Flos Inula
.33 oz. Perilla Semen
.44 oz. Rhizoma Curcumae
.44 oz. Buthus Martensi
10 each - Semen Strychnotis
7 each - Hibiscus Syriacus

TIEH DA YAO
FORMULA C



TIEH DA YAO
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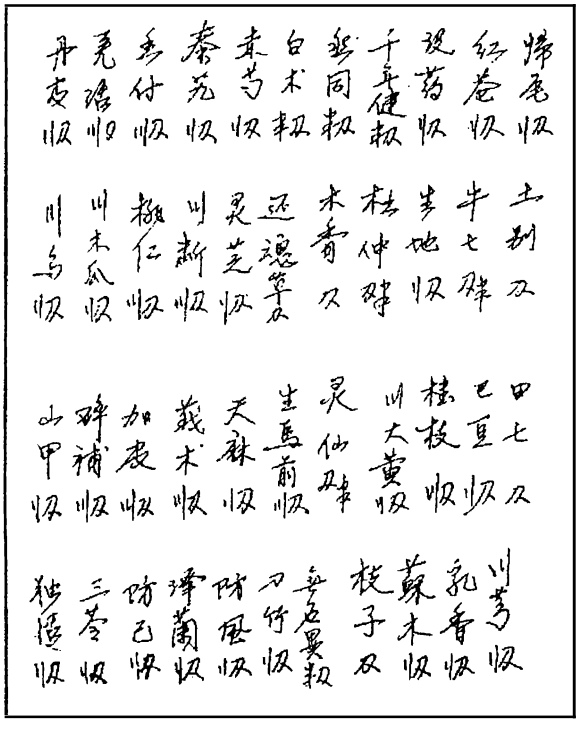

TIEH DA YAO
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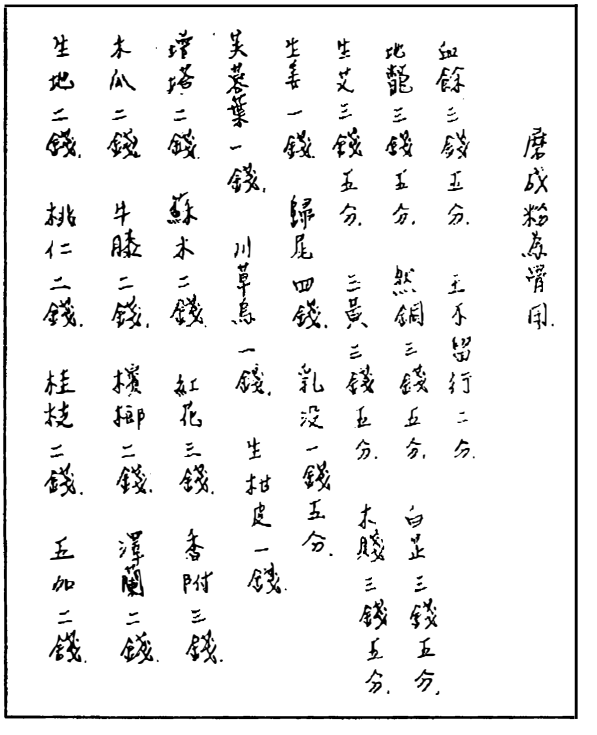


Energizing and Programming Herbs

Introduction to Energizing Plant Formula

In the early 1970s I began interning as an acupuncturist and herbalist in a small clinic in Monterey, California. Both of my teachers were master healers - doctors of Chinese medicine who took an interest in me because of my previous Northern Shaolin Gongfu training. In my youth, I spent many years learning herbal healing, traumatology, bone setting, Chinese massage, and Needle Insertion from my Gongfu master.

Under the careful eyes of my two new instructors, I was now to be instructed in Chinese clinical medicine. Dr. Yao, who once sat on the board of medical examiners for the People's Republic of China, introduced me to Chinese patent medicine formulas. Dr. Hugh, a shaman monk from a monastery in Northern Korea, instructed in all five branches of Acupuncture Therapy (needling, cupping, bloodletting, moxa, and magnetic therapy), Medical Qigong Therapy (distance Qi emission, self-regulation prescriptions, Qigong massage, and healing sound therapy), and Herbal Therapy (nutritional education, and the construction of herbal teas and soups, tinctures and wines, oils, balms and liniments, and compresses, powders and pills).

Each morning we would spend an hour in meditation before opening the clinic to the public. Besides treating patients with moxa, separating and cleaning the needles, and running the autoclave, my first year was spent primarily watching Dr. Hugh insert needles. After he inserted the needles, Dr. Hugh gave me the task of performing Qi emission therapy on the patients through the inserted needles, removing the needles, teaching the patients Qigong homework prescriptions, pulling the herbal prescriptions, energizing the herbs, and then teaching the patients how to prepare the herbal prescriptions.

After the morning meditation, I was given a different herb to chew. I was instructed to taste the herb, feel my body, and locate the specific channels and internal organs that this herb effected. Both doctors believed that by allowing time to fully taste and experience the energetic quality of the herb, the medicinal quality of the plant was revealed.

In order to taste the herb, I was instructed to first place a small piece on the tip of my tongue, then chew it for two to three minutes. I was told that all herbs have primary and secondary actions. The taste experienced on the tip of the tongue indicates the herb's primary action, while the taste experienced on the back of the tongue indicates its secondary action. Some of the various tastes and textures are described as follows:

- **Sour Taste:** The taste of sore is an indication of acids (i.e., citric acid or oxalic acid) and tannins. These herbs have an astringent quality to their nature (causing tissues to tighten) and can be used to dry up excess liquid. They can be effective in reducing swelling, protecting inflamed tissue, and increasing stomach acid in order to cause an alkalizing response to the body's metabolism.
- **Bitter Taste:** The taste of bitter is sometimes an indication of some type of Tonic. These herbs bring Qi and Blood to an area, exciting the cells to expand and contract, as well as bring tone to the tissues.
- **Sweet Taste:** The taste of sweet is an indication of carbohydrates, which have the function of storing and transporting Qi. These herbs affect the pancreas and spleen, contribute to fertilization, blood coagulation, and tissue development. They are important in influencing the smooth operation of the immune system.

  On a side note, Saponin-containing plants are also considered sweet, however, they actually have a soapy quality to their taste, and their primary medicinal effect is as an expectorant (i.e., bringing up excess mucous).
- **Pungent Taste:** The taste of pungent (or spicy) is an indication that the herb has stimulating and warming properties. These herbs usually have an effect on the circulatory system. The strong taste also indicates a high content of volatile oils, which reveals highly medicinal properties such as antiseptic, antiinflammatory, expectorant, and carminative (antispasmodic and gas relieving in the digestive tract) qualities.
- **Salty Taste:** The taste of salty is an indication that there are minerals contained within the plant, which give it its nutritive quality. For example,

the high iron content makes your teeth feel funny, while the taste of chalk indicates calcium.

- **Mucilage Texture:** This type of herb feels very smooth, with a slippery, oily consistency to its texture. Generally, these types of herbs have soothing qualities to their nature, which protect and heal any type of mucosal lining tissue. Because of their sticky texture, they can also be used to absorb toxins and waste material and carry them outside of the body.
- **Numbing Texture:** This type of herb causes your mouth to go numb while chewing, which usually indicates some type of antibacterial or antiseptic healing property to its nature.
- **Drying Texture:** This type of herb causes your mouth to go dry while chewing, which usually indicates some type of astringent quality to its nature.

Later during the day (usually at lunch), the doctors and I would discuss the healing properties and contraindications of the new herb. Although each doctor had a different perspective as to herbal formulas and treatments (one doctor specialized in patented herbal medicines and the other specialized in free-standing herbal formulas), they both agreed on the essential importance of energizing and programming the herbs before giving them to the patient.

Having taught at several T.C.M. Universities, both in the People's Republic of China and the Unites States, I have noted that this essential practice of energizing and programming herbs is not included in the herbal training given to the new generations of acupuncturists. Therefore, I would like to take the time to reintroduce this ancient practice to future healers.

ENERGY AND THE PLANT REALM

Ancient Daoists understood nature as being composed of different realms, each with its own characteristic patterns of Jing, Qi, and Shen. These interconnecting and interdependent realms (the Mineral Realm, the Plant Realm, the Animal Realm, the Human Realm, and the Heavenly Realm) were all understood to be part of the energy and divine consciousness that originally created them. The energy (Qi) and form (Xing) that manifested as matter (Wuzhi) were regarded as an extension of the consciousness (Ling Shen) that originally patterned their energetic function and purpose (Dao).

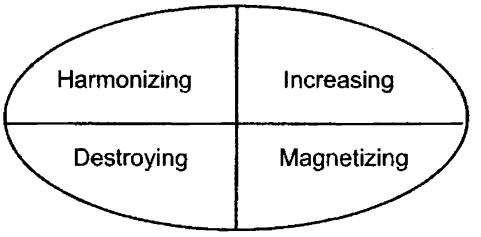


Figure 1.330. Four examples of energetic imprinting

Every material form has its own vibratory pattern that serves as a unique blueprint for manifesting energy into the physical realm. In Daoist herbology, to alter or increase an herb's specific energetic function, it was necessary for a priest to first understand the herb's original energetic nature. This understanding allowed the priest to more easily imprint a specific intention onto the herb's original vibrational pattern, thereby strengthening and refining the herb's original energetic function. When properly performed, this magical process caused the imprinted herb to quickly and powerfully influence the energetic matrix of the patient's tissues.

Before energizing and programing any herbal power, pill, tincture, or elixir, the ancient Daoist priest needed to first determined a specific function and purpose for the herbal formula (i.e., healing, blessing, defense, etc.). Some common examples of magical abilities imprinted into herbs during the energizing state include Increasing, Magnetizing, Harmonizing, or Destroying energetic states (Figure 1.330).

It is important that the priest understand the exact reason for which the energetic formula was created and its specific function; keeping this purpose in mind throughout the process of energizing the herbs as a basis for strengthening and refining the effects of the herb or formula. This helped the priest to choose which herbs to blend together (i.e. certain herbs naturally cause the body's energy to rise, fall, expand, contract, heat, cool, etc.). Then, when the herbs are boiled in water, the water acts as a condenser and retains the herbs' energetic influence. As the individual drinks this energized liquid, his or her tissues respond accordingly.

Energetically Imprinting Herbs

In order to integrate the herb or formula with the desired intention, ancient Daoist priests would utilize the principles of Creating (Chuangzao), Feeling (Ganjue), Imprinting (Mingli), and Activating (Shi Huodong). These four primary magical properties used for energetic imprinting are described as follows (Figure 1.331):

- **Create (Chuangzao) - Forming the Energetic Blueprint:** The word "Chuangzao" translates as "to create," and it describes the Creative property of Qi. Chuangzao refers to the production of the energetic form, as well as to the forces and energy associated with it. This creative property of energy makes life itself and the phenomena of materialization and dematerialization possible. Within the physical body, the creative property of Qi is responsible for the construction, maintenance, and reconfiguration of molecules, cells, tissues, and organs. When materializing Qi, the creative property (Chuangzao) is used to construct the shape, size, and texture (color, sound, solid, liquid, vapor, or light) of the energetic object.
- **Feel (Ganjue) - The Sensate Property of Qi:** The word "Ganjue" translates as "to feel or sense," and it describes the aspect of feeling and experiencing the created item's energetic quality. Ganjue is considered the manifestation of the "sensory" aspect or property of the Created Qi, referring to the tangible feeling of the energetic form or substance and to the specific forces and energies associated with it (hot, cold, heavy, light, etc.). Within the body, the feeling property of Qi makes it possible for an individual to experience the sensations of physical pleasure or physical pain. Ganjue gives substance and reality to the priest's energetic feelings, sentiments, and sense experiences. When materializing energy, the feeling property of Qi allows the priest to fully experience the quality of the subtle vibrations resonating within the energetic form that he or she has created. These qualities most often manifest through the Eight Energetic Touches (hot, cold, heavy, light, expanded, contracted, vibrating, and spiralling).

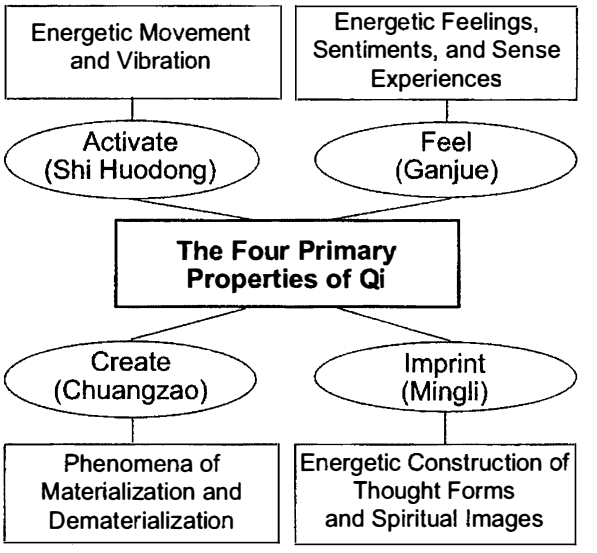


Figure 1.331. The Four Primary Properties of Qi

Mastering the feeling aspect of Qi allows the Daoist priest to energetically dissolve into the Wuji and experience every dimension of existence. For example, the priest can easily feel the ebb and flow of the subtle energetic fields that permeate an individual's physical body by dissolving into the spiritual matrix that exists in-between the individual's energetic particles and cells.

- **Imprint (Mingli) - Tasking the Energetic Form:** The word "Mingli" translates as "Imprint," and it describes the energetic aspect of imprinting and spiritually "inscribing" the priest's intention into the energetic form. Mingli allows the energetic form to retain specific instructions and perform required tasks. This process of imprinting and tasking makes the energetic construction of all thought forms and spiritual images possible and is used after the priest has adequately shaped an energetic form through the utilization of the Creative (Chuangzao) and Feeling (Ganjue) properties of Qi. Imprinting and tasking can be considered as a type of encoding of the energetic form, and it includes all energetic and spiritual forces associated with the thoughts, emotions, and intentions (i.e., strengthening, weakening, balancing, protecting, destroying,

isolating, healing, etc.) that have impregnated the created object. When observing images, Mingli allows an individual to comprehend and remember an object's physical, energetic, and spiritual qualities (shape, size, color, etc.).

Within the body, the Imprinting property of Qi enables the cells and tissues of the body to align themselves within a consistent and coherent energetic structure, energizing and organizing every aspect of an individual around a single theme.

- **Activate (Shi Huodong) - Awakening the Vibrational Property of Qi:** The term "Shi Huodong" translates as "to activate," and it describes the activity of formally "initiating" the energetic and spiritual functions of the created object. The activating quality of Qi makes unified energetic movement and multi-dimensional vibration possible. Shi Huodong is sometimes considered the awakening of the vibrational motion contained within an energetic form as well as the specific powers (or forces of energy) associated with the object, it's movement, or the awakened qualities of the object.

  The Activation of Qi is used as the means for transporting the priest's intentions. Within the body, the Activating property of Qi is responsible for all conscious activities (walking, physical coordinations, and eye movements) and unconscious actions (the energetic functions of the circulatory system, respiratory system, vascular system, nervous system digestive system, etc.).

CREATING, FEELING, IMPRINTING, AND ACTIVATING QI MEDITATION

The priest can master the above Four Primary Properties of Qi by practicing Shengong exercises that layer powerful interconnected images into the energetic and spiritual matrix of an object. Combining and integrating various powerful images is an advanced technique that is applied in all traditional schools of magic. When creating an "Energy Ball," for example, the priest would utilize all Four Primary Properties of Qi, described as follows (Figure 1.332):

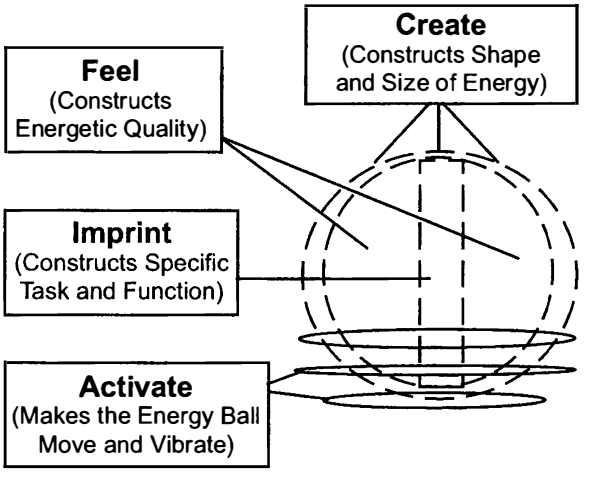


Figure 1.332. The Four Primary Properties of Qi Used to Create an Energy Ball

- **Create (Chuangzao):** The Creative property of Qi is used to construct the shape and size of the energy ball.
- **Feel (Ganjue):** The Feeling property of Qi allows the priest to feel and acknowledge the energetic quality contained within the energy ball, (hot, cold, heavy, light, vibrating, spiralling, etc.).
- **Imprint (Mingli):** The Imprinting property of Qi enables the priest the ability to impregnate the energy ball with a specific task or function (Tonifying, Purging, Regulating, protecting, destroying, isolating, healing, etc.).
- **Activate (Shi Huodong):** The Activating property of Qi awakens the energy ball's vibrational movement, giving it life.

A meditation used to refine and master these Four Primary Properties of Qi is described as follows:

1. **Create:** The priest begins from a seated posture. While closing his or her eyes, the priest will perform the "One Through Ten" and "Three Invocations." After completing the third invocation, the priest imagines pulling an energetic cord into his or her right palm (directly from the Heavens). Next, the priest feels the divine energetic cord mold into a powerful luminous ball. Then the priest imagines this

luminous ball of white light energy molding into the size of a tennis ball, fitting easily into the priest's right hand. These types of imagery exercises are utilized to cultivate the Creative property of Qi.

2. **Feel:** Next, the priest feels the weight of luminous ball of white light energy as it rolls around within the palm of his or her hand. The priest imagines and feels that the energy ball is alive, electrical, hot, and vibrating. The priest should also feel the weight of the energy ball rolling around in his or her palm like a sphere of liquid mercury. This trains the priest in mastering the Feeling property of Qi.
3. **Imprint:** After creating this complex layered energy ball, the priest can imprint it with specific tasks, directing it to perform specific energetic functions (dispersing stagnation, gathering Toxic Qi, rebuilding a diseased internal organ, etc.). The exact function imprinted into the energy ball depends on whether the energy ball is going be inserted into a specific internal organ inside an individual's body, used for long distance healing or cursing, or used as a part of some other magical ritual. Ultimately, the strength and power of the energy ball is due to the intensity, detail, and clarity of the priest's concentration. This type of creative imagery exercises the Imprinting property of Qi.

   When utilizing this energetic modality for healing, it is important to realize that when divine light used to construct the energy ball, it automatically fills the orb with preprogrammed healing light; this is considered the "Imprinting of the Divine's Creative property of Qi." This dynamic transformation initiated by the Divine Imprinting is a powerful tool in altering the preexisting energetic patterns of the disease and changing the patient's energetic fields.
4. **Activate:** Once the energy ball has been Created, its energetic power has been realized and felt, and its energetic form Imprinted with a specific "task," all that is left is to Activate its energetic function and give it life by giving it the mental command to begin. When the energy of the herb or herbal formula is Activated, its energy is then available to the priest for use. If the priest is using the energy ball for healing, at this point he or she releases the energy ball into the herbal formula and seals it there. Once the patient ingests or applies the herbs, the priest's intention is carried into the patient's tissues by virtue of the Activating property of Qi. If, for example, the energy of an herb or herbal formula is created for the purpose of dissolving a tumor, when the energy imprinted within the herb is ingested into the patient's body, the reaction within the tissues (the tumor breaking down and dispersing) is considered the manifestation of the Activating property of Qi.

Defining An Herbs Energetic Purpose

When utilizing the Four Functional Properties of Energy, the priest most consider the purpose of the energized material. As previously explained, it is important that the priest understand the exact reason for which the energetic object was created and its specific function; keeping these ideas in mind as a basis for maintaining and refining its energetic manifestation.

In Daoist Herbal Magic, the priest must gather, raise (i.e., increase), and release powerful forms of natural and supernatural energy. Normally, when the energy of an herb or herbal formula is Activated, this energy is then released or projected into an individual's tissues using the Activating property of Qi. If, for example, the energy of an herb or herbal formula is created for the purpose of dissolving a tumor, when the energy imprinted within the herb is ingested into the patient's body, the reaction within the tissues is considered the manifestation of the Activating property of Qi.

When the herbs are boiled in water, the water acts as a condenser and retains the herbs energetic influence. Then, when an individual drinks this energized liquid, his or her tissues respond accordingly.

Many herbal formula become ineffective because the priest was not concentrating on the specific purpose of the energetic Imprinting at the time of the magical ceremony. This lack of concentration resulted in the priest's Qi and Shen not being transferred into the herbs at the time of the imprinting.

PLANT SPIRITS

Nature Spirits, in the form of Plant Spirits, can adapt to a wide variety of shapes and images. They have a tendency to choose shapes and images we can readily identify with, often human-like shapes and faces, frequently simple in structure and form (Figure 1.333). Plant Spirits also know all about the natural laws of physical, emotional, and spiritual healing, as well as the various effects of Five Element transformations (since they exist and survive within the energetic realm of the five seasonal changes).

When a Daoist priest enters into the realm of "Higher Magic," one of the first type of spirit entities he is first taught to contact (outside his personal Celestial Guardian/General, Instructor/Guide, and Spirit Servant) is a spirit of the Plant Kingdom. According to magic tradition, each kingdom of spirit entities outside the celestial realm has its own unique set of problems and advantages.

Starting from the easiest to contact, to the most difficult to control are the following list of spirit entities:

- Spirits of the Plant Realm
- Spirits of the Animal Realm
- Spirits of the Human Realm
- Spirits of the Elemental Realm
- Spirits of the Angelic/Demonic Realm

Utilizing the healing energy of a Plant Spirit to treat a patient is unlike the clinical approach of treating a patient with modern herbalism (which uses the chemical properties of a plant to heal the physical body). Without needles or physical pressure the Plant Spirit can bestow its spiritual powers and allow its "true essence" to be ingested by the patient, initiating dramatic results.

In ancient times, the shamans and mystics used entheogens (psychoactive hallucinogens) combined with song (chanting), drumming, and dance in order to help them enter into altered "trance" states of awareness. They believed that through performing these transforming rituals, they could communicate directly with the spirit world.

Until a just a few generations ago, many practitioners of spiritual medicine gained most of their knowledge about the healing qualities of plants in visions or dreams through personal and mentored questing. They understood that the various properties of a plant are helpful in assisting the healing process; however, they also learned through direct communication with the plants that the main healing factor is not derived from its physical structure (its roots, stems, branches, leaves, flowers, fruit, and seeds), but from the spirit or sacred properties of the plant.

Figure 1.333. Plant Immortal

To learn this ancient Chinese healing method is a journey of spiritual self discovery that demands dedication, patience, and reverence. Sadly, this ancient shamanic healing method has faded into obscurity. Most of those who heal with plants

today are educated herbalists or botanists who have developed wonderful memorization skills but lack the ability to have a direct personal visionary communication relationship with the spirit of plants. Fortunately in recent decades, regardless of ancestry, there is a revival of this ancient way of healing with plant spirits.

Plants are more similar to people than they are different. They have physical cells, connective tissues that construct their body, energetic internal and external sensory patterns indicative of a mind, as well as a spirit. Therefore when gathering magical herbs, the ancient Daoists believed that the wild plants living within remote areas such as mountains contained a full and vibrant spirit (plants growing in rural areas or gardens were considered to have far less energetic connection with their own plant spirit). The plants living within the remote areas of the mountains were considered to be wise, and the ancient Daoists believed that when properly cultivated, the spiritual nature of these wise plants could teach the mystic the hidden secrets of nature. In Daoist magic, there is an ancient belief that a plant will give the priest the magical essence of its spirit to be used as medicine if the mystic knows how to properly ask.

Chinese Historical Encounters With Plant Spirits

According to Daoist teachings of the Song Dynasty (906 -1279 A.D.), living plants and trees have their own unique vibrational expressions of Jing, Qi, and Shen, and they live, grow, and die like humans. The Shen substance is infused into plants by the cosmos as an extension of its Yang Soul, which bestows onto the herbs, plants, and trees a certain amount of "Ling" (spiritual or magical) power. Plant spirits, trees, shrubs, and herbs all contain soul substance. According to the ancient Chinese, there are two categories of plant spirits: Anthropomorphic Plant Spirits and Amorphous Plant Spirits. Each category has a powerful influence on mankind, described as follows (Figure 1.334):

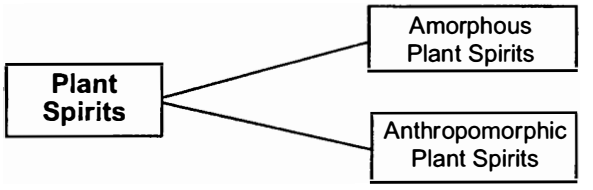


Figure 1.334. According to the ancient Chinese, there are two categories of plant-soul substances: Anthropomorphic and Amorphous Plant Spirits

- **Amorphous Plant Spirits:** These consist of plants that contain an amorphous Shen substance and can possess a health giving power for humans. These beneficial plant spirits can either cure a person of physical and mental anguish and disease, or prolong life and (in rare cases) even allow an individual to live as an immortal.

  The focus of studying this category of plant spirit is centered on understanding each plant's Shen substance, which has been infused into the herb, plant, or tree by the Yang energetic and spiritual light of the cosmos. The study of the Amorphous Plant Spirits constitutes the investigation of the life or Jing of the plant, in addition to the energetic content of the plant's Ling or spiritual power. The ancient Chinese believed that if the plant's Ling was strong enough, it could invigorate the consumer's vital Qi and Shen and considerably or indefinitely prolong his or her life. The belief that plants possessed such powerful Jing, Qi, Shen, or Ling qualities contributed to the clinical foundation and formation of herbal medicine, whereby a patient could have health restored by consuming and interacting with the soul substances of the plant. Therefore, by ingesting extra doses of the universal Shen contained within the Plant Kingdom, the individual could indefinitely invigorate his or her own Shen.
- **Anthropomorphic Plant Spirits:** These consist of plants that are possessed of spirits in human or animal form. The Anthropomorphic Plant Spirits are generally protective

guardians of a plant group or species, and if approached with proper respect, they can be very useful to the individual seeking botanical understanding. However, when disrespected, these plant spirits can also be malicious, and in some cases they may even create physical and mental anguish or disease. Similar to fox spirits, demonic plant spirits were sometimes known to bewilder their victims, making them become mad or ill, as well as sometimes physically abducting them or abducting their souls.

The identification of plant spirits with humans or animals appears in one of the oldest records, finding its way into the archives of the *Standard Histories* of China. Within this ancient text are recorded cases of trees and plants speaking, chanting, or humming - all with human voices. The ancient Chinese believed that a plant could receive the indwelling of a human spirit, especially if the plant or tree came in close contact with the corpse. This energetic and spiritual transformation could occur especially if the individual had cultivated a powerful Shen before his or her death.

Additionally, ancient trees that grow in the mountains were believed to possess the ability to speak. The Jing of such trees were commonly known as "Cloud Yang," and were believed to contain the Yang of Heaven's Shen.

The most common destructive type of Anthropomorphic Plant Spirit was known as a "Tree Devil," and was responsible for more serious types of mischief. Believed to be the dwelling place or the house of a demon, this type of tree was considered very dangerous to disturb or attack, as one could incur the unbridled wrath of the indwelling spirit.

If, while in human form, the tree spirit is wounded, the wound would show on the corresponding part of the tree. Once the tree was chopped down, the ancient Chinese believed that the tree demon could appear as various types of monsters (generally huge snakes), often in gigantic black forms.

COMMUNICATING WITH PLANT SPIRITS

The users of plant spirit medicine often tell many amazing stories, recounting vivid experiences of magical journeys into the Plant Kingdom. Energetically enveloping plants that live within the mountains and forests can facilitate such experiences, and thereby introduce the mystic to the powerful magic contained within the local environment.

To communicate with a plant spirit, you must first change your level of consciousness. The conscious mind cannot generally enter into the spiritual realm and talk to plant spirits. However, if through deep meditation we enter into the altered state of consciousness known as the waking dream state, we can access the subtle subconscious interactions of the spiritual realm and then interact with plant spirits.

Although the plant spirits are real, they simply do not inhabit the same vibrational level of interaction as does our conscious mind. While in the dream state, however, we can interact with things that we could not normally access while in the normal waking state of consciousness. Therefore, you must first enter the dream state (while still awake) to purposefully contact the plant spirit.

Traditionally, shamans, mystics, and priests will access the waking dream state through one of the following three ways:

- **Through Deep Meditation:** By purposefully relaxing the conscious mind or engaging in self disciplined Shengong training, the priest can enter into an active dream state, known as "lucid dreaming." While in this state, he is able to commune with the spirit world.
- **Through Sound Meditation:** In some traditions, the use of sound (i.e., drumming, chanting, singing, etc.) is used in order to sedate the conscious mind and allow the Daoist priest to journey into the spiritual realm.
- **Through Ingesting Psychoactive Plants:** By eating or drinking specific powders, pastes, teas, or elixirs derived from psychoactive plants or mushrooms, the priest sedates his conscious mind and journeys into the spiritual realm.

All three methods work. However, the third method is commonly misused in our culture, and since it does not require any level of maturity or master, this method can easily cause one to get lost and fall off the path. Generally, priests will spend some time purifying themselves before forcefully splitting open the veil that separates the physical world from the spiritual realm. I have seen several people uneducated in the cause and effect of spiritual manifestations and magical invocations pursue this method (i.e., ingesting psychoactive plants or mushrooms). Most of the time, the outcome has unfavorable. They generally end up with dark shadows that have returned with their spirit and have attached themselves to the individual's second Wei Qi field. These spirit entities are currently existing as energetic vampires, ingesting the individual's life-force energy (a form of spirit oppression) and are in the process of working their way into the individual's body (eventual possession) through means of covert manipulation.

Establishing A Relationship

The process of communicating with plant spirits focuses on three main points: establishing a physical, energetic, and spiritual relationship. In Daoist Magic, this is actively pursued by a priest only after purging his body, energy, and spirit of toxic energy, and then quieting his mind. Only then could a priest begin to establish a relationship with a plant spirit. This was accomplished by following the following three important steps:

- **Physical Relationship:** It is important to first develop a physical or sensory relationship with the plant. The Plant Spirit usually resides in the strongest, largest, or healthiest plant in a group. It generally radiates and feeds the other plants that it is overseeing.

  When first sitting in nature, scan the forest and try to get a sense of who is energetically watching you. Shift your focus from being an observer to being observed. See who is energetically attracted to you. You will notice a plant that seems brighter, more vibrant and alive than the rest of the forest.

  When first visiting the plant, look at it, contemplate it, touch it, smell it, and "taste" it (do not actually eat the plant; here "tasting" entails allowing the body's senses to inhale the plant's "aroma").

  Observe the plants surroundings. What is the specific habitat that the plant has chosen to live within and flourish. Has it chosen to live within the powerful rays of the Sun. In this case, its Yang solar energy will be active, warming, stimulating and drying. Or, has the plant chosen to grow within the shade. In this case, its Yin energy will be calming, cooling, and moist. Then, observe and experience all of its various colors, flowers, branches, stems, roots, veins, etc. in order to get a better understanding of its energetic nature.

  When touching the plant, does it feel dry, with not much liquid? If so, maybe it has astringent qualities that can be used to dry excess liquid. Does the plant feel juicy? If so, maybe it has the ability to promote fluid production.

  When smelling the plant, does its aroma taste sweet or does it have a strong odor? A strong odor indicates the presence of volatile oils, which further indicate that this plant has medicinal properties.
- **Energetic Relationship:** Next, develop an energetic relationship with the plant. Each plant has a different frequency to which we can attune. In order to commune with the plant's Qi, energetically envelop the plant and "fall" into the infinite space (Wuji) contained within its external tissue structure. This will allow your Yuen Shen (Original Spirit) to commune with the plant's Yuan Shen.
- **Spiritual Relationship:** Finally, develop a spiritual relationship with the plant by clearly and gently expressing yourself and your intention. In certain traditions, it is customary to first offer a gift to the Plant Spirit before beginning the ritual of communion. Patiently wait until you receive a response from the Plant Spirit. In most cases, you may then begin to communicate freely with the plant. For example, in certain magical traditions, the priest will ask the question, "Do you have special medicines that I can share with my patients?" Remember that true healing comes does not

come from specific medicinal minerals, plants, techniques, etc. It comes from a divine source - the same source that maintains the physical, energetic, and spiritual structures of the world. The purpose and objective of following specific healing protocols and techniques is tfor a Divine healing to occur. To truly heal somebody is to bring them back to the original magical state of what they energetically and spiritually are.

When first studying Chinese herbal medicine, back in 1973, one of my teachers Doctor Yao informed me that to become a great herbalist I needed to study the plants that were indigenous to my current environment. He stated, "Diseases in the mountains are different from diseases by the ocean or desert. Plants that grow in the mountains are different from plants that grow by the ocean or in the desert."

It was his belief that the only plants that can energetically bring the patient the most potent healing effects were local plants, those that were indigenous to the patient's current environment. As mentioned earlier, the specific energies and minerals within the soil feed and energetically construct the plant's structural habitat. Plants from China or the Amazon do not normally live in Northern America. Therefore medicines derived from such plants may be less effective than those that are indigenous to the area and are under the effects of their guardian spirit plants.

TRADITIONAL PLANT HARVESTING

To effectively gather herbal medicine, the priest must have an extensive knowledge of the energetic changes within the surrounding environment (season, place, time, etc.), as well as the specific energetic quality of the roots, bark, leaves, flowers, fruits, etc. The priest must also possess the harvesting skill required for gathering the herb. For example, a plant's energy and essence generally descends into its roots during the Autumn and Winter, making this the best time to gather most root medicines. Similarly, leaves are generally harvested in the Spring, while flowers and fruits are gathered just prior to the peak of their maturity. Modern botanical science supports the validity of these practices by demonstrating an increase or decrease in the various "active"

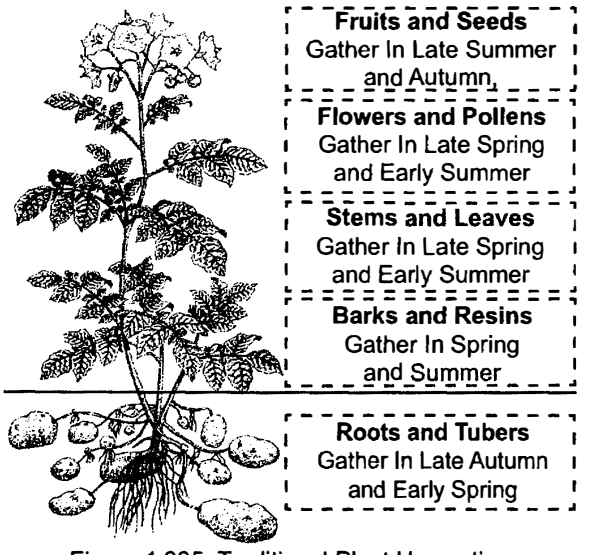


Figure 1.335. Traditional Plant Harvesting

chemical constituents of a plant according to the climate, soil, and season.

Once the herbs have been gathered, the priest must then begin the procedure of processing them. The process work is especially important, as some herbs are poisonous and need to be detoxified, while others can have their properties enhanced through the extracting process.

When I was interning as an Acupuncturist and Herbalist in the early 1970's, one of my clinical teachers was a Daoist Priest, who was adamant about teaching me the "proper way" of magical herb wild-crafting. He explained that the secret knowledge of the ebb and flow of environmental energy was essential for proper herb harvesting. He also stated that "a Healer of the Dao must not only be good at reading the energy of the land (i.e., a master of "Feng Shui"), but he must also understand Chinese Astrology, Astronomy, Yijing Divination, and comprehend how the various stars affect the ever changing Environmental Qi. Only then, could he understand the ever changing energies of the human body, brought about by the various seasons, and effectively harvest magical herbs.

The following is a brief overview of my detailed conversations with my herb teacher, combined with frequent "field-trips" into the magical realm of Daoist Wild-crafting (Figure 1.335):

- **Roots and Tubers:** In Late Autumn and Early Spring, much of the Qi of the plant descends underground into its Roots and Tubers. Therefore, "Smell the Scent" and "Feel the Energy" of the Roots and Tubers resonating underneath the Earth first, make sure they are strong, then gather the Roots and Tubers.
- **Stems and Leaves:** In Late Spring and Early Summer, much of the Qi of the plant is flourishing, and the energy enters into its Stems and Leaves. Therefore, "Smell the Scent," "See the Colors," and "Feel the Energy" of the external body of the plant first; make sure they are strong, then gather the Stems and Leaves.
- **Flowers and Pollen:** In Late Spring and Early Summer, the Qi of the plant is blossoming, and the energy enters into its external Flowers. Therefore, "Smell, See, and Feel the Energy" of the flowers first; make sure they are strong, then gather the Flowers and Pollen.
- **Bark and Resin:** In Spring and Summer, the Yin Qi of the Earth moves upward, splitting Bark from the tree and pushing the Resin outward. Therefore, "Smell the Scent," "See the Colors," and "Feel the Energy" of the Bark and Resin first; make sure they are strong, then gather the Bark and Resin. Place special attention on collecting resin deposits that have formed naturally, especially those caused from a fracture in a tree limb by a storm, lightning, or animals scratching on the bark - these all have special magical properties.
- **Fruits and Seeds:** In Late Summer and Autumn, the plant gives birth, and the Qi of the plant enters into its Fruits. Therefore, "Smell the Scent," "See the Colors," and "Feel the Energy" of the Fruit first; make sure it is strong, then gather the Fruits and Seeds.

Secret Technique for Harvesting the Magical Essence of the Plant's Spirit

One important Plant Magic secret that I have been taught and experienced, is that you don't have to cut and grind the plant's flesh and blood in order to gather its magical essence. All you need is the full cooperation of the plant's guardian spirit. Several of my senior students sell herbal medicines and magical potions collected in this ancient shamanistic manner. The healing powers of these herbal elixirs and potions are truly astonishing.

In order to perform this specialized magical technique, the Daoist priest must first understand that each plant has a ruling planet and plant spirit. Certain plant spirits can be energetically contacted and employed as helpers or assistants to create powerful magical elixirs and potions. Other plant spirits need to be bound and restrained before the priest can use the plant's hidden magical powers.

When harvesting the magical essence of a plant through the assistance of a plant spirit, the priest will proceed as follows:

- The priest will first determine the specific plant, its ruling planet, and what type of guardian spirit is overseeing it.
- Then, the priest will perform a purification, introduction, and announcing of intention ritual.
- Next, the priest will contact the spirit guardian of the plant, present offerings, and then ask it to assist him or her in their desire to create a specific type of magical elixir by placing the plants magical healing powers into a presented glass vial full of quartz crystal-enhanced water.
- The priest will then perform a sealing and containing ritual followed by a thanking and releasing ritual,
- Upon the completion of the ritual, the priest will respectfully leave the wooded area.

RITUAL FOR HARVESTING PLANT ESSENCE

In ancient China, in order to gather (harvest) the energetic properties of a plant's magical powers, it traditionally required a two day process, incorporating special magical rituals that the Daoist priest would strictly follow. This two day process is described as follows:

- **On the First Day:** The priest would begin by visiting the plant, and introducing himself. At this time, the ancient priests would bring specific offerings (i.e., a special type gift that he believed the plant spirit would appreciate). This act of respect was performed to honor the guardian spirit responsible for the health and magical properties of the plant. Some Daoist magical sects taught that this was an act of worshipping the "divine spiritual essence" (the core aspect of "god") contained within the Ling Shen of the plant.
- **On the Second Day:** The priest would return, and after again presenting a special offering, request that the plant's spirit place its magical essence in a glass vial that contains the purified quartz-crystal water (or spring water) that you have brought. Explain why you want it, how it will be used, and ask its permission. It is important that your intention is sincere, yet not groveling. Imagine talking to another priest and asking for a favor. In certain Daoist traditions, if the plant refuses to assist you, you cannot harvest it in this benign manner.

  In other Daoist traditions, magical talismans are used to eliminate any and all obstacles (i.e., paralyze the plant spirit) in harvesting the magical qualities of the plant.
- **The Harvesting:** The true harvesting must be done in a ritual manner, with use of mantras and prayers. I generally teach my disciples to first perform the "One Through Ten Meditation" and the "Three Invocations." Next, after getting permission from the plant spirit, hold up the glass vial that contains the purified quartz-crystal water and begin the energetic fusion ritual, connecting the energetic contents of the water to the spiritual and magical healing components of the plant's spiritual essence. After several minutes have passed, and the appropriate mantras and prayers have been spoken, the transformation is completed. You will know and feel that it is done. At that point, thank the plant spirit, commend it and honor it for its assistance in benefiting humanity in alleviating suffering (by providing physical and energetic healing) or enlightenment (by providing spiritual awakening).

COMPOUNDING THE PLANT ELIXIR

The "internal life elixirs" of the ancient Chinese alchemists were believed to be masterfully composed fluid "condensers" (natural energetic capacitors used for storing powerful forms of energy). Ancient Chinese "elixirs" were considered dynamic regenerative formulas that were prepared in order to influence not only the individual's physical body, but also the energetic and spirit bodies as well.

The ancient composition and uses of herbal Tinctures, Essence Formulas, and Salts and Extracts can be energetically categorized as follows:

- Tinctures stimulate the Spiritual Body
- Essence formulas stimulate the Energetic Body
- Salts and Extracts stimulate the Physical Body

After harvesting the magical herbs, the priest then compounds (blend and mix) his or her mind and spirit with the internal life force of the plant's internal life elixir. According to ancient Mao Shan teachings, compounding a magical elixir restores its internal essence to an energetic state that existed prior to the emergence of time. When all of the magical ingredients are placed inside the crucible, matter reverts back to its original state of essence. This state of magical transformation is the alchemical manifestation of Jing (Essence) becoming Qi (Energy), and then Shen (Spirit), and finally returning back to the Wuji (Infinite Space), toward to the Dao.

According to the ancient Tai Qing (Great Clarity) text *Talisman for Expelling Demons* (Quegui Fu): "When you compound the 'great medicine,' you should always stay in a quiet, remote place in the mountain forests.

- Then, after building the Chamber of Great Medicines, hang four double-edged swords at the four directions (pointing downwards).
- Next, make the Pellet for Expelling Demons, as described as follows:

  "Gather equal parts of
  Cinnabar (Zhusha),
  Realgar (Xionghuang),
  Orpiment (Cihuang),
  Tortoise Shell (Guijia),
  Black Veratrum Root (Lilu),
  Peach Pits (Taoren),
  Aconite Tuber collected in Spring (Wutou),
  Aconite Tuber collected in Autumn (Fuzi),
  large bulb of Pinellia Tuberifera (Da Banxia),
  Poison Ivy (Yege),
  Sulphur (Shi Liuhuang),
  Croton Seed (Badou),
  Fresh Rhinoceros Horn (Sheng Xijiao),
  Umbrella Leaf (Guijiu),
  Musk (Shexiang),
  Spindle Tree Wings (Guijian), and
  Dried Centipedes (Wugong)."

  "Pound these 17 ingredients inside a mortar, and then sieve them. Mix the fine powder together with the juice of Anise Follicles, and make pellets the size of the yoke of a hen's egg."

  "Whenever you decide to make the "Medicines of Immortality," hang one pellet within the four walls of your chamber for protection. If you burn one pellet, a hundred demons will run away. If you burn one more, you will kill them all! Keep this method a secret,as it is extremely effective and powerful!"
- Next, construct the Talisman for Expelling Demons (Figure 1.1336). Affix and hang both inside the Chamber. If you do not do so, when the time comes to compound the 'great medicine,' the power of their magical essence will be inhaled (stolen) by demons.

The following magical talisman is called the "Precious Talisman for Warding Off Evil" (Figure 1.337). This talisman is drawn in green ink on the mortar or cauldron used for making magical potions, elixirs, and Immortal Pills. On a Jia-Zi or Jia-Yin day, the Daoist priest will stand facing the East and begin his purification practice. An identical talisman is also drawn on a eight-inch piece of white silk and suspended over the Western direction.

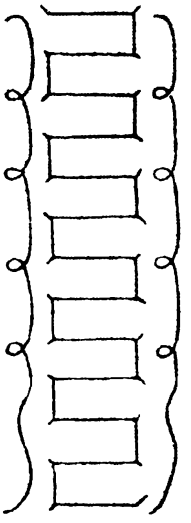


Figure 1.336. The "Talisman for Expelling Demons"

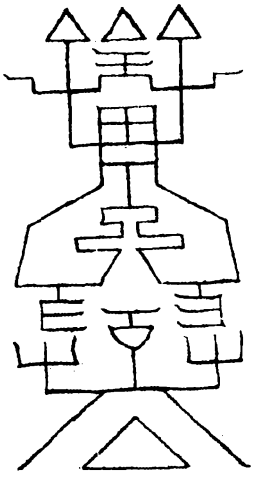


Figure 1.337. The "Precious Talisman For Warding Off Evil"

As magical potions, elixirs, or Immortal Pills are being constructed, after they have been chanted over, energetically charged, and then meditated over the herbal ingredients eventually become a living entity.

At the end of the ritual, the Daoist priest utters a magical invocation to summon the specific powers of celestial deities that will inhabit the herbal potions, elixirs, or Immortal Pills. The ancient Daoists believed that after ingested, the power of a specific deity summoned into the magical potions, elixirs, or Immortal Pills would enter into the body and bring to light the priest's hidden powers.

USING PSYCHOACTIVE PLANTS FOR LOCATING AND CREATING THE IMMORTAL ELIXIR

Since ancient times, shamans, mystics, and priests have all used psychoactive plants in order to change and transform their consciousness to "see" into the spiritual realm. The ritual of ingesting psychoactive plants was especially performed when gathering special magical plants and other ingredients that contained the esoteric components needed for constructing external alchemic elixirs. Such magical elixirs (constructed of powerful minerals and spiritual herbs) were only ingested after the Daoist priest had established a basis of inner power through Neigong, Qigong, and Shengong training. Once he or she completed these advanced cultivation methods, the priest's internal channels were cleansed, open, and able to receive the magical components of the external alchemic elixirs.

The "wild-crafting" of such magical plants needed to construct the esoteric elixirs was always performed on a full moon. The ancient Daoists believed that there were "special" mountains that contained powerful Nature Spirits. These Nature Spirits jealously guarded and protected the forest which generally contained the locations of the needed magical plants.

Therefore, before entering into the mountains, the ancient Daoists would perform certain fasting, cleansing, and purifying rituals in order to prepare their physical, energetic, and spiritual body.

On an auspicious day, armed with a magical talisman, the Daoist priest would enter into the mountains in an uninhabited location, looking for the specific alchemical herb needed to make the spiritual medicine.

After locating the needed plant, that Daoist priest would wait until around 11:00 p.m. before ingesting a specific elixir which contained psychoactive plants and mushrooms. This elixir would assist the Daoist in determining the appropriate time in which to uproot and remove the magical plant.

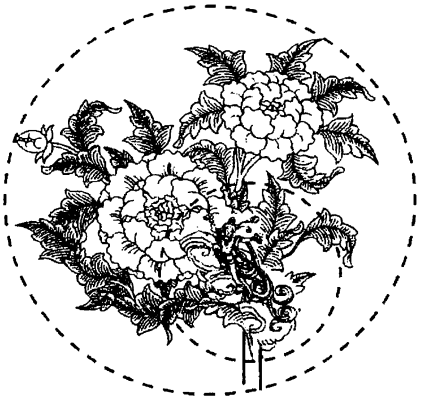


Figure 1.338. The Priest will trap the Plant Spirit inside the herb using a magic talisman and incantation.

As the elixir begins to take its effect, it gives the Daoist priest "Yin-Eyes," allowing him to transcend the physical world and exist within the dream-like state of the spiritual realm. The priest then observes the ground as energetic mists and clouds (known as the "Breath of the Dao"), lightly swirling around the various rocks, trees, plants, and vegetation of the forest.

Next the priest focuses on the specific plant he has chosen and observes the magical light of the plant's spirit as it comes into and goes away from the plant's structure. Within the light of the full moon, the priest waits until the plant's spirit fully inhabits and illuminates its entire structure. Then, he immediately shouts a Breath-Incantation while tossing a specific magical talisman at the plant in order to paralyze the plant's spirit and capture its Ling Shen (Figure 1.338). This is now the time to uproot the plant (while its Ling Shen is still trapped within its physical structure).

The Daoist priest then takes the plant and carefully leaves the area, to combine the energy of the plant's spirit's Ling Shen with other herbal ingredients. Together, the combined energies will construct the Daoist priest's external alchemic elixir. Time is now considered to be an important factor in the construction of the magical elixir. Additionally, if the spiritual medicine becomes contaminated or energetically defiled in any way, the special power of the magical elixir will not develop.

TEACHER PLANTS

Within the Plant Kingdom, there are a few species of trees, plants, cacti, and mushrooms known for their magical effect of transporting the eternal soul of an individual into the spiritual realms of ethereal wonder. These sacred plants were known to produce changes in an individual's perception, thoughts, and mood, but seldom do they produce mental confusion, memory loss, or prolonged time disorientation.

DEFINING A TEACHER PLANTS

One of the earliest forms of life existing on Earth were plants. The intimate physical relationship existing between the Human Realm and Plant Realm is readily apparent. The Plant Realm provides the essential medicinal and life giving foods (i.e., calories and vitamins essential for metabolic regulation) needed for the survival of both the animal and human realms. However, the subtle spiritual relationships between the Human Realm and Plant Realm normally takes years of special training to understand. One way of speeding up this process of learning about the varied and complex spiritual properties of the Plant Realm was for the Daoist priest to approach and learn from a "Teacher Plant."

In ancient times it was commonly known that a Daoist priest who lived in harmony with nature could consciously interact with plant entities. The ancient Chinese believed that certain plants were the residence of powerful spiritual forces, who understood the natural flow of Earth Qi moving within the Earth's energetic channels. These nature spirits could teach or guide the priest in understanding the various magical properties of the Plant Realm. Sometimes knows as "Teacher Plants," these plant spirits were considered to be living forms of spirit entities, nature spirits, or Gods.

FINDING A TEACHER PLANT

Daoist priests were trained to engage in spiritual interactions with the Plant Realm through either Internal Methods or External Methods described as follows:

- **Internal Methods:** These methods involved cultivating higher states of perception and awareness through the use of advanced Shengong techniques.
- **External Methods:** These methods involved using magical talismans, employing spirit guides, or ingesting mind altering substances such as the root of the soma plant.

When using either method of communication, the Daoist priest would generally receive information from the Teacher Plant through visions, sensations, or audible instructions. These interactions were sometimes difficult to comprehend, and at other times were accompanied by vividness, clarity, and understanding.

One of my teachers described this ancient method of communication as follows, "One aspect of Nature Contemplation is seeking interaction with a Teacher Plant. When you speak to the Teacher Plant with your heart, mind, and soul, it sees your Yuan Shen (true inner nature). If it decides to open to you and reveal its secrets, you will see, hear, and receive things that are invisible to others. These magical things are given to you so that you may pursue a deeper path in your relationship with the Dao."

RITUAL FOR FINDING A TEACHER PLANT

There are numerous rituals and Shengong techniques that Daoist priests can use to find a Teacher Plant. One popular method is described as follows:

- The priest begins from a Wuji posture, standing in the natural environment in which he or she wishes to find a teacher plant.
- The priest then performs the One Through Ten Meditation and the Three Invocations. The first invocation is used to establish a magical connection between the priest and the energetic fields of Heaven and Earth, and the center of time and space. The second invocation is used to create a protective energetic field (via a Magic Circle) that surrounds the priest's physical body. The third invocation is used to create a ball of divine white light, located inside the priest's Lower Dantian.
- Once the priest is secure at the center of the Magic Circle, he or she relaxes his or her mind, adopts the standing "Immortal Post" posture. This posture allows all of the priest's senses to extend outside of the physical body, expanding his or her intuitive perceptions outward into infinite space.

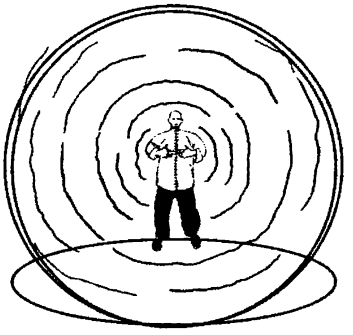


Figure 1.339. Slightly bounce on the heels, allows the body to increase its external projection of resonant vibration, causing the energetic circle to become larger as it ripples outward

- The priest then begins to ripple Qi and Shen out from his or her Taiji Pole into the environment, like waves of water expanding out in all directions. These ripples of vibration can be increased by slightly bouncing on the heels. The priest programs each of these energetic ripples to contain his or her benevolent intention of finding a Teacher Plant (Figure 1.339).
- Next, the priest places his or her attention and focus on their internal connection with the divine light of compassion, and begins to externally listen to and search for the location of a Teacher Plant.
- While bouncing on his or her heels, the Daoist priest can also use Hand Seals to strengthen his or her intention. These specific Hand Seals act as a type of unveiling device used to bring to light any spirit entities residing within the environment's energetic or spiritual realms (Figure 1.340).
- When rippling the energetic rings outward, the priest audibly chants the magical incantation "Rang Yang" in a slow hypnotic pattern. Rang translates as "come," or "let it be," while Yang translates as "feel good," or "be nourished." The chant is repeated over and over in a constant streaming rhythm.
- The priest continues to ripple energy outward into the environment until the Ling Qi within the area has been sufficiently stimulated and the local nature spirits and guardians begin to make themselves visible. At this point, the Daoist priest may notice an uncommon

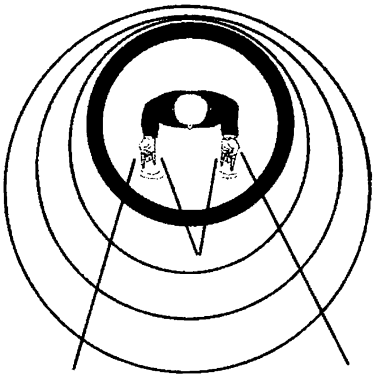


Figure 1.340. Hand Seal used to summons a spirit entity

amount of Ling Qi emanating from particular plant's foliage.

- It is important to note that within any natural environment, there are sometimes guardian plants who seek to protect the area by misleading and redirecting curious individuals away from particularly sacred or sensitive plants. If the priest encounters one of these spirit guardians, the priest is to assure the spirit guardian of his or her benevolent purpose and intention to find a Teacher Plant. Sometimes the priest may be required to pass a certain test or perform a Gift Exchange in order to have access to the deeper levels of the area. As the local nature spirits and guardians begin to arise, it is important that the priest not allow any of these spirit entities to penetrate the energetic protective shield of his or her magic circle.
- Once it has been located, the Teacher Plant should be approached with respect and gratitude. As with any teacher, a Gift Exchange and a declaration of intention is performed during the initial contact.
- After making contact with the Teacher Plant, the priest may be instructed in specific practices or rituals needed to access the spiritual energy of the area. For example, he or she may be asked to return with a specific offering at a specific time, at which point he or she is invited to ask questions about the different plants in that area and exchange information about their uses. Occasionally, the priest may ask questions on the first meeting with the Teacher Plant.

ANCIENT CHINESE PLANT ALCHEMY

In ancient China, as in modern times, in order to make a magical potion, tincture, elixir, or Immortal Pill, a priest first needs the "ingredients of power." He or she should also understand the proper position of the celestial bodies, choose the correct rituals to perform, use the proper tools, and gather the assistance of the correct deities or spirit entities.

Appeasing the celestial deities or earth spirits is essential before making any magical potion. The time needed to make a magical potion, tincture, elixir, or Immortal Pill is generally several weeks (depending on the specific recipe). However, this time factor can be lowered through the proper application of astrology (the utilization of the Sun, Moon, and planetary powers) and the appeasing the certain celestial spirits.

There is no way to know if the construction of the magical potion, tincture, elixir, or Immortal Pill is successful or not until it is ingested. The effects of an imperfect magical potion can be anything from amusing to devastating.

Chinese Plant Alchemy involves the preparation and use of herbal tinctures and herbal elixirs (constructed for ingesting the seven planetary elixirs used to rebalance the spiritual centers in the human body). Alchemically prepared tinctures and herbal elixirs are necessary for the proper construction of a Plant Stone (also known to the ancient Daoists as an external "Immortal Pill").

The practice of Plant Alchemy brings about an intimate knowledge of both the visible nature of plants and the invisible energies of a plant's life and consciousness. This esoteric knowledge allows the disciple to transmute and regenerate him or herself, and to attain "Inner Initiation." The ancient Daoists believed that only then is the path of physical transmutation open to the initiate to create the "Immortal Fetus."

In ancient Chinese alchemy, everything is composed of three parts (Jing, Qi, and Shen) and described in "code" (Figure 1.341). "Sulphur" was the word used to describe Shen (or spirit), "Mercury" was the word used to describe Qi (or life-force energy), and "Salt" was the word used to describe Jing (or physical essence). It was the goal of the ancient alchemist to separate and recombine these three basic principles of creation as often as necessary, until they evolved into perfect proportion and energetic harmony with each other. When this energetic harmony was achieved, the creation of an "Immortal Pill" was completed. If the Immortal Pill was externally constructed (via specific recipes of plant and mineral components) then it would be used to achieve certain alchemical transformations for the alchemist (or for another individual). This was accomplished via an energetic medium such as water (or wine), or through direct ingestion.

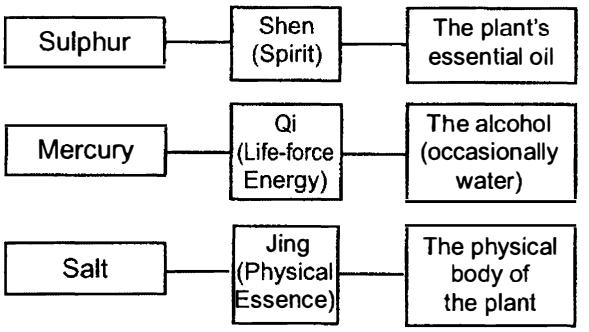


Figure 1.341. Plant Alchemy: It was the goal of the ancient alchemists to separate and recombine these three basic principles of creation as often as necessary until they evolved into perfect proportion and energetic harmony with each other. When this energetic harmony was achieved, the creation of an "Immortal Pill" was completed.

In the Plant Kingdom, the physical body of the plant itself is the Salt (Jing), its essential oil is the Sulphur (Shen), and alcohol (and occasionally water) is the Mercury (Qi). Thus, the aspiring alchemist seeks to separate these three parts and recombine then, giving rise to the term "Spagyrics" (to "separate and recombine"), which is given to plant work in external Alchemy (also known as the "Lesser Circulation"). The "Greater Circulation" of external alchemy consists of working with the Jing, Qi and Shen of specific metals and minerals. Its alchemic process follows the same principles as those used in plant work, however, it is traditionally undertaken only after a certain degree of plant mastery has been attained.

Creating an alchemical or magical plant tincture is among one of the highest and most rewarding activities that a student of esoteric mysticism can accomplish. Much can be gained from the theoretical study of Chinese Plant Alchemy, however, it is only in the actual conducting of experiments that any meaningful degree of insight and growth can be attained. For this reason, the following experiments have been given to enable the would be alchemists to try it for themselves, without the heavy investment in laboratory equipment during their trial period. The methods given and time for completion reflect this simple, low-tech, approach. In some cases, however, with proper glassware and heat source, the time required can be dramatically reduced.

CAUTIONS IN MAKING MAGIC ALCHEMICAL ELIXIRS

According to Daoist master Ge Hong, in ancient China there were several precautions taken into consideration before constructing a magical plant elixir. Master Ge Hong writes,

"A magic alchemical elixirs should only be compounded on a special mountain, in an uninhabited location, with no more than three people (Yang number) in the group.

Before gathering the magical herbs, the individuals must first fast for 100 days, and then bathe themselves in purified water.

During this time of purification, it is important that the individuals keep themselves pure. They are not allowed to approach anything polluted, and must not associate with vulgar people.

It is also important that they keep the harvest time secret, and to not allow anyone who does not believe in the Way (Dao) to know about it. If the spiritual medicine is slandered or it healing potential dismissed and rejected, the magic elixir will not develop."

The ancient Daoists believed that all sacred mountains have righteous spirits guarding them. Therefore, the famous Five Sacred Mountains are considered to be good locations for gathering and constructing magic alchemical elixirs.

CHOOSING THE DAY

Before entering into the mountains, it was important to the ancient Daoists to first choose an auspicious day, and only to go armed with magic protective talismans.

In Daoist Magic, there are several rules dictates by ancient priests concerning the days on which the compounding of magical elixirs should not take place. For example:

- **The Days of Strife:** On the following days, for Men, on the 3rd day and Jia-Yin day of the seventh month; and for Woman, one the 7th day and the Geng-Shen day of the 1st month, one should not compound the magical elixir. On these special days, the magical essence of the minerals fight against each other.
- **The Days of the Death of the Five Stones:** On the following days, Ren-Chen (in Spring), Gui-Wei (in Summer), Bing-Xu (in Autumn), and Ding-Chou (in Winter), the energetic essences of the minerals are "yielded and frozen," and do not release their fullness of the magical manifestation.
- **The Days of Life of the Five Evils:** On the following days, Ren-Yin (in Spring), Gui-Si (in Summer), Ren-Shen (in Autumn), and Gui-Hai (in Winter), one should not enter into a mountain, buy elixir ingredients, or explain the magical teachings.
- **The Days of the Extinction of the Five Peaks:** On the following days, Geng-Yin (in Spring), Gui-Wei (in Summer), Bing-Shen (in Autumn), and Ding-Chou (in Winter), one should not compound the magical elixir or search for any of its ingredients. On these special days, the celestial spirits inspect the Hun and Po of all human beings.
- **The Days of the Opening of Heaven and the Cracking of Earth:** On the following days, Bing-Xu and Bing-Shen (in Spring), Xin-Wei and Xin-Chou (in Summer), Ren-Chen and Ren-Xu (in Autumn), and Gui-Wei and Gui-Chou (in Winter), one should not make the crucible or compound the magical elixir.

Additional Cautions

When creating a magical elixir, the ancient Daoists warned their disciples against Four Calamities that could inadvertently rob the elixirs of their energetic potential. The Four Calamities are as follows:

- **Tremors:** When compounding the magic elixir, avoid places where there are tremors, even if the tremors are only caused by passing chariots.
- **Curious Individuals:** When compounding the magic elixir, avoid contact with envious and/or curious people.
- **Thunderclaps:** When compounding the magic elixir, avoid thunderclaps that shake the crucible. If you hear a thunderclap, immediately cover the crucible with a wet cloth to prevent the magical essence of the elixir from being dispersed.
- **Tastes and Smells:** When compounding the magic elixir, avoid sour and hot flavors, as well as the smell of burned skin of chicken or dog.

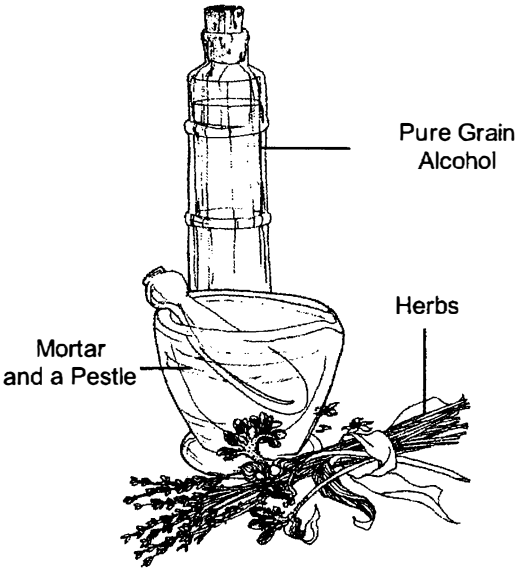


Figure 1.342. Making Plant Tinctures

The Magical Art of Plant Alchemy

In ancient Daoist Plant Alchemy, special longevity and immortality elixirs were created based on plant or animal materials. Many of these magical formulae included such ingredients as Dihuang (Rehmannia glutinosa Liboosch - Earth Yellow Herb), Fuling (Poria cocos - China Root Fungus), Huaimu (Sophora japonica - Locust Tree Parts), Huma (Sesamum indicum- Sesame), Huangjing (Polygonatum sibiricum - Yellow Essence) Lianshi (Nelumbo nucifera - Lotus Fruit), and Zhanglu (Phytolacca acinosa - Poke Root).

The production of a plant tincture is the first and easiest type of magical elixir to construct. It requires no special equipment, and can be created by any Daoist disciple. All that is needed is patience and perseverance (Figure 1.342).

When constructing a magical elixir, any type of medicinal plant can be used. The following is an example of a simple tincture that can be constructed with the herb "Xiang Feng Cao" (also known as Lemon Balm: *Mellissa Officianalis*). Lemon Balm has been used throughout history as a medicinal herb. It has mild sedative properties and has been used to relieve gas, reduce fever, and increase perspiration. The volatile oil contains citral, citronellal, eugenol acetate, and geraniol. Both oil and hot water extracts of the leaves have been shown to possess strong antibacterial and antiviral qualities. It is important to note, that whenever working with plants, careful consideration must be taken into account as to the plant's toxicity. Also, when wild-crafting (harvesting the plant from the wild), do not use a metal knife to cut the plant (a sharp stone knife is better), as the metal will rob the plant of some of its energetic properties.

In order to create a magical plant tincture, you will need the following utensils and ingredients listed below (Figure 1.343):

- Purchase (or harvest and dry) 200 to 300 grams (7 to 10.5 oz.) of dry lemon balm (melissa officinalis) to conduct your experiment. The dry seeds keep their germinating power, and contain the spark of life. For each operation, one once (52 grams) of the dried herb will be needed. Unless otherwise stated, the bulk herb will consist mostly of leaves, some stem, and occasionally the roots of the plant specified. If you are unsure as to the content, either ask the herbalist you are purchasing it from, grow you own, or harvest it yourself from the wild. If dried herbs are not available, a large quality

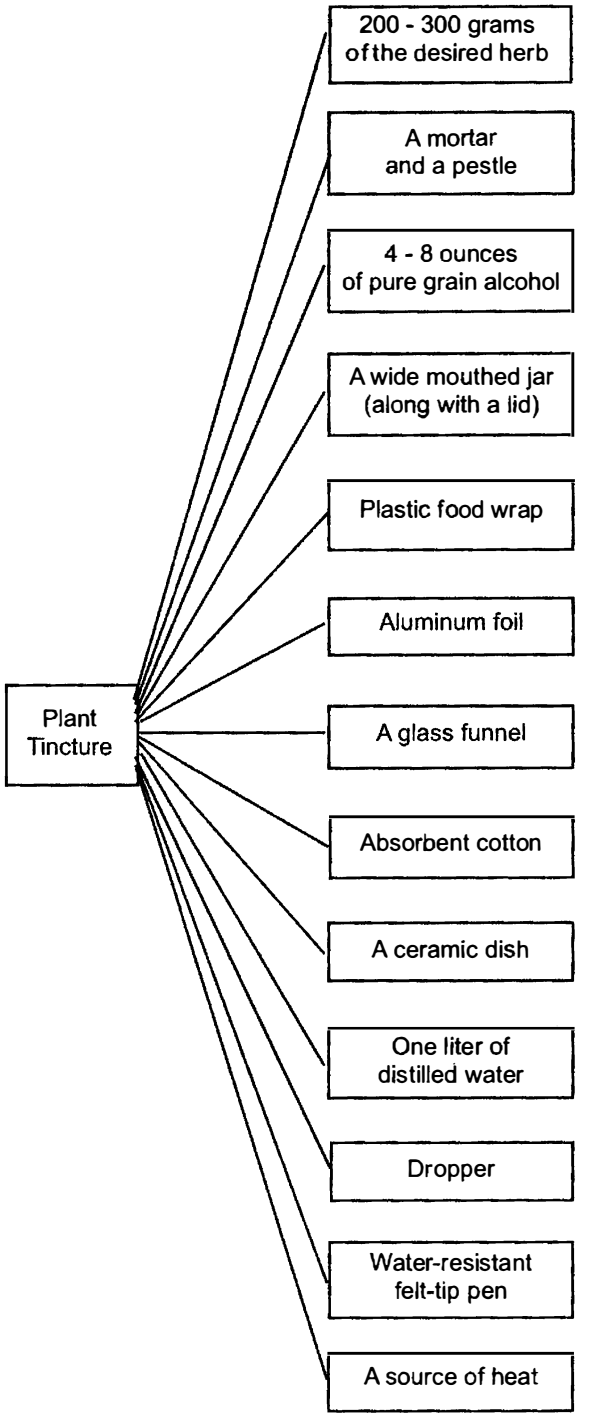


Figure 1.343. The utensils and ingredients needed for making Plant Tinctures

of fresh plants may be substituted. Alchemists have personal preferences as to when an where to use fresh versus dried plants. Experience will help you sort this out later on. For now, either plant will suffice for this experiment.

- A mortar and a pestle (or equivalent); so that you can reduce the plant to a powder. A manual tool is a preferable choice as electric grinders are not appropriate for this work. To crush herbs, use two mortars and two pestles. Reserve one set solely for making toxic compounds (i.e., magical inks, incense, banishing powders, etc.), and the other set for crushing culinary herbs that will later be ingested. Grind the herbs in a clockwise direction when preparing healing potions or immortal pills. Grind the herbs in a counterclockwise direction when making magical repellents or banishing incense.
- Four to eight ounces of pure grain alcohol will be needed (190 proof). If this is unavailable then any strong wine alcohol is sufficient (about 300 cc of wine alcohol like cognac, armagnac, or strong brandy). Any alcohol that does not come from the wine is absolutely excluded from this experiment.
- A wide mouthed jar (along with a lid), plastic food wrap, aluminum foil,
- A glass funnel.
- Some absorbent cotton, as used in surgery.
- A ceramic dish that can resist very high temperatures. This dish is going to be used for calcinations. Borosilicate glass like Pyrex is not resistant enough to stand such heat. On the other hand, Coors porcelain may be used. The lid can be made of something like Pyrex because at its top the temperature is lower.
- One liter of distilled water.
- A dropper
- A water-resistant felt-tip pen.
- A source of heat: gas heat is preferred over an electric heat because it permits better control of heat intensity. If one does not have a Bunsen burner a camping gas stove is adequate. Also a lab hot plate may be used if no gas is available.

Lemon Balm is ruled by the planet Jupiter

Jupiter rules Thursday

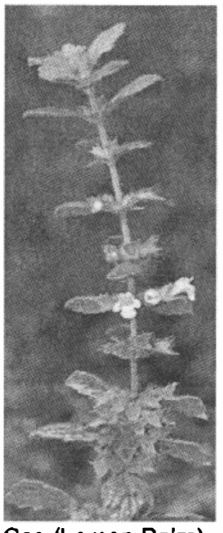


Figure 1.344. Xiang Feng Cao (Lemon Balm).

Creating a Magical Plant Tincture

The ancient Chinese alchemists would always begin the operation in the specific planetary hour of the ruling planet of the herb. For Lemon Balm, its ruling planet is traditionally Jupiter. While planetary hours come several times a day for each planet, the first (and often easiest) is to begin within a few minutes of sunrise on the day of the ruling planet. Since Lemon Balm is ruled by Jupiter, and Jupiter rules Thursday, the first planetary hour of Jupiter would occur immediately after sunrise on Thursday (Figure 1.344).

- After setting up an altar and starting the ritual with prayers and offerings to summon the powers of the Four Directions.
- Next, present prayers and offerings to the God of Earth, asking that the mysteries of the plant realm be revealed to you. Then, to summon the God of Earth, repeat the following magical incantation:

"Na Mo San Man Duo.
Muh Toh Nam. An.
Du Lu Du Lu Dei Wei So Ha."

This magical incantation contains a secret mantra from the Daoist Maoshan sect, and is used for gathering great power. The ancient

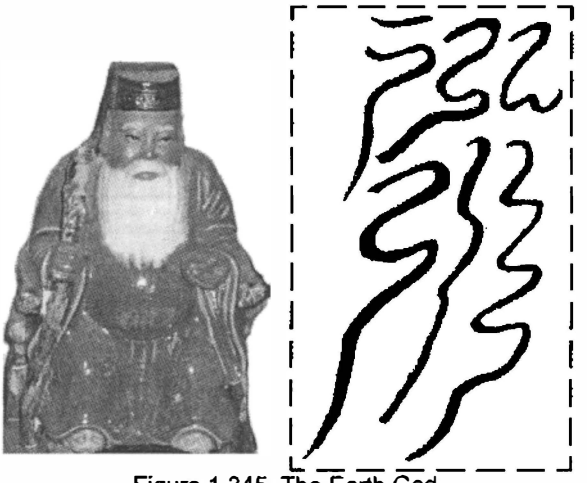


Figure 1.345. The Earth God and the Magical Seal used to Summon Him

Zheng Yi Daoists believed that after the priest has recited this mantra the God of Earth will appear, causing malevolent spirit entities to leave the area.

When using the mantra in any ritual, the Daoist priest must strike his or her heel on the ground three times after speaking the magical incantation in order to summon the God of Earth.

While summoning the Earth God, draw the following magical seal within the incense smoke (Figure 1.345). It is also necessary to offer the Earth God a few cups of wine, five cups of tea, a bowl of rice, and a dish of fruit. All of these should be available on the altar table when summoning this deity and asking for assistance and blessings.

- Next, take the herb from the Earth Altar and begin grinding it by hand in a mortar and pestle. Make it as fine a powder as possible, focusing on the idea that you are releasing the divine power of the herb (as well as from within yourself) through this alchemical work.

If their is not enough time to grind all of the herb by hand, or if the herbal components are simply too tough (such as a seed or root), then grind it partially in the coffee grinder (or glass blender). It is important that you spend some time with the herb in energetic and

physical contact. If you must grind it entirely by machine, then afterwards place it in the mortar and grind it with the pestle, and begin to energetically imprint thought and intention into the herb. It is important to focus on developing the energetic relationship between yourself, the herb, and its ruling planet (as well as the planet's energetic correspondences that are active within your physical, energetic, and spiritual bodies).

As you stir each ingredient, intone a rhythmical incantation into its energetic components as you grind the herbs in a clockwise direction. Mentally infuse each ingredient with the specific attribute you expect it to contribute to the Healing Tincture. Throughout the preparation concentrate, imagine and feel the positive outcome you wish to produce, and visualize the individuals who will be benefiting from the Healing Tincture becoming healthy.

Conversely, if you are creating a Banishing Tincture, grind the herbs in a counterclockwise direction while infusing each ingredient with the specific attribute you expect it to contribute to the Banishing Tincture. Throughout the preparation concentrate, imagine and feel the problem disappearing and visualize the individuals who will be benefiting from the Banishing Tincture acting relieved and happy again.

- When the powder is finished, place it in the glass jar, and slowly, with concentration, pour the grain alcohol over the herb, until it is saturated with fluid. Then add an additional amount of alcohol equal to that already in (usually two to four "fingers width") the container. Because room is needed for expansion (the contents heat and sometimes expand during the maceration process), the jar should not be more than 1/2 to 2/3rds full of fluid.

The fluid inside the jar will evaporate as it naturally "cooks," and it will begin to condense (as it is not capable of escaping). This will cause the fluid to get darker with each passing day. This coloration, or tincturing, is the extraction of the Sulphur (Spiritual) property from the plant's Salt (Essence) physical matter, by the Mercury-alcohol (Energetic) medium.

The fluid should not touch metal, and if needed, cover the mouth of the jar with some form of food wrap prior to tightly sealing it with the lid. It is important that no light disturb its alchemic transformation process. Therefore, place the jar inside a dark silk bag, and then place it somewhere warm. Shake its contents vigorously once or twice a day. Continue this process for one to two weeks, until the color of the tincture is dark.

Remember, that this magical tincture is considered to be your energetic "Child," and therefore must be treated with love and respect. Each time you handle it for inspection, or shake its contents, remember that it is a physical representation of your "soul-personality." Therefore, treat it no differently than you would treat yourself, a small child, or an important house guest. As you separate the Sulphur (Spirit) from the murky sludge of the herbal mass, imagine that you are separating your Eternal Soul (Shen Xian) from the constraints of physical life and incarnation.

It is the priest's projected Shen (Spirit), Yi (Intention), and Zhi (Will) that creates the magical power of alchemy. This attitude is literally transferred into the herbal matter being acted upon, just as if it were a patient receiving energetic or spiritual healing. When the final alchemical product is consumed, it is considered to be an act of taking into oneself the power of a magical, living talisman. In this magical process, our physical body (Salt) and Life-Force energy (Mercury) is being regenerated by receiving the spiritual power of the divine elixir (Sulphur). Each time we repeat the process, we are alchemically transformed and regenerated by minute degrees, moving closer to divine perfection.

- After the color of the liquid is sufficiently dark, pour it off, being careful to strain or filter it. Then, press out the remaining fluid from the plant matter. This magical tincture now contains the Sulphur (essential oils, waxes,

and vegetable fats) and the Mercury (alcohol and some water) of the Lemon Balm.

Preparing the Salt (Plant Mass)

While the leftover plant residue (Salt) need not be consumed with the tincture, it can be used in order to assist in increasing the overall magical effects of the alchemic operation. The Salt level extractions contain the magical plant essence, which was made by purifying the plant body until it became a clear or white crystalline Salt, and then adding the Salt to the alcohol tincture to capture the physical signatures of the plant. This part of the extract serves to give the essence "body" in alchemical terms and helps to carry its healing actions into the physical. The leftover plant residue (Salt) can be further refined as follows:

- Take the leftover plant residue (sometimes known as the plant feces or "caput mortum" - dead head) outside, place it in a large, deep container, and ignite it. Our concern is not with what may be drawn out of the ashes, but what may be drawn out of the tincture. Use a large pot lid to smother the flames if necessary, as well as protect the dried ash from blowing away in a sudden breeze. Be aware that there may be a considerable quantity of smoke released from the burning plant residue. Continue to heat the plant residue until it turns into ash.
- After the cooked plant residue (Salt) has cooled, bring it inside and place it in a covered heat proof dish. Then place the dish in the oven and heat it at 500 or more degrees Fahrenheit, until it has turned to a grey-white, or completely white powder. Frequently remove the plant residue (Salt) and grind it with a mortar and pestle in order to assist in this process of preparation. The finer the particles become during the maceration process, the more Sulphur (plant essence) will be extracted; the finer the particles during the heating, or calcining process, the easier it is to get the grey-white or white stages of purification.
- Keep the plant residue (Salt) separate, and place a few grains of its powder in a teaspoon of the tincture (1-2 ml/10-20 drops). Then, place the combined ingredients into a glass of distilled water. This should be done during the planetary hour, on the planetary day ruling the herb (in the case of Lemon Balm, it will be performed on a Thursday).

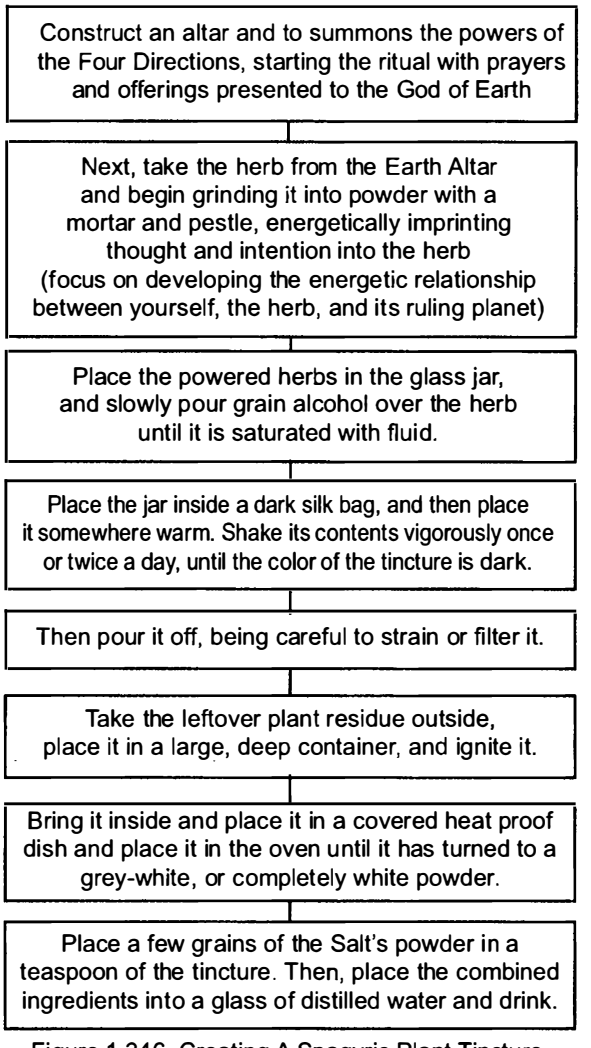


Figure 1.346. Creating A Spagyric Plant Tincture

Always remember the sacredness of the external alchemic process you are performing (Figure 1.346). It is intended for regeneration (physically, emotionally, and spiritually) through the assistance of the tincture as a manifestation of your own spiritual power. In order to intensify the desired effects, some mystics will combine this transformational aspect of Plant Alchemy with ritualistic and astrological invocations, similar to that which is done for constructing a talisman.

PLANT ENS (IMMORTAL ELIXIRS)

"Plant Ens" were known as external "Immortal Elixirs" in ancient China. They were constructed of magical herbs and minerals and were used in order to assist the Daoist mystic on his or her journey with the infinite Dao. The ingestion of the various types of Plant Elixirs allowed the disciple to use the skill of external alchemy to increase his or her subtle perceptions that had been developed from internal alchemy meditation exercises. The combination of both the internal and external alchemic processes was used to assist the Daoist disciple through ever greater energetic and spiritual transformations. In the following description, herbal master Mark Stavish, M.A. carefully outlines the process of creating a Plant Ens in his article on *Practical Plant Alchemy*.

In the Plant Kingdom, an "Ens" is considered to be the "First Extract" of any plant that has not yet attained its full maturity ("final perfection") and is therefore considered to be richer in seminal virtue. The primary goal is to separate the Premium Ens (First Essence) from the Prima Materia (First Matter) that acts as the vehicle for the First Essence in the physical world. The "First Matter" is believed to be the genetic principle of from which the first natural life-impulse derives its substance and potency. In the plant world, an Premium Ens is created from plants which are "still in the blade" (i.e., still sprouting) or from among unripe fruits.

Constructing a Plant Ens Elixir is different than constructing of a Plant Tincture. In the Plant Tincture, the herbal formula can be "exalted" through a repeated process in which its calcined Salts (plant matter) are added to the tincture. An Ens Elixir, however, is not mixed with calcined Salts. Tinctures almost always contain more than one species of plant, while Plant Ens Elixirs generally contain only one specific type of magical plant.

One ancient mystic stated, "the Ens manifests the highest initiated virtue of the plant that it is made from." The Ens, or Entia (plural), is the plant's primary energetic and spiritual influence that affects the physical, emotional, and spiritual bodies. Created from the Plant Kingdom, the Ens Elixirs can be used to correct energetic imbalances and bring about physical, energetic, and spiritual health. The Ens is among the most powerful of medicines, yet it is one of the easiest to make.

The nature of magical plant Ens Elixirs, is to clear out the stagnation and energetic blocks existing within our physical, energetic, and spiritual bodies. This subtle cleansing and transformation allows for the increased exchange of energetic information flowing between the dense physical world of matter and the more subtle spiritual realm in which we exist. In creation, there are no disconnections, gaps, or holes. Such things only exist in our understanding, knowledge, or realization of Nature. With each corresponding increase in energetic intensity, a spiritual rebirth occurs, resulting as a subtle magical initiation into the deeper mystical comprehensions.

The natural power of creation is found in the energetic force that continually motivates, moves, and changes all of creation, encouraging it to progress toward more refined levels of existence. When we create and ingest a Plant Ens or any alchemical product, we are simply assisting Nature in the awakening process by quickening our own personal evolution.

THE CREATION OF THE ENS ELIXIR

Like the construction of the basic Plant Tincture previously described, an Ens Elixir can be made for each of the seven planetary rulers (one for each day of the week). Therefore, it is through the herb ruled and influenced by a particular planet that we seek "initiation" into the energetic sphere or spiritual realm ruled by that planet (Figure 1.347).

Unlike a "Plant Stone" (also known as an "Immortal Pill"), the Ens Elixir has a lesser initiated power, although its release of energy is still quite effective and sometimes surprising. In the Plant Stone, all of the four Elemental aspects of Earth, Air, Water, and Fire are kept in balance. However, in the Ens Elixir, the Fire Element is considered to be the predominant power. The advantage of the Ens Elixirs lies in the simplicity of their creation.

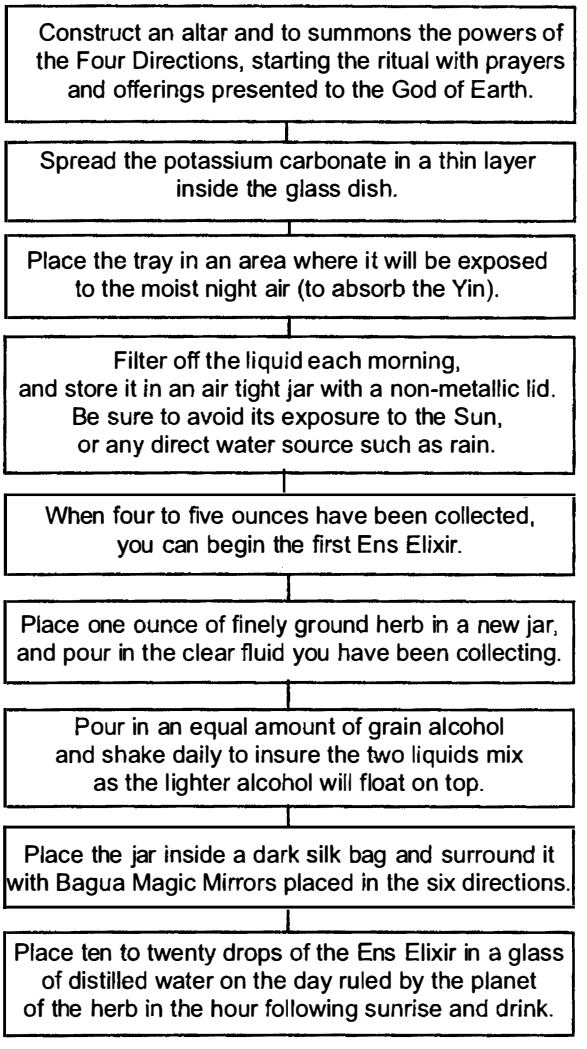


Figure 1.347. Creating A Plant Ens (Immortal Elixirs)

This allows anyone, regardless of their level of experience, to create an effective Ens Elixir. While several methods exist for the creation of the Ens Elixirs, the following method is easy, safe, and requires no special equipment.

The same materials are used as previously described in "Creating A Magical Plant Tincture." Additionally, about 1.5 pounds of potassium carbonate (Salt of Tartar) will be needed, as well as a glass dish (no less than one inch deep).

- Spread the potassium carbonate in a thin layer inside the glass dish, no more than 1/4 of an inch thick (1-2 cm.). Caution should be taken to avoid exposure to the potassium carbonate in either its dry state or when it becomes liquefied through exposure to the night air. It is toxic and can cause a rash, or burning of the mucous membranes. Wash your hands thoroughly after handling to avoid any accidental exposure or contamination of your eyes or other sensitive areas. The potassium carbonate will also etch the sides of the glass container in which it is used during this experiment.
- Place the tray in an area where it will be exposed to the night air (to absorb the Yin). As potassium carbonate liquefies (becoming deliquescent), it absorbs the night's watery mist (Breath of the Dao) carried in the night air. This water (or humidity), is believed to be the energetic vehicle of the "Universal Fire," and is most easily obtained in the spring and summer months. This Universal Fire is what sets both our personal and planetary energetic fields into action on various levels. The ancient Daoists believed that the vital life-force energy was carried in the air (from which we extract its vital energetic essence). This type of energy manifested as a spiritual Fire (by means of condensing into Water) and was captured in the physical medium of the Earthly herb.
- Decant or filter off the liquid each morning, using either a syringe, large dropper, turkey baster, or lab pipette (never pipette by mouth). Be sure to avoid its exposure to the Sun, or any direct water source such as rain.
- When four to five ounces (150-200 ml) have been collected, you can begin the first Ens Elixir. In order to avoid too much loss of this precious liquid when filtering, you may want to collect it in a jar or flask first, and then filter it all at once prior to use. Remember that it will etch the glass it is stored in as well. Make sure you seal the storage jar tightly to prevent the liquid from absorbing any additional fluid from the surrounding air.

- Place about one ounce (52 grams) of finely ground herb in a new jar, and pour in the clear fluid you have been collecting and filtering. Again, remember to begin this portion of the operation on the specific planetary day and hour of the planet ruling the herb. Pour in enough fluid to cover the top of the herb and to allow for thorough shaking. Depending on the dryness and the absorbent nature of the herb you have chosen, this can be from 100 ml to 200 ml of the collected "Oil of Tartar" per herb for adequate coverage. If any "Oil of Tartar" remains, save it for future use.
- Pour in an equal amount of grain alcohol and shake daily to insure the two liquids mix as the lighter colored liquid (oil) will float on top. This liquid will be the Ens Elixir that is removed after the fluid turns a dark reddish color. It is important to always remember that the "Oil of Tartar" is caustic and will be unpleasant if swallowed.
- Because of the energetic nature of the magical elixir, it is important that the lid be non-metallic, and that the mouth of the jar be wrapped in plastic wrap prior to sealing. Place the jar inside a dark silk bag and surround it with some form of energetic protection to limit or reduce the amount of psychic contact the liquid receives (thoughts directed towards the elixir can change its energetic components). In ancient China, Daoist priests placed Bagua Magic Mirrors in the six directions (front, back, right, left, above and below) surrounding the elixir for its protection.
- After several weeks, the "separation of the Yin from the Yang" manifests in the separation of the Sulphur (oil) and Mercury (alcohol). When this happens, separate the two liquids by carefully pouring the lighter oil into a clean glass container. This liquid is the plant's "Essential Oil." The heavier remaining alcohol liquid can also be used, however it is of a much lower energetic quality and for this reason is sometimes referred to as "toilet water."

How to Use the Ens Elixir

The initial training surrounding the secret construction and ingestion of Ens Elixirs is only taught to an "initiated" Daoist mystic (one who has received the "true" secret transmissions from his or her master). Because it is designed to have a special effect on the subtle or spiritual body of the user, some of the more powerful Ens Elixirs are only used in special rituals and ceremonies.

When first ingesting the Ens Elixir, the priest is encouraged to carefully note his or her dreams in a journal, recording the energetic effects caused by the phases of the moon, and any other psychic occurrences that may have happened due to its consumption. The Ens Elixir is ingested in the following manner:

- Place ten to twenty drops of the Ens Elixir in a glass of preferably distilled water on the day ruled by the planet of the plant in the hour following sunrise. If this is not possible, then in any of the other three planetary hours occurring that day. As before, you may consecrate it prior to consumption with various astrological rituals, as you would do for a talisman.

How to Pick a Plant

For those disciples not wishing to create all seven of the planetary Ens Elixirs at once, the following may be taken into consideration when picking a plant for your first time. First, you may wish to choose the quality and power of a specific plant based upon the planetary sign that you are currently deficient in. The following is a list of the seven planets and their herbal influence. The creation of all seven Planetary Ens Elixir, and their perfection, represents a physical demonstration of the students mastery of the physical and energetic realms of the Plant World.

1. **The Sun.** A Sun Ens Elixir is designed to assist in awakening intuition, self-mastery, and the sphere of Spiritual Fire. It may also be used to ascend into the various spiritual realms using the energetic powers of the Sun as a base. The following are some examples of various herbs related to the power of the Sun:

- (Sun-Fire) Cardamom or amonum pods (Elettaria cardamomum)
- (Sun-Fire) Chamomile (Matricaria recutita)
- (Sun-Fire) Cinnamon (Cinnamomum cassia)
- (Sun-Fire) Rosemary Leaf (Rosmarinus officianalis)

2. **The Moon.** A Moon Ens Elixir is designed to open you up the psychic world, especially the realm of the Air Immortals. It may also be used to ascend into the various spiritual realms using the energetic powers of the Moon as a base. These herbs carry the watery energy of the Moon and are used esoterically for manifestations of higher energies. The following are some examples of various herbs related to the power of the Moon:

- (Moon-Water) Passion Flower Leaf (Passiflora incarnata)
- (Moon-Water) Uva Ursi Leaf (Arctostaphylos uva ursi)

3. **Mercury.** These following Ens Elixirs are designed to utilize the esoteric powers and influence of the planet Mercury:

- (Mercury-Air) Gingko Leaf (Gingko biloba)
- (Mercury-Air) Lavender (Lavendula officianalis)
- (Mercury-Air) Lemongrass (Cymbopogon citratus)
- (Mercury-Air) Marjoram Leaf (Origanum majorana)

4. **Mars.** These following Ens Elixirs are designed to utilize the esoteric powers and influence of the planet Mars:

- (Mars-Fire) Basil leaf (Ocimum basilicum)
- (Mars-Fire) Milk Thistle Seed (Silybum marianum)
- (Mars-Fire) Nettle Leaf (Urtica dioica)
- (Mars-Earth) Echinacea Leaf (Echinacea purpurea)

5. **Venus.** These following Ens Elixirs are designed to utilize the esoteric powers and influence of the planet Venus:

- (Venus-Water) Catnip Flower and Leaf (Nepeta cataria)
- (Venus-Water) Hibiscus Flower (Hibiscus sabdariffa): Hibiscus flowers carry lustful and passionate energy and were used in a tea to release licentious behavior.

6. **Jupiter.** These following Ens Elixirs are designed to utilize the esoteric powers and influence of the planet Jupiter:

- (Jupiter-Fire) Bay Leaf (Laurus nobilis)
- (Jupiter-Fire) Eucalyptus (Eucalyptus Leaf, Eucalyptus globulus)
- (Jupiter-Fire) Hyssop Leaf (Hyssopus officianalis)
- (Jupiter-Fire) Lemon Balm Leaf (Melissa officianalis)
- (Jupiter-Air) Dandelion Root (Taraxacum officianle)
- (Jupiter-Water) Red Rose Buds and Petals (Rosa centifolia)

7. **Saturn.** These following Ens Elixirs are designed to utilize the esoteric powers and influence of the planet Saturn:

- (Saturn-Air) Sage Leaf (Salvia officianalis)
- (Saturn-Fire) Mandrake Root (Podophyllum peltatum)
- (Saturn-Earth) Comfrey leaf (Ocimum basilicum)
- (Saturn-Earth) St. John's Wort Leaf (Hypericum perforatum)

Calculating the Planetary Hours

Planetary hours are not the same as the 24 hour (60 minutes) cycles that we are familiar with. Planetary hours consist of 12 daylight hours and 12 dark hours. Therefore, depending on the times of the sunset and sunrise, the hours can be longer or shorter than the usual 60 minute time period. This is the same for the Blood Heat cycle and energetic flow contained within the body's channel system, currently used in Traditional Chinese Medicine.

In order to make sure that the planetary hour for whichever day you wish to create herbal tinctures is correct, make a note of the time at which the sun rises and sets prior to the day you wish to prepare the specific herbal formula.

		Orange-Red	Silver	Red	Blue	Green	White	Yellow
				Yang (Daylight) Planetary Hours				
	Hour	Sunday	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
Sunrise (Dawn)	1	Sun	Moon	Mars	Mercury	Jupiter	Venus	Saturn
	2	Venus	Saturn	Sun	Moon	Mars	Mercury	Jupiter
	3	Mercury	Jupiter	Venus	Saturn	Sun	Moon	Mars
	4	Moon	Mars	Mercury	Jupiter	Venus	Saturn	Sun
	5	Saturn	Sun	Moon	Mars	Mercury	Jupiter	Venus
	6	Jupiter	Venus	Saturn	Sun	Moon	Mars	Mercury
Noon	7	Mars	Mercury	Jupiter	Venus	Saturn	Sun	Moon
	8	Sun	Moon	Mars	Mercury	Jupiter	Venus	Saturn
	9	Venus	Saturn	Sun	Moon	Mars	Mercury	Jupiter
	10	Mercury	Jupiter	Venus	Saturn	Sun	Moon	Mars
	11	Moon	Mars	Mercury	Jupiter	Venus	Saturn	Sun
	12	Saturn	Sun	Moon	Mars	Mercury	Jupiter	Venus
				Yin (Dark) Planetary Hours				
	Hours	**Sunday**	**Monday**	**Tuesday**	**Wednesday**	**Thursday**	**Friday**	**Saturday**
Sunset (Dusk)	**1**	**Jupiter**	**Venus**	**Saturn**	**Sun**	**Moon**	**Mars**	**Mercury**
	2	**Mars**	**Mercury**	**Jupiter**	**Venus**	**Saturn**	**Sun**	**Moon**
	3	**Sun**	**Moon**	**Mars**	**Mercury**	**Jupiter**	**Venus**	**Saturn**
	4	**Venus**	**Saturn**	**Sun**	**Moon**	**Mars**	**Mercury**	**Jupiter**
	5	**Mercury**	**Jupiter**	**Venus**	**Saturn**	**Sun**	**Moon**	**Mars**
	6	**Moon**	**Mars**	**Mercury**	**Jupiter**	**Venus**	**Saturn**	**Sun**
Midnight	**7**	**Saturn**	**Sun**	**Moon**	**Mars**	**Mercury**	**Jupiter**	**Venus**
	8	**Jupiter**	**Venus**	**Saturn**	**Sun**	**Moon**	**Mars**	**Mercury**
	9	**Mars**	**Mercury**	**Jupiter**	**Venus**	**Saturn**	**Sun**	**Moon**
	10	**Sun**	**Moon**	**Mars**	**Mercury**	**Jupiter**	**Venus**	**Saturn**
	11	**Venus**	**Saturn**	**Sun**	**Moon**	**Mars**	**Mercury**	**Jupiter**
	12	**Mercury**	**Jupiter**	**Venus**	**Saturn**	**Sun**	**Moon**	**Mars**

Figure 1.348. The Planetary Hours

- **To find the Daylight Planetary Hours:** Begin by calculating the exact number of minutes between sunrise and sunset, for example if the sun rises at 04:18 and sets at 19:52 then there would be 15 hours and 34 minutes, therefore, the number of minutes between sunrise and sunset would be 934. This number is then divided by twelve to give twelve equal periods of time (the planetary hours for that day), which equals 77.8 minutes.
- **To find the Dark Planetary Hours:** The dark planetary hours are found in much the same way: if the sun sets at 19:52 and rises again the next morning at 04:20 then there would be 8 hours and 28 minutes. Therefore the number of minutes between sunset and sunrise would be 508. This means there are twelve dark planetary hours of 42.3 minutes each. Now locate the specific planet with the influence you wish to use in the planetary hours chart to find out what time of day you should perform your alchemy. The hours of influence for each planet are as follows (Figure 1.348).

PLANT STONES (CREATING IMMORTAL PILLS)

"Plant Stones" were known as external "Immortal Pills" in ancient China. They were constructed of magical herbs and minerals and used in order to assist the Daoist mystic on his or her journey with the infinite Dao. The ingestion of the various types of Plant Stones allowed the disciple to use the skill of external alchemy to increase his or her subtle perceptions that were developed from internal alchemy meditation exercises. The combination of both the internal and external alchemic processes was used to assist the Daoist disciple through the next energetic and spiritual transformation, thus allowing the disciple to enter into a "higher" level of spiritual training.

The creation of a "Plant Stone" (Immortal Pill) expresses the symbolic balancing of the various Elements. This harmony is the basis for its functional reality. With the harmonizing of the plant's Sulphur (Shen or spiritual components), Mercury (Qi or life-force energy), and Salt (Jing or physical essence), the herbs are perfected in their potential use as a medium of energetic and spiritual power.

In ancient China, the magical effects of the Plant Stone are kept secret, and are only offered in training to true disciples (these "immortal pills" are used in certain rituals and ingested in order to increase the disciples' intuitive perceptions). While the disciples' physical health may be somewhat effected, the primary purpose (at the beginning stage) is to increase the student's energetic and spiritual consciousness.

Because each Plant Stone can be used as a profound and powerful gateway into the spiritual realm, the rituals and ceremonies surrounding the Plant Stone also represent a certain degree of mastery of the plant's "soul nature."

The creation of all seven Planetary Stones, and their energetic perfection as a magical "tool" represents a physical demonstration of the disciples' mastery of the energetic and spiritual realms of the Plant World. Therefore, both master and disciple would gather and prepare the Plant Stone together, allowing the transmission of the secret skill of "wild-crafting" the energetic and spiritual powers of magical plants to create an "Immortal Pill" to be passed on.

THE CREATION OF THE PLANT STONE

The process of making a Plant Stone is similar to that of making a Spagyric Tincture as previously described. However, instead of having the option of disposing of Salt (the physical essence of the plant's matter), here it must be calcined (heated and reduced to powder), and then kept for future use. In some instances, Sea Salt may also be used if the Salt obtained from the plant matter is insufficient.

Leaching may sometimes be necessary in the final stages to balance the Elements within the Salt. Leaching is accomplished by placing the Salt in a moderate amount of distilled water, and allowing it to evaporate naturally (or with the assistance of an oven). The Salt is then scraped off the container, ground, and re-calcined. Experience has shown that leaching can be done in fifteen to thirty minutes if the Salt is finely spread, and the heat source is close by.

During the creation of a Plant Stone, the Sulphur (plant's Shen or spiritual components) and Mercury (plant's Qi or life-force energy) having been previously blended together in the tincture, in some instances are separated into their respective aspects. Thus, the creation of a Plant Stone still utilizes all three separate materials that are recombined in the alchemical laboratory.

If separation of the Sulphur (oil) and Mercury (alcohol) is not possible because of equipment limitations, then they may be used together, but this may affect the quality of the Plant Stone produced. An "Artificial Plant Stone" may also be made with Sea Salt, alcohol, and high grade essential oils of the desired plant. It is important to note that a Plant Stone takes time to produce, in some cases up to several months, and will change in color and texture after it is created. Patience, dedication, and confidence are needed at this stage.

There are many ways of making a Plant Stone, ranging from the simple to the complex, each with its own advantages and drawbacks. For simplicity, and the increased possibility of success, several brief methods will be outlined.

METHOD # 1: CONSTRUCTING A "PLANT STONE"

Preparation is the key to success in alchemical work (Figure 1.349). Preparation of the materials needed, the place of working, and above all, of the attitude of the worker is essential. One's attitude must be a mixture of humility and unswerving confidence in the ultimate success of the undertaking. Imagining, feeling, experiencing and realizing the creative process (from beginning to end) will help in its final material realization. In the following description, herbal master Mark Stavish, M.A. carefully outlines the process of creating a Plant Stone in his article on *Practical Plant Alchemy*.

- The Salt may be calcined (heated and reduced to powder) ahead of time, or you may wait to do this until the exact planetary hour, on the day of the ruling planet of the herb.

  The process of calcining is more complicated than it appears, as the simple burning off of the alcohol will not produce enough heat to ashen the residue. The embers must be made to glow by gently blowing on them, until they are bright orange. If you are unsure of your ability to control the ash, use a small, fine wire mesh screen to place over the dish used for calcining to help hold the ashes down. This is very important, as the finer, lighter ash will easily be blown away, and this ash is needed for the creation of a Plant Stone.

  You may also place small amounts of the ash in a crucible and allow the heat from your gas stove to envelop the crucible. Tongs will be needed as the crucible will grow very hot.
- Let the ashes cool, then grind them.
- Soak the ashes again in alcohol, and then repeat the entire process until you observe "white powder." Sometimes it requires a fourth or fifth burning until you achieve the proper white, or grey-white color needed to proceed.
- If the Salt has been prepared ahead of time (before the planetary hour), place it in a heat resistant dish on a low fire. The heat may be modulated, but under no circumstances let it burn or scorch the herb.

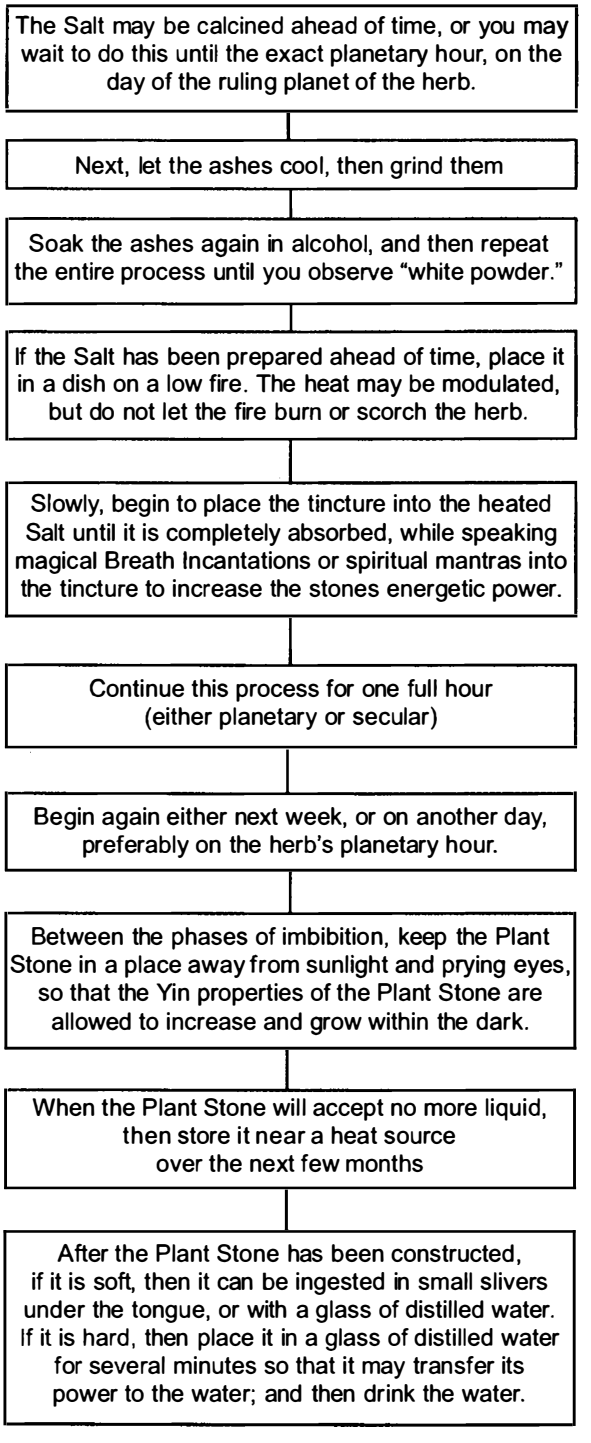


Figure 1.349. Constructing A "Plant Stone"

- Slowly, drop by drop begin to place the tincture into the heated Salt until it is completely absorbed. This is called "Imbibition," and it refers to the process of imbibing the Plant Stone with Qi or life-force energy (Mercury) and the spiritual essence of the Soul (Sulphur). Because you are, in essence, reincarnating the herbal power of the plant, specific Breath Incantations or spiritual mantras are used during the "imbibition" process to increase the stones power.
- Continue this process for as long as you like, or stop after one full hour (either planetary or secular).
- Begin again either next week, or on another day, preferably Saturday, on the planetary hour of the plant. Between the phases of imbibition, keep the Plant Stone in a place away from sunlight and prying eyes. Whether it kept in a basement or buried underground (within the "Womb of the Earth"), it is important that the Yin properties of the Plant Stone are allowed to increase and grow within the dark.
- When the Plant Stone will accept no more liquid, then place it where you can observe the changes that may take place over the next few months. If possible, store it near a heat source, such as an incubator, or even a gas range oven with a running pilot light if it is available.

Ingesting the Plant Stone

After the Plant Stone has been constructed, if it suddenly jells, quickly pour it out of the crucible into a thimble, as it will harden and become difficult to get out of the porcelain crucible (this is actually more desirable to work with). If the Plant Stone is soft like liquorice, then it can be ingested in small slivers under the tongue, or with a glass of distilled water.

If the Plant Stone is hard, then place it in a glass of distilled water for several minutes so that it may transfer its power to the water; and then drink the water. If the Plant Stone is perfected, repeated immersion will not degrade or "attack" the energetic properties of the Plant Stone.

Using the Moon

It is imperative that you keep a careful record of the days, times, and phases of the Moon, during which your Alchemic work is done. It is strongly urged that this type of alchemy not be done during the "dark phase" of the Moon. As with most psychic activities or projects, Full Moon periods (Full Yang within Yin) are most beneficial for constructing Plant Stones.

Remember that it is the light of the Moon that is used as the stimulative factor in these magical energetic activities. As the Earth and Moon share one energetic double, all energetic and spiritual activities are at their most powerful when the Moon is at its fullest. Likewise, during the New Moon, spiritual energy is at its lowest and dark forces have a tendency to rise up and give trouble. Consequently, practical occult work is best left alone to experienced masters during the dark time of the Moon (the life giving forces are relatively weak it this time and the unbalanced forces are relatively strong; the results, in inexperienced hands, generally lead to chaos).

Method #2: Constructing an "Artificial Plant Stone"

If Salts from the plant used to make the tincture are not available, then an "Artificial Plant Stone" may be made in its place using a similar process. The "Artificial Plant Stone" may be constructed as follows:

- In place of the calcined residue, sea salt is soaked in rain water and dried several times, being crushed with a mortar and pestle between cycles. The energy radiating from the hands of the alchemist during this type of construction is most crucial during this type of alchemy. This is why during the handling of the Salt and tincture, the attitude of the alchemist is so important; and this is why alchemists often work alone (undisturbed by the inquisitive and disruptive thoughts of others).

  Remember that thoughts are real things (in energetic form) on their way to becoming tangible in our material world. It is for this very

reason that we mentally envelop ourselves in an energetic blanket or veil to psychically isolate ourselves from the disruptive energy of others; and this is also the reason why we physically wrap our magical plant products in aluminum foil after they are completed. Alcohol is very susceptible to psychic vibrations, as is cold water, and both act as condensers (storage mediums) for concentrated psychic energies.

- If you chose not to soak the sea salt, then crush it, imagining that it (like the Plant Salt), is opening itself up to the creative powers of the tincture. Use your consciousness to imbue the Sea Salt with your heart's intention and life-force energy (Mercury) as well as the spiritual essence of your soul's incantation (Sulphur). Specific Breath Incantations or spiritual mantras are still used during the "imbibition" process to increase the stones power.
- On the appropriate planetary day and hour, begin the imbibing process with a dropper, first with grain alcohol until saturated, and then with essential oil. Continue this process for as long as you like, or stop after one full hour (either planetary or secular). Repeat several times, and proceed as discussed in the previous method.

SEA SALT AND ALCHEMY

Modern salt refineries are indebted to the ancient alchemists for many of their methods. The sea and its symbols have been rich inspiration for alchemists and mystics of all periods. The salty waters of Eaux-Meres, or "Mother Waters", is the basis of our plasma, amniotic water, and all of our body fluids. For this reason, only sea salt which is naturally refined and collected (i.e. organic) is suitable for this work. Salt mined from deep inland, or strip-mined off the beaches is "alchemically polluted" and will not do for this work of rejuvenation. Salt produced in the slow, natural manner contains over 84 trace minerals, many of which are absent when the speedier more economically methods of mass production are employed.

CONCLUSION

Alchemy is a lifelong process. The procedures outlined here are sufficient to keep an aspiring spagyrist busy for at least a year or more. Spagyric medicines when taken over time have an accumulative effect. While the individual dose may wear off after a week or so, each time it is ingested the organs of spiritual perception are expanded a little more. Like any study worth undertaking, patience, confidence, and faith are important tools needed to complete the project.

Therefore, before engaging in any of the experiments outlined in this chapter, read and reread the material several times with a notebook nearby. Outline the steps in each technique, and place them on the front page of your notebook. When performing the experiments, pay attention to your notes, and write down each step as you take it. Compare your list with the steps described in this chapter, as well as the steps listed in your notebook.

This is designed to get you in the habit of noting down what you do, and how you do it; so that later on, if you decide to do more complex experiments, the required safety and notation habits will have already been formed. As stated earlier, plant work is relatively safe, if you mis-label something you can throw it out or test it under your tongue. Metallic work however, is much less forgiving. Good habits formed early last a lifetime and save a lot of work. As one becomes imbued with the alchemical theory and transformation of plant essences, the unintelligible language of nature becomes clearer, then luminous.

Never attempt an alchemical experiment if you don't know the objective, the procedure, and the desired result. In Chinese Alchemy, there is no random experimentation, nor is an experiment made out of mere curiosity.

Using Plant Stones For Protection

In ancient China, Daoist priests would sometimes create nine magical Plant Stones and use them for the energetic protection of a home, temple, or monastery. In this magical practice, nine protective stones were energetically imprinted and used as nine magical Guardian Stones. When strategically placed along the property, these nine Guardian Stones created a protective energetic grid, the energy of which was then used in order to create a magical canopy that would envelop and protect any person, place, or thing existing within the grid's energetic boundaries. This powerful energetic grid could also be used for creating a healing energetic field, as well as for creating an energetic field that is used to induce the deep meditative states needed in spiritual transformation practice.

Magical Herbs Used for Making Protective Plant Stones

In order to create the nine magical Plant Stones used in energetic protection, a priest would first choose specific herbs that had powerful protective qualities (i.e. herbs that were traditionally used in Daoist rituals for removing and banishing ghosts, evil spirits, and demons). Some examples of these powerful types of magical herbs include: Ai Ye (Mugwort), An Xi Xiang (Benzoinum), Du Shen Qie (Mandrake), E Wei (Asafoetida), He Bao Mu Dan (Fumitory), Huang Shui Xian (Daffodil), Luo Le (Basil), Alum (Ming Fan), Niu Bang (Burdock), Ou Long Ya Cao (Agrimony), Ru Xiang (Frankincense), Shi (Yarrow), Sheng Ma (Balck Cohosh), Yan (Sea Salt), Yao Yong Shi Can (Betony), Yi Mu Cao (Motherwort), Yuan Dang Gui (Angelica), Yue Gui Shu (Bay Leaf), Yu Zhu Ya Ma (Blue Flax), and Xie Gen Shu (Bryony).

It is important to note that before constructing nine magical Plant Stones out of the above named herbs, sometimes magical elixir water was constructed out of specific magical stones (i.e., Fire Agate, Amber, Amethyst, Jade, or Jet) chosen for their protective properties. The stone elixir water was energetically Imprinted, and then combined with the magical herbs and used to create the nine Guardian Stones.

The Gate-Keeper Stone

The primary Guardian Stone of the property was known as the "Gate-Keeper" Stone. This powerful magical stone or plant was placed at the main entrance area of the property and used as an energetic sentry. According to magical tradition, any person, animal, or spirit entity wishing to harm an individual living within the protected home, temple, or monastery had to first overpower the guardian of that area before the antagonist could proceed.

Traditionally, the Gate-Keeper Stone was energetically and spiritually attached to the magical power of a strong, wrathful Guardian Deity. This Guardian Deity had been summoned by the Daoist priest and had committed itself to exist on the property as the protector of the individuals who currently lived within the particular home, temple, or monastery. Because of the immense power needed in order to establish and maintain this type of energetic sanctuary, the Gate-Keeper Stone (used to magically secure the property's guardian) was different in energetic construction then the other nine Guardian Stones (used to magically create the property's force-field). For example, the planetary herbs, plants, and minerals used in the construction of the Gate-Keeper Stone is specific to the type of spirit guardian summoned to oversee the protection of the home, temple, or monastery. Each type of spirit guardian requires a different form of energetic correspondence, designed according to the spirit entity's specific ruling Element, direction, constellation, planet, and power.

In most Chinese temples, there are fierce statues, wall carvings, or wall paintings of Guardian Deities positioned in the entry ways. These fierce statues represent the temple's or monastery's Gate-Keepers. What most people don't know is that buried underneath these statues (or sometimes within the very fabric of the carved warrior's image) are the temple's Gate-Keeper Stones. Once the temple's Gate-Keeper Stones have been put in placed, a secret ritual is performed and a living animal is sacrificed (usually a rooster or chicken), offerings are presented, along with blood-wine and burnt incense. Then, the blood of the sacrificed animal is used to dot the eyes of the statue and summon in powerful Guardian Spirit into the carving or painting to act as a protector of the area.

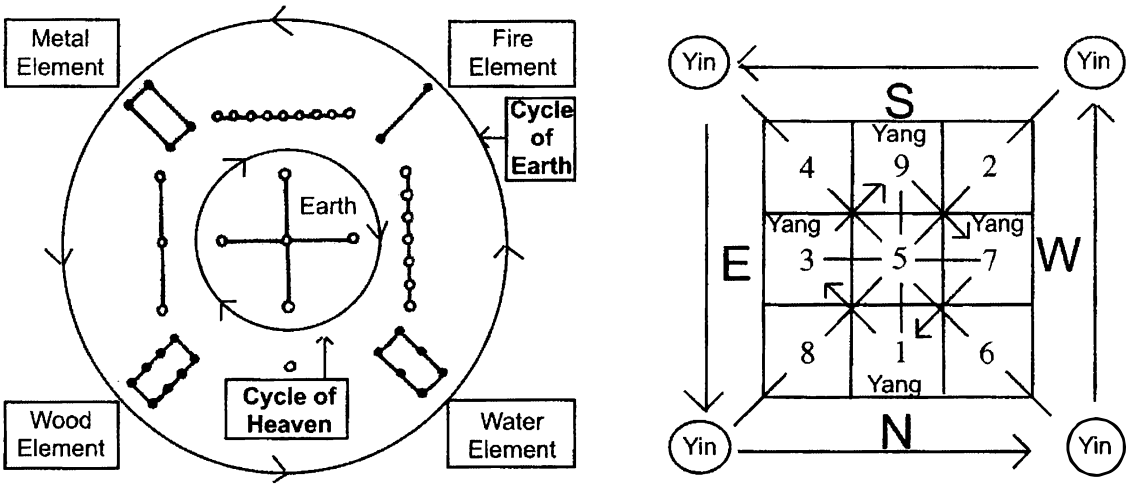


Figure 1.350. The energetic movement of the Nine Palaces of the Magic Square (Nine Celestial Palaces), according to the ancient Daoist design of the Luo River Graph

MAGICAL PATTERN OF THE ENERGETIC GRID

After constructing the Gate-Keeper Stone and the nine magical Guardian Stones, the priest will direct his or her attention onto energetically designing the specific type of magical grid that would be most beneficial to the people living in the home, temple, or monastery.

In ancient China, there were two main patterns used by Daoist priests in constructing this type of magical grid: The magical pattern of the Magic Square, and the magical pattern of the Eight Trigram Formation. Each of these energetic patterns contained nine specific power positions which are needed for the placement of the nine Guardian Stones.

- **The Magic Square (Nine Celestial Palaces):** The Magic Square's energetic pattern represents the various positions of the Nine Celestial Palaces. According to the ancient Daoist design of the Luo River Graph (Figure 1.350), this magical pattern expresses the energetic movement of Yin and Yang, the Five Elements, the Cycles of Heaven, and the Cycles of Earth, and the Ten Directions of Space (North, South, East, West, Northeast, Northwest, Southeast, Southwest, Up, and Down).
- **The Eight Trigram Formation (Prenatal Bagua):** The Eight Trigram's energetic pattern represents the various positions of the Eight

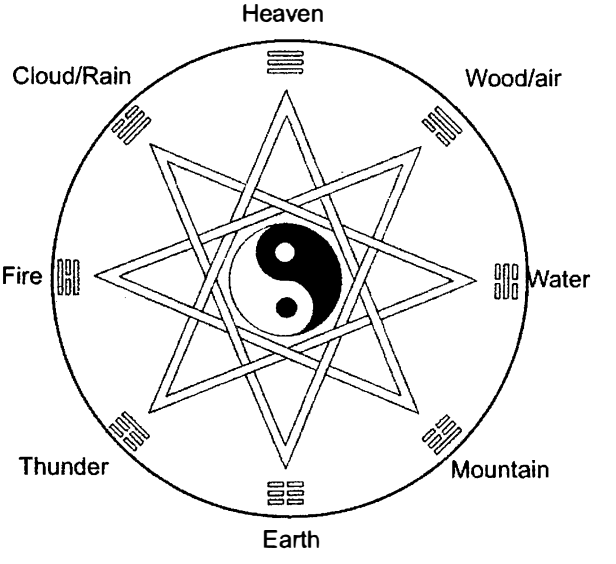


Figure 1.351. The energetic movement of the Nine Prenatal Bagua Pattern, according to the ancient Daoist design of the Fu Xi

Powers of Creation surrounding the central transformative energy of the Taiji Pole. According to the ancient Daoist magical design of Fu Xi (Figure 1.351), this energetic pattern expresses the movement of eight dimensions of energy in Yin and Yang harmony, which are responsible for the creation of all phenomena.

This magical cycle of harmony relates to the world of thoughts and ideas. This magical pattern expresses the energetic movement of Yin and Yang, the Five Elements, the Eight Trigram Powers (Heaven, Cloud/Rain, Fire, Thunder, Earth, Mountain, Water, and Wood/air), and the Ten Directions of Space (North, South, East, West, Northeast, Northwest, Southeast, Southwest, Up, and Down).

Constructing the Energetic Grid

When creating a powerful energetic net to magically protect a property, the ancient Daoists would first energetically superimposed either the Nine Palace positions of the Magic Square or the Eight Trigram positions of the Bagua onto the property. After the property had been divided into nine segments, next, the Gate-Keeper Stone was placed in the entry-way to the property. Once the guardian of the Gate-Keeper Stone had been summoned and commissioned as a sentry, then, each of the nine Guardian Stones were activated and placed into one of eight positions surrounding the property, with the center position placed last.

The magical fields of the nine Guardian Stones were then fused together and used in order to create an energetic net or magical fence (Figure 1.352). This magical fence was then fused to the center position (also known as the Ming Tang or Bright Hall) of the property, which acted as the center pillar and Taiji Pole of the Magic Square or Bagua.

Finally, the priest connected and fused the energy of the center position to the celestial powers of the Heavens above, rooting it to the Celestial Pole Star. Then, the center position was anchored to the energetic fields under the Earth, rooting it to the Earth's center core. This completed the magical ritual.

Performing the Magical Ritual

After determining which energetic pattern is needed to adequately construct a powerful protective force field (either the Magic Square or the Eight Trigram pattern), the priest begins the magical ritual by energetically activating and placing the Gate-Keeper Stone into the entrance area of the property. This is accomplished by the priest first ringing a bell or shaking a Demon Screamer (Figure 1.353) in

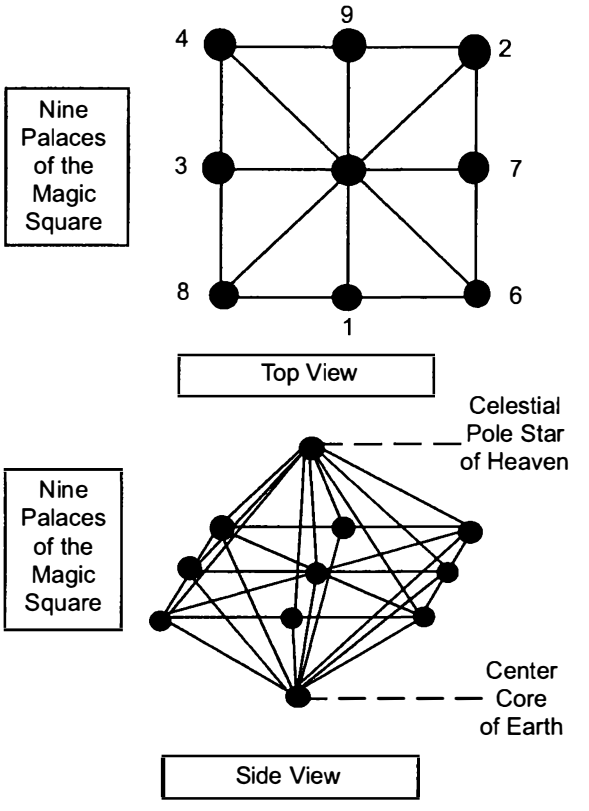


Figure 1.352. The energetic canopy of the Nine Palaces of the Magic Square

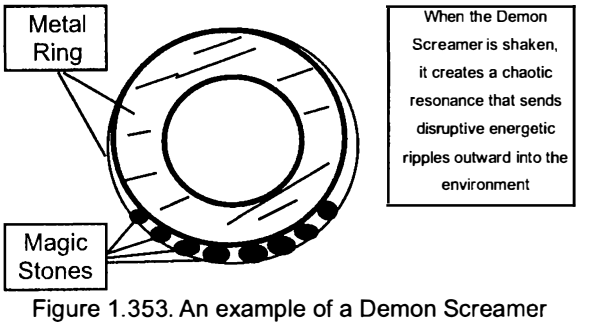


Figure 1.353. An example of a Demon Screamer used in Daoist exorcism for purifying an area

order to clear and purify the environmental energy contained within the soil of the Earth. As the bell is rung (or Demon Screamer shaken), the priest will speak a powerful purification incantation while directing his or her intention through the magical tool into the ground. The sound is used to pierce the

physical, energetic, and spiritual realms of the soil. It not only removes Evil Qi and purifies the surrounding area, but it is also used to attract the Celestial Guardian Deity to the area. At this point in the magical ritual, the priest will summon and acknowledge the presence of the Guardian Deity associated with the Gate-Keeper Stone, and will request it to stay and remain as the guardian and protector of this particular home, temple, or monastery.

Then, the priest will use the magical peach-wood sword to pierce the soil and "Open the Earth," while exhaling the magical incantation "Kai" (which translates as "open"). While creating a small magical cave through which to bury and seal the Gate-Keeper Stone (Figure 1.354), the priest will simultaneously speak an incantation signifying "Heaven's Mandate" for the protection of those living within this sacred place.

Once the Gate-Keeper Stone has been buried, the priest will then draw his or her magical seal over the ground above the buried magical stone. The talismanic seal that is used in this part of the magical ritual is one of the 24 magical seals presented to the Daoist priest at the time of his or her "Lu" ordination. This magical seal carries the ancestral backing and magical power of the priest's personal Daoist lineage.

Once the Gate-Keeper Stone has been activated and buried, the priest will begin the process of activating and then burying all of the nine Guardian Stones. This magical process is needed in order to create the property's protective energetic net.

THE ACTIVATION PROCESS

At each of the nine designated areas, the priest must energetically activate and bury one of the Guardian Stones. In order to begin the process of activating and burying the magical stones, the priest will proceed as follows:

- First, the priest rings the bell or shakes the Demon Screamer in order to clear and purify the environmental energy contained within the soil of the Earth. As the bell is rung (or Demon Screamer shaken), the priest will speak a powerful purification incantation while directing his or her intention through the magical tool into the ground. The sound is used to pierce and cleanse the physical, energetic, and spiritual realms of the soil.
- Then, with the left hand holding the magical peach-wood sword, positioned over the Lower Dantian, the priest takes his or her right hand and places one of the Guardian Stones below the naval in front of the Lower Dantian and says "Xu Bi" ("it is necessary, allow and permit"). It is important that the priest focus on the Guardian Stone's ability to energetically effect, influence and protect the physical, realm.
- Next, the priest moves his or her right hand and places the same Guardian Stone at the heart and Middle Dantian area and says "Xu Bi" ("it is necessary, allow and permit"). It is important that the priest focus on the Guardian Stone's ability to energetically effect, influence and protect the energetic realm.
- Then, the priest moves his or her right hand and places the same Guardian Stone at the Third Eye and Upper Dantian area and says "Xu Bi" ("it is necessary, allow and permit"). It is important that the priest focus on the Guardian Stone's ability to energetically effect, influence and protect the spirit realm.
- Next, the priest moves his or her right hand and places the same Guardian Stone above his or her head and imagines extending the right arm into the heavens, carrying the Guardian Stone into the upper celestial realm.

Figure 1.354. The magical peach-wood sword is used to pierce the soil in order to "Open the Earth" and make way for the Gate-Keeper Stone.

Figure 1.355. Perform three standing kowtows

Figure 1.356. Point towards the Heavens

Once the priest feels that he or she has reached the upper celestial realms, the priest will slowly twist his or her body clockwise (like turning a key) and imagine that a magical portal is opening up within the Heavens. As this magical portal begins to energetically open, the priest will turn the Guardian Stone while says "Kai Xing" ("open its form"), "Kai Qi" ("open its energy"), and "Kai Shen" ("open its spirit").

Then, the priest will imagine the magical Guardian Stone opening its physical matrix (Wuzhi) on all three levels (the physical, energetic, and spiritual), becoming imprinted with celestial protective power.

- Next, the priest will use the magic peach-wood sword to pierce the soil in order to "Open the Earth" and make way for the Guardian Stone. When piercing the soil, it is important that the edge of the priest's sword face the direction of the center of the Magic Square or center of the Bagua circle.

  As the priest pierces the soil, he or she will exhale the word "Kai" ("open"). Then, when placing the Guardian Stone into the Earth, the priest will say the following magical incantation, "From holy place, to holy place make this a holy place." After speaking the incantation, the priest will cover the Guardian Stone with the soil. Once the Guardian Stone is buried, the priest will write his or her magical seal over the ground above the magical stone.
- After, the priest has activated, placed, and covered the Guardian Stone into the Earth, he or she will offer three standing kowtows (three bows with the hands placed over the heart) and mentally say "thank you, thank you, thank you" (Figure 1.355)
- The priest will perform this ritual nine times, once at each of the nine areas.
- Finally, after all nine Guardian Stone have been activated, placed, and buried within the nine areas surrounding property, the priest will go to the middle of the home, temple, or monastery area (i.e., position Number Five of the Magic Square or center of the Bagua Trigrams) and use his or her magic peach-wood sword to energetically connect all of the surrounding eight areas together, linking them to the center ninth point. This energetically creates the webbing of the magical net.
- Next the priest will point his or her magic peach-wood sword towards the Heavens and, while speaking a magical incantation, links the center on the top of the magical net to the Pole Star (Figure 1.356).
- Then, the priest will point his or her magic sword towards the Earth and, while speaking a magical incantation, link the center of the bottom of the magical net to the Earths center core. This final action not only stabilizes the energetic net, but it also suspends it between the energetic powers of Heaven and Earth.

USING HERBS TO CREATE DAOIST TALISMAN PAPER

One well kept secret of ancient Daoist Magic is the technique of using magical herbs to create Talismanic Paper. When making Talismanic Paper, the following herbs (Figure 1.357) were traditionally mixed during the paper creating process in order to help activate the spell and contain the magical incantations that were projected through the calligraphy pen and through the Daoist priest's Breath.

- 30% Huang Bai (Phellodendri Cortex)
- 30% Ming Fan (Alumen)
- 40% Bing Pian (Borneol)

In modern China, the best and most popular type of calligraphy paper used in Daoist monasteries is Xuan (Shuyantse). This type of talismanic paper is divided into two main colors, red and yellow, described as follows:

- **Red Talismanic Paper:** This type of calligraphy paper is used for talismans that are constructed to guard homes, banish evil spirits, and cure sickness. These magical talismans can be hung on the walls of monasteries, homes, and offices, or they can be placed on different parts of the body in order to heal and cure disease or remove evil spirits and curses.
- **Yellow Talismanic Paper:** This type of calligraphy paper is used for talismans that are constructed for Daoist rituals in order to "Offer Petitions to Heaven," or for balancing the energy within the environment (Feng Shui Talismans).

The alchemical properties of these herbal papers are transformed during the burning process of the talisman and can then be placed into the Altar Cup water in order to create Fu Shui or "Talismanic Water." This magical water was then used to either heal the sick or bring a specific type of blessing to an individual and his or her family. Talismanic Water consists of creating a talisman on the red paper, and then empowering the talisman with Qi and Shen through Breath Incantations to energetically activate it. The paper is then burned (Ceremonial Moxacautery) and its ashes are placed into the water.

Figure 1.357. Herbs used in constructing Talismans

Creating Talismanic Water requires the Daoist priest to perform a magical ritual using the summoned powers of the Air, Water, Fire, and Earth Elements. The energy and power of these four Elements are combined in ritual by using three separate prayers, described as follows:

- First, the Holy Water is prayed over using magical Breath Incantations. The Holy Water is then placed on top of the Earth Altar table. This represents the magical fusion of the powers of the Air and Water Elements.
- Next the magical talisman is constructed, prayed over, and then burnt. This represents the activation of the magical powers of the Fire Element.
- The ashes of the talisman (representing the magical powers of the Earth Element) are then gathered and placed into the Holy Water, which is again prayed over one last time.
- The magical water is then either given to the patient to drink, or sprinkled onto the patient's body. The ancient Daoists believed that when drunk, the power of the specific deity summoned by the magical talisman would enter into the patient's body from the water and fight off the evil spirit that caused the illness.
- If a blessing was being invoked through the Talismanic Water, then the individual would only take three sips from the Alter Cup followed by prayer, offering incense, and kowtowing three times.

Using Herbs To Load Daoist Altar Statues

In ancient China, one of the most secret magical practices performed within a Daoist temple required the Senior Abbot and his priests to fill and energetically "load" the hollow altar statues of the temples patron saints and celestial immortals (i.e., The Three Pure Ones, Celestial Master, etc.). The special magical ingredients that were placed inside these hollow altar statues were traditionally held as one of the greatest kept secrets in Daoist magic.

According to ancient Daoist magic tradition, special talismans, herbs, minerals, and other esoteric materials were secretly energized, magically activated, and then inserted inside the altar statue. This special energetic loading and magical imprinting allowed the lifeless statue to become "alive," and exist within the temple as a powerful living icon. The altar statue was then viewed as an energetic representation of the supernatural powers of the honored celestial deity.

Depending on the Daoist sect, before filling and loading an altar statue, various types of magic rituals had to be performed. These special magic rituals were used to first remove any unwanted spirit entity and then energetically clean the altar room.

Next, the priest had to create a powerful energetic vortex in order to magically "open" the energetic matrix of the altar statue and infuse it with the divine energy of a particular deity or celestial immortal.

After filling and loading the altar statue, the Daoist priest would then perform the "Opening the Light" (Kai Guang) magic ritual. This special magic ritual was used in order to energetically activate and empower the statue of the deity, by inviting and "calling down" the divine spirit of whomever the altar image was cast.

It is important to note that this same magic ritual can also be used to summon spirits of the dead into a carved or forged statue, ancestor tablet, or effigy (i.e., a paper, straw, or bamboo image), to be used to symbolically represent the body of a deceased individual.

Function of Loading Statues

The ritual process involved in filling and energetically loading an altar statue personally connects the temple priests to the sacred object they are activating. According to ancient teachings, there are great magical benefits for a priest's body (Jing), speech (Qi), and mind (Shen) when he practices the ritual of filling and loading an altar statue. For example, it is written that the ritual process of filling and loading an altar statue helps to transform how the priest physically, energetically, and spiritually relates to the cast bronze statue. During this important energetic transformation process, the statue itself becomes a resonating body of divine light, and not just a mere metal shell.

When performed correctly, the special loading ritual allows the prayers and incantations used to imprint the altar statue to remain contained inside its physical structure, vibrating within its center core. After the final dedication and activation rituals have been performed, the energies of the prayers and incantations will continue to resonate inside the altar statue, acting as a powerful magical tool that can be used to transform people's minds.

Preparing the Loading

First, the priest must clean the inside and outside of the statue, and remove any and all forms of impurities created from the casting process.

Next, specially prepared magical ingredients such as gems, herbs, talismans, and corresponding planetary metals are all placed inside the altar statue, and then magically sealed. These special ingredients are used to represent the altar statues corresponding energetic connections related to the various magical realms. For example, special minerals, plants, insect parts, animal parts, and human parts are specifically chosen to represent the Three Realms of Heaven, Earth, and Man.

The final stage of energetic "loading" occurs when the altar statue is magically dedicated, opened, and activated by the senior Daoist priest. After the Senior Priest has activated the altar statue, he immediately invites the ultimate awareness of the celestial deity to enter into and merge with the altar statue.

THE INGREDIENTS

The magic rituals and esoteric ingredients used for filling altar statues are specific to each Daoist sect. Each lineage has its own magical incantations, that are used with the gathering and placing of the special ingredients. The following is but one example of the various ingredients used during this secret magical ritual:

Figure 1.358. Hai Ma (Sea Horse)

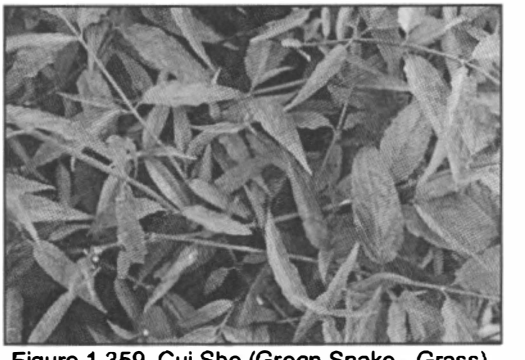


Figure 1.359. Cui She (Green Snake - Grass)

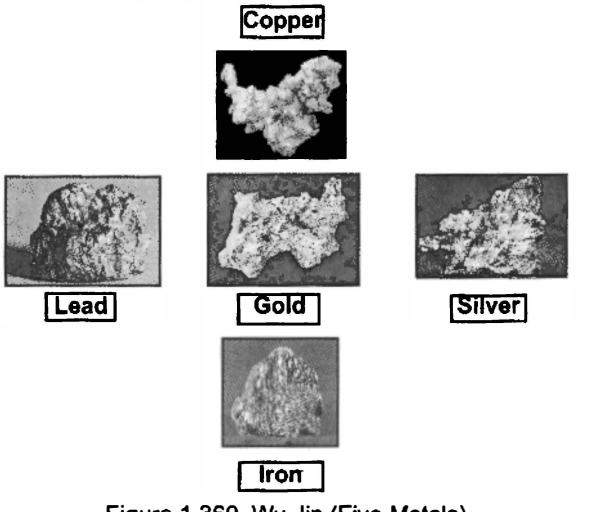


Figure 1.360. Wu Jin (Five Metals)

Magical Herbs Used for Loading the Altar Statue:

Depending on the size of the Altar Statue, the priest will traditionally use 20 grams for each item. It is important to be flexible in application, as the larger, heavy items may require a different quantity than the smaller and lighter Altar Statues. The most important quality is to establish a good balance of all of the magical ingredients.

1. Hai Ma (Sea Horse): The Sea Horse is a form of Pipe Fish or Sea Dragon (Figure 1.358). It is therefore associated with the Water Element. When used in Chinese Medicine, it helps to stimulate the Liver and Kidney Channels, increase Yang Qi, and Invigorate the Blood. In Daoist Magic, the Sea Horse corresponds to the magical realm of Scaly Creatures, and is sometimes used in order to represent the magical powers of the Dragon. Traditionally, the priest would place a special type of dried Sea Horse at the base of the statue, facing the direction of the East.

2. Cui She (Green Snake-Grass): Also known as Snake Grass, this special medicinal herb belongs to the family of Acanthaceae. It is well known for its anti-snake and anti-scorpion venom healing benefit, especially among folk healers (Figure 1.359).

When researched, the plant's extract exhibits antityphoid and anti-fungal activities. It is traditionally used as a powerful drug for clearing away evil-heat, expelling superficial evils, and diminishing inflammation. It is also very effective when used to treat upper respiratory tract infections.

3. Wu Jin (Five Metals): The ancient Daoists believed that the Five Elements were energetically linked to the Five Metals, Five Colors, Five Directions, and to the Five Planets, described as follows (Figure 1.360):

- **Gold:** Corresponds to the Yellow Color, Center Direction, Earth Element, and the Planet Saturn.
- **Silver:** Corresponds to the White Color, West Direction, Metal Element, and the Planet Venus.
- **Lead:** Corresponds to the Blue / Green Color, East Direction, Wood Element, and the Planet Jupiter.
- **Copper:** Corresponds to the Red Color, South Direction, Fire Element, and the Planet Mars.
- **Iron:** Corresponds to the Black Color, North Direction, Water Element, and the Planet Mercury.

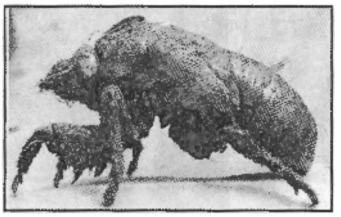


Figure 1.361. Chan Ke (Cicada Shell)

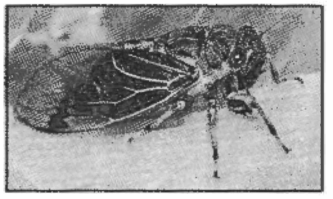


Figure 1.362. A "Singing" Cicada

4. Chan Ke (Cicada Shell): More commonly called "Chan Tui," the Cicada Shell is an ancient symbol of transformation (Figure 1.361). In the Chinese classic "Journey to the West," the "Priest of Tang" was named the "Golden Cicada;" in this context, the multiple shedding of the cicada shell symbolizes the many stages of transformation required of a person, before all illusions have been broken and he reaches enlightenment.

The interior of the male abdomen is substantially hollow to amplify the resonance of the "singing" sound (Figure 1.362). A cicada rapidly vibrates these membranes, and enlarged chambers derived from the tracheae make its body serve as a resonance chamber, greatly amplifying the sound. The male cicada modulates the sound by positioning its abdomen toward or away from the substrate. In ancient Daoist Alchemy, the disciple would listen for the sound of "One Thousand Cicada's Singing" before he would begin his Spirit Travel Training.

5. Feng Zi (Bee): From an ancient Chinese perspective, the Golden Yellow Bee (Figure 1.363), is the bringer of spiritual gifts (honey and wax), and is responsible for the natural energetic transformation of Earth-substance. When I was training at the Mao Shan Monastery in 2004, one of my teachers told me of the magical correspondences

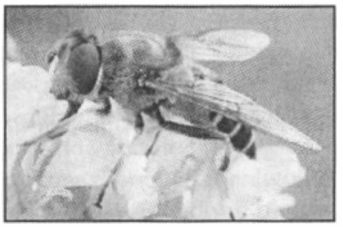


Figure 1.363. Feng Zi (Bee)

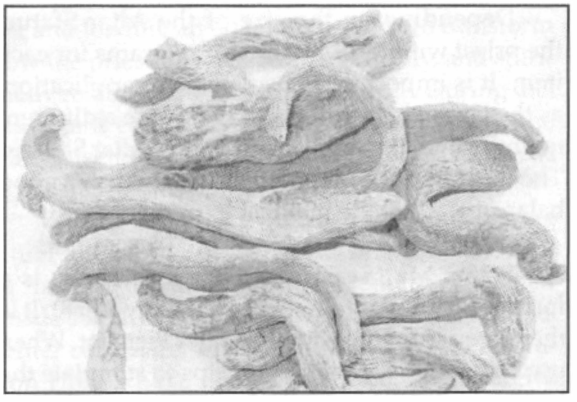


Figure 1.364. Tian Ma (Heavenly Hemp)

existing between the energy attracting the "Bees to a Hive," and the "Daoist Disciples to the teachings of Laozi." The sound of a Bee is not only the energetic manifestation of the Spirit Body entering into a higher resonance within the disciple's energy field, but it is also viewed as a symbolic representation of the Daoist priest's desire to achieve the pure sweetness of a spiritual walk, only acquired through persistent application.

When using a Bee as a magical ingredient for Loading the Altar Statue, it can either be inserted dead or alive. If the priest chooses to use dead bees, he should choose about 5- grams; If he chooses to use live bees, then he should only use 2 or 3 of the Golden Yellow insects.

6. Tian Ma (Heavenly Hemp): Heavenly Hemp (Gastrodia elata Blume), refers to the tuber of an orchid (Figure 1.364). Gastrodia was originally listed in the ancient *Shennong Bencao Jing* (written in 100 A.D.), and was later classified by Tao Hong as a "Superior Herb," meaning that it could be taken for a long time to protect the health and

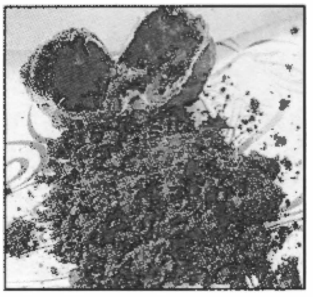


Figure 1.365. She Xiang (Musk Deer)

Figure 1.366. Gan Cao (Licorice Root)

prolong life. Gastrodia has been included in the Chinese Materia Medica, and over the centuries, many Daoist priests have attributed Gastrodia to possessing magical properties (such as giving strength and virility, improving circulation and memory, and expelling all kinds of poisons from the body).

7. She Xiang (Deer Musk): Musk comes from the wild Musk Deer (Figure 1.365), which ranges throughout China and much of Mongolia.

The musk is produced in the "musk pod," a gland located in a pouch or sac under the abdomen of the male musk deer. Traditionally, the musk pod is harvested, dried in the open air, and then cut open, revealing a small, oval-shaped kernel. The main chemical compound in musk is muscone, which gives musk its distinctive, persistent odor.

In Daoist Magic, Deer Musk corresponds to the Yang (masculine) Divine Energy, and represents the subliminal, psychological aspect of this energetic sphere. It also represents the spiritual principle of Divine Wisdom, although we experience it as a stimulant to the libido, its dynamic outpouring of energy also corresponds with the Third Eye, and is associated with deep meditation.

In ancient Daoist magical tradition, Deer Musk is among the few scents that are used to connect a disciple to the highest valued consciousness, including creative genius, awakened spiritual energy, magical transformation, and stimulated libido.

Deer Musk is also identified with the Earth aspect of Saturn, and working with spirit entities. According to ancient Daoist belief, Deer Musk renders its handler invisible to the lower energies of certain individuals. Among its many magical qualities are increased health, vitality, longevity, and sexual potency.

Traditionally, it is considered to be most powerful when used in Love Potions, Aphrodisiacs, and Sex Magic. When Deer Musk is carried around for stimulating sexual appeal, it mixes with the handler's own pheromones, making him or her extremely attractive.

8. Gan Cao (Licorice Root): Since ancient times, Chinese Licorice Root (Figure 1.366) has been used for energetically harmonizing the other ingredients in an herbal formula. It is also traditionally used as a "carrying agent," to lead and conduct the healing energy of the other herbs in the formula throughout the Twelve Primary Channels.

When Licorice Root is placed inside an Altar Statue, it is traditionally used for Protection Magic. In ancient times, Licorice Root was sometimes buried in the tombs of the deceased, in order to protect the Soul on its journey. It was also placed in magical amulets in order to expel toxins, poisons, and negative energy from the body. The same energy that created an energetic barrier around the magical practitioner, also provided a protective field around the Altar Statue.

Licorice Root is also used in making erotic incense. It is specifically used for heightening body awareness and acts as an aphrodisiac. It is commonly used in Daoist Sex Magic, and the root is often chewed for increasing sexual potency.

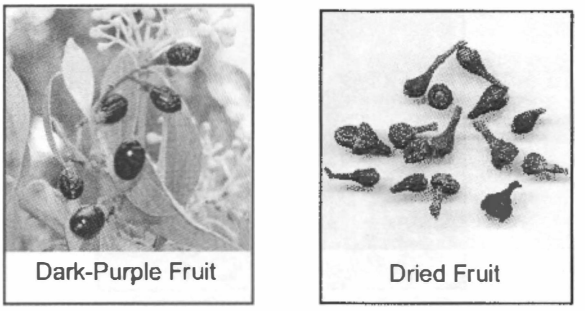


Figure 1.2367 Gui Zi (Cinnamon Fruit)

9. Gui Zi (Cinnamon Fruit): The Cinnamon Tree has Golden Red Bark, that is dried and is the cinnamon spice. Its new foliage is commonly deep red, with small white flowers that are followed by Dark-Purple fruit. The fruit is used dried and unripened, for cooking and they are similar to cloves (Figure 1.367).

This Cinnamon Tree is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Fire, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun. The Cinnamon Tree is also closely associated with the myth of Heng'O ("Moon Goddess") and the "Moon Hare" ("Jade Rabbit").

10. Bai She (White Tongue): Also known as "Bai Hua She She Cao," this herb was not mentioned in the classic herbals, but has been a popular folk medicine that was later reported in books and medical records after the Chinese revolution. Bai Hua She She Cao is known as the common weed (Figure 1.368), used for treating the venomous bite of a viper. Because of the appearance of the leaves, it is sometimes called "She Cao" ("Tongue Weed"); referring to the long thin leaves of the herb that are shaped like a snake's tongue.

It is extensively used in modern Chinese Medical practice for the treatment of viral infections, and used as a preventive measure against toxic heat diseases.

What is special about the Oldenlandia Corymbosa herb, is that it has auto-fluorescence abilities. Meaning, that its biological structures possess the natural ability to emit light. According to modern research, in a few cases, auto-fluorescence actually illuminated the structures of interest.

Figure 1.368. Bai She (White Tongue)

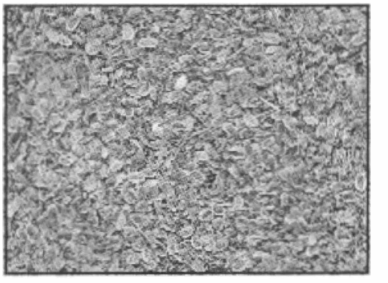


Figure 1.369. Qian Li Yan (Eyes That See 1,000 Miles)

11. Qian Li Yan (Eyes See 1,000 Miles): The term "Qian Li Yan" ("Eyes that See a Thousand Li"), is an ancient saying used in to describe the magical effects that Mongolian Thyme had on a shaman's spirit eyes (Figure 1.369). In Daoist Magic, Mongolian Thyme is sometimes used to induce psychic vision (it is said that if you wear Mongolian Thyme, you will be able to see Nature Spirits). It is also used to help the Daoist priest energetically attune himself to the future lives of his patients, and to project and observe past or future events when performing magical divinations.

Mongolian Thyme cleanses and renews the spirit, and calls divine forces to one's side. It is said that submerging oneself in a bath containing Mongolian Thyme Oil is sometimes needed for serious purification, especially after having performed an Exorcism, or when coming in contact with a malevolent spirit of the dead, or a rotting dead corpse.

Mongolian Thyme is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature; it is associated with the Water Element, and its planetary correspondence

is Venus. It is also used to cleanse and renew the spirit, and calls divine forces to one's side.

Because it is used to remove all sorrows and ills of the past year, it is often burned in magic rituals as an incense, for the purification of the magical space.

When added to magical elixirs, Mongolian Thyme is generally used in combination with other magical ingredients (i.e., primarily used to amplify the magical powers of other herbs). When Mongolian Thyme is placed inside an Altar Statue, it is traditionally used for Protection Magic, especially from the negative energy of others.

12. Shun Feng Er (Ears That Hear The Wind): The term "Shun Feng Er" ("Ears That Hear The Wind"), is an ancient saying used to describe the effects that the Chinese Lobelia Herb had on a Daoist shaman when performing Weather Magic (Figure 1.370). It is considered to be an Element of Water, and it has the ability to facilitate a dreamy, relaxed state of mind. In Daoist Magic, Shun Feng Er is traditionally combined with other herbs and used for Altar Purification and Divination Rituals.

The primary uses for Chinese Lobelia can include the following:

Figure 1.370. Shun Feng Er (Ears That Hear The Wind)

- **Weather Magic:** By throwing the dried herb into the Wind while speaking a special magical incantations, or burning it during a magic ritual, the priest can summon the spirits of the Heavens (Sky) and ask for the manifestations of different types of weather.
- **Healing:** Sometimes known as Shun Feng Qi, the Chinese Lobelia Herb is commonly used in Chinese Medicine for treating snake-bite poisoning, centipede-bite poisoning, and bee or scorpion stings.
- **Love Magic:** It can be used for either initiating a love connection or creating a separation.
- **Nature Spirits:** It can be used for summoning or invoking Nature Spirits.

THE MAGICAL PROPERTIES OF TREES

Tree-worship was widely spread throughout China in ancient times. Many ancient shrines to local gods were often placed at the roots or in the fork of a tree that was known for its remarkable size and beauty. It was believed that the soul of the god resided in the tree, which was held as sacred. Wrapping the trees with garlands of flowers and brightly colored silk and decorating their branches with lanterns was part of the ancient rite of tree worship. Sometimes a strip of red cloth was attached to the tree in order to prevent evil spirits from possessing the tree, and vampire the energy that has been invested into the sacred altar area. It was also said that if anyone were to cut down or try to dig up the sacred tree, the guilty individual was liable to be executed.

In ancient times, many trees are known especially for their unique energetic and spiritual attributes. Each tree is a healer, but there are a few special trees that appeal to the human condition because of the special properties they embody. For example, the ancient Daoists believed that a village was protected against the demonic forces of the Universe, by having "5 Camps" ("Guardian Trees"). These were four enormous trees, located near the four corners of a village, and a center tree located in the middle of the town, near a temple. Each tree represented a supernatural soldier, and was considered to be the towns first line of defence against undesirable supernatural forces.

The trees below are especially important and have been used throughout history because of their healing and magical properties. The following is a brief description of various trees used in both Eastern and Western Magic. This list includes the trees' Yin or Yang potential, as well as their energetic effect on the body's internal organ system:

- **Alder (Yang):** This tree is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature (Figure 1.371). The energetic properties of this tree influence the priest's inner strength, confidence, and awareness. In ancient times, the Alder tree was associated with water and was believed to be a gathering place for water spirits. The leaves of an alder tree can be made into a tea to treat kidney problems.
- **Apple (Yin):** This tree is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Water, and its planetary correspondence is Venus (Figure 1.372). Apple is also associated with the powers of the Moon, and it is commonly used for making love spells. The energetic properties of this tree target the stomach and spleen. Apples produce fluids that lubricate the lungs, enhance digestion and detoxification, and increase the blood sugar level.
- **Ash (Yang):** This tree is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature, its Element cor-

Figure 1.371. The Alder Tree (Yang)

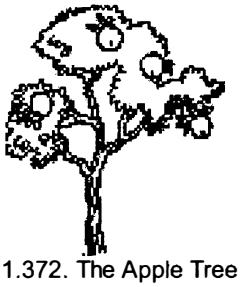


Figure 1.372. The Apple Tree (Yin)

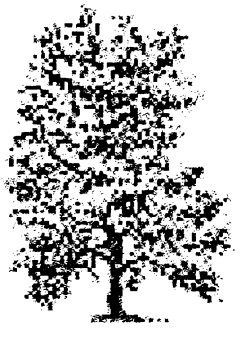


Figure 1.373. The Ash Tree (Yang)

responds to Fire, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun (Figure 1.373). Ash leaves are traditionally placed beneath a pillow in order to induce psychic dreams. The leaves are also said bring good luck and fortune when carried in a pocket or bag worn around the neck.

Ash tree leaves are said to prevent hexes and harm, to attract love, and to prevent others from making passes at your lover. Because it is one of the few woods that burn steadily and easily while still green, divination fires are often constructed out of green ash. It is commonly used in sea rituals and prosperity spells. Ash is especially valued for its ability to enable a priest to access the Three Worlds (Heaven, Earth and the Underworld). Mountain ash twigs were traditionally tied into knots to prevent evil spells and psychic attacks initiated from sorcerers and witchcraft. Ash is often used in making talismans, amulets, and magical tools.

- **Aspen (Yang):** This tree is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Air, and its planetary correspondence is the Mercury (Figure 1.374). The energetic properties of this tree target the lungs. White Aspen is considered to be one of the most powerful condensers of Yang Qi. This tree strongly influences clairvoyance and healing.
- **Bamboo (Yin):** This tree is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature. Bamboo was used in ancient China for strength and protection (Figure 1.375). It is an evergreen and therefore unchanging, hence it is also the symbol of old age. The energetic properties of this special tree target the heart, lungs, gall bladder, and stomach.

It is believed that the leaves of the bamboo droop because its "heart" is empty (in China, an empty heart is symbolic of modesty), therefore the bamboo symbolizes the virtue of modesty. Therefore, Bamboo "Throwing Sticks" were choosen and commonly used for magical Divination in most Daoist temples.

In Chinese, the word for "Bamboo" and the word for "prayer" sound alike. Therefore, incense sticks are traditionally constructed out of Bamboo shoots, in order to increase the magical effectiveness of a prayer. The incense stick is

Figure 1.374. The Aspen Tree (Yang)

Figure 1.375. The Bamboo Tree (Yin)

created by harvesting the bamboo from one of the Five Sacred Mountains which "contain blissful realms of magical bamboo forests." On an auspicious day, the bamboo facing the Southern direction are gathered and harvested while speaking magical incantations.

In ancient times, the Daoist priests summoned spirits by constructing magical bamboo flutes. Traditionally, the mouthpiece was attributed to "infinite space" and the energetic power of Heaven; while the base of the flute (gathered from where the roots meet the soil) was attributed to the energetic power of the Earth. It was believed that when a Daoist priest played this special Magic Flute, the hypnotic tones had the power to summon spirit entities. In order to create such a Magical Bamboo Flute, the secret name of the spirit entity was first carved onto the inside of the wooden instrument. Next, after the priest performed purification rites, he would then play an improvised melody in order to summon the spirit. Magic Flutes are sometimes painted or have carved motifs, which add to their symbolic meaning.

Figure 1.376. The Birch Tree (Yin)

Figure 1.377. The Cassia Tree (Yang)

- **Birch (Yin):** This tree is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Water, and its planetary correspondence is Venus (Figure 1.376). According to certain ancient traditions, Birch was used for protection from lightning, and its branches were used to exorcise spirit entities from animals and humans (gently strike possessed people or animals with birch to exorcise demonic spirits). Birch is valued as the tree of inception and beginnings. In many magical traditions, the birch was considered to be the tree of health, wisdom, and safety; its wood was used in baby cribs and cradles, and its twigs were kept in the house in order to ward off the "evil eye."

  Birch is traditionally used as a source of protective magic, and its twigs were kept in the house to turn aside psychic attacks and traveling clairvoyance from evil sorcerers. In certain traditions, Birch twigs were beaten into the ground and positioned along the boundaries of the property to drive away evil forces.

  Because the energetic properties of Birch are considered to be highly protective, in ancient times its bark was boiled in water, and then added to a bath in order to protective and energetically envelop a priest. Birch Bark can also be burned on charcoal in order to remove negative energies from the home or place of business.

  It is important to know and understand that the Birch tree spirit is held to be among one of the most dangerous Nature Spirits, empowered with the ability to inflict madness or death. Therefore those who have access to Birch should keep in mind its ability for protective magic but should utilize this skill with caution and respect. Priests who work with Nature Spirits sometimes find it useful to make magical staffs or wands of Birch to protect themselves against the more dangerous types of Nature Spirits. White Birch and Black Birch have similar magical energies and effects.

  The energetic properties of this tree can be used for good or evil, depending on the intentions of the priest. For example, in certain magical traditions, a priest wishing to do harm will drive a rusty nail into a Birch tree trunk while thinking of the individual that is to be injured. It is believed that the victim will then begin to grow weak and die. Additionally, a small piece of Birch bark can be applied to the brow of a person who is sweating, and it is said to also generate enough power to kill the victim.

- **Cassia (Yang):** This tree is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Fire, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun (Figure 1.377). The energetic property of this tree targets the spleen, kidneys, and urinary bladder. It is commonly known as Cinnamon. It has purifying and protective qualities, and is used to access solar power and the Fire Element.

  The cassia is an evergreen plant with bright yellow flowers that is sometimes incorrectly referred to as Chinese cinnamon.

The Cassia tree is closely associated with the myth of Heng'O ("Moon Goddess") and the "Moon Hare" ("Jade Rabbit").

Because the Chinese word for Cassia (Gui) has the same pronunciation as the word used for "high rank" (gui), the Cassia was used to represent success in the imperial examination system.

The image of both Cassia and peaches together represent "high rank" and "longevity." Additionally, the images of Cassia and the seeds of lotus, pomegranate, gourd together expresses the desire for many sons who will achieve high office.

Since ancient times, Chinese Licorice Root has been used for energetically harmonizing the other ingredients in an herbal formula. It is also traditionally used as a "carrying agent," to lead and conduct the healing energy of the other herbs in the formula throughout the Twelve Primary Channels.

When Licorice Root is placed inside an Altar Statue, it is traditionally used for Protection Magic. In ancient times, Licorice Root was sometimes buried in the tombs of the deceased, in order to protect the Soul on it's journey. It was also placed in magical amulets in order to expel toxins, poisons, and negative energy from the body. The same energy that created an energetic barrier around the magical practitioner, also provided a protective field around the Altar Statue.

Licorice Root is also used in making erotic incense. It is specifically used for heightening body awareness and acts as an aphrodisiac. It is commonly used in Daoist Sex Magic, and the root is often chewed for increasing sexual potency.

- **Cedar (Yang):** This tree is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Fire, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun (Figure 1.378). The energetic property of Cedar targets the kidneys and can have a diuretic effect on the body. Cedar also provides relief from bronchitis, colds, and arthritis.

Figure 1.378. The Cedar Tree (Yang)

Cedars were considered to be the trees of paradise in the Mid-East, the symbols of faithful lovers in China, and are still held sacred in Nepal. Ceders, like Yews, were commonly planted around cemeteries to symbolize eternal life, and also to keep the ghosts of the dead in their graves. The Ceder's intense fiery energy is a powerful tool for purification; used to banish hostile spirits, it is an invaluable tool in exorcism. It is also used as a powerful tool for attaining magical powers, and is used to draw Earth energy and for grounding.

It is said that Cedar can be used to stimulate or strengthen the psychic powers, attract love, and prevent nightmares. In magical rituals Cedar is used for Purification, Consecration, Protection, Hex-breaking, Healing, Prophecy, and Prosperity.

Cedar and Maple bark can be combined and powdered while speaking magical incantations; depending on the incantation, the powder can then be used as an incense for Healing, Courage, Purification, Protection, or Prosperity. Cedar and White Sandalwood can be similarly combined, powdered, and then used as an incense for Purification or Protection. Cedar can also be used in love sachets.

Cedar encourages the flow of Qi, and eliminates physical, mental, and emotional blockages and toxins. Because Cedar has a way of keeping the psychic channels open while protecting the priest, it is sometimes use to anoint the Third Eye or is burned to induce psychic powers. It cleanses and purifies the body, skin, and the environment from all negativity and stagnation.

Figure 1.379. The Cherry Tree (Yin)

- **Cherry (Yin):** This tree is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Water, and its planetary correspondence is Venus (Figure 1.379). The energetic properties of this tree target the liver, lungs, kidneys, and stomach.
- **Chestnut (Yang):** This tree is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Fire, and its planetary correspondence is Jupiter (Figure 1.380). The energetic properties of this tree target the spleen, stomach, and kidneys.
- **Crabapple (Neutral):** The energetic properties of this tree target the liver, lungs, and heart (Figure 1.381).
- **Cypress (Yin):** This tree is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Earth, and its planetary correspondence is Saturn (Figure 1.382). Like the Pine, the Cypress is renowned for its longevity. Magically, the energetic properties of this tree is considered to be one of the most powerful condensers of Yang Qi. The vitality of the Qi contained within the Cypress tree was said to be superior in quality to that of any other tree.

  Because the Chinese word for Cypress (Bai) is pronounced the same as the word for "one hundred" (bai), the Cypress is frequently paired with other symbols to express "many" or "everything." Therefore, Cypress leaves were used in traditional Chinese weddings.

  According to ancient Daoist tradition, the Earth Spirits of the East dwell in the Cypress tree. Therefore, it was believed that some of the Cypress tree's Ling Shen (magical power)

Figure 1.380. The Chestnut Tree (Yang)

Figure 1.381. The Crabapple Tree (Neutral)

Figure 1.382. The Cypress Tree (Yin)

could be absorbed into the body if the priest chewed its resin. If consumed for a long period of time, Cypress Seeds will render a man healthy and free from disease. They will also endow him with good color, improve his hearing and eyesight, cause him to never experience the feelings of hunger, nor grow old.

The smoke from Cypress wood (incense) can be used to consecrate ritual objects. Sometimes smudging with Cypress is used to initiate emotional comfort and to ease feelings of grief in times of crisis (especially at the death of a friend or relative).

Because the Cypress is energetically connected to death, its wood is sometimes used in the construction of coffins.

Figure 1.383. The Datewood Tree (Yang)

- **Datewood (Yang):** This tree is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Air, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun (Figure 1.383). The energetic properties of this tree deal with healing, longevity, and protection. In certain traditions, Datewood is used to construct various Daoist ritualistic "tools" (Talismans, Thunder Blocks, Magical Swords, Seals, etc.). In such cases, the wood must be taken from the Southern side of the tree.
- **Ebony (Yin):** This tree is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Fire, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun (Figure 1.384). The energetic properties of this tree deal with banishing, protection, gestation, and matters of death and rebirth. Ebony is a wood of enormous energetic power, particularly for magic performed during the "dark moon." It is used in making magical amulets that give the priest pure, unadulterated power. Never stand beneath an ebony tree during a storm.
- **Elder (Yin):** This tree is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Water, and its planetary correspondence is Venus (Figure 1.385). The Elder tree is believed to possess a magical feminine spirit that is fragrant, and has healing powers. The Black Elder tree is believed to contain the most magical power. A flute carved from elder wood (played at midnight far from human habitation), can also be used to summon spirits.

The Elder tree is a powerful magical tree that can be both helpful and harmful. The energetic properties of this tree deal with strong protection, and for this reason its wood is often used to construct good luck talismans. Used as a powerful tool for magical protection, an Elder tree planted near a house can keep hostile magic at bay and protect the household against the ravages of sorcery. It can be worn as an amulet to ward off attackers, protect against evil and negativity, and protect against robbers. Elder also has the power to force evil priests to release any spells they may have cast against you.

Figure 1.384. The EbonyTree (Yin)

Figure 1.385. The Elder Tree (Yin)

In ancient times, branches of the Elder tree were placed near graves in order to keep the corpse from being inhabited by an evil spirit. If a door was pinned shut with a green elder twig, it was believed that neither Nature Spirits nor harmful magic could open and enter the house. Elder leaves were gathered (usually during the beginning of May) and fastened to doors and windows in order to banish the psychic attacks of hostile magic. Since its magical properties were considered to be so powerful, it was always kept and used outside. Therefore, ancient tradition prohibited bringing an Elder tree indoors.

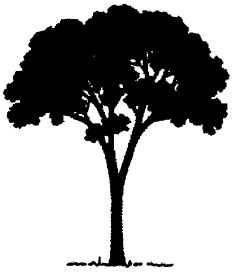


Figure 1.386. The Elm Tree (Yin)

Figure 1.387. The Fig Tree (Yang)

In ancient times, the Elder tree was also burned in the fireplace by dark priests in order to summon evil spirits. If Elder wood was used to build a crib or cradle, the ancient Chinese believed that the Tree-Spirit would attack the child and pinch it until it had bruises all over its body. Also, it was believed that to fall asleep under an Elder tree was to risk awakening in the emotional state of madness.

Conversely, Elder is also used at weddings to bring good luck to the couple. In order to bless a person, place, or thing, scatter the leaves and berries to the four winds in the name of the person or object to be blessed. Then scatter some more Elder over the person or object itself.

In some areas, it was claimed that the Elder tree only grew where blood had been shed. Powerful Nature Spirits were thought to live within the elder, and this is why it bled red sap when cut. Therefore, before felling an elder, the woodsman would normally recite a protective incantation while kneeling before the tree, prior to making the first cut. This allows the Tree Spirit time to vacate.

- **Elm (Yin):** This tree is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Water, and its planetary correspondence is Saturn (Figure 1.386). The energetic properties of this tree targets the stomach, small intestine, and large intestine. The Elm tree is associated with Nature Spirits and is traditionally linked to lucid dreaming (especially the leaves). It is said that Elm bark can be used to stop slander and gossip, and it is also used to awaken self-confidence.
- **Fig (Yang):** This tree is sometimes considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Fire, and its planetary correspondence is Jupiter (Figure 1.387). The energetic properties of the Fig tree target the lungs, large intestine, and spleen.

The wood and fruit of Fig trees were commonly used for fertility and love spells in certain ancient magical traditions. Small phallic images were carved from fig wood and carried by woman who wish to conceive. They were also used by men to overcome infertility or impotence. Fresh figs were eaten for the same reasons.

Fig leaves were sometimes used for Divination. The priest would write a question on a fig leaf. If the leaf dried slowly, the answer was yes and it was considered to be a good omen. However, if the leaf dried quickly, the answer was no and it was considered to be a bad omen.

A fig tree grown in the home is said to bring good luck to the inhabitants. When grown in the bedroom it ensures restful sleep, and when grown in the kitchen ensures that the family never goes hungry.

Figure 1.388. The Ginkgo Tree (Neutral)

Figure 1.389. The Hawthorn Tree (Yang)

- **Ginkgo (Neutral):** The energetic properties of this tree target the lungs, kidneys, and heart (Figure 1.388). The Ginko is a sacred tree in eastern Asia, where it is often planted near Daoist and Buddhist temples. Since the Han Dynasty (206 B.C.-220 A.D.), roasted nuts from Ginko trees were considered to be a precious delicacy by the royal family. During the Song Dynasty (960-1279 A.D.), Ginko was known as Yin Xing, the "Silver Apricot." After the Yuan Dynasty (1279-1368 A.D.), the Ginko tree was widely cultivated throughout China, particularly in temple grounds.
- **Hawthorn (Yang):** This tree is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Fire, and its planetary correspondence is Mars (Figure 1.389). The energetic properties of this tree target the spleen, stomach, lungs, and large intestine.

Hawthorn is used for protection, purification, and banishing. In certain magical traditions, Hawthorn is considered to be a "tree of hope," and it is placed in protection sachets and made into amulets in order to protect against evil influences. In ancient times, Hawthorn was placed in cradles to guard a child from evil spells. Hawthorn was also used to protect a person or home against lightning, and was believed to be powerful enough to protect a home against any damage caused from a storm.

It was believed the Hawthorn was so holy that no malicious spirit could approach it, and it was therefore never cut down. Its dead branches were used for magical protection, and for energetically connecting with Nature Spirits. Hawthorn wood is also placed in homes to ward against ghosts.

The Hawthorn is believed to be sacred to Nature Spirits, and it is part of what is called the "tree fairy triad" (Oak, Ash, and Hawthorn). It is believed by certain magical traditions that where all three of these trees grow together one may see fairies.

Hawthorn was believed to increase fertility, and was therefore incorporated into weddings and believed to promote happiness in a marriage (especially those performed in the spring). The leaves were also placed beneath the mattress or around the bedroom and used to enforce or maintain chastity or celibacy.

When worn or carried, Hawthorn is said to promote happiness in those who have a troubled heart, are depressed, or are sad. The berries are sometimes burned as an incense when a change in life is needed.

Figure 1.390. The Hazel Tree (Yang)

Figure 1.391. The Holly Tree (Yang)

- **Hazel (Yang):** This tree is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Air, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun (Figure 1.390). It is said that the energetic property of the Hazel tree could be used for protection, and that any part of the tree could also be used in order to invoke healing, clairvoyance, inspiration, and wisdom.

  In ancient times, sprigs of hazel were carried for good luck, and it was also believed that the wood become especially powerful if it was bound together by red and gold thread and formed into a solar cross. Hazel nuts were used in fertility spells, and its wood and leaves were sometimes used to construct fertility talismans. Wearing a crown or wreath of hazel leaves was believed to allow a priest to become invisible. It was also believed that to enlist the aid of a plant fairies, a mystic could string hazelnuts on a cord and hang up in his or her house or ritual room.

  The forked branches of Hazel wood were used as a dowsing tool, and its nuts were chewed prior to divination practice. Because the wood of the Hazel tree effectively conducts energy, both Western and Celtic magical traditions used it for the construction of all kinds of magical tools (i.e., wands, divining sticks, dowsing sticks, etc.). Hazel was considered to be the ancient Celtic tree of wisdom, inspiration, and poetry. In the Celtic magical tradition, the "Salmon of Knowledge" is said to "eat the 9 nuts of poetic wisdom dropped into its sacred pool from the hazel tree growing beside it." Ancient Irish tales also speak of poets and seers "gaining nuts of Wisdom." This was an old metaphor used to describe a heightened states of consciousness induced from drinking a potent brew known as "Hazel-mead," which was made from hazelnuts, and used to induce visions.
- **Holly (Yang):** This tree is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Fire, and its planetary correspondence is Mars (Figure 1.391). The male Holly tree has prickly leaves and the female Holly tree has smooth leaves. The energetic properties of this tree offers strong protection, and it is said to banish both lightning and psychic attacks due to hostile magic.

  Because it wards off many types of negative energy, Holly is made into good luck charms and talismans. Its shiny green leaves represent the vitality of life, even in the coldest of times.

  In ancient times, Holly was planted around the home for protection against evil spirits and psychic attacks. Holly water (infused or distilled) was also sprinkled on newborn babies to protect them from evil spells. When thrown at wild animals, a magical powder constructed from Holly berries was believed to cause the animals to lie down quietly, and leave the priest alone (even if the animal was not directly hit with the plant).

  Holly was carried to promote good luck, especially by men, since the Holly is a "male" plant (Ivy is the corresponding plant for women). The leaves and berries were also carried by men in ancient times to heighten their masculinity, virility, and to attract a lover.

  In certain magical traditions, the Holly tree was believed to be a symbol of the life force, vitality, and immortality, and it was therefore used to construct magical wands in order to command invoked spirit entities.

Figure 1.392. The Juniper Tree (Yang)

- **Juniper (Yang):** This tree is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Fire, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun (Figure 1.392). When carried or burned, it is believed that Juniper enhances psychic powers. It is also said that Juniper Berries transform negative emotions into positive ones and purify the Energy Body's aura fields. The Juniper tree is believed to be a protective tree (i.e., protects against accidents, harm, and theft). Therefore, it was considered to be unlucky to cut down a Juniper tree.

  Juniper is commonly carried (or burned as incense) in order to break hexes or curses, and is often used in exorcism rituals. It is also burned at the closure of an Evocation Ritual in order to chase off any lingering spirits. At one time, Juniper trees were either planted near homes or hung along doorposts as a form of protection against evil spirits and to protect those in the house from sudden sickness caused by malevolent priests and witches. It was said that the only way for a witch to get past the Juniper plant and enter into the house was by correctly counting all of the tree's needles. Juniper is believed to be one of the earliest incenses used by Mediterranean Witches for breaking hexes and curses, driving off snakes, and removing delirium from fever. A sprig of Juniper was also believed to protect its wearer against attacks from wild animals.

  In ancient times, Juniper Berries were carried to increase male potency. Juniper was also added to love mixtures, and its berries were used to attract lovers (i.e., once the berries had been dried, they were then worn as a love charm).

Figure 1.393. The Magnolia Tree (Yin)

Figure 1.394. The Maple Tree (Yang)

In Southern China, Juniper leaves are traditionally used during weddings. They are tied with red string and tucked behind the bride's ear or hair, in order to symbolize the bride bringing luck and prosperity into the groom's family.

The Juniper tree has an abundance of healing properties and is believed to boost the immune system. Infusions can be made from the berries to treat kidney disorders, reduce swelling, relieve arthritis, treat liver troubles, treat edema, help relieve phantom pains caused from organ amputation, aid in digestion, and treat intestinal cramps.

- **Magnolia (Yin):** This tree is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Earth, and its planetary correspondence is Venus (Figure 1.393). The energetic properties of this tree target the lungs, stomach, gall bladder, large intestine, and spleen.
- **Maple (Yang):** This tree is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Air, and its planetary correspondence is Jupiter (Figure 1.394). The energetic properties of this tree target the spleen, kidneys, and large intestine.

Figure 1.395. The Mulberry Tree (Yang)

Figure 1.396. The Oak Tree (Yang)

- **Mulberry (Yang):** This tree is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Air, and its planetary correspondence is Mercury (Figure 1.395). The energetic properties of this tree target the lungs, large intestine, spleen, and kidneys.

  In ancient Chinese cosmology, the magical "Yao Shu Kui" tree (the Tree of Renewal) was believed to be akin to the Mulberry tree. According to legend, at the beginning of time, this magical tree united the Nine Sources (the Realm of the Dead) with the Nine Heavens. In certain Chinese traditions, this World Tree is identified as the hollow Mulberry. This magical tree was considered to be a hermaphrodite, and its origin dates back to "before the separation of Yin (female) and Yang (male)." To the ancient Chinese, this magical tree represents the all-encompassing cosmic order of the Dao. This is one reason why a sacred Mulberry grove (Sang Lin) was always planted outside the eastern gate of the early royal capitals of ancient China.

  For at least 5,000 years the White Mulberry tree has been the home of the Chinese Silkworm. In Traditional Chinese Medicine, the fruit (used to moisten and nourish the Yin), leaves (used to dispel Wind Heat, clear the liver, and to brighten the eyes), stems (used to dispel Wind Heat, and promote the circulation of Qi), and root bark (used to cool and purge Lung Heat) of the White Mulberry tree are used as healing agents.

- **Oak (Yang):** This tree is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Fire, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun (Figure 1.396). The energetic properties of this tree target the large intestine, spleen, kidneys, and heart.

  It is associated with all manner of energetic protection. In ancient times Oak was hung over windows and doors in order to protect a house from evil spirits. After getting permission from the tree's spirit guardian, priests would burn oak leaves for purification of ritual spaces.

  Mistletoe (Yang, Air, Sun), which grows on Oak trees, was believed to contain the essence of the tree's energetic power. Certain magical traditions use the Oak to channel and direct high levels of energy. Because they were believed to be imbued with great power, a staff or wand constructed of Oak was traditionally considered to be a useful tool for practicing Weather Magic and Earth Magic.

  Oak is one of the most sacred trees associated with solar fire and is traditionally used for good luck charms. In ancient times, the acorns of an Oak tree were commonly carried in order to increase fertility in women and to increase sexual appeal in men.

  The healing properties of the Oak tree include: increasing bravery and courage, perseverance, strength, protection, health, money, luck, banishing illness, and ridding one of despair. Therefore, it was considered unlucky to cut down an oak.

Figure 1.397. The Paulownia Tree (Yang)

Figure 1.398. The Peach Tree (Yin)

- **Paulownia (Yang):** This tree is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature (Figure 1.397). The energetic properties of this tree target the heart.
- **Peach (Yin):** This tree is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Water, and its planetary correspondence is Venus (Figure 1.398). The energetic properties of this tree deal with healing, longevity, and protection. It is commonly used in the construction of Daoist ritualistic "tools" (Talismans, Thunder Blocks, Magical Swords, Seals, etc.). In such cases, the wood must be taken from the Southern side of the tree.

In ancient China, the peach is the food of the gods as well as being the symbol of immortality. Shouxing, the God of Longevity, is often depicted holding the Peach of Immortality (Pan Tao), which grows in the Heavenly Peach Orchard of the Jade Emperor. This peach tree is said to bloom only once every 3,000 years, and the fruit takes 3,000 years to ripen. Legend claims that peaches from this tree give immortality to anyone who eats them. When the fruit ripens, Shouxing and the Immortals have a banquet in the palace of the mythical Queen Mother of the Western Paradise (Xiwangmu), the highest goddess in the Daoist pantheon. There they feast on the Peaches of Immortality and become young again.

In Daoist magic, peach flower pedals are sometimes used by Daoist sorcerers to cast Love Spells onto men.

According to Daoist Folk Magic, peach wood can be use in order to ward off evil spirits and exorcise demons. For example, bows and arrows constructed out of peach wood are believed to be able to shoot down evil spirits.

Additionally, the images of the two guardian Door Gods popularly used as protectors of the main entrance of the house, are always drawn on tablets constructed out of peach wood. The reason for this ancient custom, can be traced back to the legend of Shen Shu and Yu Lei, two guardian exorcists. This ancient legend is explained as follows:

According to legend, there is a magical mountain, located in the Eastern Sea, named Mount Tushou. On this special mountain grew a giant magical peach tree. The lowest branches of this magical tree grew towards the North-East, forming an arch. This arch acted as a magical portal through which all of the spirits of the Three Worlds (Heaven, Earth, and the Underworld) flew in and out of the world.

Two Celestial Guardians by the name of Shen Shu and Yu Lei were chosen by the Jade Emperor to stand guard over this magical gate that led in and out of the world. Shen Shu and Yu Lei were exceptional guardians. At a glance, they could discern which spirits were good and which were evil. As soon as the Celestial Guardians saw an evil spirit guilty of bringing harm to humans, they immediately tied it up and fed it to a magical tiger who at it.

Learning of the Celestial Guardians brave deeds, the Yellow Emperor (Huang Di) decreed that images of Shen Shu and Yu Lei should be drawn onto peach wood tablets and placed at all entrances of a house in order to ward off all malevolent spirits. From that day forward, people began traditionally placing the images of the two brothers each Lunar New Year onto the front door.

- **Pine: (Yang):** This tree is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Air, and its planetary correspondence is Mars (Figure 1.399). The energetic properties of this tree target the liver. Pine is considered to be one of the most powerful condensers of Yang Qi. To the ancient Daoist monks living at high altitudes on the sacred mountains, eating Pine Nuts (the "fruit" of the Pine tree) was believed to bestow eternal life.

  Because they all can flourish during the winter, the Pine, Plum Tree and Bamboo are known as the "Three Friends in Winter."

  In ancient China, the great Earth God was believed to live in a Pine tree. Other Earth spirits and deities were believe to reside in the Four Directions, living in other species of trees (e.g., the homes of the spirit gods of the North resided in Acacia trees, the homes of the spirit gods of the East resided in Cypress trees, etc.).

  The most popular trees used for energetic absorption are Pine and Fir trees, followed by the Cypress. The Fir Tree is commonly used in Purification Rituals for getting rid of the stubborn entities. However, it must first be magically activated and enhanced before it is used for "Spiritual Sweeping."

  The ancient Chinese frequently identified and documented such trees as the Fine, Cypress, and White Aspen to be the most powerful condensers of Yang Qi. According to the *Books of the Northern Chi Dynasty* (550-577 A.D.), it was believed that the Pine and Cypress trees could naturally stand against the ravages of air, weather, and insects due to their strong constitutions. Therefore, the vitality of Qi contained within their wood and their capacity to live long was said to be unequalled by any other tree. The Pine is a tree of peace and, being an evergreen, considered to be an herb of immortality.

  In ancient China, both Pine and Cypress trees were chosen as material for coffins and grave-vaults because of their ability to contain powerful Earth Qi; for this reason it was thought that their woods could be used to strengthen the soul in the grave. Additionally Pine, Acacia, White Cedar, Catalpa, and Chestnut trees were traditionally planted in specific spots to honor certain Celestial Immortals around Chinese temples.

Figure 1.399. The Pine Tree (Yang)

In China, Pine was the symbol of friendship, since it remains green all year long. The Pine tree was known as the tree of the Sun. Its ancient title was the "sweetest of woods." The scent of Pine is useful in attuning to nature, grounding, and dispelling guilt. Marco Polo said that the Khan had many Pine trees planted because he believed that "he who plants a tree will live a long life."

Pine is commonly used in magic for purification rituals, and its needles are sometimes used in the construction of cleansing and purifying baths. Pine is also used in magic to banish negative energies, exorcise evil, attract money, break hexes, heal, cleanse, protect, and awaken positive self-acceptance. Pine needles are a valuable source of vitamin C and can loosen a tight chest.

In ancient times, Pine Cones were carried to increase fertility and to enable one to reach a vigorous old age. A Pine Cone gathered on Midsummer (still retaining its seeds) was considered to be a powerful magical object. Pine Needles are burned during the winter months to purify and cleanse the house. Scattered on the floor, the needles were believed to drive away evil. When burned, the needles were believed to exorcise the area of all negativity, and were sometimes burned in magical rituals in order to reverse a spell and send back a curse.

Figure 1.400. The RowanTree (Yang)

Figure 1.401. The WillowTree (Yin)

The Pine provides protection when planted near graves. This is because the mythical creature Wang Xiang, who devours the brains of the dead, is afraid of the Pine.

According to ancient belief, a Pine Tree that is one thousand years old will resemble a blue ox, a blue dog, or a blue human being. The branches of a three thousand year old Pine Tree have underneath their bark, accumulations of resin in the shape of dragons. If this special resin is collected, pounded, and consumed in a quantity of ten pounds, the priest will be able to live for 500 years.

- **Rowan (Yang):** This tree is considered to be Yang (Masculine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Fire, and its planetary correspondence is the Sun (Figure 1.400). In ancient times its berries were carried in magical pouches for good luck and for increasing psychic power. It is considered to be one of the most powerful protective trees, and it is used to break hostile magic, chase off destructive spirits, and protect against storms and lightning. Rowan trees were commonly planted in churchyards to keep away evil spirits from the bodies of the dead. A cross made of two Rowan twigs tied together with red thread offers protection in the house by preventing hostile priests from entering. A Rowan branch placed in the bed is believed to keep the sleeper free from nightmares. In some magical traditions, it is believed to be a tree of vision, healing, psychic power, and divination. Its branches are used for dowsing rods in certain mystic traditions. The most powerful and magically effective Rowan tree was known as a "Flying Rowan." The Flying Rowan was a tree that had grown with its roots positioned in the cleft of a rock, or on the branches or stump of another tree rather than in the ground.
- **Willow (Yin):** This tree is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Water, and its planetary correspondence is the Moon (Figure 1.401). The energetic properties of this tree target the heart and spleen..

The Willow (Liu) is associated with the life of scholars and poets who drew inspiration while strolling among them. Its branches were considered magical, and were used in exorcisms and in "sweeping tombs" during the Qingming Festival (also known as "Festival of the Tombs"). On this day, young men also wore green willow branches in their hair in the belief that it would prevent them from being changed into a brown dog in a future existence.

Because of similarity in pronunciation to the Chinese word "to part" (Li), Willow branches also represent parting and sorrow since they were traditionally given to friends departing for distant lands.

Willow is said to guard against evil and can be used to bind a spirit. In ancient times, Willow was carried or placed in a home for protection against evil or negative spirits. Because it is linked with the powers of the Moon, in certain magical traditions, crushed willow bark is burned outdoors with White Sandalwood during the waning moon in order to conjure spirits.

Additionally, in ancient China, the Wu (i.e., shaman sorcerers) would carve images within the willow wood in order to communicate with the spirit world.

In magic ritual, Daoist priests consider water that is sprinkled via a willow branch to have a powerful purifying effect. Deities such as Tai Yi Jiu Ku Tian Zun and Zi Zai Ci Hang Tian Zun (normally known as Guan Yin) are often seen holding Willow Leaf Whisks, used for spiritual purification.

Willow Leaves are used to symbolize the Spiritual Whisk. Once the Willow leaves ae being dip into water and sprinkled out, the water will be enhanced with positive energies in order to eliminate the negative entities and also by using the positive energies it will lessen or wash off the sins and debts of all beings, thus it is considered a sacred plant and very important in salvation rituals.

Ancient burial mounds and cemeteries are both often lined with Willow, symbolizing the spiritual gateway that this tree provides between the living and the dead, and spirit and matter. In ancient times, Willow bark was crushed, mixed with White Sandalwood or Myrrh, and then burnt. Priests would then bathe in the smoke in order to sojourn into the Underworld.

Willow is also used to attract love, and a forked Willow branch was sometimes used for dowsing. Willow is used for healing spells, is beneficial for relieving arthritis pain, and is currently still being used in the clinic to ease muscle and joint pain. In ancient China, women believed that if they wore sprigs of willow in their hair, it would keep their eyes clear and ward off blindness.

It is important to note, that due to the difficulty in finding Willow Trees, sometimes Pomegranate Leaves were used as a replacement in certain Daoist monasteries. This is because the ancient Daoists believed that the Pomegranate was a very energetically sensitive plant. It is said that if a woman who is menstruating, pregnant, or mourning (all considered spiritually unclean) goes to pluck the leaves of the plant, after awhile, the plant will mysteriously wither. Therefore, in order to prevent such a thing from happening, the women was told to hang a red packet with a red string onto the Pomegranate tree after plucking its leaves.

Figure 1.402. The Yew Tree (Yin)

Additionally, Pomegranate Leaves are very similar in magical application to the Pomelo Leaves (i.e., Chinese Grapefruit). The leaves of both trees can be used for cleansing people, places and things, and for warding off many forms of bad luck.

- **Yew (Yin):** This tree is considered to be Yin (Feminine) in nature, its Element corresponds to Water, and its planetary correspondence is Saturn (Figure 1.402). The energetic properties of this tree target the kidneys. Historically, many plants have been associated with the spiritual realm of the Underworld. These include specific trees that were often used as grave guards and were traditionally planted in cemeteries. The tree most often associated with raising the spirits of the dead is the "Yew" evergreen tree (its evergreen foliage symbolizes eternal life).

The Yew is considered to be a magical evergreen tree or shrub. It contains dark stiff poisonous needles and fleshy fruit. It sometimes grows up to sixty feet tall, has bark that is scaly and reddish, has short needles, and instead of a cone it produces a red fleshy berry. It is commonly planted around cemeteries (the ancient Chinese believed that it had special powers that would keep the dead safely in their graves). The Yew is also used for protection against spirit entities (especially ghosts), and it istraditionally used for exorcism and laying a ghost to rest.

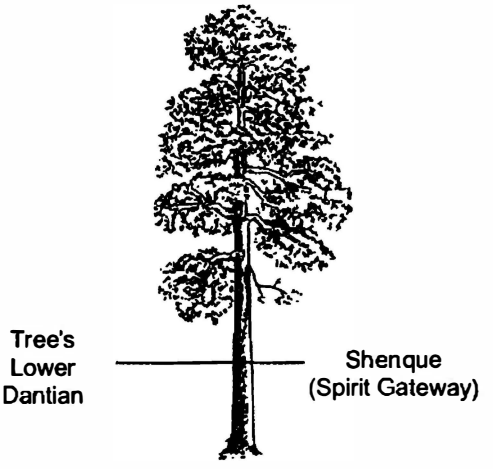


Figure 1.403. A Male Tree's Lower Dantian

GATHERING QI FROM TREES

Trees are tremendously powerful plants and are commonly used by both priests and apprentices to absorb and transform negative pathogenic Qi into clean, healthy, life-giving energy. The more Earth Qi contained within the environmental soil, the stronger and more radiant the trees and foliage will be.

To the ancient Daoists, each tree had its own Lower Dantian. The tree's Lower Dantian can usually be identified as a knot, which is considered to be the tree's Shenque (Spirit Gateway) CV-4 point. The mystic can locate and identify the tree's Shenque point by using his or her Extended Fan Palm to feel its energetic power center (Figure 1.403).

LOCATING TREE POWER SPOTS

Whenever possible, the ancient Daoist mystics would search for and locate a tree "power spot" before performing "Tree Cultivation" techniques. A tree "power spot" is defined as the energetic space surrounded by a specific group or cluster of trees naturally arranged into a "sacred" energetic pattern. The energetic pattern of the tree formation allowed the Daoist mystic the ability to absorb the energy of several trees at once (Figure 1.404).

In ancient China, the energy of the Earth was known as a "Dragon Pulse," and was believed to exist as an active energetic current that traveled within the mountains, valleys, forests and deserts. When this energetic current "pools," it creates a powerful energetic vortex or "power spot." Any

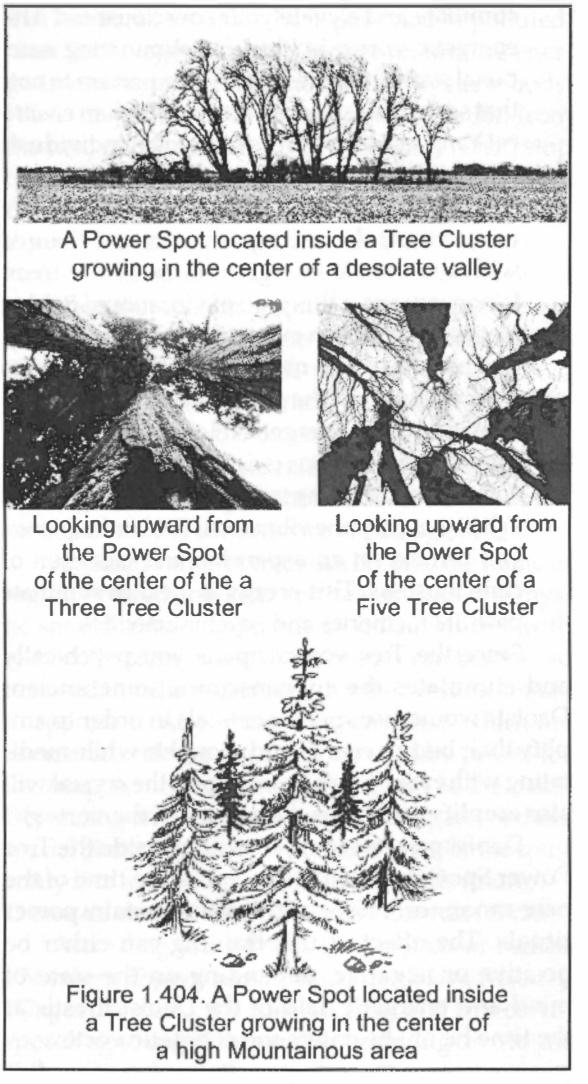


Figure 1.404. A Power Spot located inside a Tree Cluster growing in the center of a high Mountainous area

training performed within this special area of trees, allows an individual who is sensitive to the subtle energetic fields the ability to greatly enhance his or her energetic and spiritual training.

According to ancient Daoist belief, the energetic vortices of a tree's power spot are charged and manifested in one of three specific ways:

- **Yang Energetic Field:** The energetic property of this vortex is electro-positive, Yang, and charged with the male energetic force of the trees. When you enter this type of vibrational field or frequency, you will become charged physically and emotionally. The surrounding energy will

stimulate and elevate your consciousness. This energetic vortex is ideal for eliminating emotional states of depression. It is important to note that some Daoist instructors consider an electrical Yang tree vortex to be a strain on individuals with high blood pressure or heart problems.

- **Yin Energetic Field:** The energetic property of this vortex is electro-negative, Yin, and charged with the female energetic force of the trees. When you enter this type of vibrational field or frequency, you can expect to open psychically, and become much more perceptive; the effects are primarily on the subconscious mind.
- **Yin and Yang Energetic Field:** The energetic property of this vortex is a combination of Yin and Yang forces, resulting in a perfect state of balance. When you enter the vibrational field or frequency, you can expect an expansion and elevation of consciousness. This energy is ideal to stimulate past-life memories and psychic activities.

Since the Tree vortex opens you psychically and stimulates the subconscious, some ancient Daoists would use specific crystals in order to amplify their body's energy and thoughts while meditating within the Tree's Power Spot (the crystal will also amplify and focus the energy of the vortex).

Daoist priests would meditate inside the Tree Power Spots during a full moon, at the time of the new moon, or before and during certain power rituals. The effect of this training can either be positive or negative, depending on the state of mind and energetic field of the Daoist mystic at the time he or she enters the energetic vortex.

Techniques For Qi Cultivation

Techniques used in ancient Daoism for the cultivation and regulation of Earth Qi from trees begin by having the disciple face a tree. In the following exercise, disciples are taught how to absorb Qi from various types of trees by inhaling and drawing the Earth Qi from tree into their body. The energy is then guided down the disciple's chest and into the Lower Dantian. It is advisable to gather and cultivate the Earth energy early in the morning (just before the sun crests the horizon) when the Qi is fresh.

- Begin by facing a small tree while standing in a Wuji posture.
- Raise both hands and extend them a few inches away from the tree, with the palms facing each other. Both arms should be bent at the elbows with the shoulders relaxed and sunk. As the palms face the tree, they should be slightly curved and never locked.

  Important Note: If your hands feel comfortable then proceed to the next step; however, if your hands feel numb or begin to hurt, usually this is a signal that it is necessary to try another tree that is more open to an energetic exchange.
- Focus your intention forward into the tree, and imagine it as an enormous pillar of energy, emitting a particular color or light (depending on the type of tree). According to ancient Daoist teaching, the color of the trees energy field is divided into Five Element colors, described as follows:

Pine Tree: Green Color, East Direction, and Wood Element. Used to tonify the Liver Organ System.

Paulownia Tree: Red Color, South Direction, and Fire Element. Used to tonify the Heart Organ, improve blood circulation and bring clarity to the mind.

Aspen Tree: White Color, West Direction, and Metal Element. Used to tonify the Lung Organ System.

Cedar Tree: Black Color, North Direction, and Water Element. Used to tonify the Kidney Organ System.

Willow Tree: Yellow Color, Center Direction, and Earth Element. Used to tonify the Spleen and Stomach Organ System.

It is important to wait until you can feel the sensation of the tree's energy filling your hands. Then feel an energetic connection developing between your Heart, Middle Dantian, Lower Dantian and the tree before proceeding to the next stage.

- Your breathing should be slow, subtle, deep, long, and even. As you exhale, slowly bend your knees and begin sinking into the Earth. While sinking your body, sweep your palms downward along the sides of the trunk of the tree. Imagine that your palms are emitting a mass of energy the same color as the tree. Then imagine that the tree is absorbing the energy from your palms, exchanging it with the tree's energy mass.
- Inhale as you slowly straighten your legs,

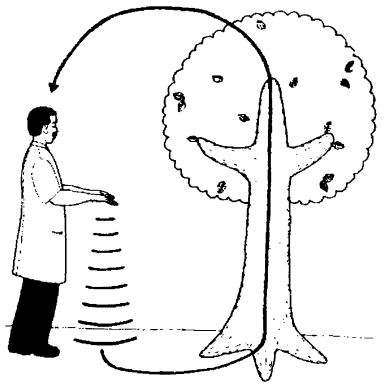


Figure 1.405. A Daoist Qigong practitioner can extend his Qi and intention deep into the root system of the tree and absorb its natural energy through the Baihui point at the top of his head.

sweeping your palms upward along the sides of the trunk of the tree as your body rises. Imagine that your palms are absorbing a mass of energy the same color as the tree, exchanging it with the tree's energy mass. Continue this exercise for several minutes.

Extend your Qi and intention deep into the root system of the tree and imagine absorbing its natural energy through the Baihui point at the top of your head (Figure 1.405).

- End the exercise with "Pulling Down the Heavens" and return to the Wuji posture, allowing the gathered Qi to sink and return into the Lower Dantian.

PRECAUTIONS

Students should be monitored regularly to prevent Qi deviations, which may occur while absorbing Qi through the pores. For best results, choose a quiet, safe, and healthy environment. Select trees with a stable root or with thick trunks. The color of the tree is also very important, and any leaves and flowers should be bright, full, and healthy.

Because the body's internal energy matches that of the external environment, it is important to avoid selecting any area that is unpleasant or unhealthy. Avoid any tree that is sick, dying, has lost its color, or has just been pruned. Sick trees can pass along their suffering into the unexperienced individual who tries to cultivate their life-force. It is important not to meditate in front of any tree that has parasites or has been poisoned or polluted, since such vegetation will induce an impure energetic resonance within the Daoist mystic's body. When absorbing Qi into the Lower Dantian from the tree, if any discomfort or resistance is felt, stop immediately. Using trees for cleansing the body or absorbing energy is forbidden at night, because during this time period the trees are believed to "inhale" environmental energy and release toxic Qi.

Trees that contain brightly colored songbirds are traditionally considered to be very healthy. The ancient Daoists believed that birds were the messengers of Heaven, consequently, the more beautiful and melodic the bird, the better the potential for the gathering of Qi. However, if there are rarely any birds around the training area, it is important to look for any energetic problems such as the presence of pathogenic Qi.

As certain ancient trees can become the home of highly evolved energetic spiritual entities, the mystic should always approach an unknown tree with respect (in some cases, these entities can become so removed from human energy that they become unsafe to approach). Also, there are many trees which are associated with the dead and are used by priests for the purpose of summoning the spirits of the dead. Depending on the location and culture, parts of these special plants and trees may be used to entice the spirit entity into answering questions about the future.

CEREAL AND TREE OF EACH DIPPER STAR

According to the *Beidou Qiyuan Jinxuan Yuzhan ('Northern Dipper Seven Principles Golden Mystery Winged-Stanzas')*, the special cereal and tree corresponding to each Dipper Star (growing on Mount Tai) are listed as follows:

- **1st Star (Tan Lang - Greedy Wolf):** Pine and Cypress Tree - millet cereal
- **2nd Star (Ju Men - Giant Gate):** Pine Tree - rye cereal
- **3rd Star (Lu Can - Store of Wealth):** Cypress Tree - rice cereal
- **4th Star (Wen Qu - Civil Chief):** Cypress Tree - wheat cereal
- **5th Star (Lian Zhen - Pure and Chaste):** Pine Tree - hemp-seed cereal
- **6th Star (Wu-Qu - Military Chief):** Mulberry Tree - soybean cereal
- **7th Star (Po Jun - Troop Destroyer):** Pine Tree - peas cereal

TREE SPIRITS

The ancient Chinese believed that trees have personalities that are as diverse as people, and that certain trees will naturally bond with an individual. Since plants, like animals, have their sexes and reproduce their kind by the union of the male and female elements, the physical structure of a male tree differs from the physical structure of a female tree. The branches of a male tree, for example, are believed to be positioned further up the trunk, with the tips of the branches pointing upward. The branches of a female tree, however, are believed to be positioned lower on the trunk (closer to the Earth), with the tips of the branches pointing downward.

- Male tree spirits are said to be kindly, wise, and reserved; they tend to be open to sensitive women and may court their souls.
- Female tree spirits are said to be more playful and adventurous with humans, and they may fall in love with a man.
- Old trees are filled with spiritual wisdom, energetically imbedded within their many internal rings.
- Young trees (taller than the mystic) are valuable for increasing Qi and are the easiest trees to use when practicing alchemic cultivation exercises.

Additionally, all plants and trees, like animals, are also able to energetically extend their Shen outward and become receptive to activities occurring within the specific territory that they have "staked-out" or marked as being their personal space. For example, according to extensive research conducted by Cleve Backster, a plant that is brought into a new environment becomes attuned to the energetic activities, thoughts, and intentions of the various people and animal life forms within that area. The safety and survival of the plant seems to relate to its ability to access this information (commonly bonding with those who take care of them).

The ancient Chinese believed that many trees were inhabited by spirits. These Nature Spirits were considered to be either benevolent or malevolent, depending on the specific interaction that occurred between humans and the tree spirit (Figure 1.406).

Figure 1.406. A Tree Spirit

Many ancient cultures worshipped trees as manifestations or abodes of the divine. If there was a beautiful tree at the entrance to any village, it was honored because it was believed to be the residence of a spirit.

Stories of trees that bleed and utter cries of pain or indignation when they are hacked or burned occur very often in Chinese books, especially in *Standard Histories*. Therefore, old woodsmen still secretly ask healthy, sound trees to forgive them before they cut the tree down. They practice this ancient ritual in order to not draw down on themselves the retribution of the spirits who live in the trees, and who are apt to avenge themselves by visiting with the woodsmen's household with grievous sickness and injure.

Sometimes it is the souls of the dead which are believed to animate trees. The spirits take up their abode, by preference, in tall and stately trees with great spreading branches. When the wind rustles the leaves, the locals believe that it is the voice of the spirit; and they never pass near one of these trees without bowing respectfully and asking pardon of the spirit for disturbing his or her repose.

In many places in the world, every village has its sacred tree; a tree in which the souls of the dead fore-

fathers of the village are said to reside. Offerings are made to the tree, and any injury done to it is believed to bring some type of misfortune onto the village. It is believed that if the tree were ever to be cut down, the village and all its inhabitants would inevitably perish. To such spirits offerings of cake, wine, and pork are made on heaps of stones piled under the trees.

Among the Miao-Kia (an aboriginal race of Southern and Western China), a sacred tree stands at the entrance of every village, and the inhabitants believe that it is tenanted by the soul of their first ancestor. It is believed that this first ancestor still rules their destiny.

Since ancient times, it has always been customary for the Chinese to plant trees on graves in order to strengthen the soul of the deceased, and thus save his or her body from corruption. Because the evergreen cypress and pine trees are believed to contain the most vitality of any of the trees, they are nearly always preferred for this purpose. Hence the trees that grow on graves are sometimes identified with the souls of the departed. In most cases, the spirit is viewed as being incorporated within the tree. This spirit animates the tree and must suffer and die within the confines of its form. However, there is another type of Tree Spirit which only inhabits the tree as a home and can enter and leave this residence at will. Thus, certain trees are believed to be (at times) inhabited by roving demons. If the trees were to be damaged, it would immediately release the demon to go about on rampages of destruction and mischief. Ancient people were always careful to respect any prominent, striking, or unusual tree, and were careful not to cut them down.

Trees and Hexing

In ancient China, Daoist priests believed that every tree had its own unique spirit, which was a natural part of the life of that tree (i.e., its Jing, Qi, and Shen). It was further believed that if a tree spirit was disturbed by hammering a nail into its abode, the tree spirit would immediately come out of the tree to seek revenge.

It is taught that, when the tree sap reaches the nail, the spirit would emerge from the tree. It is at this exact time, when the sorcerer, dressed in white, must repeat his or her request to the tree spirit to "pursue and haunt ----."

Trees and Warfare

In ancient China, trees played an important role in warfare. As a supreme symbol of conquest, conquerors would cut down holy forests instead of destroying temples.

Many of the Chinese magical weapons were made of wood from special trees, in the hope that the magical weapon would take on the strength of the tree.

Forest Spirits

There are various types of spirits that are said to dwell in the Nature Kingdom (which includes the three energetic fields of minerals, plants, and animals). These spirits possess supernatural powers and are usually invisible to humans. Nature Spirits come in countless shapes, sizes, and dispositions. Some are regarded as being benevolent towards humans, while others are mischievous or malevolent. Some are human-like in appearance, while others assume the shapes of animals or have half-human and half-animal forms. Nature Spirits are usually attached to an object or place in nature (hence their name) and can inhabit a particular forest, tree, plant, river, stream, mountain, cave, etc. Traditionally, the ancient Chinese believed that Nature Spirits were not immortal and could only live a number of centuries or millennia.

- **Forest Spirits:** This type of spirit lives in the deep forests. They are believed to be tree dwellers. According to the Standard Histories, written during the Han Dynasty (206 B.C.-220 A.D.), although these spirits generally have a human shape, they can also take other forms (e.g., a one legged demon whose hands and feet have nails as sharp as hooks). The Forest Spirits belong to the special class of Gui (ghosts) and Mei (evil spirits). When attacked, Forest Spirits can cause their assailant to drop into epileptic convulsions and experience hot and cold fevers.

  A few years ago, a young American went to visit India, He arrived at Chowpatty, Bombay's downtown beach. He went into the forest to relieve himself under a tree. Unfortunately, the tree was inhabited by a tree spirit, which, taking offence at his lack of respect

immediately possessed him. He suddenly fell down and experienced his "first" epileptic seizure. Almost all holy men and women, psychics, and spiritual intuitives understand that 90% of epileptic seizures are physical manifestation caused from spirit possession.

In another example, one of my graduates from the masters course in Medical Qigong therapy was treating a young man in his early 20's for epileptic seizures. The young man had been institutionalized for most of his life because he "saw" spirits, and had also occasionally experienced epileptic seizures. Therefore, according to Western medical treatment protocols, he was medicated in order to treat his condition of "hallucinations" and possible schizophrenia. However, even after receiving the medication, the epileptic seizures and "hallucinations" still continued.

His parents, loving their son, had became completely frustrated by the misguided council and abusive clinical treatments that their son had received at the hands of these Western doctors, and they eventually contacted one of my graduate student's for help. When recanting the experience of treating this young man, my student stated, "Having arrived at his house, I was directed to his room. After we were introduced, he suddenly started whispering. While pointing to the corner of the room he began saying, There it is - do you see it! And sure enough, there in the corner of the room was the energetic presence of a dark and powerful demonic spirit entity. I watch it approach the young man and start to enter into and control the poor guy's body. At that point I suddenly realized how horrible his life had become. He was spiritually gifted as an energetic "seer," yet misunderstood and left all alone with no one to understand or even believe his spiritual observation. He was also habitually drugged, which destroyed any mental resistance to possession and allowed the demonic spirit the ability to easily enter and control his body. This poor young man's potential for aiding society and contributing to the spiritual growth of humanity had been sabotaged by dark forces at a very young age."

"The Gift Exchange"

When performing any type of High Magic and communicating with a spirit entity, it is imperative that the priest understand the magic ritual of the Gift Exchange. A Gift Exchange is traditionally performed after you have summoned or invoked a particular type of spirit entity (i.e., a Plant Spirit, Animal Spirit, Celestial Immortal, etc.), or are in the process of a spirit "visitation."

Traditionally, there are three types of gift exchanges that occur between a priest and a spirit entity when first contact is initiated. The Gift Exchange is explained as follows:

- **First:** When the spirit begins to manifest, observe as much as possible. Notice the particular size, shape, color, sounds, and smells that "embodies" the spirit as it manifest itself.
- **Second:** Introduce yourself as your "Most Secret Name" (your Magic Name). You Magic Name (Daoist Priest Name) is how you are known and respected within the spirit realm.
- **Third:** After introducing yourself, ask the spirit for its name. This represents the first magic gift, the Exchange of Magic Names.
- **Forth:** Ask the spirit if there is anything that it needs from you. If so, energetically create this gift through focused though intention, and the respectfully give it to the spirit entity.
- **Fifth:** Ask the spirit if it has anything it has for you. If so, receive the gift with gratitude and appreciation, and project its spiritual influence (i.e., the spiritual manifestation and "fruit" of this gift) into your future.
- **Sixth:** Ask the spirit to transform the gift into a magical symbol, and to place this magic symbol into your body. It is important that you see and feel the energy of the magic symbol radiate throughout your body and beyond. This represents the second magic gift, the Exchange of Powers.
- **Seventh:** Thank the spirit for the gift and ask it how you may again call it. When you receive the Magic Invocation and Hand Seal, say goodbye to the spirit using its True Name. Then, write the magic contact information down in you Book of Magic. This represents the third magic gift, the Exchange of Invitation.

The Study of the Realm of Animals

Introduction to the Alchemical Transformations of Animals

All systems of magic incorporate the use of animals and animal products in their rituals, herbal formulae, talismans, and magical tools. Generally, animals are used in Daoist magic for four specific purposes:

- **Healing:** Animals are used for their healing properties, as part of certain herbal formulas.
- **Magical Tools:** Animals are used for their body parts, magical essence, and life-force energy in order to enhance the spiritual power of certain magical tools, and for divination.
- **Companionship:** Animals are used as a "Familiars" (spirit companions and helpers).
- **Sacrifice:** Animals are used as sacrificial offering in certain rituals.

In magical rituals, an animal is valued for the energetic property of its specific parts (i.e., the energetic and spiritual powers contained within the animals life-force, blood, reproductive organs, etc.).

The tissues of each animal are related to specific energetic properties inherent within the animals spiritual nature (i.e., territorial, defensive, nurturing, protective, etc.). In the animal world, it is difficult to gather sufficient magical power from an animal's life-impulse unless it is collected from the animal's tissues, especially concentrations of the animal's essences such as blood, semen, or ova (traditionally, the spawn of frogs and similar organisms are utilized for this purpose).

Chinese Healing Animal Parts

Since ancient times, the Chinese herbal pharmacopoeia has included as many as 5000 plant and animal species, as well as other substances called "herbs" which were nevertheless derived from animals and minerals. Some animal substances used in medicinal healing include: antelope and deer horn, donkey skin gelatin, earthworms, human placenta, bat feces, cicada exoskeleton, wingless cockroach, bear gallbladder, charred human hair, toad skin secretion, and seal penis.

What follows is a list of animal parts used in Traditional Chinese Medicine, many of which are still being used in China today because of their medicinal properties.

Snake

Bai Hua She (Agkistrodon Seu Bungarus) White-Patterned Snake: This animal part is used to treat the Liver and Spleen. It powerfully unblocks the channels and extinguishes wind.

Wu Shao She (Zaocys Dhumnades) Black-Striped Snake: This animal part is used to treat the Liver and Spleen. It powerfully unblocks the channels and extinguishes wind.

She Tui (Exuviae Serpentis) Snakes Skin Slough: This animal part is used to treat the Liver. It dispels wind, removes superficial visual obstructions, and stops spasms.

Turtle

Bie Jia (Carapax Amydae Sinensis) Soft Shell Turtle Shell: This animal part is used to treat the Liver and Spleen. It nourishes the Yin, roots the Yang, invigorates the Blood, promotes menstruation, and dissipates nodules.

Gui Ban (Plastrum Testudinis) Fresh Water Turtle Shell: This animal part is used to treat the Heart, Kidneys, and Liver. It nourishes the Yin, roots the Yang, tonifies the Kidneys, strengthens the bones, cools and nourishes the blood, tonifies the Heart, and stops Uterine bleeding.

Deer

Lu Rong (Cornu Cervi Parvum) Deer Antler: This animal part is used to treat the Kidneys and Liver. It tonifies the Kidneys, fortifies the Yang, tonifies the Governing Vessel, regulates the thrusting and conception vessels, and tonifies the Qi and blood.

She Xiang (Secretio Moschus) Navel Gland Secretions of the Musk Deer: This animal part is used to treat the Heart, Spleen, and Liver. It is used to intensely open the orifices, revive the spirit, invigorate blood, dissipate clumps, reduce swelling, and alleviate pain.

Various Animal Parts

Chan Su (Secretio Bufonis) Toad Venom: This animal part is the dried skin secretions of a toad. It is used to treat Kidney and Stomach problems, relieve toxicity, reduce swelling, alleviate pain, expel Summer Heat and Dampness, and open the orifices.

Chuan Shan Jia (Squama Manitis Pentadactylae) Penetrate Mountain Scales: This animal part is the anteater scales, and it is used to treat the Liver and Stomach. It disperses blood stasis, unblocks menstruation, reduces swelling, expels wind dampness from the channels, and promotes discharge of puss.

E Jiao (Gelatinum Corii Asini) Donkey Hide Gelatin: This animal part is used to treat the Kidneys, Liver, and Lungs. It tonifies and nourishes the blood, stops bleeding, and nourishes the Yin.

Ge Jie (Gecko): This animal part is used to treat the Lungs and Kidneys. It strengthens the Kidneys, tonifies the Lungs and assists the Kidney Yang in augmenting the Jing and Blood.

Hai Gou Shen (Testes Et Penis Otariae) Sea Dog Genitals: This animal part is the male seals sexual organs. It is used to strengthen the Yang and Jing.

Hu Gu (Ostigris) Tiger Bone: This animal part is used to treat the Liver and Kidneys. It dispels wind dampness, disperses wind cold, and strengthens the sinews and bones.

Huo Zao (Calculus Macacae Mulattae) Monkey Jujube: This animal part is used to treat the Liver, Gall Bladder, Heart, and Lungs. It dislodges phlegm, controls spasms, stops wheezing, clears heat, and reduces toxic fire.

Ji Nei Jin (Endothelium Corneum Gigeriae Galli) Chicken Inner Gold: The Chicken Gizzard's internal lining is used to treat the Stomach, Spleen, Small Intestine, and Bladder. It strongly reduces food stagnation and improves the Spleen's transportational functions. It also transforms hardness and dissolves stones.

Ling Yang Jiao (Cornu Antelopes) Antelope Horn: This animal part is used to treat the Heart and Liver. It is used to extinguish wind, control spasms and convulsions, calm the Liver and root the Yang, improve vision, drain heat, and clear damp heat.

Niu Huang (Calculus Bovis) Cattle Yellow: This animal part is the cattle's gallstone (in some parts of China a water buffalo gallstone is used instead). It clears the Heart, opens the orifices, awakens the spirit, disperses phlegm, clears the Liver, relieves toxicity, extinguishes wind, and stops tremors.

Wu Ling Zhi (Excrementum Trogopteri Seu Pteromi) Fat of the Five Spirits: This animal part is the feces of the Flying Squirrel. It is used to disperse blood stagnation, stop bleeding, and alleviate pain.

Xi Jiao (Cornu Rhinoceri) Rhinoceros Horn: This animal part is used to treat the Heart, Liver, and Stomach. It clears heat, relieves toxic fire, cools the blood, and arrests tremors.

Xiong Dan (Vesica Fellea Ursi) Bear Gallbladder: This animal part is used to treat the Heart, Liver, and Gallblader. It clears heat and alleviates spasms, benefits the eyes, and reduces swelling and pain.

Ye Ming Sha (Excrementum Vespertilionis Murini) Night Brightness Sand: This animal part is the bat's feces. When combined with other herbs it can be used to affect the Liver Channel, improve vision, cure night blindness, and treat childhood malnutrition.

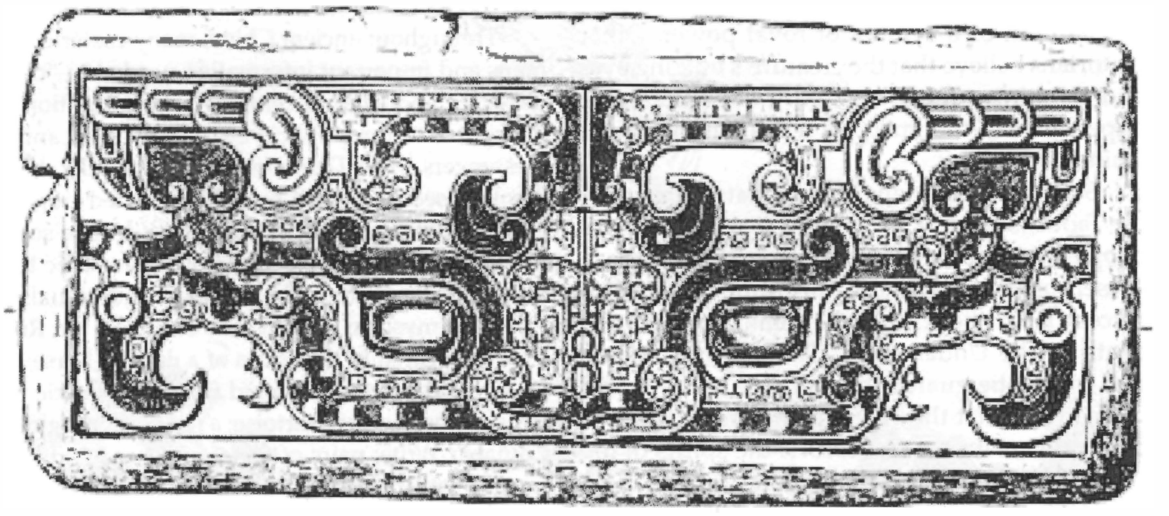


Figure 1.407. The ancient Chinese image of a "Taotie"

ANIMAL IMAGES OF ANCIENT CHINA

One of the great mysteries of ancient China is the origin and meaning of the terrifying animal faces etched onto ancient ritual vessels, carved into ancient weapons, and engraved onto bronze vessels that were left in ancient tombs. Many of these fierce animal faces are over 4,000 years old, but are just as terror-inspiring as they were during the times of bloody sacrifices performed during the Shang Dynasty (1600-1028 B.C.) period. Although the pattern of one particular type of animal image occurred on virtually all bronze vessels, almost nothing is known today about it, except for its name: "Taotie" (Figure 1.407).

The Taotie is a mixture of different kinds of animals. It has horns and fangs, and sometimes looks like a raging bull, other times it looks more like a fierce tiger. The most striking feature of the face is undoubtedly its piercing eyes. Some historians believe that this was part of the function of the Taotie - to watch over the slaughtering of the sacrificial victims.

Most Chinese archaeologists identify the Taotie pattern as having originated in or before the Erlitou culture (2000 B.C.-1500 B.C.) in Yanshi, Henan Province. It was during this time period that jade objects like daggers, axes, disks, and scepters were decorated with the faces of fierce animals with menacing teeth and claws, sharp horns, tails and legs.

The Chinese name "Taotie" was not the original name used to describe the fierce animal's image. This name was given to the animal image during the Song Dynasty (960-1279 A.D.) when scholars first began research into Chinese art. It is said that because the images of the Taotie monsters were so ravenous in appearance that the ancient Chinese scholars used the characters "Taotie" which contained the character for "eat."

As a motif, the Taotie image remained popular throughout the Shang Dynasty period, eventually changing in style and in meaning. Some historians believe that the fierce expression of the Taotie sug-

gest that it was originally intended to be a type of guardian or a symbol of royal power. Other historians believe that the creature's bulging eyes and prominent fangs marked the first tentative appearance of the image of a dragon in ancient Chinese history.

Still other historians believe that the image of the Taotie is one of a man-eating beast that harms people. Because the Taotie occurs on ritual bronze vessels used for sacrifices (including human sacrifices), it was believed to be some connection to death or the Underworld. One theory suggests that the Taotie guards the entrance to the world of death, or that the Taotie is the one of the Underworld creatures who escorts the spirits of the departed to their final destination.

During the Zhou Dynasty (1028-221 B.C.), the images of fierce looking animals eventually became dragons with button-like staring eyes. Over time, the image of the Taotie faded as a motif to be replaced during the Han Dynasty (206 B.C.-220 A.D.) by artistic influences from northern and western China. During this time period, the original compacted images of big, solid, monestrous animals transformed into the slim and friendly images of the imperial dragons.

The nomadic Xiongnu (northern Mongolian tribes of Central Asia) influenced the ancient Chinese artists to inlay their bronze weapons and implements with realistic hunting scenes that included tigers, deer, and even unicorns. At the same time, free-standing stone animal sculpture was being used for the first time, especially in the form of horses and bears. It was during this time period that the Fu Dog (Celestial Lion) made its first appearance in Chinese art. This was most likely due to the influence of certain relics of Assyria and Babylonia in addition to the influence of Buddhist art, which were both beginning to spread through China along the Silk Road. For the ancient Buddhists, the Celestial Lion was regarded as a protector of truth and a defender against evil. The Buddha Shakyamuni is referred to as the Lion of the Shakya clan, and in India, Celestial Lions were often shown supporting the Buddha's throne.

Chinese Totem Animals

Throughout ancient China, many esoteric talismans and important information needed to "create a change and save the empire" were traditionally brought into the public's eye via magical animal messengers. Many Daoist treasures, especially special "tools" used in ancient magic, originated from the sacred "markings" found on stones, dragon scales, tortoise shells, and jade. Most of these magic tools were specifically brought to chosen individuals by way of a mystical animal. For example: the River Chart appeared in the scales of a dragon-horse; the Lo Writings were deciphered from the esoteric patterns on the back of a tortoise; a red bird brought the Cinnabar Write; pairs of fishes appeared and birds transformed themselves into jade tablets and prophetic writings; a unicorn, seeing Confucius, covered its ears and spat out three scrolls, which predicted the rise of the Fire aura of the Han Dynasty; and while fishing, Daoist Tai Gong caught a fish, in whose belly was a Huang (a semi-circled jade seal), which eventually set the foundation for "Tai Gong's Military Art."

Because of the powerful influence brought about through the interactions with spirit animals, the Chinese created Totem Animals as a way of understanding, honoring, and categorizing them.

In ancient China, animals were divided into five classes, each with its own respective representative. The five classes of animals are described as follows:

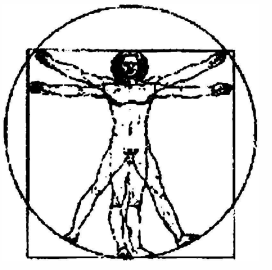
- **Feathered Creatures:** The feathered creatures were represented by the Phoenix.
- **Furry Creatures:** The furry creatures were represented by the Unicorn.
- **Naked Creatures:** The naked creatures were represented by Man.
- **Scaly Creatures:** The scaly creatures were represented by the Dragon.
- **Shelled Creatures:** The creatures with shells were represented by the Tortoise.

Each of the four animals represented the four powers of the four main directions (e.g., Phoenix-South, Turtle-North, Dragon-East, and Unicorn-West). These four powers surrounded and protected the energetic field of Man (Figure 1.408).

Animals are also used in the ancient Daoist skill of Feng Shui. Traditionally when keeping any animal, it was important that their color matched

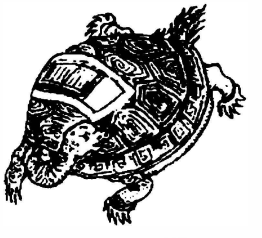
The Feathered Creatures were represented by the Phoenix

The Scally Creatures were represented by the Dragon



The Naked Creatures were represented by Man

The Furry Creatures were represented by the Unicorn



Creatures with Shells were represented by the Tortoise

Figure 1.408. The Four Animals represented the four powers of the four main directions which surrounded Man. They were originally believed to be the magical companions of Pan Gu Shi, the Grand Architect of the Universe.

the owner's birth season. This energetic correspondence was said to harmonize the relationship between the animal and the owner, increasing the power and the bond between the two, for example:

- **Spring:** An individual born in the Spring time should own an animal that is green or blue (bird, lizard, fish, etc.).
- **Summer:** An individual born in the Summer time should own an animal that is red or pink (bird, fish, etc.).
- **Late Summer:** An individual born in the Late Summer time should own an animal that is yellow or light brown (bird, cat, dog, fish, etc.).
- **Autumn:** An individual born in the Autumn time should own an animal that is white (bird, dog, cat, fish, etc.).
- **Winter:** An individual born in the Winter time should own an animal that is black, midnight blue, or purple (bird, cat, dog, fish, etc.).

Chinese Totem Animals are used to represent the instinctual, primitive, physical and sexual cravings and impulses that reside within the disciple's unconscious mind. They correspond to the "animal nature" of the disciple's Po and symbolize the various stages and archetypal forces that influence his or her psychic growth and development (manifesting through dreams, visions, and spiritual summoning).

The energetic nature of an animal icon is a direct manifestation of that creature's natural behavioral pattern and instinct. Therefore, animals that have Yin energetic patterns (i.e., quiet, stealthy, docile, etc.) manifest and radiate those energetic qualities; animals that have Yang energetic patterns (i.e. active, ostentatious, aggressive, etc.) manifest and radiate those energetic qualities. Once a disciple has chosen an animal totem (or the animal has chosen him or her), the personalities of the disciple and the animal begin to merge and certain attributes begin to manifest.

Animal totems are commonly observed within the dream realm, expressing the suppressed feelings from the deepest realms of the unconscious mind. They are imbedded within the energetic matrix through which the subconscious arises. For example, the more dangerous the manifested animal, the more urgent the need to address the situation; and the more mystical the animal, the greater the transcendence of spiritual consciousness.

Animals are also associated with various deities, religious figures, or spiritual systems. Such animals can appear either as "helpers" and "guides" within a dream, or as a specific warning of unapproved conduct.

The specific Element associated with each animal is based on each animals energetic characteristics and natural habits. For example, Earth Animals emerge from caves and under the soil, Water Animals emerge from the ocean, pools, rivers, etc.

The following is a list of Chinese Totem Animals, their ancient historical relevance, and specific energetic qualities. When choosing a specific animal totem, the energy and symbol of the chosen animal should vibrate in tandem with the priest's innermost needs. The more mindful the priest becomes of the animals specific magical traits and powers, the more focused and effective the energy will become.

Figure 1.409. Bat

Bats

Bats are associated with Yin, and the Water Element. The bat is a symbol of good luck and happiness (Figure 1.409). Bats live in caves, which represent portals to the beyond.

In China, a bat is called "Fuyi" ("Embracing Wings"), which describes the manner in which it spreads out and hangs by its wings. Other names given to the bat are "Tianshu" ("Heavenly Rat"), "Xianshu" ("Fairy Rat"), and "Yeyan" ("Night Swallow").

In Mandrin, the pronunciation of the word bat ("Fu") is identical to the pronunciation of the word for "good fortune" (Fu). This motif is expressed in artwork depicting a priest with a jar from which five bats are emerging.

Often a bat is shown flying upside down because the character for "upside-down" (dao) and the character meaning "to have arrived" (dao) are both pronounced the same. Therefore, if a person were to say "the bat is flying upside down" a listener could just as easily hear this as "happiness has arrived" which, of course, has a very auspicious connotation. Additionally, the term "a bat descending from the sky" (fuzi tianlai), sounds exactly like the term "happiness descends from heaven" (fuzi tianlai).

According to ancient Chinese belief, bats that are 1,000 years old are "white as silver, feed on stalactites, and hang from boughs with heads pointing downwards." It was believed that if you could catch one of them, dry it, and then eat it, you would live for a long time and have good vision.

Two bats facing each other mean double good fortune or happiness. A red bat is considered to be a harbinger of especially good fortune. Not only because of its cinnabar red color (which wards off demons), but because the Chinese word for red ("hong") sounds the same as for the word for "enormous." Therefore, red bats are said to bring abundance and great prosperity, especially when shown in a circular gathering of five red bats (the Yang symbol of prosperity). This five pattern magical emblem is extremely popular as it signifies the "Five Blessings From Heaven" (i.e., Old Age, Health, Wealth, Love of Virtue, and Natural Death).

It was believed to be an exceptionally good omen if a family of bats took up residence in your home. This omen represents immense good fortune and success for the entire household.

In ancient Chinese medicine, Ye Ming Sha (Night Brightness Sand) or Bat's feces (Excrementum Vespertilionis Murini) was combined with other herbs and used to affect the body's Liver Channel, improve vision and night blindness, and for treating childhood malnutrition.

BEAR

Bears are associated with Yang and the Wood Element (Figure 1.410). The bear stands for strength and courage, and it symbolizes "Man" (just as the snake symbolizes "Woman"). The constellation of the Great Bear (also known as the Bei Dou: North Star) is often represented as a magical icon positioned on altar vessels, swords, and other magical tools used in Daoist religious ceremonies.

Because of its seasonal hibernation and awakening in the Spring, the bear symbolizes the cycle of birth (merging from the Yin-darkness), death (retreating from Yang-light into darkness), and resurrection (rebirth).

The image of a bear is rarely depicted on Daoist magical charms and amulets. However, it is considered to be a powerful animal that the ancient Chinese believe could invoke fear in humans and evil spirits. Sometimes, a model or picture of a bear was used as a charm against robbers.

Sometimes, the image of a bear is shown with the image of an eagle. This is because an eagle or hawk (ying) together with a bear (xiong) sound just like the word "hero" (yingxiong).

Figure 1.410. Bear

In the Daoist Wudang system of Baguazhang (Eight Trigram Palm, based on the Internal Martial Arts system of the Yi-Jing), the Bear is symbolized through the Gen Trigram, which represents the Mountain. The top Yang line signifies something firm and solid, while the two bottom Yin lines signify the Earth, creating the image of a mountain.

The Bear's physical attributes are that of resting and keeping still, with the sudden ability to energetically release forceful power and "uproot." When related to spiritual manifestations, the Bear is known for its perceptive intuitions and patience.

In martial application, the Bear will usually wait and counterattack by rushing in when the opponent is off balance in his stepping, posture, or mind. He will wait calmly until his opponent is within striking range and then seize the correct moment to "whip" his paw to strike the opponent. The body's intrinsic energy is the most explosive in the Bear. A good example of the Bear's strategy is: when fighting an opponent who is faster then himself, the Bear will simply move out of range and wait for an opening. This application is similar to that of encountering an antagonistic hornet at a picnic. First you roll up a newspaper in order to swat a hornet. Because of the hornet's speed and skillful evasive maneuverability, you must have patience and wait for the proper moment to strike. Then, at the appropriate time, you strike.

In ancient Chinese medicine, Xiong Dan (Vesica Fellea Ursi) or Bear Gallbladder, was used to treat the Heart, Liver, and Gall Bladder, and also to clear heat, alleviate spasms, benefit the eyes, and reduce swelling and pain.

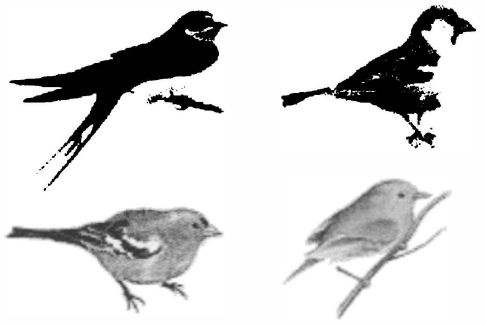


Figure 1.411. Birds

Figure 1.412. Cat

BIRDS

Birds are associated with Yang, and are generally associated with the Metal Element (Figure 1.411); however, the specific Element of each bird varies according to its energetic color and function (i.e., hummingbirds, ravens, and crows relate to the Fire Element).

In the energetic world of Daoist mysticism, birds play an important role. From observing the of actions flying-fish, the ancient Chinese believed that birds evolved from fish. Therefore birds were considered more important than fish in energetic evolution, and they were used to represented messengers of the Divine in ancient China.

Birds are a symbol of freedom, they represent the Eternal Soul (Shen Xian) attaining enlightenment, higher states of consciousness, transcendence, and the embodiment of celestial things.

The following birds have a particular symbolic significance in ancient Daoist mysticism: Cranes, Eagles, Magpies, Orioles, Pheasants, Quails, and Swallows. In ancient China, the leader of the feathered creatures has always been represented by the mythical Phoenix.

According to ancient Chinese mythology, birds are considered to be messengers from the gods, and the carriers of souls of the dead to the celestial realms (especially cranes). A common practice in all ancient Daoist monasteries was to hang feathers around the doorposts in order to repel evil influences. A feather found on the ground was believed to be a gift from the Divine, and a very auspicious omen. These feathers were usually brought indoors and placed in all four directions around the door frames. There is also an ancient Daoist tradition to give feathers to good friends (however, you are never permitted to ask for them in advance). If the wind blew away the feather, it was not considered auspicious, however, you were never allowed to throw the feathers away yourself.

In ancient Daoism there are many tales of mystics who could understand the language of the birds and used this knowledge to get themselves out of danger. The ancient Daoists believed that the birds also keep the grave of Emperor Yu clean. They also brought Earth (soil) to the burial places of holy men and used their feathers to cover their corpses. Although good people may be rewarded in some way by birds, there are also bird-demons that one must be on guard against.

CATS

The cat is considered to be a Yin animal, and it is strongly connected to the realm of the dead (Figure 1.412). Cats also represent energetic aspects of stealth, mystery, sexuality, sensuality, and power.

The cat ("Mao") symbolizes wishes for a long life, because it has the same pronunciation as the word for an 80 year old or "octogenarian" (mao).

The ancient Chinese believed that a cat possessed demonic powers, and because of their eyesight, it is believed to be able to see spirits in the dark. To the ancient Daoists, a cat's cry was compared to a demon crying from hell. According to writing from the *Standard Annals*, imperial

consorts implicitly believed in the possibility of individuals changing themselves after death into cats and taking revenge on those men and women who persecuted them during life.

In ancient China, in order to work evil, certain priests would either project their souls as a phantom image of a cat, or project their souls into the living animal and use it as a vehicle. This magical technique was known as the black art of "Cat Sorcery," and was accomplished through means of sacrifices, spells and incantations. It was generally used in order to steal an individual's possessions by inducing sickness or death. So powerful was the magical art of Cat Sorcery, that during the Sui Dynasty (581-618 A.D.) the emperor issued an Imperial Decree to persecute and destroy all families accused of it.

In the province of Zhejiang, white cats are never kept. This is reflected in the folk-belief that if a white cat climbed onto the roof at night, it would steal the moonbeams and could even turn into a mischievous spirit (in China the color "white" is the symbol of death). It is also believed that if a cat jumped over a coffin the corpse would revive and become one of the "undead," haunting people in the surrounding area.

In ancient Chinese, it was sometimes believed that if a strange cat has her kittens in an individual's house, it was considered to be a very bad omen. Also, if a strange cat enters into the house, it is considered to be an omen of poverty. The belief that a strange cat entering one's house was an inauspicious omen was contrived from the belief that the cat instinctively knows that there will soon be lots of rats entering into the house, and these rodents will soon eat the family out of house and home.

The ancient Chinese believed that the cat not only resembled the tiger in outward shape, but also in characteristics as well. Therefore, any contact between a cat and a corpse was considered to be particularly dangerous on "tiger days" of the month, when the influence of the feline race predominates nature.

One cat that is traditionally associated with overcoming evil is the lion. Pairs of lions (male and female) can have a dramatic effect on a place's Fung Shui. However, because of their power, the placement of the lions should be used with extreme caution and placed at the front door only (facing away from the house and never in towards the house).

Since cats eat mice, and mice destroy silkworm larvae and cocoons, the cat was appointed the "Patron Saint" of the silk industry. Pictures of cats are hung on the walls of rooms devoted to the breeding of caterpillars.

The Chinese are particular in selecting a cat, and consider those with yellow eyes and numerous ridges in the roof of its mouth to be the best. When choosing a cat, they will use a pair of chopsticks to open its mouth and count the ridges. Also, a litter of two kittens is considered to be an ideal number for giving birth. Any more then two tends to make the kittens weak in constitution. A "butterfly" cat is considered to be very auspicious. This is a tabby with blotched instead of striped markings (usually symmetrical), and roughly in the shape of the insect's wings. The combination of cat and butterfly denotes longevity (from seventy to ninety years), which probably accounts for its popularity.

According to one Chinese author, it is possible to tell the time of day by observing a cat's eyes. At midnight, noon, sunrise and sunset the cat's pupil is like a thread. At 4:00 and 10:00, morning and evening, it is round like the Full Moon. At 2:00 and 8:00 it is elliptical, like the kernel of a date. According to the same author, the end of a cat's nose is always cold except on the day of the Summer Solstice (around June 21st), when it becomes warm.

Additionally, the powdered bone of a cat's head was sometimes used to heal diseased states of the body and mind caused from demonic oppression, Ku Poison, and pain in the heart and belly.

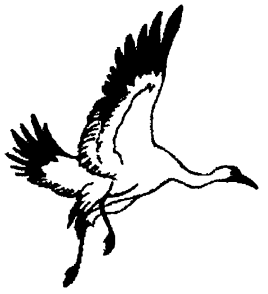


Figure 1.413. Crane

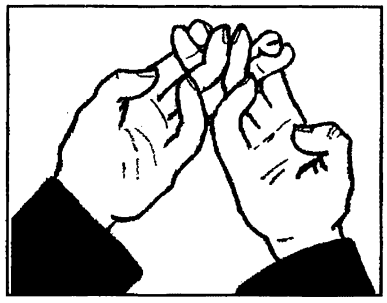


Figure 1.414. The White Crane Double Hand Seal

CRANE

Cranes are associated with Yin and the Water Element. The crane is one of the many ancient Daoist symbols of longevity, wisdom, and immortality (Figure 1.413). These beautiful long-necked birds with a red tuft of feathers on their foreheads are often seen in Chinese art depicted with the God of Longevity.

The crane is the messenger of Spring and the symbol of rejuvenation. Because of its attribute to longevity, the crane is often pictured together with a pine tree and a stone, which is said to energetically triple the magical symbol of longevity.

The image of the crane was traditionally embroidered on the robes of high government officials. Because the Chinese pronunciation for the word Crane "He" is the same as that for the word "harmony" (He), the crane is sometimes shown on Daoist magic charms used to imply a good and harmonious marriage.

In ancient China, Daoist priests admired the crane for its untiring strength in flight, therefore a crane's wing fan was sometimes used as an magical amulet to fight against becoming exhausted and tired. The Daoist priest's White Crane Feather Fan was also believed to have the magical ability of reviving the dead.

Expressions like "Heavenly Crane" (Tian He) or "Blessed Crane" (Xian He) point to the wonderful qualities attributed to the crane in its secondary role as a symbol of wisdom. The third attribute, immortality, is sometimes symbolized by a picture of a Daoist priest ascending to the celestial realms on the back of a giant crane (or in a cart drawn by a giant crane).

There are said to be four kinds of Crane: the white, yellow, blue, and black (which lives the longest). According to Chinese mythology, when the crane reaches 600 years old, it drinks water but no longer takes in food. When it reaches a thousand years old, it becomes blue; when it lives a second millennium, it becomes black, and is known as a "dark-colored crane." To the ancient Daoists, the crane's blood was considered to be the seat of the birds soul, and was therefore used in the construction of Immortal pills and immortal elixirs during the Han Dynasty (206 B.C.-220 A.D.).

In ancient China, the death of a Daoist priest was said to be Yu Hua, "the soul turning into a (crane) feather." Additionally, the figure of a crane with outspread wings and an uplifted foot is sometimes placed on the center of a coffin in a funeral procession. The picture is used to convey that the soul of the departed has been taken to the Western Heaven on the back of the celestial crane.

In ancient China, garments of crane plumage were particularly appropriate to Daoist adepts. By the Tang Dynasty (618-907 A.D.), such a garment became the stereotype of "retirement from the imperial court to take up the life of a Daoist recluse."

In ancient Daoist rituals, the White Crane Hand Seals are often used for specific evocations or worship, for example:

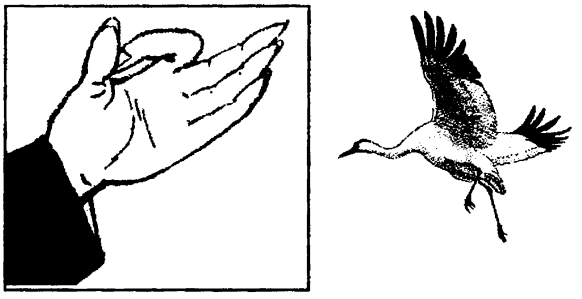


Figure 1.415. The White Crane Single Hand Seal

Figure 1.416. Deer

- **The White Crane Double Hand Seal:** This is a two-handed Hand Seal that is used for Worship (Figure 1.414). It represents the immortal crane and is energetically used to cross the spiritual waters of the afterlife, riding on the back of the crane.
- **The White Crane Single Hand Seal:** This Single Hand Seal is also used for Worship (Figure 1.415). It is energetically used to show respect to the Celestial Immortals. The last three fingers (held straight) symbolize an offering of three incense to the Celestial Immortals. The first finger and thumb represent the eternal circle and the infinite space of the Wuji through which to access the Di (Divine or God).

DEER

Deer are associated with Yin and the Wood Element. The Chinese word for deer "Lu" is the exact phonetic equivalent to "good income," which symbolizes wealth (Figure 1.416). However, more frequently it is used as a symbol for longevity. In ancient China, deer were considered to be supernatural beings and messengers of Forest Spirits. They were believed to bring speed, endurance, and long life.

The deer is traditionally believed to be the only animal able to find the magical lingzhi fungus of immortality. Therefore, the deer is often seen by the side of Shou, the God of Longevity.

In ancient China, this magical whisk (also known as the Deer's Tail Whisk) was originally constructed from the tail of the alpha stag, who served as the leader of the herd. It was believed that, as the deer followed this stag's tail, so too would the disciples follow the magical teachings and divine authority of the one who carried the whisk.

Deer are among the most frequently seen animals drawn on Daoist magic charms. The Chinese character for deer "Lu," also referred to the salary a government official receives. A picture of a deer is therefore expressing a wish for a top government office with a high salary.

In ancient Chinese medicine, Lu Rong (Cornu Cervi Parvum) or Deer Antler, was used to treat the Kidneys and Liver. It tonifies the Kidneys, fortifies the Yang, tonifies the Governing Vessel, regulates the Thrusting and Conception Vessels and tonifies the Qi and Blood.

In ancient Chinese medicine, She Xiang (Secretio Moschus) or Navel Gland Secretions of the Musk Deer, was used to treat the Heart, Spleen, and Liver. It is used to intensely open the orifices, revive the spirit, invigorate blood, dissipate clumps, reduce swelling, and alleviate pain.

In ancient Chinese medicine, Ling Yang Jiao (Antelope Horn), was used to treat the Heart and Liver, extinguish wind, control spasms and convulsions, calm the Liver and root the Yang, improve vision, drain heat, and clear damp heat.

Figure 1.417. Dog

Dogs

Dogs are associated with Yang, the specific Element of a dog is determined by its color and energetic characteristic (i.e., a black vicious dog is associated with the Water Element, a friendly yellow dog is associated with the Earth Element).

The dog is considered to be a companion, guardian, and protector of the spiritual realms (Figure 1.417). The dog is regarded as the companion of the Chinese God Er-Lang (Figure 1.418), who purifies the world by ridding it of evil demons. In ancient China, paper dogs used to be thrown in the water on the fifth day of the fifth month in order to bite the evil spirits and drive them away. The dead were also given paper dogs for their protection. Lunatics were traditionally washed with dog's dirt in order to expel the demons who had possessed the individual.

According to ancient Chinese myths, the dog can be used as a guide to the underworld, and is sometimes associated with transformational abilities. It is also believed that neither dogs or cats should be buried as they will turn into demons. If any individual was suspected of being a spirit they were sprinkled with dog's blood causing the spirit to transform into its real image.

A pure white dog, being the color of mourning, was not considered to be an asset in Chinese culture. The ancient Chinese *Book of Five Elements* state, "Should a man breed a black dog with white ears, he shall become rich and noble. If he produces a white dog with a yellow head, his family will prosper. A yellow dog with a white tail will ensure that his descendents in every generation become officials. A black dog with white forelegs signifies the birth of many male children in the family. A yellow dog with white forelegs brings good luck, however, a white dog with a black head adds riches to good fortune. And finally, a white dog with a black tail will cause the family through all generations to ride in chariots."

Figure 1.418. Chinese God Er-Lang

According to the ancient Chinese *Book of Rites*, dogs are classified into Hunting Dogs, Watch Dogs, and those commonly known as the Edible Variety (which were bred for eating). The food value of the dog was assessed according to their color, described as follows:

- **Black Dogs:** This type of dog was believed to be the most nutritious. A dish of black dog meat was credited with the power of reducing fatigue due to lack of sleep. In ancient times, it was accordingly prescribed for students who were competing in the provincial and national examinations.

The following is a secret magical procedure used in ancient China to energetically imprint the meat of a black dog with powerful concentration Qi. It was commonly used by students for gaining stronger emotional concentration when competing in the provincial and national examinations:

A hungry black dog is tied up within the sight of a large plate of food. The emotion of hunger is increased by periodically changing the meal for one that is more appetizing. Once the hungry dogs deeply imprinted focused concentration and directed intention towards the food has reached its peak, the animal's head is immediately chopped off. The meat was now believed to contain the powerful essence of focused and directed concentration, and was believed to be immediately transferred to any who ate the meat.

- **Flowery Dogs:** This type of dog was composed of mixed color and deemed to be the most palatable.
- **Yellow and White Dogs:** These types of dog were considered to be a lower grade of meat.

At one time, puppies were fattened on rice, reaching culinary maturity at nine months. However, in 1915, the public marketing of dog meat was prohibited by the Republic of China (1912-1949).

Animal imagery has always been an important element in Chinese art, but few animal icons have lasted as long as the "Fu Dogs" (or Chinese Lions). The ancient Chinese believed that Fu dogs were really lions (sometimes known as a "Celestial Dog" or "Lions of Buddha"). The Fu Dog can trace its ancestry back over 3000 years to the Spitz and several other Asian breeds. According to some scholars, the Fu Dogs (or Foo Dogs) take their name from "fojiao," the Chinese term for Buddhism, while other scholars claim that the name was derived from the city of Fuchow. In Greater Tibet, this guardian lion is also known as a Snow Lion.

Figure 1.419. Chinese Fu Dogs (or Celestial Dogs) are also known as Lions of Bubbha

The Chinese Fu Dog is sometimes known as the Happiness Dog (Fu is the Chinese word for happiness, good fortune, and blessing). It was originally a hunting dog, a working dog, and a family protector. Fu Dogs are powerful mythical protectors that have traditionally stood in front of Chinese imperial palaces, temples, emperors' tombs, government offices, the homes of government officials, and the wealthy since the Han Dynasty (206 BC-220 AD).

These Chinese lions usually appear as male and female pairs, with the male lion holding a ball under one paw, and the female lion holding a lion cub lying on its back (Figure 1.419). One Chinese legend holds that female lions have nipples on the bottoms of their paws which they use to suckle the cub. The ball is believed to represent the union of Heaven and Earth, or the totality of Buddhist law, and the cub is believed to represent the world.

In Daoism, dogs are considered to be Yang, while cats are considered to be Yin. Therefore, when buying Fu Dogs it is important that they have more of a Yang quality.

DRAGONS

The dragon is one of China's most complex and multidimensional symbols. It is symbol of natural male vigor and fertility (Yang), and the Fire Element.

According to ancient legend, the first king of Chine was Fu Xi, who was said to have lived 6,500 years ago. It is said the Fu Xi created his capital in Wan Qiu and dominated nine tribes. Each of the nine tribes had its own animal totem (python, deer, tiger, crocodile, lizard, carp, eagle, whale and shark). At the first alliance of the nine Hua Xia tribes, Fu Xi combined the nine animal totems and created a new totem, with the body of a python, a crocodile's head, a deer's horns, a tiger's eyes, a lizard's legs, an eagle's claws, a carp's scales, a shark's tail, a whale's whiskers, and named it "Long" (Dragon). Gradually, the Dragon totem became the imperial symbol of power, representing integration and unification.

From the Han Dynasty (206 BC-220 AD) onwards, the dragon became the symbol of the Chinese emperor, the Son of Heaven. The emperor was therefore always closely connected with the Dragon God, and his throne was known as the "Dragon Throne." It was said that the celestial powers of the Dragon God can be used to preserve, sustain, or destroy, likewise, the terrestrial powers of the emperor can be used to preserve, sustain, or destroy. Until the revolution of 1911, the Chinese flag consisted of a great fierce-looking dragon on a yellow background.

The dragon's claws on a ceremonial dress represented the specific rank of the upper class. Therefore, the dragon on the emperor's robe had five claws; four claws indicated a prince; and three or less claws indicated an official.

Traditionally, there are three types of dragons mentioned in Chinese mythology: the Sky Dragon, the Water Dragon, and the Mountain Dragon. Each of these three dragons are described as follows:

THE SKY DRAGON

The Sky Dragon (Long) is the primary dragon, acknowledged in most Chinese art and sculpture. It is generally portrayed as a composite animal, with the head of a camel, the horns of a stag, the eyes of a demon, the ears of an ox, the neck of snake, the belly of a frog, the scales of a carp, the claws of an eagle, and the palm of a tiger. Along the dragon's back, there is a ridge numbering eighty-one scales; the scales on its throat lie towards its head, and those on the head resemble the ridges in a chain of mountains. On it head is the "Qi Lump," that acts like a gas-bag and enables the dragon to soar through the air. The body has three joined parts, the first being the head to shoulders, the second being the shoulders to the breast, the third being the breast to its tail.

Figure 1.420. Dragon

On each side of the dragon's mouth are whiskers, and its chin is decorated with a beard (Figure 1.420). The scales number 117, of which 81 are imbued with Yang (good) influence, and 36 with bad Yin (bad) influence (i.e., the Sky Dragon is part Preserver and part Destroyer).

The Sky Dragon breathes a sort of vapor, which may coagulate as rain or become incandescent, and its voice is as the sound of copper pans clashing (like cymbals). Additionally, its magical breath can sometimes change into water, and in other times transform into fire.

According to ancient Chinese mythology, the Sky Dragon lives in the water and acquires five colors from its aquatic environment, allowing it to become a powerful spirit. If it wishes, it can make itself as small as a silkworm or so large that it can cover the entire world; it can fly among the clouds of Heaven or dive into the deepest springs of the Earth. Constantly changing, the dragon can rise or fall, expand or contract, whenever it likes.

The dragon is imagined as spending the Winter within the deepest springs, under the Earth. On the second day of the second month of the year he rises from the Earth into the Heavens, thus causing the first Spring thunderstorm and rainfall. In Northern China this was a sign for the farmers to start planting.

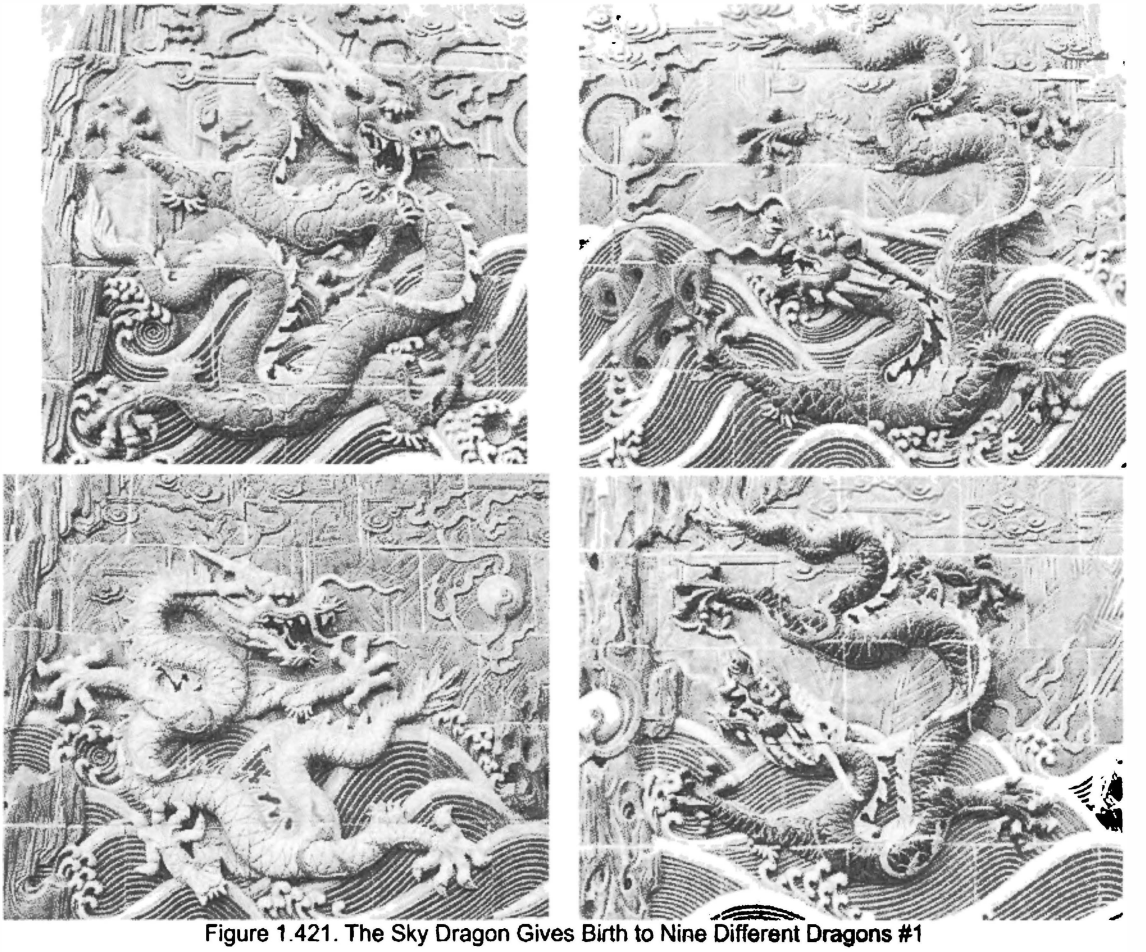


Figure 1.421. The Sky Dragon Gives Birth to Nine Different Dragons #1

In regards to diet, the Sky Dragons are believed to feed on the flesh of swallows. In ancient times, when people prayed for rain, it was common to throw swallows into the water to ensure the help of the dragon.

The Sky Dragon gives birth to nine different dragon species. In ancient China, these nine dragons were traditionally used in decoration, according to their individual characteristics, described as follows (Figure 1.421 through Figure 1.423):

The Pu Lao Dragon: Traditionally, bronze bells and gongs often have the Pu Lao Dragon cast as a ring for suspension purposes. This is because, it is believed that this particular form of dragon cries out loudly when it is attacked by its primary enemy, the whale.

The Qiu Niu Dragon: This type of dragon is believed to have musical taste, and is often carved as an embellishment for Erhu (the Chinese fiddle) screws.

The Bi Xi Dragon: This type of dragon is addicted to literature, and is often carved on the top of stone tablets, bottom of stone monuments, and used as a motif on the pedestal of tombstones. The Bi Xi Dragon is considered to be a river god, and endowed with supernatural strength.

The Ba Xia Dragon: This type of dragon is able to handle great weight. Therefore, it is often used as a monumental ornament.

The Chao Feng Dragon: This type of dragon has an inclination for dangerous situations. Therefore, it is often placed on the eaves of temples.

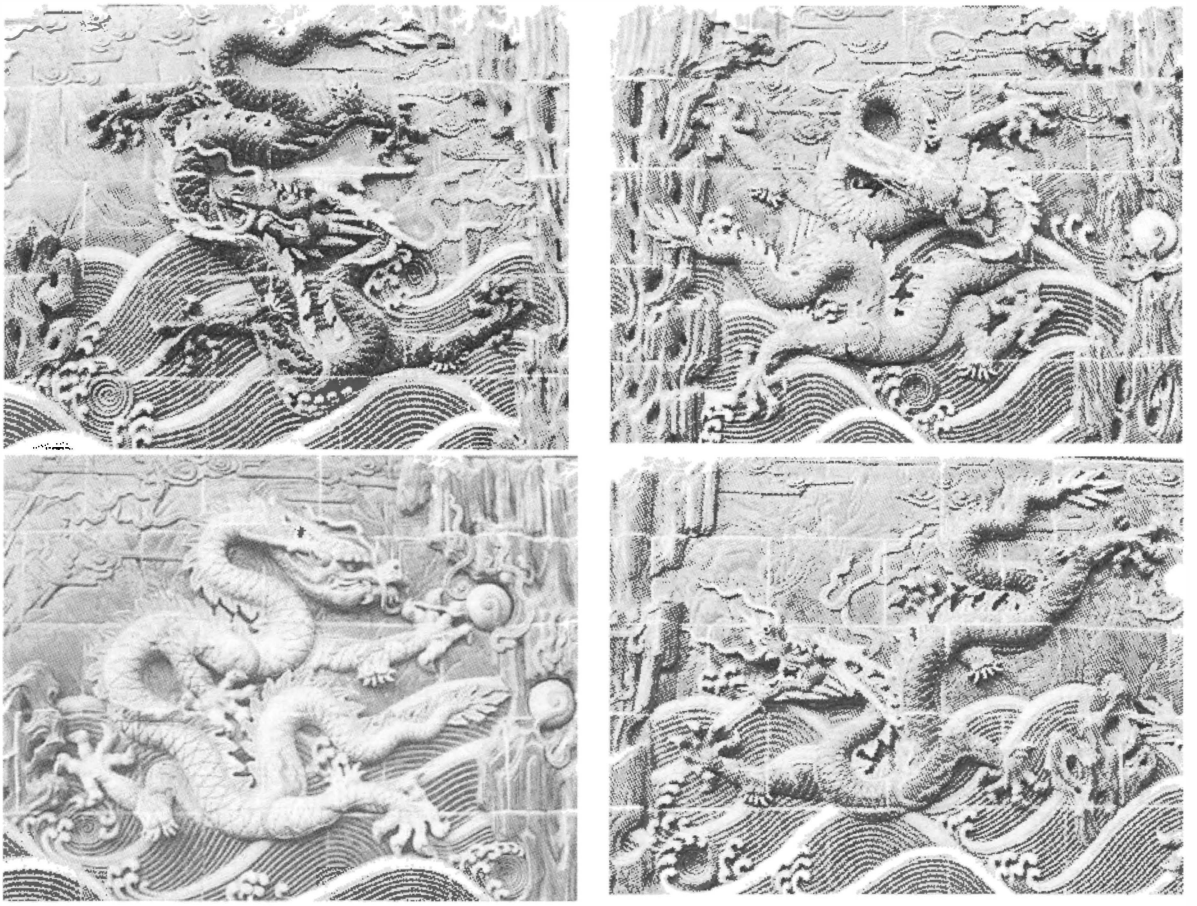


Figure 1.422. The Sky Dragon Gives Birth to Nine Different Dragons #2

The Chi Wen Dragon: This type of dragon has a fondness for water. Therefore, it is often carved on the road-bearing posts (beams) of bridges, and on the roofs of buildings (in order to keep off fire). It likes to gaze and look out, and is sometimes represented as a fish with an upturned tail.

The Suan Ni Dragon: This type of dragon is a restful creature, and is often drawn emanating a calm and peaceful ambiance surrounding the emperor's throne.

The Ya Zi Dragon: This type of dragon is the bloodthirsty member of the group. Because of its lust for slaughter, it is often used as a magical guard and placed on the hilt of a sword.

The Ya Yu Dragon: This type of dragon is also believed to be addicted to human flesh. However, it only appears when the ruling emperor is suf-

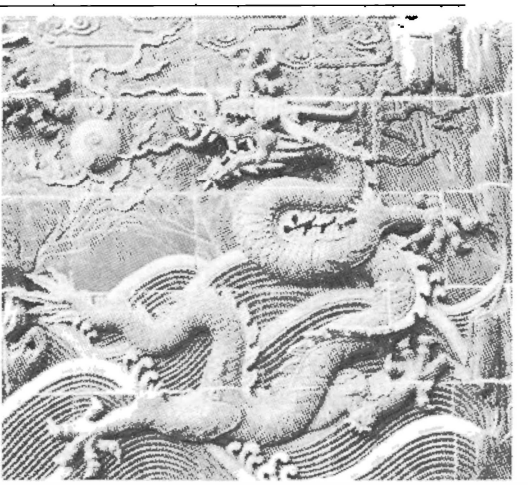


Figure 1.423. The Sky Dragon Gives Birth to Nine Different Dragons #3

ficiently lacking in virtue. It is a scaly beast with one horn, and is forty feet long. It is composed of a dragon's head, the body of a horse, and the claws of a tiger. Sometimes known as the fierce "Bi An Dragon," because it is addicted to "litigation and quarreling," it is commonly found on prison-gates.

THE WATER DRAGON

The Water Dragon (Li) is generally portrayed as a hornless dragon that dwells in oceans and large lakes. Water Dragons are closely associated with waterfalls. They are believed to dwell inside the deep pools the are located below waterfalls.

The Water Dragon was also said to possess the ability of raising great ocean waves in order to injure men and boats. According to ancient belief, a waterspout was thought to be the movement of a living Water Dragon, and the swelling of the waves was attributed to the "enchantment" of the creature's magic.

THE MOUNTAIN DRAGON

The Mountain Dragon (Jiao) is generally portrayed as a scaly reptile, who dwells in marshes and mountain caves. It has a small hornless head and neck, with a deep purplish red (crimson) chest. Its back has green stripes, and its sides are yellow. It has four legs, but resembles a snake, thirteen feet in length.

The "Dragon Well" is usually located deep inside a mountain cave. This secret well is believed to be owned and created by the Mountain Dragon. According to ancient belief, when a Yellow Mountain Dragon, born from yellow gold a thousand years old, enters a deep place, a yellow spring dashes fourth; and if from this spring some fine dust arises, these become a yellow cloud.

DRAGON LORE

The dragon traditionally stands for the direction of the East (Wood Element), the region of sunrise, fertility, spring rains, and rain in general. This is why in ancient China, wooden dragons were commonly used for rainmaking purposes.

The dragon symbolically represents the art of "seeing" and making internal connections to the spirit world. Sometimes the dragon is pictured playing with a "ball," which represents the celestial power of the sun. In ancient China, a portrait used for bringing power and good luck contained one, two, four, or nine dragons (never three).

In China, it was believed that magical dragons lived in the waters of the Earth and within the cloudy mists of the sky. Therefore the dragon was believed to posses the power to overturn the clouds and send down the rain. The three most auspicious colors for a dragon are deep dark blue-green (almost black), red, and yellow. Green Dragons (i.e., green snakes, green lizards, green crocodiles, etc.) were considered to be the Earthly species of Heavenly Dragons, and were believed to provide numerous health benefits to mankind.

As a magical animal, the dragon wields the power of transformation, and can choose to be either visible or invisible. According to the ancient *Shouwen Dictionary*, "In the spring, the dragon ascends to the Heavens, and in the autumn, it buries itself in the watery depths. It covers itself with mud in the autumn equinox, and emerges in the spring time, thus announcing by its awakening the return of nature's energies by means of magical rains."

On the day that it ascends into the Heavens it cannot be seen because it is hidden within the rain clouds on which it rides.

According to ancient legend, the dragons sleep under the water in order to "preserve the magical energies of their bodies." In the Spring time, they awaken and arise, ascending into the clouds. As in all rites of spring mating rituals, they soon begin to fight for celestial territory. These "dragon battles" that occur after the dry season are welcomed, creating thunder storms and torrents of needed rain.

When dragons fight, fire-balls and pearls fall to the ground. The pearls promise abundant supplies of water for the future. According to ancient belief, in order for all to go well with the agriculturist, it is imperative that the Blue / Green Dragons (the main spirit of water and rain) and the Golden Yellow Dragons prevail over the other dragons (i.e., the Red, White, and Black Dragons).

If too many dragons engage in battle, however, and the celestial war in the sky continues longer than desired, all of the rivers will rise and flood, causing great destruction and loss of life. Because the emperor was closely connected with the head Dragon God, social upheavals and war could result. In ancient China, it was believed

that this type of weather calamity was the consequence of the failure of both the Daoist priest and the emperor to control the dragons. The dynasty might therefore be overthrown by the indignant and ruined peasants.

Four Dragon Manifestations

In ancient China, the dragon was attributed to four types of magical power and manifestation, described as follows:

- **Celestial Dragon (Tian Long):** This dragon symbolized the manifestation of the magical regenerative power of the Heavens. It protects and supports the various mansions of the gods.
- **Spirit Dragon (Shen Long):** This dragon symbolized the magical creation and release of rain. It produces wind and rain to benefit all of mankind.
- **Earth Dragon (Di Long):** This dragon symbolized the manifestation of the magical power that controls all pools, rivers, springs, and water courses.
- **Treasure Guarding Dragon (Fu Cang Long):** This guardian dragon protects all magical treasure. It mounts guard over the wealth concealed from mortal eye.

The Five Dragon Gods-Kings

The Dragon Gods, sometimes known as Dragon Kings (Figure 1.424), were believed to have all hatched from beautiful magical stones. The specific colors of the stones were supposed to reveal the esoteric characteristics of the dragon spirits that inhabited them. Therefore, to the ancient Chinese, certain beautiful stones were called "dragon's eggs." It was believed that when the dragon's eggs were split open, lightening would immediately flash, thunder bellowed, and darkness would cover the sky. It was also believed that before the young dragon (about the size of a worm) came out of the magical gem, much water would pour out of the stone before the new-born dragon ascended into the Heavens.

According to ancient Daoist believed, there were five powerful Dragon Kings (Long Wang), each ruling over one of the four seasons, seas that encompass the Earth, and the subterranean palaces which form their respective abodes. These Five Dragon Kings are described as follows:

Figure 1.424. Dragon King of the Southern Sea

- **The Blue/Green Dragon King of the East:** He is ruler over Spring time, the Eastern Sea, and is sometimes known as Guan De (The Releaser of Virtue).
- **The Red Dragon King of the South:** He is ruler over the greater part of Summer time, the Southern Sea, and is sometimes known as Guan Li (The Releaser of Goodness).
- **The Yellow Dragon King of the Center:** He is ruler over the last months of Summer time, and is sometimes known as the Guardian of the Center Palace.
- **The White Dragon King of the West:** He is ruler over the Autumn time, the Western Sea, and is sometimes known as Guan Run (The Releaser of Favor).
- **The Black Dragon King of the North:** He is ruler over the Winter time (the Chinese season for drought), the Northern Sea, and is sometimes known as Guan Ze (The Releaser of Generosity).

These Five Dragon Kings play an important role in ancient Daoist magic, responsible for the seasons, food supply, and controlling disease (i.e. plagues). Each Dragon King was also believed to dwell in a splendid palace filled with beautiful and valuable treasures.

THE NINE PALACE/BAGUA DRAGONS

According to certain ancient Daoist teachings, there are nine dragons that correspond to the Nine Palaces of the Magic Square. Each of the Nine Dragons is also associated with a specific magical power and trigram location of the Prenatal Bagua. It is said that these nine celestial creatures have the ability to provide generous gifts to assist humanity in their evolution. The Nine Dragons and their trigram locations are described as follows (Figure 1.425):

- **The Heavenly Dragon (Qian Trigram):** This trigram is located at the top, and is associated with the peak of Yang energy.
- **The Wind Dragon (Xun Trigram):** This trigram gives way to Yin entering Yang at the bottom of the trigram.
- **The Water Dragon (Kan Trigram):** This trigram is located on the right side, and is associated with Yin surrounding Yang .
- **The Mountain Dragon (Gen Trigram):** This trigram causes Yin to push Yang upwards to the top.
- **The Earth Dragon (Kun Trigram):** This trigram is located at the bottom, and is associated with the peak of Yin energy.
- **The Sky Dragon (Zhen Trigram):** This trigram gives way to Yang entering Yin at the bottom of the trigram.
- **The Fire Dragon (Li Trigram)** This trigram is located on the left side of the trigrams, and is associated with Yang surrounding Yin.
- **The Sea Dragon (Dui Trigram):** This trigram causes Yang to push Yin to the top.
- **Golden Dragon (Center Palace):** This represents the center core of the Bagua configuration. All of the other trigram powers surround the Golden Dragon.

THE DRAGONS PEARL

The dragon is traditionally pictured playing in the clouds with a ball (or pearl). In certain traditions the pearl represents thunder and causes the rain to fall; in other traditions, the pearl represents the Sun. The pearl may also be thought of as a metaphor for perfection and enlightenment, particularly if the dragon represents the emperor.

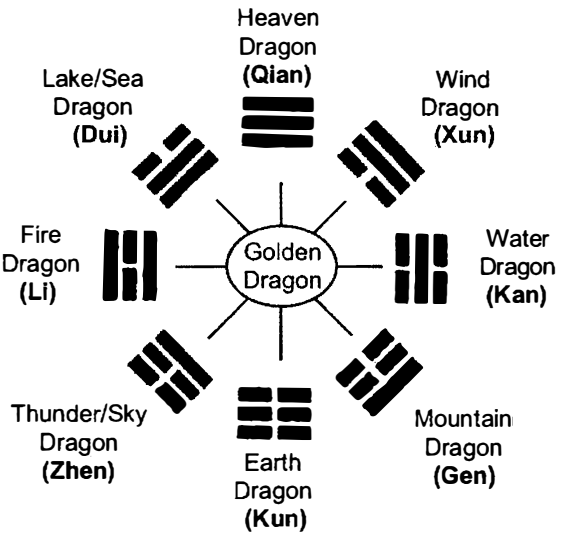


Figure 1.425. The Prenatal Bagua Trigrams: The manifestation of opposite polar forces (Yin across from Yang). This Cycle of Harmony relates to the world of thoughts and ideas. The movements of the Eight Dimensions or phases of energy are reflected within their opposite energetic forces, and are responsible for the creation of all phenomena.

In one story, the pearl also resembles the moon. As a dragon devours the pearl, less and less of the pearl is seen and the pearl appears as a waning moon. As a dragon disgorges the pearl, more and more of the pearl is seen and the pearl therefore appears as a waxing moon. The dragon and pearl thus symbolize the endless cycle of transformation.

Frequently, the "pearl" is shown with flames which symbolizes magical powers and may represent the wish-granting pearl of Buddhism. The flaming pearl is one of the Eight Treasures. The pearl can also refer to riches, pure intentions and genius in obscurity.

According to one legend, long ago the Jade Emperor gave the fireball to the dragons to lure them out of the sea, because they were racing around making a lot of waves and causing floods and tidal waves. They were so frisky, that they even made the rivers overflow. The people of the Earth complained to the Jade Emperor and asked him to get the dragons to calm down. After several

attempts at trying to calm the dragons down, the Jade Emperor decided to change his approach and thought of a way to get the dragons out of the water. He presented them with a magic fireball that couldn't get wet. The dragons found the fireball irresistible. Over time, the chasing and playing with the fireball eventually calmed the dragons, and they began to meditate and become wise. Now dragons are a model of self-mastery, inner-wisdom, and spiritual protection.

According to ancient Chinese legend, dragons, like certain fish, do not ejaculate inside their female counterparts but on them. The females are then impregnated by absorbing the semen through their gills and scales. If any semen is not absorbed by the female dragon, but falls to Earth, it congeals and becomes "Dragon Jade."

DAOIST WUDANG DRAGON TRAINING

In the Daoist Wudang system of Baguazhang (Eight Trigram Palm, based on the Yi-Jing), the Dragon is symbolized through the Zhen Trigram, which represents Thunder, and corresponds to lightning and movement. The Zhen Trigram is symbolized by a Yang line positioned beneath two Yin lines. The Yang line represents something dynamic and explosive trying to break free, while the two Yin lines represent the Earth. The Zhen Trigram therefore signifies a mighty force attempting to break free.

In energetic manifestation, the Dragon has the ability to condense its form, leap, fly, and change unpredictably. It is extremely flexible, agile, and can transform into two different types of martial energies: the Water (Yin Earth) Dragon, (which is solid and heavy), and the Cloud (Yang-Heaven) Dragon, (which is light and vaporous).

The Dragon's attacks are a very erratic combination of simultaneous high and low strikes with the arms and legs, designed to confuse the opponent. He will flow like water around the opponent's attacks and defenses. The Dragon makes maximum use of coiling and trapping techniques, utilizing inside elbow and palm work. The coiling and flexible, whiplike arm movements of the Dragon make it very difficult to counter his inside and midrange attacks. It is from the Dragon's rolling movement that the Baguazhang practitioners earned the name "Rolling Thunder Boxers."

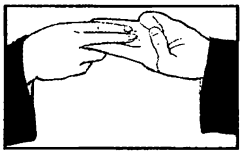


Figure 1.426. Golden Dragon Double Hand Seal

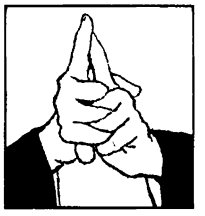


Figure 1.427. Two Dragons Pierce the Mountain Double Hand Seal

Figure 1.428. The Single Dragon that Pierces the Mountain Single Hand Seal

A disciple of Baguazhang will assume the characteristics of the Dragon when faced with a larger stronger opponent. The Dragon's inside fighting movements are best implemented on opponents who have a long reach, are slow, and have a tendency to grab and hold on (like wrestlers).

In ancient Daoist rituals, the Dragon Hand Seals are used for specific evocations, worship, or for energetic combat (i.e., Attacking and Defending), for example:

- **The Golden Dragon Double Hand and Seal:** This is a two-handed Hand Seal is used for Worship (Figure 1.426). It energetically represents the fusion of the combined energies of Yin and Yang
- **Two Dragons Pierce the Mountain Double Hand Seal:** This Double Hand Seal is used for Attacking and Defending (Figure 1.427). It is used to energetically penetrate through mountains and into the depths of the Earth. It is also used to energetically cut through, chase-after, and catch evil spirits.

Figure 1.429. Eagle

- **The Single Dragon that Pierces the Mountain Single Hand Seal:** This Single Hand Seal is used for Attacking and Defending (Figure 1.428). It is used to energetically penetrate through mountains and into the depths of the Earth. It is also used to energetically cut through, chase-after, and catch evil spirits.

EAGLE

Eagles are associated with Yang and the Fire Element. The eagle is a symbol of strength and spiritual victory (Figure 1.429). It also symbolically represents the triumph of Shen (the upper spiritual realm) over Jing (the lower material realm), through its ability to soar above the Earth.

Since ancient times, the fierce image of an eagle has always been associated with kings and royalty. For example, the ancient Huns (Xiong Nu) used the eagle as symbolic icon of their ruler.

The symbol of an eagle also represents triumph over adversity.

The eagle, falcon, and hawk (Ying) all symbolize a "hero" (yingxiong), because the pronunciation is the same. Therefore, in ancient Chinese art, if an eagle is pictured perching on a rock in the sea, it symbolizes a hero who fights a lone battle.

According to accounts given by Marco Polo, the Great Kublai Khan owned powerful eagles, that were trained to swoop down and attack eagles. It was said that due to the size and strength of these powerful birds of prey, none could escape their talons.

According to ancient Daoist Folk Magic teachings, ghosts and spirit entities can be caught by burning the greasy flesh of a "Cat's-Head Hawk (a certain type of Hawk with the head like a cat). Because it attracts spirits, sorcerers use it to catch ghosts and spirits in order to enslave them as servants.

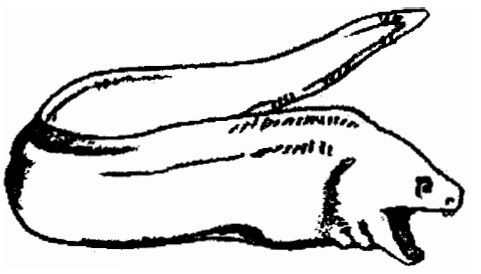


Figure 1.430. Eel

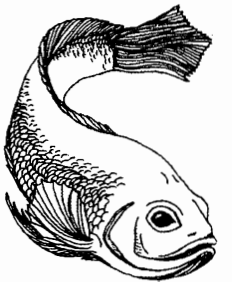


Figure 1.431. Fish

EEL

Eels are associated with Yang and the Water Element. Sometimes used as a phallic symbol, the image of an eel was used to symbolize a penis or sperm swimming in a cloudy, milky, or salty water (Figure 1.430).

Eels also represent slippery dangers lurking within the waters. According to the ancient Chinese legend (known as the "Legend of the Great Flood"), Xiang Liu, an evil minister of the Emperor Gong, was responsible for creating the flood that covered the entire Earth. Xiang Liu was reported to be an eel.

FISH

Fish are associated with Yin and the Water Element. In dream interpretation, a fish swimming downward into a deep cavern can symbolize the reaching down into the depths of one's own psychic and spiritual dimensions (Figure 1.431).

According to ancient Chinese tradition, both fish and water represent wealth. The Chinese word for "fish" (Yu) is phonetically identical to the word used for "abundance." Therefore, fish traditionally

symbolizes wealth. The most popular fish are generally the Carp, Goldfish, and Golden Arrowana (the Arrowana is also known as a Dragon-Fish).

In ancient China, the wife was traditionally responsible for all financial affairs. She kept the money and financially regulated the household. The man was considered to be the worker, and he provided the source of income while the wife regulated the expenditures. Therefore, if a fish was to be placed in the husband's office or place of work for good luck (both fish and water represent wealth), it was supposed to correspond to the birth color of his wife (the financial manager). This allowed the husband's business to boom. If the man was unmarried however, he would choose a fish that corresponded to his own birth color.

In ancient China, fish were generally used in sacrifices. For several dynasties, fish heads were sacrificed to the God of Wealth. This is the reason why people in China eat fish on New Year's day, believing that the coming year will be one of abundance.

There are many tales of drunk men turning into fish and of fish demons of this kind seducing and marrying women. However, it is said that a man who is a fish-demon could be recognized by the fact that he has to bath everyday. There are other tales of fish turning into birds (flying fish), and there is also one story in the first century BC of a giant fish swallowing a boat.

The symbol of a double fish is often worn as an amulet to ward off evil intentions. It can also be placed near the entrance of a home, so that anyone with bad intentions towards you will not succeed in staying for long.

It is believed that if you have a fish tank, you should never hang pictures of deceased friends or family above the fish tank (the swirling of the fish in the water will disturb the sleep of the deceased friends and relatives). Also, never have the fish tank face towards the kitchen (the kitchen represents fire and will burn up all the good benefits that the fish bring).

The goldfish (Jinyu) is a symbol for wealth because its first character (Jin) means "gold" and its second character (Yu) sounds like jade (Yu). Goldfish also symbolize abundant wealth because the first character (Jin) means gold and the second character (Yu) has the same pronunciation as the word for "abundance" or "surplus" (Yu).

If goldfish are used in Feng Shui to gather the energy of wealth, it is important that they keep nine goldfish in the pool or aquarium. Eight of the goldfish should be gold, and the ninth one should be black. The single black fish is used to absorb and bad luck that may inadvertently enter the home.

Fish and water coming together is a metaphor for sexual intercourse. When the constellation of the Fish becomes visible in the sky, it is a sign that the time for clouds and rain has passed (in ancient times this was taken to mean that it was no longer auspicious for the emperor to have sexual intercourse).

Concerning imperial divination, in ancient times when fish swam up the river in the shallow sandbank, it was interpreted as a rebellion against the social order and an harbinger of civil unrest.

The Chinese word for "Carp" (Lǐ) is pronounced the same as the words used to say "profit and advantage" (Li), and "strength and power" (Li). Therefore, the ancient Chinese the Carp symbolized a wish for the benefit or advancement of business.

The carp is also a symbol for an abundance of children because it produces many eggs. A pair of carp symbolizes a harmonious marriage.

One ancient Chinese legend tells of a humble carp who transformed into a mighty dragon when it successfully jumped over the "Gate of Eternal Learning" (also known as the "Dragon Gate"). This popular story represented the successful completion of the Imperial Examinations, which, for many dynasties had been the primary method used by emperors to recruit officials and ministers to the court. Since the Song Dynasty (420-478 A.D.), the Dragon Gate has symbolized the aspirations of China's young men. Those serving the emperor became members of the aristocracy and outranked everyone in the land. Therefore, the Imperial Exams were seen as the passport to fame, wealth, and glory.

It is interesting to note that carps that fail to make the leap into genuine "Dragonhood," are forever stamped with the seal of having tried and failed. This explained the red patch on the carp's forehead.

Additionally, because the overlapping scales of a carp resemble mediaeval armor, it is regarded as the symbol of martial prowess, and is admired for its persistence in battling with the currents.

FOX

Foxes are associated with Yin and the Earth Element. They are associated with deceit, trickery, slyness, cunning, and craftiness (Figure 1.432). Documents dating back to the dawn of China's civilization identify the fox as a demonic creature, upon whose back spirit entities often ride. According to ancient Chinese beliefs, there are two major characteristics used to describe this type of fox (Hu-li). The first characteristic is being able to live to a very old age; the second characteristic is its great preponderance of Yin (the female element of all things).

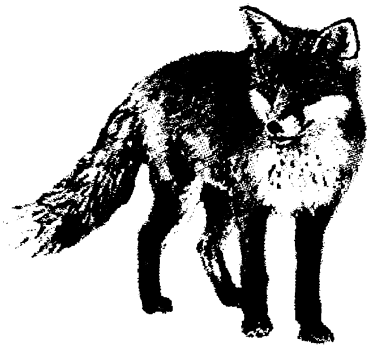


Figure 1.432. Fox

The fox's accumulation of Yin is due to its nocturnal habits, which enables the fox to easily assume the guise of a woman. As the fox naturally wishes to have a well-balanced constitution, it looks to gather Yang (the male element of all things), wherever it can. Thus is created the powerful myth that the fox-spirit must prey on the life-force of men in order to achieve longevity.

It is said that a fox spirit will frequent ancient burial tombs in order to exhume the bodies of the deceased. The fox will place the skull of the deceased on its forehead and turn towards the North Star. After speaking a magical incantation, the fox spirit will bow to the celestial stars three times. If the skull does not fall down while it is performing its prostrations, the fox magically transforms into a beautiful woman.

The life of the fox, through its cunning ability, was believed to extend to 800 or 1,000 years, and it was believed that a fox could even achieve immortality. As a result, temples and shrines were built to the Fox Spirit. In ancient China, it was believed that a fox could turn itself into a woman after it reached the age of 50 years; into a young maiden after it reached the age of 100 years (or, if it despises women, the fox can turn itself into a wizard, with all the power of magic at its command); and into a Celestial Fox after it reached the age of 1,000 years. A 1,000 year old fox is said to have nine tails and its color changes to gold. Because it is well versed in all the secrets of nature, is noted for its extreme sensuality, and can produce fire by striking the ground with its tail. According to the Ming Dynasty (1368-1644 A.D.) novel *Feng Shen Yan Yi* (The Metamorphosis of the Gods), a 1,000 year old fox assumed the form of the seductive Dan Ji and led the emperor of the Shang Dynasty (1600-1028 B.C.) into such evil ways that he eventually lost his empire and his life.

Hundreds of stories talk about how a ravishing beautiful woman appears one night to a scholar while he is studying. She entices him and he makes love to her. She disappears in the morning, only to come back each consecutive evening thereafter. The scholar gets weaker and weaker until a Daoist Monk informs him that the girl is really a fox-spirit who is sucking him dry of life-force energy in order to create the spirit entity's "Essence of Immortality" (a standard aspect of esoteric Daoist sexual training known as "vampiring"). Fox women can be distinguished from ordinary women from the fact that they never change their clothes. However, the clothes never look soiled. A creature of erotic symbolism, the fox has also been associated with venereal diseases for over 2,000 years in China.

The fox, in relationship with the human race can either be benevolent or vindictive, according to the treatment the fox receives. For example, one of the positive attributed associated with magical foxes is that they retain the knowledge of hidden or buried treasure. They can either use these riches for their own personal gain, or the can reveal these treasures to their human friends.

As a healing antidote, it is said that any form of Fox-disease may be cured by swallowing the ashes of a burned fox, either with or without water. Additionally, the snout and skin of a fox, together with an ounce of ashes taken from burning and powering a fox's head, must be cooked and eaten in order to free a victim from the powerful bewitchment caused from Fox-demon possession.

Figure 1.433. Frog

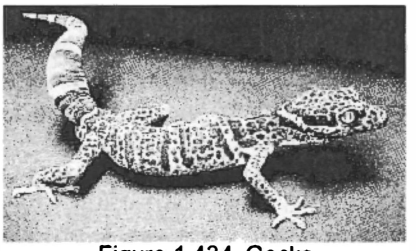


Figure 1.434. Gecko

FROG

Frogs are associated with Yin, and the Water Element. Like the toad, the frog is considered to be a moon creature, and is related to rain and water. Because it could emerge from the dark (Yin) and unknown depths of a well, swamp or bog into the light of the Sun (Yang), the frog was believed to be able to change evil into goodness and beauty. These magical attributes have made the frog a symbol of emerging, resurrection and healing. The frog is also a symbol of the life-transforming qualities of fertility and eroticism (Figure 1.433).

There are countless magical abilities assigned to the frog. In ancient China, frog seeds (i.e., frog eggs) were believed to have fallen from the "Dew of Heaven." One ancient text even assures its reader that the body's Hun (Ethereal Soul) looks exactly like a frog. It was therefore believed that a frog would enhance the power of magical potions (i.e., Magical Elixirs, Magical Essences, and Magical Pills).

Because of their association with the Hun, priests of Black Magic would sometimes use a frog in order to initiate a curse. Magical incantations were first recited over a live frog. After each magical incantation was spoken, the frog was pricked with a long needle. After a few pricks, the frog would die, and was then buried under the gate of the victim on whom the evil spell was cast. The victim eventually grew thin, pale, and then died. In ancient China, relatives of the deceased have been known to find the remains of the frog when they search under the gate of the victim's house.

Because frogs are associated with water, they have a wide spread reputation as custodians of rain, and were commonly used in Weather Magic rituals. For example, in Indo-China, certain Weather Magic rituals required the priest to place a live frog into a fire. The frog was then immediately removed and wrapped in black felt and place it under water while speaking summoning invocations. The purpose of roasting the live frog was to provoke the supernatural powers to come to the aid of the frog (the frog being considered the custodian of rain) by providing the much needed precipitation.

In ancient Daoist Magic, frogs were commonly incinerated and their remains were powdered and used for either love or hate magic. Whether the remains were used for love or hate depended on whether they sank or swim when they were cast into water. If they sank, they are potent for hate magic; if they floated, they were used in love charms.

GECKO

Geckos are associated with Yang, and the Water Element. The gecko is known as the "Bi Hu" (Wall Tiger) because it climbs the walls and ceilings and eats small insects (Figure 1.434). Another name for gecko is "Shou Gong" (Guardian of the Palace). The ancient Daoist texts discuss how a gecko was put into a clay pot on the fifth day of the fifth month and then fed for a year on cinnabar powder. At the end of the year the gecko was taken from the pot and pounded into pieces. The ointment obtained was rubbed onto the arm of a girl destined for the imperial court. This mark would vanish the first time the girl had sexual intercourse. In ancient times men going away on long journeys traditionally painted the mark on the lower part of their wive's body's. According to an ancient text on Daoist sorcery, this act insured that the woman would have no children and also the spot would disappear if she had sex.

In ancient China, an extremely powerful love charm was sometimes secretly constructed out of the remains of a newt (a small salamander) that had been burned and its remains cindered while speaking infatuation incantations. The powdered ashes

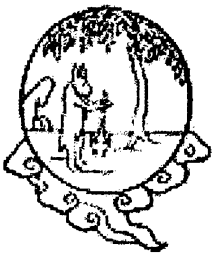


Figure 1.435. Hare

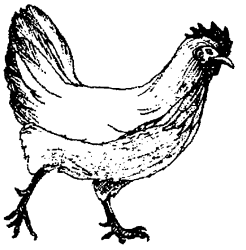


Figure 1.436. Hen

are then divided into two portions. One portion is carried by the individual who is the deprived lover, and the other portion is secretly scattered among the personal possessions of the targeted individual, or sprinkled in their hair.

Additionally, in ancient China it was taught that if the lizards were fed on vermilion and their tails cut off, and the blood rubbed onto the wrists of the ladies of the royal harem, it would prove whether they were virtuous or not. It was said that if they were virtuous, the blood will not come off: if however they were not, the blood would immediately wash off.

In ancient Chinese medicine, Ge Jie (Gecko) was used to treat the Lungs and Kidneys. It strengthens the Kidneys, tonifies the Lungs, and assists the Kidney Yang in augmenting the Jing and Blood.

HARE

Hares are associated with Yin and the Earth/Water Element. To the ancient Chinese, the hare represented the Yin energetic nature of the Moon and water (just as the Raven represented the Yang energetic nature of the Sun and fire).

In ancient times, the hare was represented as an icon of the Moon, standing on two legs with a mortar and pestle under a Cassia tree (Figure 1.435). The hare uses the mortar to pound cinnamon twigs in order to create "Immortal Pills." Therefore, on the back of certain ceremonial Daoist robes, the image of the Moon is sometimes identified by the traditional symbol of a hare pounding an elixir of immortality.

According to ancient Chinese belief, when the hare attains the age of 500 years it becomes white in color. If left to complete its life, it will eventually live for 1,000 years.

The red hare is a supernatural beast of auspicious omen. It is believed to appear when virtuous rulers govern the Empire.

According to Chinese Medicine, the hare is said to possess sweet meat that is cooling in nature. It is therefore used in order to Tonify a patient's Spleen and Stomach organs.

HEN

Hens are associated with Yang and the Fire Element. The hen, like the rooster, can drive away evil spirits (Figure 1.436). In ancient Daoists traditions, it is said that "the physical form of a chicken looks like a colorful phoenix. When it makes its sound, its cackling is heard like a golden bell. This wakes up the thunder of the heavens, which responds to its crow from 10,000 miles away. This startles the people, and even surprises the Palace of the Sun. Therefore, inside the Tai Yang Palace, it is called the Golden Bird."

In ancient Chinese medicine, Ji Nei Jin (Chicken Inner Gold), also known as Endothelium Corneum Gigeriae Galli (the internal lining of the Chicken's Gizzard) was used to treat the Stomach, Spleen, Small Intestine, and Bladder. It strongly reduces food stagnation and improves the Spleen's transportational functions. It also transforms hardness and dissolves stones.

In Chinese medicine, chicken is considered to be a "Hot" meat and its Yang energetic nature is used to stimulate and produce more Yang Qi within the body. In Northern China and Korea roosters and hens were not reared for their eggs and meat, but for their long tail feathers and their ability to crow well. In Southern China and Vietnam a both the hen's eggs and bones were commonly used as oracles. The blood of a black hen was believed to have a particularly powerful effect against spirit entities.

In ancient Daoist rituals, talismans that were used to summon and order Celestial Marshal

General Kung to bind disease was traditionally activated via chicken blood. After the priest took a sip of water from the altar cup, he or she would spray a mouthful of the "holy water" onto the chicken and then write the following talismans over the chicken's physical body, chanting the following incantations (Figure 1.437):

"The first Thunder Talisman is used for binding ghosts!

The second Thunder Talisman is used for thunder ghosts!

The third Thunder Talisman is used for chopping ghosts!

The fourth Thunder Talisman is used for sacrificing ghosts!"

Then, having said the incantation, the priest would use his or her left hand to hold and slightly shake the chicken. As the chicken flaps its wings, a feather flies off and the priest imagines that it ascends into the spiritual realm, traveling towards the Purple Mansion.

With his or her right hand embracing the knife (and with a solemn and respectful heart), the priest then uses the knife to cut the chicken's neck. The priest traditionally uses the "Dragon Knife" inherited from his or her "ancestral master" to cut the chicken's neck. This is not considered to be a cruel slaughter of a living thing, but is instead employing an ancient method of the ancestral masters used to sacrifice to the Thunder Gods. The blood is then placed into and mixed with the altar wine. Next, the left hand holds the wine and blood sacrifice being offered to the Immortal Thunder Gods, while the right hand holds the thunder-block talisman. The priest then says the following incantation:

"Thunder immortals enjoy your sacrifice, Quickly quickly show your magic!

The blood and wine is what motivates the power of the Heavenly Generals!

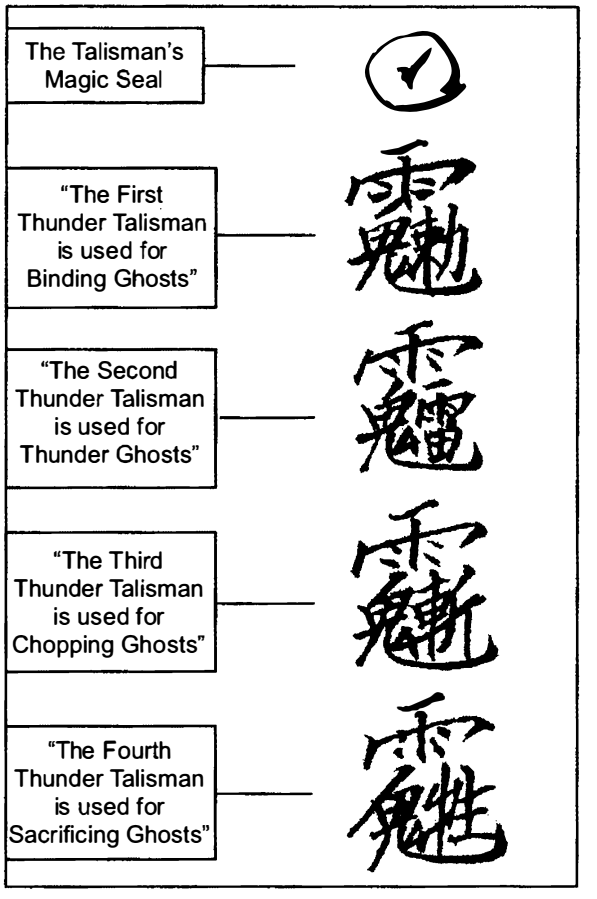


Figure 1.437. Ancient Daoist Talismans for Summonsing the Thunder Gods

It also brings out the courage of the celestial soldiers!

After the power is absorbed, they become so powerful with the sacrificial blood that they can pull up trees by the roots, move the mountains, and overturn rivers and ocean!"

The supernatural spirits immediately show up, responding to the summons and sacrifice. Sometimes the chicken blood is mixed in a bowl with the ashes on the incense burner. This "blood ink" is then used to make magical calligraphy, allowing the priest to create powerful talismans.

Figure 1.438. Heron

HERON

Herons (sometimes called egrets or bitterns) are associated with Yin and the Water Element. This bird's favorite habitat is around lakes and rivers (Figure 1.438). The Chinese word for heron "Lu" is similar to the word Lu meaning "path." Therefore the ancient Daoist associate the heron as a symbol of one who is seeking the path to the eternal Dao by living in harmony with nature.

HORSE

Horses are associated with Yang and the Fire Element. In the ancient writings of the Yi-Jing, the dragon (male) and the horse (female) were the two creatures chosen to represent the two sexes. However, in the most ancient mythology the horse was used to symbolize the Yang (male principle) while the Yin (female principles) was symbolized by a cow (or ox).

The horse represents speed, perseverance, success, and nobility; because they gallop as fast as the wind, they speed you to your destination, and therefore work to quickly transport energy (Figure 1.439). The ancient Daoist expression "getting off the horse" referred to a powerful priest who was summoning the Celestial Immortals to visit him.

Traditionally if a portrait or sculpture of a horse is brought into the house, it should contain either one or eight horses. A string of eight horse represents the famous horses of King Mu, who was supposed to have lived in the 10th century

Figure 1.439. Horse

BC. Never use five horses, as in ancient China this symbolized quarreling and terrible punishment (as a punishment for a capital offense, a prisoner was tied to five horses and pulled apart).

In ancient China, dreaming of a horse was considered to be a positive omen, and its presence foretold the promise of victories. According to the *Luo Zhong Ji*, written in the Tang Dynasty, the emperor Li Yuan began his ascent to power during the end of the Sui Dynasty (581-618 A.D.) following a dream in which he was wearing armor and riding several horses, while other horses were flying through the sky. He asked out-loud which army these magnificent animals belong to and was told, "The first emperor himself, who controls the whole universe." After this same dream repeated itself for several days, Li Yuan called his sons and told them that the dream was an omen, and that their campaign to overthrow the current emperor would succeed. The fighting continued until Li Yuan finally succeed in establishing the Tang Dynasty (618-907 A.D.).

In ancient China, the strongest horses came for Mongolia; the smallest but and most dependable horses came from Tibet. However, the overall best breed of horses were imported from West Asia (i.e., the Arabian Horses).

LIONS

Lions are associated with Yang and the Metal Element. They represent strength, courage, and primal instincts for survival. Throughout China's history, they have been used to represent authority, justice, and military might. In Song Dynasty literature (420-588 A.D.) the lion is referred to as the "King of Beasts."

The Guardian Lion is seen all over China (Figure 1.440). It is not a mere representation of a lion, but has a symbolic dimension of energetic power (they are also called "Fu Dogs" due to their "doggish" features). The ancient Chinese believed that the lion embodied the magical spirit of both the unicorn and the dragon, therefore it was endowed with the energetic power to exorcise demons and overcome evil.

It is said that when the lion exhales, its breath repeals Yin forces in the surrounding area; when the lion inhales, it draws in Yang forces from the surrounding area. Therefore, the breathing rhythm of a lion is said to coordinate the interaction between Yin and Yang influences existing within the environment.

Pairs of stone or bronze lions rival dragons in popularity as guardians of official buildings and temples. Traditionally, the male lion is always placed on the left (Yang side) and the female lion is always placed on the right (Yin side) facing away from the entrance of a shrine or other sacred place. Underneath the left paw of the male lion is an ornamental ball representing the energetic powers of the Earth, where the Guardian Lion is said be "feeling the pulse of the world." Traditionally the lion cub is believed to be contained within the embroidered ball as an egg, however, some historians believe that the ball is actually a huge pearl that the lion is playing with in order to calm his nerves). Underneath the right paw of the female is a cub.

According to certain ancient beliefs, the magical lions suckle their young through their claws. The milk, having mystical powers, is also collected by the male lion via the ball underneath his left paw. Therefore, in ancient China, hollow balls were sometimes placed in the hills by certain country people, in the hopes that lions, who cannot resist playing with the ball, would leave behind some of the precious liquid.

Figure 1.440. Guardian Lion

In imperial times, lions were often displayed outside the homes of Chinese state officials, where the number of curls on the lion's back signified the official's rank. The use of lions with thirteen curls was restricted to the imperial family and officials of the first rank, and the number of curls dropped by one with each level (the lower rank officials had lions with eight to twelve bumps on their heads). Officials below the seventh grade were forbidden to display stone lions outside their gates.

Chinese lions are often shown looking away from each other. Their mouths may be closed to shelter and keep in the good spirits or open to scare off demons. Some believe that open-mouthed lions are making the mantric sounds "ah" and "um." Many of the wooden lions found in Asia have balls carved into the lion's mouth, it is believed that turning the ball three times can bring good luck.

Pairs of lions (male and female) can have a dramatic effect on a place's Feng Shui. However, because of their power, the placement of the lions should be used with extreme caution (placed at the front door only-facing away from the house,

and never in front of your house).

In general, the lions can be seen as symbolizing the unity of Heaven and Earth. Because the statues are intended to act as guardians, ceremonies must be held in order to bring the lions to life. These magical ceremonies involve a ritual of placing a coin under the statue and dotting the eye lions' eyes with blood (or red ink/paint).

The "Lion Dance," which is usually connected to the Feast of Lanterns (held on the 15th day of the first lunar month) became popular during the Tang Dynasty (618-907 A.D.). During that time period acrobats, accompanied by music, performed in wooden lion masks with tails made of threads, eyes painted gold, and silver teeth. In modern times, only one lion appears and dances along the street threatening shops and vendors only to be pacified by showering it with coins and tribute money.

In the Daoist Wudang system of Baguazhang (Eight Trigram Palm, based on the Internal Martial Arts system of the Yi-Jing), the Lion is symbolized through the Qian Trigram, which represents the True Yang of Heaven. The Trigram Qian, being strong, full of power and creativity, is symbolized by three solid (unbroken) lines which refer to the pure Yang energy that extends outward in all directions.

The Lion is brave, strong, determined, aggressive, explosive, and very confident in his attack. He chooses opponents he knows he can physically overpower. The Lion's favorite techniques are those used in Chin Na (joint locking) and grappling (ground work and choke outs). Along with the seizing techniques of the lion paw, he uses his arms to catch, hook, and trap for initiating bone breaking and joint dislocation. The Lion charges the opponent with the intent of pouncing and crushing. If the opponent should escape, the Lion does not give chase and will never retreat, instead he will recompose himself and await the next opportune moment to pounce. The Lion is usually dominant in practitioners who have a heavy body structure and are big boned, and it can be effectively implemented on any opponent that is of smaller bone and muscular definition.

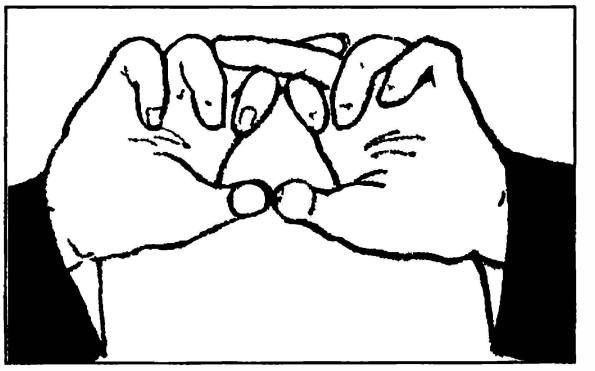


Figure 1.441. The Lions Incantation Double Hand Seal

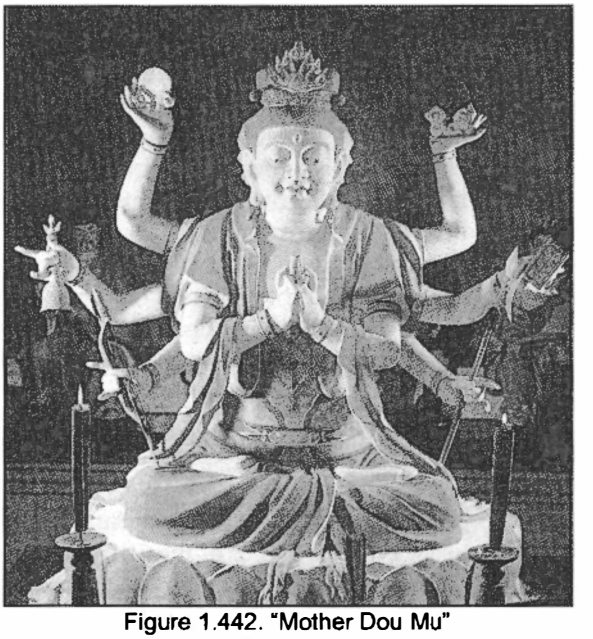


Figure 1.442. "Mother Dou Mu"
The Immortal Mother of the Big Dipper

In ancient Daoist rituals, the Lion Hand Seals are used for specific evocations of summoning the Celestial Immortals, for example:

- **The Lions Incantation Double Hand Seal:** This two-handed Hand Seal is used for Summoning Celestial Immortals (Figure 1.441). It energetically symbolizes one of Mother Dou Mu's (Figure 1.442) celestial animals.

Figure 1.443. Magpie

MAGPIE

Magpies are associated with Yang and the Water Element. The magpie is a Yang creature, partaking in male vigor (Figure 1.443). In ancient China, it was called Xi Qiao (Joy Bringing Magpie). The ancient Chinese believed that a magpie's call heralds good news or the arrival of an important guest.

To the ancient Chinese, magpies were also considered to be birds of good omen (in contrast to ravens which were considered birds of ill-omen). Once, when the founding father of the Qing (Manchu) Dynasty (1644-1911 A.D.) was fleeing from his enemies, a magpie perched on top of his helmet. Seeing this as a divine omen, the pursuit was immediately called off. Thereafter, the magpie was regarded as a sacred bird of the Manchus.

In ancient China, it was believed that a powerful love potion could be constructed from the small stones gathered from a Magpie's nest. In order to be effective, this magical formula must be constructed on the 5th day of the 5th Moon.

Additionally, the ancient Chinese believed that the powerful magical spells of a Fox Demon could be averted by burning a Magpie's nest. Similar in fashion, it was also believed that placing the head of a Magpie above the entry of a door could unmask the hidden presence of a Were-Fox.

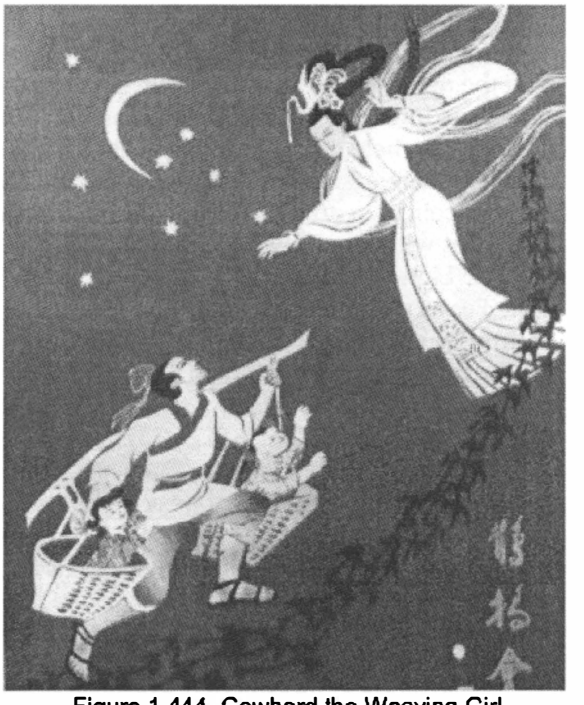


Figure 1.444. Cowherd the Weaving Girl and the Magpie Bridge

If the magpie is shown upside down, it means happiness has "arrived," because the Chinese words for "upside down" and "arrived" are both pronounced dao. Two magpies facing each other symbolize "double happiness" (Shuang Xi).

A pair of magpies also symbolize marriage. This is based on an ancient legend concerning two heavenly lovers, the Ox herd and the Weaver Girl (Weaving Maiden). The two are separated for eternity except for one day each year (known as Qixi, the Double Seven, or the Sisters Festival) when they are allowed to meet each other by crossing a celestial river on a bridge made of magpies (Figure 1.444).

Figure 1.445. Monkey

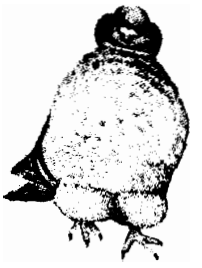


Figure 1.446. Chinese Owl

MONKEY

Monkeys are associated with Yang and the Metal Element. The monkey plays an important role in ancient Chinese mythology (Figure 1.445). The Monkey King (Sun Wu Kong) is one of the most prominent characters in Chinese mythology.

In ancient China, the monkey was believed to have the power of driving away evil influences, and was therefore valued for the protection that it gave.

The monkey is believed to have general control of mischievous spirits, fairy, and witches. It is also supposed to be able to bestow health, protection, and success onto mankind, if not directly, indirectly through keeping away mischievous spirits and fairies.

In one Tibetan myth, the Tibetan people are said to be descendants of the monkey people. In the South of China, there are many stories of women who have been abducted and ravished by monkeys and who have then given birth to children.

In the Daoist Wudang system of Baguazhang (Eight Trigram Palm, based on the Internal Martial Arts system of the Yi-Jing), the Monkey is symbolized through the Dui Trigram, which represents Metal and correlates to a Lake. The Dui Trigram is symbolized by two lower Yang lines, which represent a hard bed of Earth, while the upper Yin line is open, which signifies water converging.

In terms of physical manifestation, the Monkey has the greatest agility of all the animals. It is crafty and deceptive, and his techniques are quick. The Monkey is famous for pinching and twisting the muscle and nerve cavities, grabbing and twisting the fingers, grabbing hair, and biting. When grappling on the inside or using close to the body trapping, the Monkey will bite to counterattack if trapped. He makes great use of borrowing energy and "Light Air" Gongfu training. He literally climbs all over his opponent in an effort to frustrate him and wear him down.

OWL

Owls are associated with Yin and the Water Element. Because it is an unsocial bird of the night, with a mournful call and silent flight, the ancient Chinese believed that the owl was a bird of ill-omen that heralds disaster (Figure 1.446). It is believed to be the energetic opposite of the Phoenix (the harbinger of happiness and good fortune). Like other birds, the owl is considered to be a messenger from Heaven, however, in Chinese tradition the owl is said to be a messenger of death (its presence foreshadows a death in the family or household).

The owl is considered to be an evil bird, as its young are supposed to eat their mother. It is said that its voice resembles the voice of a spirit or demon calling to its associate. Some say that its voice sounds much like an expression of digging a grave.

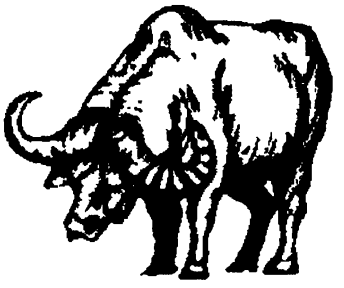


Figure 1.447. Ox

Figure 1.448. Parrots

Many authorities identify the owl with the "Demon Chariot" (a being which usually had ten heads). This demonic entity was seen as unpredictable, and was thought to be the messenger of death. It devoted itself to stealing and ravishing human souls. According to the ancient writing of Chen Zang Shi, "The Demon Chariot (Owl) flies about in the dark crying. It sneaks into human dwellings in order to gather the Hun (Ethereal Soul) and Qi of men. According to ancient tradition, at one time this demonic bird had ten heads. However, one head was devoured by dogs, and now only nine heads remain. Blood continually trickles out from the place were the missing head was, and, should any of this blood come down upon an individual's house, misfortune will immediately befall the inhabitance."

According to ancient Daoist Folk Magic teachings, ghosts and spirit entities can be caught by burning a certain type of owl.

Ox (Cow)

Oxen are associated with Yin and the Earth Element. The ox (Niu) or water-buffalo (sometimes known as a cow) is considered to be a beast of burden (Figure 1.447). In ancient China the image of an ox was used to symbolize springtime and agriculture (as work on the land begins in Spring with the ceremonial plowing). In certain Chinese traditions, individuals will not eat beef, believing it to be immoral to kill and eat a creature that helps them with their harvest.

Because of their importance to agriculture, the water buffalo or ox symbolizes springtime, harvest and fertility. To city dwellers and government officials, the water buffalo also represents a simple and idyllic life. According to ancient Chinese texts, although dreams of an ox (cow) can have many meanings, such dreams usually pertain to the females of the household (symbolizing food and nutritive properties). If an ox (cow) is killed within a dream, it cam mean that there is disruption within the family. Also, certain ancient texts state that if one dreams of an ox (cow) leading a man, it means that every avenue pursued by the dreamer will meet with success.

In ancient Chinese medicine, Niu Huang (Calculus Bovis) also known as Cattle Yellow (the gallstone of a cow or Water Buffalo) was used in order to clear the Heart, open the orifices, awaken the spirit, disperse phlegm, clear the Liver, relieve toxicity, extinguish wind, and stop tremors.

Parrots

Parrots are associated with Yang and the Wood Element. The parrot is native to South China, but has been known for thousands of years to migrate all over the country (Figure 1.448). Ancient Chinese texts mention several encounters with talking parrots. In ancient paintings, the parrot is often depicted as holding a pearl in its beak (which stands for purity and preciousness) or accompanying the Goddess Quan Yin (the Goddess of Compassion).

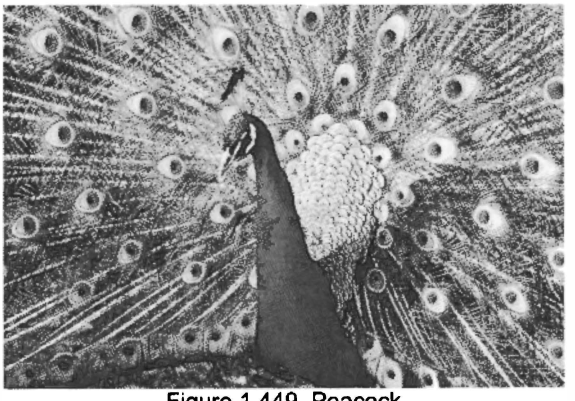


Figure 1.449. Peacock

Figure 1.450. The Queen Mother of the West Ridding on the back of a Peacock.

PEACOCK

Peacocks are associated with Yang and the Metal Element. The peacock symbolizes beauty and dignity as well as the desire for peace and prosperity (Figure 1.449).

Under the rule of the Manchus (1644-1911 A.D.), peacock feathers were used as insignia denoting rank. During that time period, fans made of peacock tail feathers were often used as decorations for the home.

Figure 1.451. Pheasant

In ancient China, Peacocks were believed to drive away evil, and to dance whenever they saw a beautiful woman.

The ancient Chinese also believed that one glance from a peacock could make a woman pregnant.

It was believed that Xi Wang Mu, the Queen Mother of the West, sometimes rode a peacock as a means of transportation instead of a crane (Figure 1.450).

PHEASANT

Pheasants are associated with Yang and the Fire Element. The pheasant plays a rather prominent role in ancient Chinese literature (Figure 1.451). It was believed to turn into an oyster or snake in the first Winter months.

In general, the pheasant was regarded as an animal of ill-omen. If the pheasants did not cry at the beginning of the 12th month, it meant a great flood was unavoidable. If they still did not cry by the middle of the same month, women would become lascivious and seduce men. The pheasant was also supposed to cry at the first thunder of Spring, and again when the celestial Dog appeared or when a comet was seen in the sky.

Figure 1.452. Ancient Phoenix

Figure 1.453. Modern Phoenix

PHOENIX

In ancient China, the Phoenix was considered to be a mythological bird that reigned over all other birds. It is composed of a combination of all that is considered to be beautiful in the feathered kingdom, and its song resembles the music of a piped instrument. The Phoenix is highly esteemed for its beauty. It is associated with Yang, the South, and the Fire Element.

There are two main varieties of Phoenix in China, the most ancient form is believed to be derived from the image of an Argues pheasant (Figure 1.452). The more modern version is a cross between a pheasant and a peacock (Figure 1.453). According to ancient artists, the original image of the Phoenix is observed as a composite animal. It has a back like a unicorn, breast like a goose (or wild swan), throat like a swallow, the beak like a chicken, neck like a snake, tail like a fish, the forehead like a crane, the crown like a mandarin drake, the stripes like a dragon, and the vaulted back like a tortoise.

Its feathers are shaped like long scales, and its tail is composed of five colors. There are 12 feathers extending from its tail in normal years, and 13 feathers extending from its tail during leap-years.

As far as diet, the Phoenix is believed to be a grain-feeder, only partaking of seeds from bamboo, and quenches its thirst only at the sweet fountains in secluded mountains. The Phoenix is believed to only perch on one tree, the Wu Tong (or Dryandra) tree. This tree is an ornamental species, with a bell-shaped blossom (white on the outside and reddish-brown on the inside). The dryandra seeds are often used as part of the ingredient in the composition of "moon cakes," which are eaten in the mid-autumn festival held during the eighth lunar month.

When it flies, a train of small birds always attends it. It is benevolent, and will not peck or injure living insects, nor tread upon living herbs.

The males are called "Feng" and the females are called "Huang." In modern times, however, such a distinction of gender is sometimes blurred into a single female entity, as the Phoenix is often paired with Chinese Dragon. The image of a Phoenix was then used to represent the empress, while the emperor was represented by the dragon.

The phoenix was a common motif in the decorations of weddings or royalty, where it was often depicted with dragons. The dragon and phoenix combination is considered to be symbol of blissful relations existing between husband and wife.

In ancient China, the phoenix was sometimes thought to be the god of the winds. Therefore, part of its name "Feng" was adapted by the ancient priests who developed Feng Shui.

The body of the phoenix is divided into five sections that symbolize five human qualities:

- **Head:** The head of the phoenix represents virtue.
- **Wings:** The wings of the phoenix represents responsibility and duty.
- **Back:** The back of the phoenix represents correct behavior.
- **Chest:** The chest of the phoenix represents humanness.
- **Belly:** The belly of the phoenix represents reliability.

The color of the Phoenix is also divided into five sections, representing the various colors of the Five Elements:

- **Head:** The head of the phoenix is light green in color, representing benevolence and compassion.
- **Breast:** The breast of the phoenix is white in color, representing rightousness and intregity.
- **Back:** The back of the phoenix is red in color, representing propriety and order.
- **Throat:** The throat of the phoenix is black in color, representing knowledge and wisdom.
- **Feet:** The feet of the phoenix is yellow in color, representing trust and faithfulness.

The phoenix is said to appear once every thousand years when times are auspicious and a good leader sits on the throne. In a commentary written during the Spring and Autumn period (770-476 B.C.), it was written that the male Phoenix, along with the female Unicorn, and the "Five Magic Beings" (the White Tiger, Turtle, Green Dragon, Red Bird, and Dark Warrior) is a sign that the land is being ruled by a just king.

Some ancient texts speak of a cinnabar red phoenix which was supposed to have been born in a cinnabar cave in the south pole. The creature is known as the "Phoenix of the Cinnabar Mountain." However, in Daoist alchemy the terminology "Phoenix of the Cinnabar Mountain," secretly refers to the female genitalia. A picture which displays a dragon on the left and a phoenix on the right symbolizes a husband and wife. A woman who has particularly attractive eyes is believed to have "phoenix eyes."

According to ancient Chinese history, the first recorded appearance of a Phoenix occurred during the reign of Huang Di (the Yellow Emperor), about 2600 B.C., and marked an era of great tranquillity. When it returned, it was said to actually nest in the palace of Emperor Yao in 2350 B.C. It was only during the Han Dynasty (206 B.C. - 220 A.D.) that the Phoenix became elevated to the rank of an object of worship. Later, its visits to the Empire became commonplace, and sightings were commonly recorded (usually to flatter an impressionable monarch).

In the Daoist Wudang system of Baguazhang (Eight Trigram Palm, based on the Internal Martial Arts system of the Yi-Jing), the Phoenix is symbolized through the Xun Trigram, which represents a penetrating Wind. The Phoenix fighting characteristics in Bagua boxing involved swirling in a continuous circle, and embody the actions of sinking while moving forward. The emotion of the Phoenix is one of daring determination. He is very brave and confident in his applications, meeting and yielding to his opponent's attacks with circular motions, utilizing his momentum in order to place his opponent into an unstable position and topple him before he can counter. The Phoenix whirls like a "tornado", and uses his elbows to cut and thrash. In addition, the Phoenix will use chopping and backhand strikes when attacking, to catch, hook, and set up for a sweep or throw. The energy of the Phoenix is continuously moving like an ocean wave.

As an opponent punches he does not feel anything because the Phoenix is so soft and fluid, changing and turning, wrapping his energy around him, and sticking to him. The active "tornado power" of the Phoenix is one of the most difficult powers to attain. This is not simply a "silk reeling" rolling power. There is a complex turning power inside the body; it also moves from side to side and up and down, manifesting as a soft spiraling energy that adheres to an opponent. This type of energetic changing involves maintaining balance between both Yin and Yang Qi. The Phoenix must be able to become either light or heavy, soft or hard, quick or still, sticky or springy at will.

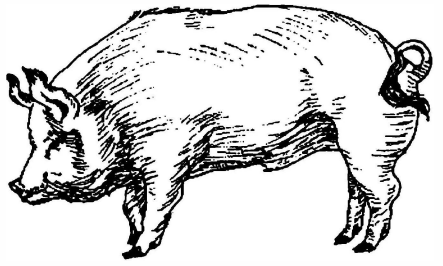


Figure 1.454. Pig

PIG

Pigs are associated with Yin and the Water Element. The pig symbolizes virility and is incredibly intelligent. Domesticated pigs have been used in order to help mankind for over 9,000 years, making them, according to some historians, the first domesticated animal (Figure 1.454).

One of the ways that a pig keeps cool is by rolling in mud. It also forges by sticking its snout into dirt and roots in order to consume important vitamins.

An old Chinese custom was to have young male children wear hats and shoes in the shape of a pig. Chinese parents believed this would avoid misfortune since the evil spirits would be fooled into thinking the child was actually a pig.

In ancient China, the image of a wild boar was used as the symbol of "the wealth of the forest."

In certain Daoist rituals, the pig is considered to be the immortal beast of Mother Dou Mu (Mother of the seven stars of the Big Dipper), and it is therefore summoned in order to bring Mother Dou Mu down into the human world (Figure 1.455).

In ancient Daoist rituals, the Pig Hand Seals are used for specific evocations of summoning the Celestial Immortals and for worship, for example:

- **The Small Pig Pass Double Hand Seal:** This is a two-handed Hand Seal that is used for Worship (Figure 1.456). It symbolizes the pathway the immortals use to travel to Heaven, and is energetically used to open the esoteric spiritual pathway into the Wuji.
- **The Big Pig's Head Double Hand Seal:** This two-handed Hand Seal is used for Summoning (Figure 1.457). It symbolizes the immortal beast of Mother Dou Mu and is energetically used to summon the animal down into the human world.

Figure 1.455. Dou Mu (Star Mother)
The Immortal Mother of the Big Dipper

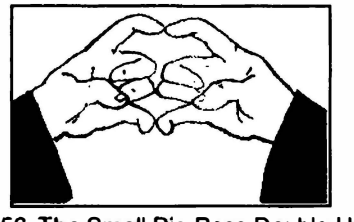


Figure 1.456. The Small Pig Pass Double Hand Seal

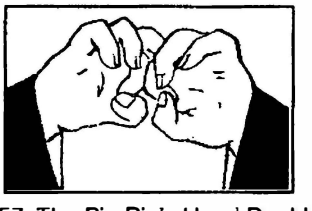


Figure 1.457. The Big Pig's Head Double Hand Seal

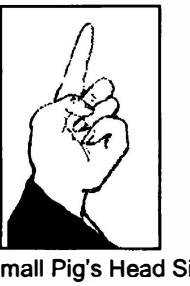


Figure 1.458. The Small Pig's Head Single Hand Seal

Figure 1.459. Quail

Figure 1.460. Rat

- **The Small Pig's Head Single Hand Seal:** This Single Hand Seal is used for Summoning (Figure 1.458). It resembles a small pigs head and is energetically used in small ceremonies to summon the immortal beast of Mother Dou Mu down into the human world. Dou Mu is the Mother of the seven stars of the Big Dipper (see Figure 1.455). She is generally depicted with three eyes in each of her four faces (one in each major direction). She has four arms on each side of her body. Two of her hands are held together, palm to palm, while the other six hold a sun, moon, bell, golden seal, bow, and halberd. Dou Mu is regarded as holding a very senior position in the Daoist hierarchy, and she is credited with the ability to save people from many types of evil and trouble.

QUAIL

Quail are associated with Yang and the Fire Element. The sparrow-sized Chinese painted quail is the smallest known gallinaceous bird (belonging to the pheasant family). However, the quail was sometimes used as a symbol of courage (although small in size, it can be very aggressive). When two quail are placed together, they will naturally begin to fight, and they immediately try to injure each other (Figure 1.459).

Additionally, when placed in a pen, some of the Chinese quail will not tolerate the smaller doves (the male birds commonly attack them). Therefore, in ancient China, quail fights were a popular form of amusement (like cock fights).

RAT

Rats are associated with Yin and with the Metal Element (White), the Water Element (Black), and Earth Element (Brown). They are quick witted and have the ability to gather and hold on to items of value. Traditionally, the rat is associated with money, and is therefore considered to be a symbol of good luck and wealth (Figure 1.460).

Rats can also turn into demons, usually male demons (in contrast to foxes who generally turn into female demons). The lowliest and most numerous of celestial beings, rat demons tend to be little more than laborers for more powerful beings. Often summoned for their ability to sense hidden objects and to track living targets, rat demons' ravenous hunger and ability to eat just about anything makes them both highly useful and easy to control. This makes them perfect for unscrupulous priests looking for servants, who will do the job that no human would ever want to do.

Far from weak, however, the rat demons' strength lies in their numbers and their complete willingness to do anything to sate their desires. While they are fierce fighters when cornered, a truly helpless rat demon will make any offer it can to avoid being killed. When encountered in groups, the typically cowardly and dim-witted rat demons can be surprisingly brutal and cunning, and not a few warriors have found a humbling end at the enthusiastic teeth and claws of these "lowly" demons.

It is important to note that certain "mysterious disease states," manifesting as mental derangement combined with clinical depression, were identified by ancient Daoist priests as being a detrimental pathological state issued from Rat Demons.

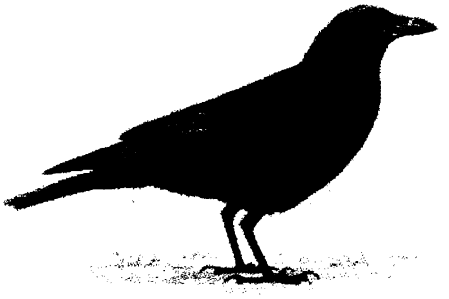


Figure 1.461. Raven

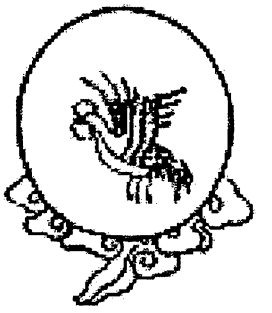


Figure 1.462. The "Three Legged Raven"

RAVEN (CROW)

Ravens (Crows) are associated with Yang and the Fire Element. In ancient China, the raven is depicted as a creature of the Sun, together with its counterpart the Moon hare. As the Sun is associated with fire, the raven is considered the fire bird of the Sun (Figure 1.461).

A three legged raven (Figure 1.462) was the messenger of the Goddess Xi Wang Mu ("Queen Mother of the West" - Figure 1.463), because the ravens were responsible for bringing her food. Therefore, the image of the Sun can sometimes be identified by the traditional symbol of a three-legged raven or rooster appearing within the red disk of the Sun (the number three is another symbol of Yang).

Ravens (Wu Ya) are supposed to be very pious birds, however, they are known for raising burial mounds (i.e., adding material) of those men who are particularly distinguished for their filial piety. There are also divine ravens who live in temple complexes and are fed by visitors.

Crows are believed to be spirit messengers, with the ability of foreknowledge about the future.

According to ancient Chinese teachings, the white-winged raven is an omen of evil. Its cry is harsh and unpleasent. Additionally, the voice and the presence of the white-winged raven were not merely considered to be ill-boding, but also decidedly productive of evil.

Crows are often considered to be omens of death because they gather at battlefields and other areas where someone is about to die to feed on the corpses. Therefore, they are sometimes considered to be the "dark messengers of God."

For the Daoist priest, the cawing of a raven is

Figure 1.463. The Queen Mother of Heaven
(The Queen Mother of the West)

interpreted depending upon the hour in which it is heard. For example, if it is heard to the South between 3:00-7:00 A.M., one will receive presents. If it is heard between 7:00-11:00 A.M., one will receive wind and rain. If it is heard in the evening (from 8:00-10:00 P.M.) it is considered a good omen, however if it is heard between 10:00-12:00 midnight it is considered a harbinger of death. For the most part the cawing of a raven is held to be unlucky.

According to ancient Chinese belief, crows act as avengers of the souls of murdered men. The avenging spirits can be stopped from completing their vicious acts of revenge by means of presenting

Figure 1.464. Marshal General Ma

Figure 1.465. Marshal General Ma Hua Guang's Fire Crow Talismans and Incantations

sacrifices to the souls of the wronged victims. This is similar in fashion to providing a wronged prisoner with his last meal before execution. In ancient China, prisoners were generally not fed any food (this was the job of either his friends or family members). However, the official executioner would sometimes personally provide a prisoner with his "last meal," especially in cases of unjust executions. This was done in order to prevent the wronged spirit from harming the executioner or his current family.

Generally, crows are associated with death and the underworld, and it is said that "the souls of slain crows are able to persecute their murderers with a shrewdness that even the souls of the dead men could hardly improve upon."

In ancient Daoist sorcery, the eyes of a crow was considered to be highly prized. This was because, the ancient magical pill that enabled a Daoist priest to see ghosts and spirit entities was constructed of onion seeds and crow's eyes. Additionally, it was believed that if the crow's eyes were first soaked in a solution containing the afore mentioned magical powder in water, the priest would be able to see spirit entities even at night.

According to the ancient teachings of Daoist exorcism, the "Fire Crows," also known as "Fire Ravens" ("Hua Ya"), serve Marshal General Ma (Figure 1.464), and are traditionally summoned in order to destroy demons and evil spirits. When constructing the Martial Ma "Fire Crow Talisman" (Figure 1.465), the Daoist priest will draw the talisman on yellow paper, in black ink, and recite the following magical incantation:

"Fire Crows released in wrath,
Set deviant shrines ablaze;
Iron ropes
Joyfully envelope and entwine,
And banish all mountain goblins!"

Figure 1.466. Rhinocerous

RHINOCEROS

The Rhinocerose (or "Sworded Cow) is associated with Yang and the Earth Element. In ancient times, China had its own indigenous species of rhinoceros (Figure 1.466), found in Szechuan. This animal is now extinct. Its horn was considered to be one of the lucky symbols associated with a scholar. It was an emblem of "sound character," which a good scholar sought after. The horn was also popular because it was believed to have the property of identifying poison in a liquid by sweating.

A belt made of rhinoceros hide was believed to be impermeable. According to this legend, such a belt was worn by Cao Guo Jiu (one of the Eight Immortals) when he crossed the path of the Dragon King who lived underwater (Figure 1.467).

According to the *Yuan Zhuo Fu* (Talisman for Remote Seizure), prior to initiating the magic ritual, the Daoist priest must first inform both his overseeing Celestial Official, and the Celestial Marshal for Justice and Law, General Ma Sheng (Figure 1.468) as to the level of offense that justifies this type of magical ritual. Sometimes the spiritual manifestation of General Ma is envisioned mounted on a Scarlet Red Rhinoceros standing inside the shrine targeted for destruction.

In ancient Chinese medicine, Xi Jiao (Cornu Rhinoceri) or Rhinoceros Horn, was powdered and used to treat the Heart, Liver, and Stomach, as well as to clear heat, relieve toxic fire, cool the blood, and arrest tremors.

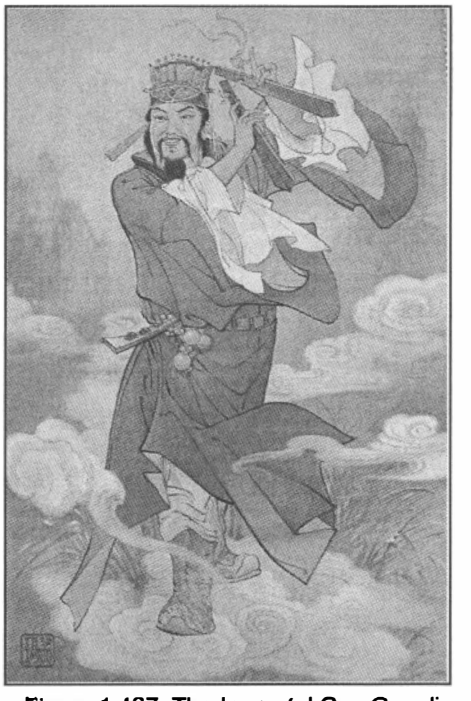


Figure 1.467. The Immortal Cao Guo Jiu Wears a magic belt constructed out of Rhinoceros Hide, believed to be impermeable.

Figure 1.468. General Ma Sheng

Figure 1.469. Rooster

ROOSTER

Roosters are associated with Yang and the Fire Element. The rooster (cock) symbolically represents the awakening to spiritual illumination (the celestial Sun). Its energetic power can be effectively used to banish all evil spirits (Figure 1.469). In ancient China, the rooster has a special place in the bird kingdom. When the rooster crows at dawn the daylight comes and all of the negative Yin forces, ghosts, and evil spirits are chased away. Therefore, the ancient Chinese believed that the roosters' call allows Yang Qi to arise.

It is believed that the flesh of a rooster is harmful to eat. This is due to the fact that in both ancient and modern times, the shedding of rooster blood is used in sacred magical oaths and sacrifices, and is therefore not to be slain on ordinary occasions.

The red comb or crest on the rooster's head was believed to contain powerful magic. For example, at burials, Soul-tablets of the dead were given animation by marking them with blood from the rooster's crest (the red crest being the most Yang, fiery, and bloody part of the rooster's body). Being an emblem of the Sun (full of Yang vitality), the blood of rooster's crest was used to strengthen the souls of the dead on their way to the grave. One ancient Daoist magical formulae required the priest to use the blood from the red crest of a rooster that was at least three years old (this crest was believed to contain a "superabundance of Yang Qi").

A white rooster is said to be an effective protection against baneful spiritual influences, and is also said to be the only capable guide used to assist transient spirits.

Because the rooster is believed to ward off evil, a picture of a red rooster is believed to be able to protect the house against fire.

In ancient China, a white rooster placed on a coffin was believed to keep evil spirits at bay and clear the road of demons.

The rooster's claws were also believed to contain the magical ability to wipe out backbiting and partisan politicking in the work place.

Additionally, the ancient Chinese believed that certain roosters possessed the magical power to change themselves into human form, in order to inflict good or evil onto mankind.

The Chinese ascribe five virtues to the rooster, described as follows:

- **Crown:** The crown on his head is a mark of his literary spirit.
- **Spurs:** The spurs on his feet are a token of his warlike disposition.
- **Courage:** He is courageous, for he fights his enemies.
- **Benevolent:** He is always clucking for the hens when he scratches up a grain.
- **Faithful:** In the morning, he never loses the hour.

Fung Shui masters place porcelain or specific gemstone roosters inside the house to chase away trouble and "Evil Qi." Traditionally only one rooster is placed in the house as ancient Daoist mystics believed that too many roosters will cause a cock fight.

One little known about, secret Daoist Magic "tool," was called a "Roosters' Egg." These special "eggs" were laid by stout roosters, who were locked up in cages and segregated, but not removed, from hens. Such magical eggs were said to be of extreme medical value, because they were "crystallizations of Qi activated within the roosters."

Figure 1.470. Sheep

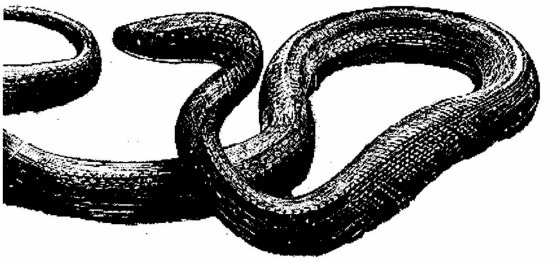


Figure 1.471. Snake

SHEEP

Sheep are associated with Yin and the Earth Element. The sheep is an emblem of filial piety (Figure 1.470). It is known for its gentle and passive characteristics. It is also considered to be one of the most feminine signs of the Chinese zodiac. In ancient China, sheep and goats were used as an emblem of retired life and filial piety. This was because a lamb always has the grace to kneel when taking its mother's milk.

SNAKE

Snakes are associated with Yin and the Wood, Fire, Earth, or Water Element (depending on the snakes specific color and characteristics). The snake is regarded as a symbol of great psychic power and spiritual transformation (through shedding its skin). The snake can also be a symbol for healing, wisdom, and sexuality (Figure 1.471).

In Chinese mythology, the snake is considered to possess great magical power and mystical ability. The coils of a snake represent the cycles of energetic manifestation and levels of psychic powers. It is also believed that the snake has powerful connections to the underworld, and that it can energetically manipulate the subconscious mind.

According to ancient Chinese myth, a water snake will transform into a dragon after many years of living within the mortal realm (Figure 1.472 and Figure 1.473). For example, after 500 years, a water-snake changes into a Dragon-Fish. Then, after 1,000 years a Fish-Dragon transformes into a Dragon. A Dragon, after 500 years, changes into a horned dragon; and after 1000 years changes into a Dragon with wings.

In ancient Daoist black magic, the snake was one of the five noxious creatures used to induce coma in order to steal the victim's soul (Hun).

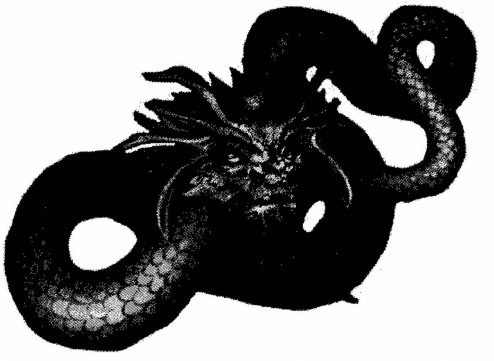


Figure 1.472. The Water Snake begins to slowly transform into a Dragon Fish

Figure 1.473. The Dragon Fish begins to slowly transform into a Dragon

The ancient Chinese believed that faries and demons had the the magical power to transform themselves into snakes. In fact, many of the an-

cient river Gods were imagined to manifest in the form of magical snakes. For example the God of the Yellow River was a small golden colored snake with a square head and red dots under the eyes.

The snake is very clever, but can also be extremely wicked, evil, and treacherous. Some snake Gods demanded the sacrifice of young girls on certain days of the year. Snake demons with human heads are supposed to exist in the Province of Guang Xi. In this province it is said that the snakes are so big they can swallow a horse.

Tales of Snake-demons are numerous in ancient China. There are many stories of victims incurring the wrath of Snake-demons resulting in misfortune, illness or death, either for themselves or along with their families. Sometimes, Snake-demons appear in Chinese mythology as instruments of punishment. There are even instances on record of Snake-demons causing illness by sending their souls into the bodies of their victims. It was also believed that snake-like shadows may be considered dangerous should they by any means enter an individual's body (the shadows of a person, animal, or plant are associated with its soul substance).

Some ancient books also make mention of Snake-demons acting as "devils of disease" under the guise of "celestial snakes." Diseases ascribed to "celestial snakes" manifest in certain forms of leprosy or ulcerous affections caused by snake bight.

According to ancient Chinese texts, dreaming of a snake can be interpreted in numerous ways. For example, a dream of a black snake is taken as a sign of a birth of a daughter, a dream of a whitish or gray snake is taken as a sign of a birth of a son.

In the Daoist Wudang system of Baguazhang (Eight Trigram Palm, based on the Internal Martial Arts system of the Yi-Jing), the Snake is symbolized through the Kan Trigram, which represents Water and is Yang in nature. The Trigram Kan is symbolized by two Yin lines positioned on the top and bottom (representing the Earth or a river bank). A Yang line is positioned in the middle (representing the energetic and forceful movement of the current). The Yang line is concealed between the two Yin lines suggesting that the true power of the snake is concealed within the fluidness and flexibility of it's torso. The Yang sinks into Yin and this center of Yang creates tides or rippling Qi. The image is that the energetic nature of the Kan Trigram is constantly being filled and is overflowing from within the center of the snake's body. This allows the Upper and Lower Dantians the ability to receive a constant flow of life-force energy, enabling the Snake fighter to extend Qi and Shen from his Middle Dantian.

The Snake is the most poisonous and cruel of the Eight Trigram animals. The attitude of the Snake is one of indifference. He is cold and cruel, showing no emotion or remorse. Flowing like water, the snake moves smoothly and vigorously, penetrating every opening and hitting the vital points of the body. The snake's speciality is attacking the opponent's nervous system.

The Snake makes his body move like water. It is soft and passive on the outside in order to make full use of the tendons and bones. The tendons are used to whip, or sling (much like a rubber band) the body's bone structure into the opponent. The bones act as tubes funneling the Qi into the opponent upon impact. In order to facilitate this movement of Qi, relax fully and stretch the tendons. When the mind's intent strikes, the body follows.

Snake liver is much sought after today for its medical properties and snake is commonly eaten in China. Snake fat however, is considered very dangerous. Today in Traditional Chinese Medical clinics, various types of remedies still used snake to heal, for example:

- **White-Patterned Snake (Bai Hua She - Agkistrodon Seu Bungarus):** This snake was used to treat the Liver and Spleen. It powerfully unblocks the channels and extinguishes wind.
- **Black-Striped Snake (Wu Shao She - Zaocys Dhumnades):** This snake was also used to treat the Liver and Spleen. It powerfully unblocks the channels and extinguishes wind.
- **Snake's Skin Slough (She Tui - Exuviae Serpentis):** This snake was used to treat the Liver. It dispels wind, removes superficial visual obstructions and stops spasms.

TIGER

Tigers are associated with Yang and the Earth Element. It is assigned to the direction of the West (Metal Element), the sunset, Autumn, wild storms, and turbulent winds. Originally, the tiger is considered to be the "King of the Wild Animals" and master of the world (Figure 1.474). It was not until later (because of Buddhist influence) that these attributes were given to the lion and the symbolism of the tiger was changed.

The energetic natures of tigers are opposite to that of dragons, and they are sometimes thought to be cunning, deceitful, and restless. Tigers are not only used as a symbol of courage, strength, and bravery, but also for danger, terror, violence, and destruction. In ancient China, sacrifices were made to the tiger to prevent it from attacking villages.

The tiger is traditionally considered to be a Yang creature and the bearer of male energy. However, the White Tiger represents Yin energy and is associated with the Underworld, which always connects the tiger to death.

According to ancient Daoist traditions, the energetic presence of a tiger was used to drive away demons (this is why stone figures of tigers are carved on graves). It is said that the tiger can grasp spirit entities, tear them asunder, and devour them. This is why the claws and whiskers of a tiger are considered to be powerful charms against evil spirits and devils. In ancient China, the meat of the tiger was eaten in order to impart its strength, cunning, and courage to those who were lucky to partake of it.

The image of a tiger's head depicted on the front of imperial doors (the golden door knockers) is used as a guardian to protect against demons. More than one celestial immortal is depicted riding on the back of a tiger because they have defeated death.

According to Chinese mythology, the hair from a tiger's tail had powerful magical qualities. It was said to be endowed with the magical power to bring the soul back into any human body which lies is a coma. In ancient China, this magical hair was known as "Hui Hun Mao" ("hair that causes the soul to return"). Also, in ancient China when

Figure 1.4734 Tiger

an individual suddenly became sick, he or she would sometimes burn or roast some tiger's skin and consume it with water. This practice was initiated in order to quickly heal from an attack on the physical body caused from a spirit entity.

In ancient Chinese medicine, Hu Gu (Ostigris) or Tiger Bone was used to treat the Liver and Kidneys, to dispel wind dampness, disperse wind cold, and strengthen the sinews and bones.

Like human bones, tiger bones are considered to contain soul substance and are therefore highly valued (especially if taken from the head). Even the small bones of a tiger's foot were used in magical charms and amulets, especially for protecting small children and babes.

In certain provinces of ancient China, priests would sit on a tiger's skin (of fragment of it) in order to increase their "devil dispelling" powers. Many idols were literally painted with tiger skins, and images of tigers were carved in wood or metal and worn as magical amulets against demons of disease. Additionally, a tiger's claw or nail was sometimes bound to an individual's body in order to avert evil.

Tigers appear on Daoist magic amulets because they are powerful animals, symbolize heroism, and are believed to be able to eat evil spirits, or at least cause them to flee, and can in general protect people from misfortune.

Tigers also are able to see well in the dark. For these reasons, images of tigers and tiger's heads

Figure 1.475. Celestial Master Zhang Daoling

Figure 1.476. Dudu Zhao Yuan Shuai

are considered particularly effective in protecting children from malignant spirits.

Tigers symbolize longevity because the ancient Chinese believed tigers could live for 1,000 years. It is said that when the tiger turns 500 years old, his color changes to white.

According to ancient belief, a tiger's victim becomes an evil spirit after it is eaten. After digested, the spirit of the person becomes a servant of the tiger and urges the beast to devour others. This is because of the belief that those who have met a violent death may return back to the world if they are fortunate enough to secure a substitute. According to Kang Xi's Dictionary, when a tiger bites a man is such a way that death ensues, the man's soul has no courage to go elsewhere, but regularly serves the tiger as a slave, and is called a "Zhang."

In Daoist Exorcism, sometimes Celestial Guardians, Marshal Generals, and Thunder Generals are depicted with "demon-eating Tigers, for example:

- **Celestial Master Zhang Daoling:** He was a very powerful Daoist sorcerer, healer, and exorcist, who founded the Zheng Yi Daoist sect. Because of his position as a powerful exorcist, he is sometimes pictured riding on top of a fierce Demon-eating tiger (Figure 1.475).
- **Zhao Yuan Shuai:** He is one of the military leaders of the celestial soldiers who protects the Daoist priest's Original Altar. He has dark face and skin, represents the North Direction, the Water Element, and the Color Black. He is assigned to the position of slaying evil spirits and demons, and for keeping the celestial armies in order. Sometimes pictured sitting on a fierce Demon-eating black tiger, he carries a magic Nine-Section Sword, and a "Demon-Binding Chain" or incense burner (Figure 1.476).

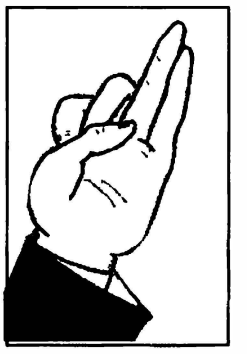


Figure 1.477. The Magic Tiger Hand Seal

In ancient exorcism rituals, Daoist priests would sometimes use Tiger Hand Seals for specific evocations, specifically used in summoning the Celestial Guardians and Protectors. One example of this magical esoteric practice is the "Magic Tiger Hand Seal," described as follows:

- **The Magic Tiger Hand Seal:** This special Hand Seal (Figure 1.477) is traditionally used for summoning the powerful Ghost-Eating Tiger of the celestial realm. It represents the magical image of the celestial Ghost-Eating Tiger, believed to fiercely devour malevolent ghosts and evil spirits. It is traditionally used in magical rituals that request the assistance of Marshal General Zhao's Magical Tiger or the Celestial Master's Magical Tiger to the altar area in order to remove evil spirits.

Figure 1.478. Toad

TOAD

Toads are associated with Yin and the Water Element. In ancient times, it was believed that the toad could live to a considerable age, and it was therefore the symbol of longevity (Figure 1.478). In was also believed that the toad could make you invulnerable.

Just as a three legged raven is considered a symbol of the Sun in the ancient Daoist tradition, the three-legged toad is considered a Moon symbol. According to ancient Chinese mythology, the Three-Legged Toad named Chanzhu, lives on the Moon.

Additionally, according to ancient legend, Chang Yi, the wife of Chieftain Hou Yi, stole the warriors Pill of Immortality before he could ingest it and fled to the Moon. While on the moon, she was changed by the gods into a toad as punishment (other stories state that she was transformed into a rabbit, and forced to make Immortal Pills for all eternity).

The three-legged toad is also used as a symbol of money making and success, and is part of the many legends surrounding the Eight Immortals. In Feng Shui, the three-legged toad is placed on the floor (usually under chairs or sofas).

In 10th century China, there emerged a story about a Minister of State named Liu Hai who was proficient in Daoist Magic. It was said that Liu Hai carried a three-legged toad that could be used in order to charged his energy field and allowed him the ability to teleport (instantaneously move from one place to another). The three-legged toad was not entirely reconciled to this way of life, and occasionally escaped by diving down the nearest well. Because the toad had an obsession for the glitter of gold, Liu Hai could always recapture it by dangling a string of gold coins before its eyes (Figure 1.479).

Figure 1.479. Liu Hai and his Magic Toad

According to ancient belief, the toad is also associated with water and rain, because of its association with the powers of the Moon. The ancient Chinese believed that the magical toad could swallow the Moon (as in an eclipse), so the toad also sometimes used in order to symbolize unobtainable wishes and desires.

In ancient Chinese believe that the spawn of the frog falls from heaven, like dew, and that the spittle of the toad has powerful medical qualities (i.e., boiled to treat sore throat caused from excess smoking).

In ancient Chinese Medicine, Chan Su (Secretio Bufonis) or Toad Venom (the dried skin secretions of a toad) was used to treat Kidney and Stomach problems, relieve toxicity, reduce swelling, alleviate pain, expel Summer heat and dampness, and open the orifices.

It is important to note, however, that diseases caused by toads manifest as nervous insanity, and can be cured by catching and destroying the beast.

In Daoist rituals, the Toad Hand Seals are used for specific evocations of worship, for example:

- **The Magical Toad Single Hand Seal:** This Single Hand Seal is used for Worship (Figure 1.480). It represents an image of the immortal

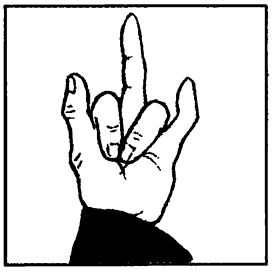


Figure 1.480. The Magical Toad Single Hand Seal

three legged toad from the Moon Palace and is energetically used to bring the fragrant smell of the celestial world into the realm of the human world.

TORTOISE

Turtles are associated with Yin and the Water Element. Because turtles live a very long life, they are received as a symbol of longevity and also represents strength and endurance. In ancient Daoism, all large turtles represented long life (Figure 1.481).

As one of the Four Celestial Animals of Feng Shui, the Turtle Snake protects the area of the North, the place of the strongest Yang energy.

The ancient Daoists believed that if a turtle icon was placed in the house, it should face a specific direction according to the material from which it is constructed. For example:

- **A Wooden Turtle:** A wooden turtle must face East or Southeast.
- **A Stone Turtle:** A stone turtle must face the South or Southwest.
- **A Earth Turtle:** A clay, ceramic or porcelain turtle must face North.
- **A Metal Turtle:** A cooper, brass, or iron turtle must face West.

It is said that the wooden columns of the Temple of Heaven in Beijing China were originally set on live tortoises. This was done under the belief that as these animals are supposed to live for more than 3,000 years without food and air, therefore they are gifted with miraculous power to preserve the wooden columns from decay.

The turtles shell was used in ancient times to remove evil and guard against the ghostly presence of spirit entities. In Chinese kitchens, the fact

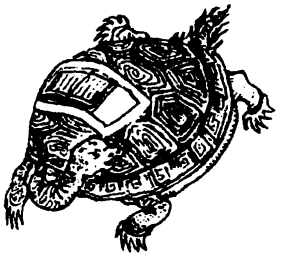


Figure 1.481. Tortoise

Figure 1.482. In ancient China, tortoise shells were used as an augury for divination; each crack represented a specific energetic change or an approaching form of destiny.

that pots and pans are hung from ceiling racks is based on the same principle (the backside of the Wok has the same rounded form as the backside of the Turtle's shell).

The tortoise has always been a highly symbolic creature to the ancient Chinese, who regarded it as a representative of the universe. There is a saying that the turtle "Conceals the Secrets of Heaven and Earth." The dome-shaped circular top of its shell is compared to the celestial vault of Heaven (i.e., the Yang constellations of the Heavens), while the flat, squared underside of its belly is compared to the four corners of the Earth (floating on the waters).

In ancient times, the turtle's shell was used in divination (Figure 1.482), because the 24 rimmed plates of the tortoise shell corresponded to the 24 divisions of the agricultural calendar. According to ancient Daoist texts written during the Han Dynasty period (206 B.C.-220 A.D.), "Although the turtle lives in the water, when its shell is placed

in the fire it can be used for divination and can correctly predict the good or bad fortune in all things."

Tortoise-shell divination was accomplished by removing the outer skin of a tortoise shell and then applying a coating of blood or ink onto the shell. The other side of the shell was then placed over a fire. As the ink or blood dries it cracks the shell, producing lines that resemble characters. The divining priest then interprets these lines.

Another shell or bone divination technique required the priest to scratch a question for an individual seeking council from the spirit world onto a tortoise shell or oracle bone in which a small hole had been bored. The shell or bone was then held over a fire by means of a bronze poker inserted into the hole, until lines and cracks appeared over or near the freshly written characters. The marks were then interpreted by the priest and regarded as the answer of the summoned spirit to the individual's questions.

The tortoise is sometimes known as a hero in many Chinese legends. Tradition states that it was a turtle who helped the first emperor (Yu) tame the Yellow River in order to create fertile land. The ancient Chinese also believed that the giant turtle Ao carried the Earth on its back. This is why the turtle shell was used in ancient times as an oracle (i.e., because it was believed to be symbiotically connected the heavenly realm). Additionally, whenever a cultural hero springs into power in order to bring order to the universe, a tortoise is always depicted as being by his side.

The image of a tortoise is often placed on top of a stone grave pillar, and the ancient inscription tablets of the Chinese emperors were supported on stone tortoises. The tortoise is also regarded as an immortal creature. In ancient times the Turtle Snake of the North was sometimes referred to as the "Dark Warrior" (Figure 1.483).

Along with certain other animals, the tortoise was also considered to be the author of dangerous diseases in East Asia. For example, tortoises were considered to be extremely dangerous when they were hidden in the ground, and it was said that an individual could be suddenly smitten with disease and other forms of evil simply by passing overhead.

Figure 1.483. Zhenwu (The Perfected Warrior)

In ancient Chinese medicine, Gui Ban (Plastrum Testudinis) or Fresh Water Turtle Shell was used to treat the Heart, Kidneys, and Liver. It nourishes the Yin and roots the Yang, tonifies the Kidneys and strengthens the bones, cools and nourishes the blood, tonifies the Heart, and stops uterine bleeding.

In ancient Chinese medicine, Bie Jia (Carapax Amydae Sinensis) Soft Shell Turtle Shell was used to treat the Liver and Spleen. It nourishes the Yin and roots the Yang, invigorates the Blood, promotes menstruation, and dissipates nodules.

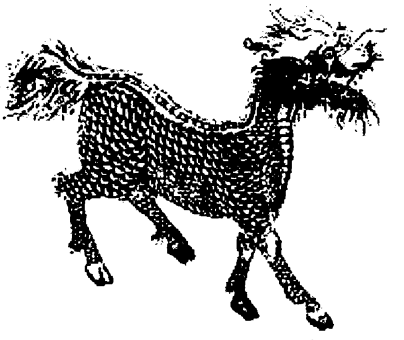


Figure 1.484. Unicorn (Qi Lin)

UNICORN (QI LIN)

Unicorns (Qi Lin) are associated with Yin and the Earth Element. In China, the unicorn is sometimes categorized as being a "Dujiao Shou" (Figure 1.484). The words "du jiao," translate as "one horned;" and the word "shou" translates as a kind of "magical beast."

Endowed with magical qualities, the Qi Lin first appeared to the public when it emerged from the Yellow River bearing on its back the magical map from which the legendary Fu Xi (the founder of the Prenatal Bagua) derived the understanding of the fundamental principles of Yin and Yang and the polar nature of the universe.

Traditionally, the four legged, Heavenly, magical animal that brings prosperity, success, longevity, illustrious offspring and all-around good fortune is the Qi Lin. Qi Lin are not exactly Unicorns, as they sometimes have two antlers. Quite often, the Qi Lin are confused as being Dragons, and are sometimes referred to as "Horse Dragons" or "Deer Dragons."

In Daoist exorcism, one of the Original 16 Heavenly Marshals of the Thunder Department, Marshal Yin, is Commander of the Earth, and leader of the celestial military soldiers. General Yin is actually a Star God in human form, and is sometimes pictured riding a Qilin, on his way to subdue demons and remove evil spirits (Figure 1.485).

There are many types of "Shou," just as there are many types of Dujioa Shou. Some "Shou" have curly hairs along their heads and bodies, and they often resemble things like lions and dogs

Figure 1.485. Marshal General Yin

combined with the animal parts of other kinds of animals (i.e., with dragon or fish fins, feathers, and or long flowing whiskers). Often, ancient Chinese immortals are depicted riding on a Dujiao Shou.

The Qi Lin is described as being courteous and benevolent. It has a musk deer's body, the tail of an ox, forehead of a wolf, red eyes, round neck, fishy scaled body, the cloven toes of a horse (or five toes on each foot), and one to three horns that are covered with fur. Its skin is of five colors (blue/green, red, yellow, white, and black). It is yellow under its belly, and is 12 cubics high. Its voice is like the sound of bells and other musical instruments. Some writers state that the Qi Lin has the body of a horse, that is covered with scales like a fish, and has two horns bent backwards.

Along with the dragon, phoenix, and turtle, the Qi Lin is one of the Four Supernatural Creatures (Si Ling). The ancient Chinese believed that the Qi Lin appeared when the land was well governed or when a saint was present, depending on the circumstances. In general the unicorn expresses good wishes.

One ancient legend states that before the birth of Confucius, a Qi Lin appeared to his mother

and presented her with a tablet of jade, on which was inscribed, "The son will become a throne-less king." Another Qi Lin appeared shortly before his death, and his disciple Shu Sun Shi, while gathering fuel, caught this one. Is is said that Confucius believed that his doctrines could not gain way because of the death of this unicorn."

In the ancient Chinese book *Feng Shen Ban* (the ancient text where all the Chinese Mythical gods and magical-animals received there names), the Qi Lin are mentioned many times, usually as noble steeds with which Warrior Gods rode into battle. Additionally, in Chinese Mythology, magical animals, including the godlike ones, can morph their bodies to be bipedal and walk on two legs as a human, or transform their shape into another creature.

In most traditional Chinese art, the Qi Lin is depicted as having thick hair, which flows upward defying gravity, and gives a supernatural or Heavenly feeling to its great power. The Qi Lin are usually illustrated with cloven hooves. Their tails may vary, yet they usually have beards and mustaches of varying lengths. They often have sprouts or tufts of hair on the fetlocks, around the hooves, the back legs, and often either on the breast, the forelegs, or armpits.

Some have finlike structures, feather-like structures, and wispy things growing from the body. Some are depicted as being gentle and sweet, while others are depicted as being ferocious with large fangs and growling.

In the Daoist Wudang system of Baguazhang (Eight Trigram Palm, based on the Internal Martial Arts system of the Yi-Jing), the Unicorn (Qi Lin) is symbolized through the Kun Trigram, which represents Earth and is Pure Yin in nature. Because the internal energy of the Kun Trigram is pure Yin, the shape of the trigram also reveals its receptive symbolism. All three lines are broken and receptive with a hollow channel in the middle through which things can flow, indicating that each Dantian will receive and flow with continuous receptivity, while also demonstrating the Earth Element's ability to contain.

The Qi Lin is capable of flight, and it can change forms unpredictably. Its famous for using the technique of rotating and turning its body while spinning on one leg for counterattacking. This animal is, by nature, flowing and therefore the body is fast and light. It moves like a swirling wind and turns like a spinning top. The Qi Lin's fighting characteristics are yielding and receptivity.

Disciples who are naturally quick, agile, and evasive can emphasize the Qi Lin as their specialty in fighting. The Qi Lin is always evading, much like a matador would against a bull, all the while looking for an opening to attack. This fighting style is extremely effective if the opponent is much bigger, stronger, and more aggressive (i.e. a Lion).

A master of bobbing and weaving, dodging, and withdrawing, the Qi Lin is known for its sudden spins and its crafty one-leg turning strikes. Extremely deceptive, the Qi Lin draws its opponent in, avoiding the attack, and then counterattacks. The Qi Lin does not aggressively kick or strike, instead he will use his deceptive movements, placing his feet, knees, elbows, and palms strategically so that the opponent unwittingly runs into them. Even when retreating, the Qi Lin will use every opportunity to counterattack.

The Unicorn's strength is his outside fighting and his weakness is infighting. When the Qi Lin finds himself on the inside, he will bob and weave in order to evade his opponent and move back to the outside range of fighting. Many disciples will display the characteristics of the Qi Lin when meeting another opponent for the first time in order to get a good sense of his adversary's martial skills. The Qi Lin's carefree attitude and evasive movements are ideal in this situation. Disciples will also frequently use the evasive techniques of the Qi Lin to first set up the opponent, and then switch to another, more aggressive animal to finish him off.

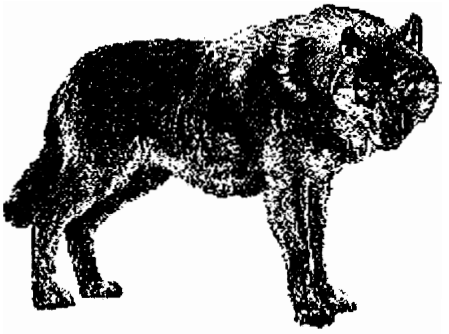


Figure 1.486. Wolf

WOLF

Wolves are associated with Yin and the Earth Element. The wolf symbolizes cruelty, covetous intention, and greed (Figure 1.486). Because of their fierceness, craftiness, and gluttony, in Chinese mythology wolves are associated with the forces of evil. There is an ancient Chinese proverb that states "it is better to kill ten tigers than one wolf." This is because tigers are usually solitary creatures, while wolves hunt in packs and take revenge if any one of their members is killed.

It is said that if the grass in nine centimeters tall, a wolf can hide in it. Like the changing colors of the plants and trees, the color of a wolf's fur changes with each season.

Wolves are also associated with the Moon and the underworld, and they are considered to be guides to the souls of the dead. According to an ancient Chinese text, dreaming of a wolf is considered to be an omen of unsuccessful travel.

The Chinese distinguish two varieties of wolves, the Chai and the Lang, described as follows:

- **Chai:** This is a small, brownish-orange colored species.
- **Lang:** This is a large, gray colored species. The Lang is considered to be the more dangerous of the two.

According to ancient Daoist Magical Teachings, the First Star of the Big Dipper "Tan Lang" ("Lusty Wolf"), is also known as "The Clarity of Yang" and "Yang Luminosity" (Figure 1.487). It is the star located at the lip of the Dipper's bowl, and it is sometimes called "The Pivot of the Sky"

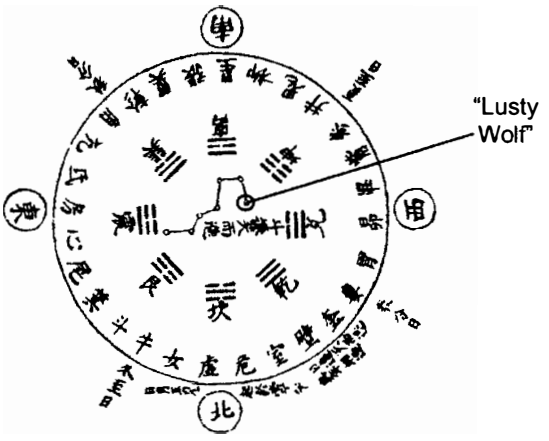


Figure 1.487. The First Star of the Big Dipper is called "Lusty Wolf"

and "The Heavenly Pivot Palace." In the ritual of "Walking the Dipper," the priest begins at the midnight hour, starting at the "The Clarity of Yang," when the Yang energy begins to rise.

This star is also known as "The Gate of the Moon," and it represents entry into the spirit realm. When working specifically with just the "Clarity of Yang" star as a magical portal, the altar should face the North. It is also important that the Magical Seal used to open the celestial gate be engraved onto a silver talisman, during one of the three days of the Full Moon, and that no sunlight ever be permitted to shine onto this special seal. The incense used to access the spirit realm of the First Star is Camphor.

It is important to note, that the Magic Talisman of the 1st Star "Lusty Wolf," energetically influences the will and desires, and directs Qi towards specific goals and visions. It also corresponds to the Rat in Chinese Astrology, the Zi Earthly Branch (1st Branch: 11:00 pm-1:00 am), Millet Grain Offerings, and Pine and Cypress Trees. The Immortal's Secret Name is "the Xu Star Immortal Zi Qin" ("Yangming").

According to the *Most-High Lao-Lord's Revelation Increasing-the-Account Divine-Talismans Marvelous-Scripture,* the 1st Star of the Northern Dipper (Lusty Wolf) - Controls the Domain of Evil Qi.

ANIMAL PHYSIOGNOMY

In the Qing Dynasty (1644-1911 A.D.), during the reign of Emperor Kang Xi, a Daoist master named Fan Lai wrote a manual of fortune telling using the art of physiognomy (the skill of observing an individual's appearance in order to determine his or her inner character and fortune). The popular textbook was entitled *The Water Mirror, Too Good To Be True, Fortune-teller*, and it was commonly studied by many Daoist mystics and priests because it described the effect on an individual's character and luck of every organ of the body. The manual begins by dividing the human race into sixteen animal types, described as follows:

- **The Dragon:** This individual has a long face with a high-bridged nose and "popping," goldfish eyes that sparkle. His eyebrows are wide, and his height is above average. He has fine bone structures and his arms and legs are well-proportioned. He has good manners and is extremely clever. Such a man is connected with royalty (like the Phoenix).

- **The Tiger:** This individual has a huge head, with a broad forehead and round nose. His mouth is big, and his hair and moustache are sparse. His voice is thunderous, and his gaze fixed. He is tall and walks with a heavy gate. Such a man is invaluable in the military and in fighting, however, he lacks commercial instinct.

- **The Unicorn (Qi Lin):** This individual has a domed skull, that slops backwards. His ears are set high on the sides of his head, his eyebrows are thick, and he has a broad forehead and deep-set eyes. Such a man will rise high in the world (like the Dragon and Crane).

- **The Lion:** This individual has a flat and receding nose, with a large square mouth. His eyebrows are irregular, and his beard and moustache are thick. His eyes are large and round, and he has yellowish pupils. Such a man is invaluable in the military and in fighting.

- **The Crane:** This individual has an ethereal look, with a long neck. He walks with a long stride, and has a clear, musical voice and a good sense of humor. Such a man will rise high in the world (like the Unicorn and Dragon).

- **The Deer:** This individual has dark lustrous eyes. He has long ears that are set high on the sides of his head. He his prominent cheekbones, and a thick moustache. He has hairy arms and legs, and walks with a trotting gait. Such a man is altogether a harmless individual, with not much positive qualities.

- **The Ox:** This individual is strongly built with black rolling eyes, a big head and thick neck. He has a peaceful temperament, and is not easily aroused or excited (showing little or no emotion). Such a man is a slow mover and a hard worker, but gives no recompense.

- **The Snake:** This individual has a long, flat forehead, with a narrow skull. He has narrow eye-slits, a wide mouth, and a narrow, red tip, pointed nose. His waist undulates when he walks, and he is constantly turning his head and leaning backwards. Such a man is not a trustworthy individual.

- **The Horse:** This individual has a long face, with big eyes and a mouth filled with huge teeth. His body is long and he walks with a rapid gate. Such a man is a hard worker.

- **The Sheep:** This individual has a square head and a long, flat-cheeked face, with a pointed chin and a narrow jaw. The pupil of his eye is swollen. Such a man is harmless and stupid.

- **The Pig:** This individual has a big head and a long face, with long eyelashes and big ears. He has a thick, short neck and a shapeless figure. Such a man is just plain stupid.

- **The Dog:** This individual has a large head, with a narrow face and a pointed chin. He

has a big, thin-lipped mouth, and the pupils of his eyes are yellow. Such a man has a quick temper, but compensates for this by being a hard worker.

- **The Phoenix:** This individual is of slender build (not to plump), with small bones. He has long, narrow, clear and beautiful eyes, with well-shaped eyebrows and an aristocratic nose. His voice is like an echo. Such a man is connected with royalty (like the Dragon), and has favorable implications.

- **The Eagle:** This individual has a square head, with a round forehead. He has a hooked nose, and the pupils of his eyes are golden-red (resembling an eagle). Such a man has a quick temper, but compensates for this by being a hard worker. Such a man has a quick temper and is not a popular individual, as his patterns give evidence of someone who is untrustworthy.

- **The Peacock:** This individual has a small face, with small round eyes and a disproportionately large body. Such a man has an unstable nature, and loves luxury.

- **The Lu Si Bird:** This individual has a narrow head, square neck and long waist. He is feminine in nature, and has a tiny body, with narrow slit eyes and long eyebrows. He has long legs and walks with light steps. Such a man is volatile in nature.

The previous observations are mere generalizations, used to diagnose an individual at a glance. Afterwards, the individual's character is assessed according to a detailed examination of his anatomy. Each item (area of his body) plays an important part in confirming or negating some other characteristic. The individual's posture and his movement are of utmost importance. The ancient Daoist have a saying, "the perfect man should stand as firm as a pine, sit as well based as a mountain, and walk like flowing water."

Figure 1.488. Tiger Mask

USING ANIMAL MASKS FOR PROTECTION

The wearing of special masks is a very old tradition that formed an integral part of ancient Chinese shamanistic sorcery. In the *Fengsu Tongyi*, master Ying Shao spoke of a Griffon Head Spirit Mask used to preserve the Hun (Ethereal Soul) of a deceased individual, and prevent it from floating about. This magical Animal Mask was also called a "Striking the Grave Pit" mask."

When placed on the wall and used as a power totem, these masks were believed to frighten off evil spirits and disease. When worn in magical ritual, they were believed to quickly induce possession.

In Daoist magic, when performing a defensive ritual against a powerful wizard, a priest may sometimes use a mask to represent or embody a ferocious animal such as a tiger (this is an animal that the ancient Daoists believed would specifically chase and eat ghosts). The animal mask acted as a protective shield that was believed to confuse demons by preventing them from recognizing the image of the priest who was conducting exorcistic rituals. Therefore, the tiger mask was especially used in ancient China when the Daoist priest exorcised aggressive demonic spirits.

A tiger mask (Figure 1.488) was traditionally worn by ancient Daoist priests when initiating magical rituals such as "Guohuo" (Crossing the Fire), performed during the consecration of a new temple. In this magical ritual (performed on the fifteenth day of the first month), at the conclusion of a long entrance dance, the priest (wearing a tiger's mask) would leap across a bonfire or walk across a pit of glowing coals into the temple.

The ancient Chinese believed that if these demonic entities tried to hinder the exorcist by making strange noises and causing objects to fly about, they would not succeed if the priest was wearing this special magical animal mask.

In Daoist sorcery, each of the four directions—North, South, East, and West—is represented by the magical power of a sacred celestial animal: the Turtle/Snake, Phoenix, Dragon, or Tiger respectively. When choosing an animal mask, the priest selects the specific celestial animal that opposes the direction from which the evil spirits are attacking, for example:

- **The Blue-Green Dragon Mask:** This mask was used against demons attacking from the West.
- **The White Tiger Mask:** This mask was used against demons attacking from the East.
- **The Black Turtle/Snake Mask:** This mask was used against demons attacking from the South.
- **The Red Phoenix Mask:** This mask was used against demons attacking from the North.

Types of Ritual Masks

Chinese masks are generally constructed out of wood, and worn either on the face or on the top of the head. Although colorfully painted, with images of people, ghosts, demons and celestial animals, they are traditionally divined into the following categories:

- **Exorcising Masks:** These special masks are used during religious and sacrificial ceremonies. They are designed to dispel ghosts and pestilence and ask specific gods for blessings.

  In ancient China, there were special "Ugly Head Masks" used by Daoist priests in magical ritual for driving away epidemical diseases. Additionally, explicitly described within the official documents known as the *Rituals of the Sui Dynasty* (581-618 A.D.) are specific Ugly Head Masks used by various

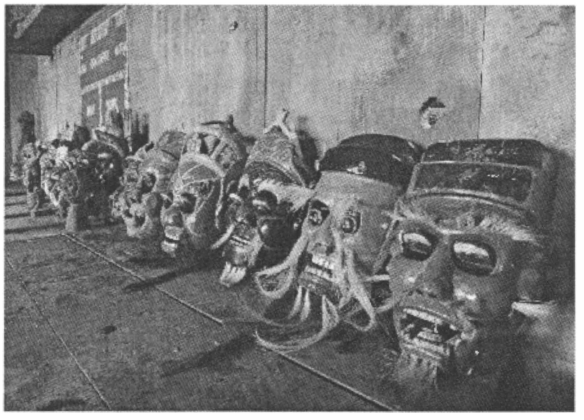


Figure 1.489. "Ugly Head Masks"

Daoist priests of official ranks in order to exorcise malevolent ghosts, evil spirits, and demons (Figure 1.489).

According to Daoist Master Duan Qing Shi, The Ugly Head Masks also served to protect the spirits of the dead. These special masks sometimes contained two, three, and four eyes, and were also known as "Ravening Obstacles" or "Grave Assailants."

- **Masks for Festive Occasions:** These types of masks are traditionally worn by people when they join Exorcising Dancers, performed during special festivals or memorial services. The purpose for these festive masks is to pray for long life, rich harvests, and to keep evil spirits at bay.
- **Masks for Keeping Houses Safe:** These special masks are developed on the basis of those worn by Exorcising Dancers, and are hung on important positions of a house to scare away evil spirits.
- **Masks for Theatrical Performances:** In the Chinese theatre, masks are an important means of portraying the various images and personalities of historic characters.
- **Masks for New Born Babies:** These special masks are used when members of society attend ceremonies marking the birth of a baby.

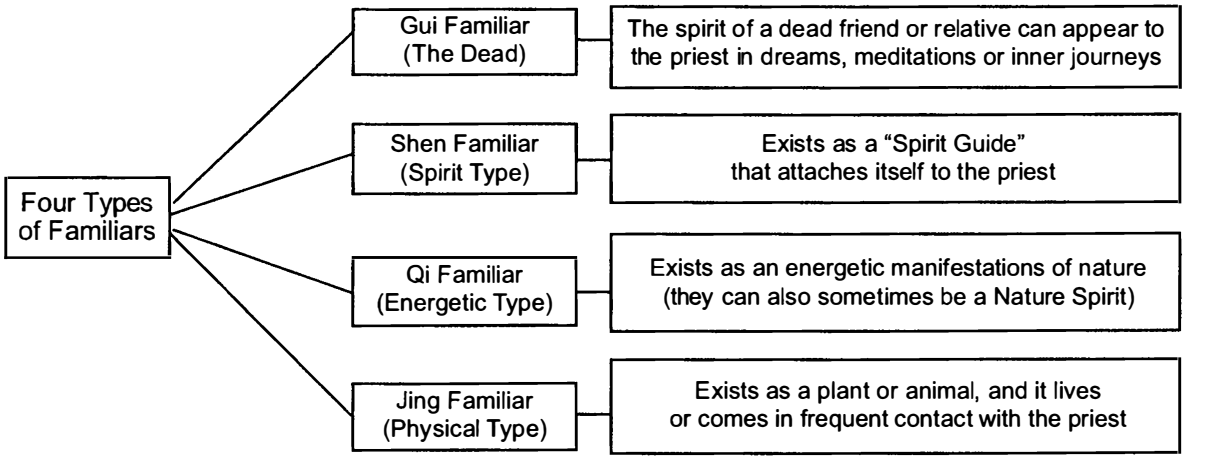


Figure 1.490. Types of Familiars Used in Daoist Magic

ANIMAL MAGIC (FAMILIARS)

In ancient times, animals were used by priests as either pets or "Familiars" (spirit helpers). In ancient China it was believed that because certain animals were energetically sensitive, they can therefore detect unseen influences more easily than the priest and could possibly protect the mystic against intrusive evil spirits. Animal Familiars were also used in order to assist the priest in communicating with nature spirits and manipulating the various powers of nature. A priest's Familiar was always kept secret and private; many times the magical animal was also symbolic of the priest's ancestral roots (a clan's "spirit protector").

TYPES OF FAMILIARS

There are several types of Familiars that can be used in Chinese sorcery. Four of the most popular types used in ancient Daoist magic are described as follows (Figure 1.490):

1. Jing (Physical Type): This type of Familiar usually resides within the physical form of a plant or animal, and it lives or comes in frequent contact with the mystic. These plants or animals establish a psychic link with the priest and are excellent for warning them of danger. The most popular of these type of Familiars are pets.

2. Qi (Energetic Type): This type of Familiar is constructed of the energetic manifestations of nature (they can also sometimes be a Nature Spirit). They are generally an Elemental (a thought form constructed out of the various energetic qualities of Fire, Water, Earth, and Air), or a Nature Spirit. This type to Familiar is sometimes used to inhabit an object for magical purposes (such as a power crystal, magic mirror, talisman, staff, etc.). These Elementals are commonly called upon in order to help strengthen the priest's magic, however, they are not forced or imprisoned in objects such as the "Spirit Servants" used by Dark Priests.

3. Shen (Spirit Type): This Familiar acts as a "Spirit Guide" and attaches itself to the priest because it has specific qualities that the mystic lacks. When the mystic is in need of energetic assistance, this Familiar "arranges" things in order to assist and support the priest.

4. Gui (The Dead): Although some priests do not practice the "High Magic" of summoning the dead, sometimes the dead may appear to them in dreams, meditations or inner journeys. It is believed that the dead should be respected and if the spirit of a deceased individual wants to help an individual, they can choose to do so as a spirit guide. The practice of communicating with the dead and asking for assistance is different. This practice was often performed in ancient times by mystics in cultures all over the world. It eventually became a natural practice for mystics, because the priest's knew how close the two worlds (physical world and spiritual world) were and

that there was nothing to fear when crossing over into the spirit realm. Communicating with the dead and asking for advice or seeking help is usually done on a specific day (such as the at the first day of Winter), when the physical world and spirit worlds come close together. This time of the year is also the time when many cultures honor their dead.

Interacting With Animal Familiars

Traditionally, the student of ancient Chinese mysticism studies their own individual animal totems (personal mythology) in order to establish a relationship to their ancestral spiritual helpers.

By performing guided meditation work with the various animals, the students are able to open the inner doorway and connect with the specific energies of the totem or Familiar with which they are working. This is practiced so that, at any time and in any given situation, the student will intuitively know what that Familiar is saying to them and why.

Starting with guided meditation and slowly progressing inward, the student learns how to observe and comprehend the omens in nature. By studying the energetic manifestations of particular Animal Familiars, the priest can also learn powerful lessons that are specific to that Animal Familiar.

Respect is important to a Familiar. These spirit entities come to you to guide, help, warn, and give you messages. Therefore, it is important to honor them and show respect by thanking them, and then leaving some form appreciation on your altar (leaving offerings of fruit or spirit money). The experiences you have with your Familiar are highly personal and many people may not understand the true inner meaning of them. To talk of the experiences you have with your Familiar may show disrespect, and can lessen the magic that you have with them (it can even make them leave).

Attunement With An Animal Familiar

All animals, like plants and trees, are naturally able to energetically extend and project their Shen outward, and to become receptive to activities occurring within the specific territory that they have "staked-out" or marked as being their personal space. For example, an animal that is brought into a new environment becomes attuned to the energetic activities, thoughts, and intentions of the various people and other animal life forms within that area. The safety and survival of the animal seems to relate to its ability to access this information. This commonly manifests as bonding with those who take care of them.

The ancient technique of creating an Animal Familiar allows a Daoist priest the ability to energetically bond and connect him or herself to a living animal by performing a magical ritual. After the energetic and spiritual bond is forged, the animal will then serve as an energetic link and external functional attribute of the priest's will. It is important to note that in this type of magical "Attunement," the priest is limited in the number of animals (or objects) that he or she may attach and energetically bond to; and that the energetic and spiritual bond can also be severed any time the priest wishes to become free from the energetic cords of attachment (or if the animal dies).

In order to form a magical Attunement with a physical animal, the creature must be friendly, mundane, and docile. Once the animal has befriended and has bonded with the priest, it gains a special type of energetic fusion known as a "Sensory Link." With this type of animal power, the priest can experience the world through the animal's senses, as well as issue the animal simple mental commands. Sometimes distance can be a determining factor in the success of this type of Attunement (depending primarily on the priest's skill level). Also taken into consideration is the general health of the animal, as the energetic link cannot function if the bonded creature is suddenly injured.

Each animal has its own way of energetically and spiritually fusing with its master. For example, when a priest chooses a cat as a Familiar, it is important to note that the cat must first taste the blood of the priest in order to seal the bond. Traditionally, on its own time, the cat will choose the correct time to bite the priest and draw blood. This could be on the priest's hand or leg, or anywhere on the body. Once bitten, the bond is complete and a blood pact is created.

More advanced bonding rituals allow the priest to temporary transfer one of his or her acquired magical powers to the Attuned animal. It is important to note that the priest may sometimes tempo-

rarily lose the power of the projected magical ability while it is being transferred to, and used by, the Attuned animal. Multiple rituals can be conducted so that an attuned animal can have several powers transferred on to it, or so that multiple Attuned animals can have powers transferred onto them.

In ancient China, these types of Attunements were also conducted with magical items (i.e., talismans, seals, weapons, etc.). This powerful technique allowed the Daoist priest the ability to connect and bond themselves to any item by performing a specific magical ritual with the object of his or her desire. After the energetic and spiritual bonding was forged, the item served as an energetic link and external manifestation of the priest's power. Priests who mastered this type of Attunement technique could bond and attach their energies to any weapon, tool, or vehicle that they are mentally and emotionally attached their will and intention to. After the energetic bond has formed, the priest could then use the "imprinted" item to perform magical tasks with greater ease and less difficulty. For example, a priest who has "Attuned" and energetically imprinted his or her calligraphy brush could paint magical talismans much easier. Any artwork that the priest painted would magically carry the energetic imprinting of the priest's thoughts and emotions into the canvas. Additionally, any warrior who has "Attuned" and energetically imprinted his or her weapon can more easily defeat an opponent, etc.).

While the magical focus placed onto an animal or item may allow it to become a powerfully attuned vehicle for the priest's will and intention, this type of energetic bonding is only used in the beginning stages of sorcery in order to acquire magical "helper" tools. It is important to note, that in some cases, what is commonly known as an animal "familiar" is actually a spirit entity that has attached itself to an animal, and works to assist a sorcerer as an energetic medium through which to work his or her magic.

ATTUNEMENT WITH A SPIRIT ANIMAL FAMILIAR

To attract an Animal Familiar, you first need to meditate on its energetic form before you summon it. This does not mean that specific Animal Familiar will come to you simply because you have called it. Familiars have a will of their own and will come if they want to, or if they feel they have something necessary for you. Sometimes they come for a short period of time and then leave; sometimes you may call on a specific animal but get another one entirely. And, sometimes a Familiar chooses you whether you have any personal liking for them at all.

The key to attracting a familiar is patience and listening with all of your senses. They may come to you through a vision, meditation, or dreams, and they will leave subtle messages. Sometimes you may notice a certain feather that appears in your path more than usual, sometimes you dream of a plant because you need it for healing, sometimes during meditation you suddenly meet a spirit with a message, sometimes you notice that there are certain things in the house that are being disrupted, moved, or even "lost" because you are not listening and they are trying to get your attention.

To call upon an animal familiar you must be acquainted with its specific energetic qualities and its particular magical ability to shape-shift. Remember that all interactions begin on the spiritual plane first, before any results can manifest on the physical plane.

The following ancient technique allows a Daoist priest to energetically bond and connect him or herself to a spirit animal by performing a magical ritual. After the energetic and spiritual bond is forged, the spirit animal will then serve as an energetic link and external functional attribute of the priest's will. It is important to note that in this type of magical "Attunement," the priest is not limited in the number of spirit animals (or guardians) that he or she may attach and energetically bond to.

The Awakening Of The Four Celestial Animals

In the following meditation, the student will experience and train the fusion of the Daoist Four Celestial Animals that are used throughout Chinese magical history as powerful guardian spirits. In this training, the Dragon (representing the Imagination and Yang) and the Tiger (representing Sensation and Yin) will combine energies and fuse as one; additionally, the Phoenix (representing the Intention and Yang) and the Turtle/Snake (representing Attention and Yin)

will also will combine energies and fuse as one (Figure 1.491). The priest will eventually use all Four Celestial Animals as a Mandala of power and surround his or her core-self, inside the Taiji Pole, with each animal's energetic presence. The Four Celestial Guardian Animals are attracted to the divine energy radiating from the priest's Most Secret Name. The powerful Mantra of the priest's Most Secret Name is imagined and kept as a Luminous Jewel, located deep inside the core center of his or her Lower Dantian.

The training of the Four Guardian Animal Spirits involves three important disciplines: the understanding of Language, Mythology, and Energetic Geometry. These three things are also needed for controlling Dream Training. Through these three important disciplines, the priest will learn the "trigger" mechanisms that initiate dream travel and visionary work.

From a standing or sitting posture, train the Four Guardian Animal Spirits as follows:

- After performing the "Radiant Breathing" Shengong exorcise, relax your body, mind, and spirit by inhaling and exhaling three simple sighs.
- Next, focus your mind on your Sixth Chakra (Third Eye) and imagine and feel a vibrant blue light forming into an blue energy ball.
- Imagine and feel this blue energy ball rolling upward over your forehead and resting on top of your Baihui point.
- Feel this blue ball sink into your head and enter the Crystal Chamber of your Upper Dantian.
- Swallow and then "sniff" the vibrant blue ball into your heart and Middle Dantian area.
- Next, swallow and then "sniff" the vibrant blue ball into your Lower Dantian and alchemic cauldron.
- Imagine and feel the vibrant blue ball surround, envelop, and energetically activate the Luminous Jewel (Most Secret Name) located in the Lower Dantian. In your mind, see this fusion as a golden light that radiates from the Luminous Jewel and Taiji Pole, and extends outward to fill your surrounding aura, and eventually your surrounding environment.

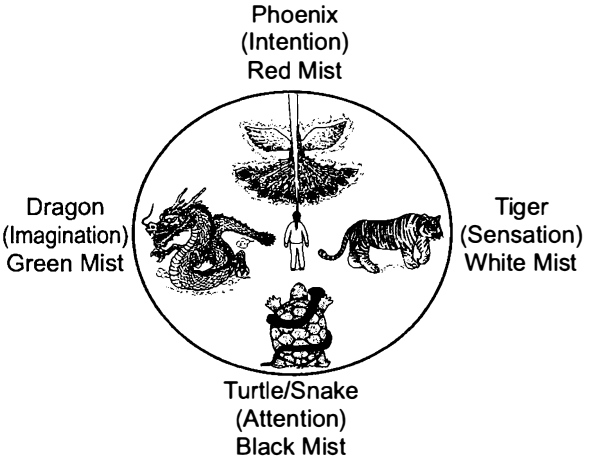


Figure 1.491. The Four Celestial Animals

- Imagine occupying the energetic space of the Luminous Jewel (see it positioned in your heart as you stand in the center of a Magic Circle). Next, focus on a specific direction (e.g., East, the direction of the Green Dragon), and begin to invoke that animal to your side from its primary direction.
- Next, introduce yourself to the animal using your Most Secret Name. It is important at this time to become close and intimate with your animal in order to create a future together. Ask the animal for its magical name, and how you can summon it (i.e., its secret Hand Seal and Incantation). This is important so that you can immediately invoke its power in times of trouble.
- Then, two times a day (every morning and evening) - for one complete Lunar Cycle (28 days), call the Celestial Animal by its name and greet it saying "good morning" when you awaken and "good evening" before you go to sleep. This practice follows the phases of the Moon. The practice of greeting the animal for 30 days and calling it by its magical name two time a day is essential. If you miss one day of practice - you must start the entire practice all over again from the very beginning.
- **The Gift Exchange:** Eventually, with consistent practice, the animal will enter into your dreams. When this happens, perform the "Gift Exchange." This practice is performed by first Invoking the guardian animal then introduce yourself. Receive

its name and then asking if the animal needs anything from you (i.e., a ritual, etc.). It is important to do whatever the animal asks.

Next, ask the animal what it has for you (i.e., a gift), and receive this gift carefully and with gratitude and respect. Also ask for a magical symbol that represents the power or manifestation of this gift. Then ask the animal to place this gift inside your body. Feel and remember where the gift is being placed. Thank the animal for the gift. Then make the gift glow and fill your body. Feel the glow overflow your body and fill the energetic field of your aura. This action and energetic manifestation of the gift causes a special spiritual alliance (pact) with your animal. Thank your first totem animal and gracefully send it on its way using its name. If you start with the Dragon (Yang), the next animal that you invoke must be the Tiger (its Yin companion).

- After establishing an energetic connection with the Four Guardian Animal Spirits, the priest should then establish a connection with their Zenith (Heaven) Animal (located above your head), as well as their Nadir (Earth) Animal (located directly beneath your feet). These six magical guardians protect the six directions of space surrounding the priest's body. It is important to practice once every Lunar cycle (every 30 days or at the least every 45 days) in order to reconnect with the energetic and spiritual fields of your six Guardian Animals.
- **Note:** It is important for the priest to accept the shape, form, and image of each animal as it energetically appears. Be aware that each animal may follow the priest's own ancestral traits and not necessarily the patterns of Chinese archetypes. Allow each animal to energetically appear and evolve according to its own energetic potential. Understanding its correspondence by what it does and its procedure is the key to understanding the most secret training of ancient Chinese shamanistic dreamwork.

TRAINING THE SAGE ANIMAL SPIRIT

The Sage Animal lives within the priest's Luminous Jewel, located deep inside the core center of his or her Lower Dantian (Figure 1.492). All of the six Guardian Animals report to the "Sage" Animal, who is responsible for leading, guiding, and directing their energetic actions. The Sage Animal is the priest's personal Core Animal, and it also acts as his or her energetic and spiritual "familiar."

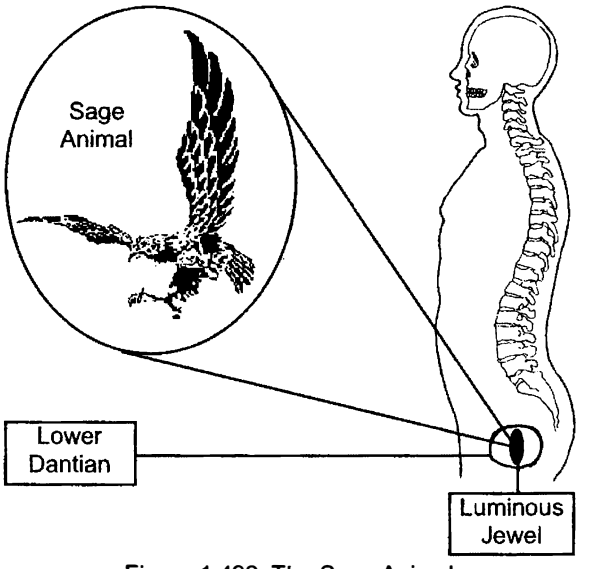


Figure 1.492. The Sage Animal

The Sage Animal's energetic existence originates from the priest's own heart. It is born from the energetic fusion of the Qi and Shen flowing from the six Guardian Animals, which is accomplished by performing the following practice:

- After performing the "Radiant Breathing Shengong exorcise, relax your body, mind, and spirit by inhaling and exhaling three simple sighs.
- Next, focus your mind on your Third Eye and imagine and feel a vibrant blue light forming into an blue energy ball.
- Imagine and feel this blue energy ball rolling upward over your forehead and resting on top of your Baihui point.
- Feel this blue ball sink into your head and enter the Crystal Chamber of your Upper Dantian.
- Swallow and then "sniff" the vibrant blue ball into your heart and Middle Dantian area.
- Next, swallow and then "sniff" the vibrant blue ball into your Lower Dantian and alchemic cauldron.
- Imagine and feel the vibrant blue ball surround, envelop, and energetically activate the

Luminous Jewel (Most Secret Name) located in the Lower Dantian. In your mind, see this fusion as a golden light that radiates from the Luminous Jewel and Taiji Pole, and extends outward to fill your aura, and eventually your surrounding environment.

- Imagine occupying the energetic space of the Luminous Jewel (see it positioned in your heart as you stand in the center of a Magic Circle). Next, focus on invoking and surrounding yourself with the six Guardian Animals (the guardian animals of the four primary directions, plus your Zenith and Nadir animals).
- Ask which of the six Guardian Animals needs the most energy.
- As that animal steps forward, go to that animal's position and allow the animal to take your place at the center of the Magic Circle.
- With the animal in position, begin to radiate light from your heart into the animal in the center of the Magic Circle. All of the other animals will also follow your lead and radiate light from their hearts into the animal positioned in the center of the Magic Circle.
- The animal positioned in the Center of the Magic circle will then thank you and all of the other animals.
- One by one, each of the six Guardian Animals will take their turn standing in the center of the Magic Circle, and receiving the radiating light from the hearts of the other animals.
- After the last Guardian Animal has received this form of energetic treatment and empowerment, you will then again enter into the Magic Circle.
- At this point, all six Guardian Animals will radiate their Qi and Shen into your heart, and out of your heart will come your Sage Animal.
- Once the Sage Animal is born, introduce it to each the six Guardian Animals and inform them that this Sage Animal is the energetic and spiritual manifestation of you.
- After dispersing the six Guardian Animals, the priest and his or her Sage Animal will stand together in the middle of the Magic Circle. The Sage Animal will enter into the priest's heart and live within the Luminous Jewel, located deep inside the core center of his or her Lower Dantian.

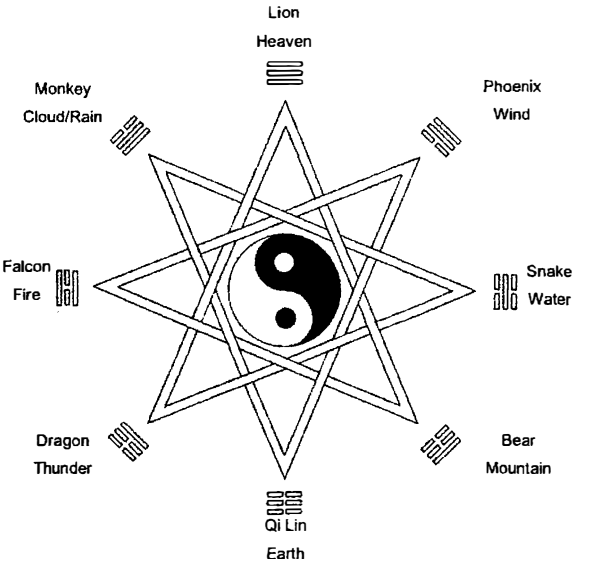


Figure 1.493. Daoist Bagua Animal Totems

DAOIST BAGUA ANIMAL TOTEMS

Bagua translates as "Eight Trigrams," which are the symbols that form the foundation of the Yi-Jing or "Book of Changes." Each trigram is composed of three Yaos (or lines) which form a Gua. Each Gua is read from the bottom up, making the bottom line the determining factor of whether the trigram is considered Yang (a solid line ---) or Yin (a broken line - -). Each of the eight Guas are attributed to a specific animal totem (Figure 1.493).

Each individual Gua develops into the characteristics of a specific animal's image and movement in order to create a unique form of energetic techniques and patterns that were used in ancient China for self-defence, healing, and magic. When mastered, each animal form becomes a manifestation of life-force energy in motion, abiding within the priest's innermost being, and arising from his or her spirit spontaneously.

By studying the Eight Trigrams and their related animals as they pertain to energetic practice and combat, the Daoist priest develops confidence and inner strength, generated by the focus of intent and the projection of the spirit. In order for the intention to be clear and the sensation of the "Animal's Flavor" to manifest, the priest must embody the alertness, power, spirit, will, and energy of that particular animal. Once the priest can reside

The Eight Trigrams	Heaven Qian	Cloud, Rain Dui	Fire Li	Thunder Zhen	Earth Kun	Mountain Gen	Water Kan	Wind, Air Xun
Yang and Yin Animal	Yang Lion	Yang Monkey	Yang Falcon	Yang Dragon	Yin Qi Lin	Yin Bear	Yin Snake	Yin Phoenix
Gereral Energetic Principles	Creative, Strength	Reflective, Tranquility	Brightness, Radiance	Excitement Movement	Receptive Form	Stillness, Balance	Darkness, Danger	Penetrating, Flexibility
	Activity	Weightless	Formed	Impetus	Passivity	Heaviness	Formless	Sensitivity
Principles of Nature	Immaterial	Evaporation	Solar Forces	Vitality	Material	Inertia	Lunar Forces	Assimilation
	South	South-East	East	North-East	North	North-West	West	South-West
	Formless	Changeability	Heat	Mobility	Form	Resistance	Cold	Organic
	Sun	Venus	Jupiter	Mars	Earth	Saturn	Moon	Mercury
	Infinite Space	Clairvoyant Observation	Penetrating Light	Growth and Power	Dense Matter	Solid Stability	Space and Movement	Perceptive Intuition

Figure 1.494. The Prenatal Bagua Trigram Powers According to the Universal Forces of Yin and Yang (System of Fu Xi)

in this increased state of psychic awareness, there is a spontaneous correctness in his or her actions.

The energetic form of each of the eight Guas involves a different type of animal spirit and characteristic. This allows each animal the ability to contain the specific characteristics of the other animals in its energetic movement, emotion, thought, and spirit. This energetic "shape-shifting" also allows to the Eight Trigrams to blend and transform their powers into sixty-four hexagrams of living energy. The Eight Trigrams and their combat animal characteristics are described as follows (Figure 1.494):

- **Lion (Heaven):** This trigram indicates animal characteristics such as being confident, brave, strong, determined, and aggressive.
- **Monkey (Mist, Cloud, Rain):** This trigram indicates animal characteristics such as changeability, reflectiveness, and tranquility
- **Falcon (Fire):** This trigram indicates animal characteristics such as being alert, and on-guard. The Falcon is able to suddenly appear and disappear quickly, quietly and undetected.
- **Dragon (Thunder):** This trigram indicates animal characteristics such as being flexible, agile, and unpredictable in its ability to expand (increasing its size to infinite proportions) or contract (shrinking its size to the smallest molecule). The Dragon can also energetically transform itself into either the Yang Heavenly Dragon (and move among the clouds, mists, and vapors of Heaven) or the Yin Earthly Dragon (and move among the waters of the Earth).
- **Qi Lin (Earth):** This trigram indicates animal characteristics such as meekness, kindness, receptivity, unpredictable transformations, and shape-shifting.
- **Bear (Mountain):** This trigram indicates animal characteristics such as power, resistance, stillness, and balance.
- **Snake (Water):** This trigram indicates animal characteristics such as flexibility, as well as being cold, cruel and indifferent, showing no emotion or remorse.
- **Phoenix (Wind):** This trigram indicates animal characteristics such as turning, spinning, and moving like a tornado, penetrating something with the energetic power of swirling, continuous circles.

Daoist Celestial Animal Totems

The ancient Daoists believed that each individual has at their disposal the untapped magical power of 12 Animal totems (Spiritual Icons), one located in each of the Twelve Chakras Gates. The understanding and control of each of these 12 Animal totems allows an individual the ability to eventually initiate and control animal Shape-Shifting.

According to Li Haiqi of the Song Dynasty (960-1279 A.D.), "Man is associated with the Celestial Animal symbols and the Twelve Earthly Branches. In the more advanced Shengong training of Daoist mysticism, the Twelve Celestial Animals and Twelve Earthly Branches are positioned surrounding the individual's Taiji Pole. This allows the priest the ability to access the various powers of the twelve guardian animal totems (Figure 1.495)."

In ancient China, the Twelve Celestial Animals could also be arranged in a circle that surrounded the Upper Dantian area, with the priest's Birth Animal placed in front of his or her Sixth Chakra (Third Eye, also known as the "Eye of God"). In this energetic arrangement, the conflict animal (the animal that questions and challenges the priest's motives) was simultaneously positioned at the back of the priest's head, located at the Wind Gate (also known as the "Mouth of God"). The priest's support animals (located every fourth animal) are positioned behind the individual's ears.

The Taiji Pole of the body is comparable to the Taiji Pole (central axis) of the Earth. The original Chinese character for Taiji means "the Great Ultimate," and represents the ultimate state of transformation (Yin transforming into Yang and vice versa).

The center core or midline of the Taiji is called the "still-point." This is because although all of the changes of Yin and Yang occur in the Heavens within the course of a day, as the stars make a 360 degree rotation (as the Earth rotates), the Pole Star remains stationary as Heaven's still-point. In a similar manner, the body's Taiji Pole is viewed as

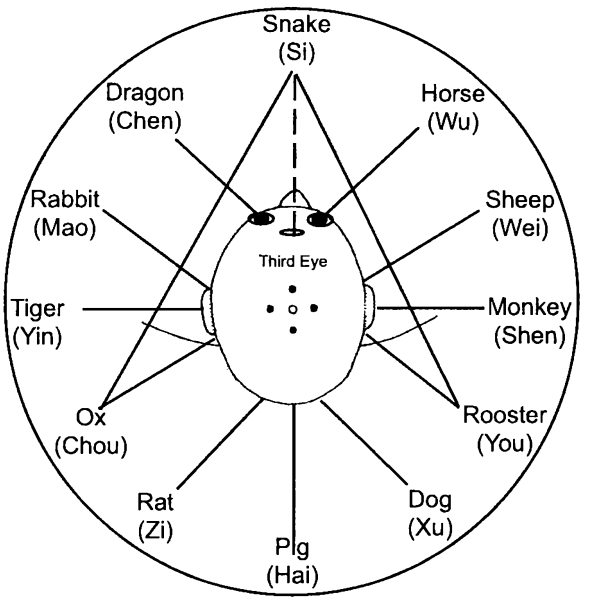


Figure 1.495. The position of the Twelve Celestial Animals is arranged in a circle surrounding the head and Upper Dantian area, with the individual's Birth Animal placed in front of his or her Third Eye. The individual's conflict animal is positioned at the Wind Gate point.

the still-point of "Man," around which a person experiences all of the changes, transformations and developments of his or her life. Consequently, great stillness can be experienced as a gateway into the infinite realm of the spirit world when a practitioner of Daoist magic gathers Qi and focuses his or her Shen into the Taiji Pole.

Through understanding the spiritual influence of each animal's personality and character, the Daoist priest can facilitate the proper utilization of each of the animal's energetic potential. The main characteristics of the Twelve Celestial Animals are described as follows:

- **Rat (Zi Branch):** This celestial animal is resourceful, ambitious, hard-working, determined, industrious, generous, diplomatic, and intelligent. Colors: light blue and white.

- **Ox (Chou Branch):** This celestial animal is patient, courageous, conventional, reliable, purposeful, independent, and intelligent. Colors: violet and pale pink.
- **Tiger (Yin Branch):** This celestial animal is adventurous, daring, idealistic, creative, confident, passionate, enthusiastic, and entertaining. Colors: red and orange.
- **Rabbit (Mao Branch):** This celestial animal is peace loving, generous, intuitive, tactile, devoted, sociable, discreet, and sensitive. Colors: pale green, white, and gray.
- **Dragon (Chen Branch):** This celestial animal is enthusiastic, daring, inspiring, successful, materialistic, independent, and intelligent. Colors: gold, green, and black.
- **Snake (Si Branch):** This celestial animal is intelligent, mysterious, intuitive, charming, seductive, sensual, daring, independent, and sophisticated. Colors: pale yellow and pale green.
- **Horse (Wu Branch):** This celestial animal is loyal, hard-working, ambitious, friendly, quick-witted, and energetic. Colors: brown and white.
- **Sheep/Goat (Wei Branch):** This celestial animal is peaceful, adaptable, honest, creative, charming, imaginative, and sincere. Colors: mauve, pink, and yellow.
- **Monkey (Shen Branch):** This celestial animal is independent, lively, quick-witted, entertaining, bold, intelligent, and inventive. Colors: yellow, red, and white.
- **Rooster (You Branch):** This celestial animal is courageous, protective, flamboyant, industrious, communicative, and honest. Colors: pale red, apricot, and yellow.
- **Dog (Xu Branch):** This celestial animal is loyal, responsible, sensitive, moral, trustworthy, defensive, generous, patient, and imaginative. Colors: brown and dark green.
- **Pig/Boar (Hai Branch):** This celestial animal is pure in heart, generous, cheerful, tolerant, and outspoken. Colors: gold, dark blue and deep red.

ANIMAL SHAPE-SHIFTING

Shape-shifting is the ability to change the shape of a specific energy field that may pertain to a physical object or something that is intangible. It involves physical changes such as alterations of age, gender, race, or general appearance, or it may involve changes between human form and that of an animal, plant, or inanimate object. Every time an individual changes shape, he or she also obtain's the powers and abilities of the new form.

The ancient Chinese believed that, since an individual's Energy Body and Spirit Body can be transformed into image of other human bodies, it can also, in certain cases, be transformed into forms such as animals, birds, fish, or insects (usually before and after the individual's death). During the Han Dynasty (206 B.C. - 220 A.D.) the belief in the transmutation of men into beasts was maintained and well documented by certain Daoist monks and recorded in the *Standard Histories*. Additionally, the belief maintained that after many years of existence the essence of an ancient animal could be transformed, assuming a human shape in order to bewilder and beguile the minds of man, tempting them continuously. Such energetic transformations commonly included the shape-shifting into tigers, wolves, dogs, foxes, and snakes.

The art of shape-shifting was a common practice in ancient Daoist sorcery, where it was known as the art of Magical Transformation. It includes the magical skill of changing the body's physical form or shape into that of another person or animal. Such magical acts of transformations are categorized as follows:

- **Shape-shifting:** This indicates changes that are temporary
- **Metamorphosis:** This indicates changes that are lasting
- **Transformation:** This indicates changes that are externally imposed

All Shape-shifting occurs on an energy level. However, depending on the density of the vibration of a specific energy field, the Shape-shifting event may be more or less obvious to the physical senses. When a complete physical transformation

occurs, a Shape-shifting is said to be physical. Vast majority of shape-shifters do not undergo a complete physical transformation and may outwardly appear pretty much the same.

According to the degree of transformation, shape-shifters are generally divided into two categories:

- **"Out of body" Shifting:** These individuals are energy shape-shifters that change the energetic form of their spirit body while in the spirit realm into the image of a person, animal, plant or thing
- **"Altered State" Shifting:** These individuals are physical shape-shifters that change the appearance of their physical form while on the physical realm into the form of a person, animal, plant or thing. The Altered State Shape-shifting uses some of the same methods of consciousness altering employed in out-of-body voyages but they are sufficiently different to enable them to be considered separately.

The most important aspect of shape-shifting, is whether the transformation is voluntary or not. With some individuals, the ability to shape-shift occurs spontaneously, and they may have a challenging time learning how to control its magical ability. Other individuals may have to invest a considerable amount of time in developing this ability. When a form is taken on involuntarily, the energetic effect is one of confinement and restraint; the person is bound to the new form. In extreme cases, the individual's personality is entirely disabled. Voluntary forms, on the other hand, are means of escape and liberation; even when the form is not undertaken to effect a literal escape, the energetic abilities that are attributed to the new form allow the individual to act in a manner previously impossible.

Some shape-shifters are able to change form only if they have some item, usually an article of clothing (i.e. tiger or wolf skin).

In many cultures, it is feared that evil priests could magically transform themselves into animal shapes and lurk about. In face, almost every culture around the world has some type of transformation myth, and almost every commonly found animal (and some not-so-common ones) has a shape-shifting myth attached to it. Usually, the animal involved in the transformation is indigenous to or prevalent in the area from which the story derives.

It is worthy to note that while the popular idea of a shape-shifter is of a human being who turns into something else, there are numerous stories about animals that can transform themselves into humans as well. Chinese, Japanese, and Korean folklore all tell of animals able to assume human shape. These transformed animals have specific traits in common: the animals are often extremely old, they grow additional tails along with their abilities, and they frequently still have some animal traits that betray their true identity.

Chinese folklore contains many tales of animal shape-shifters, capable of taking on human form. The most common such shape-shifter is the Huli Jing, a fox spirit that usually appears as a beautiful young woman; most are dangerous, but some feature as the heroines of love stories.

In ancient China, the most popular of the seductive spirits were known as "fox spirits" which were believed to live high in the misty mountains. The fox spirits could take a human form by transforming themselves through the aid of human bones (especially the skull).

Once the transformation was completed, the fox spirit (generally in female form) would travel throughout the countryside looking for individuals to seduce. When the fox spirit connected with an unsuspecting individual, it would then become an energetic parasite, absorbing the victim's life-force energy.

Two recipes found in the Ma Wang Tui Medical Manuscript *"Fifty-Two Medical Prescriptions,"* found in a tomb during the Qin Dynasty (221-206 B.C.) documented the fox spirits' active role in pathological possession.

MEDITATION & ATTRACTING SMALL ANIMALS

According to ancient Daoist teachings, when a disciple is able to externally radiate his or her divine core energy into the surrounding environment, the micro-pulsations of celestial light will attract the attention of small animals. I have personally experienced this phenomena many times, and have heard several stories from many of my students who also have encountered the same experience through our meditation practice.

In Daoist Magic, this unique phenomena is developed in the "Third Stage" of magic training, which is the secret process of energetic development wherein the disciple's internal energy begins to overflow his body and externally radiate into the surrounding environment (Figure 1.496). This unique type of energy attracts small animals who are sensitive to the Qi, and are attracted to the spiritual light.

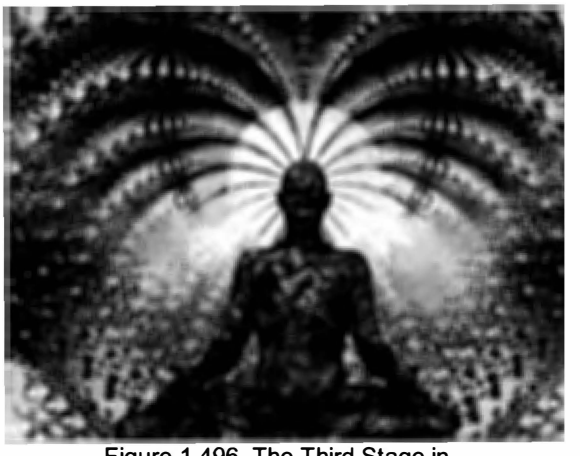


Figure 1.496. The Third Stage in Ancient Daoist Magic Training

Generally, the animals (this will happen with both domestic and wild animals) will come right up to you and gather around your body when you are meditating. After you complete the meditation session, the animals will either leave, or they will remain beside you, quiet and sedate, for quite some time. It is interesting to note that, when the small wild animals eventually leave, they always return to their lairs without disturbing one another.

According to ancient Daoist teachings, these special animals are quite intelligent and also have an uncanny sensitivity to natural life-force energy. Some of these special animals are known to perform "Sky Gazing," "Sun Worship," "Moon Worship," and other Daoist meditative exorcises in order to gather and absorb the celestial vitality of the Heavens.

Animal Sacrifices

Blood Magic began in prehistoric times as a way of acknowledging an animal when it was hunted and killed for food. Eventually, such sacrifices became an important part of ancient rituals and were common in both private and public acts of worship. These sacrifices eventually formed a type of Blood Magic that involved the slaughtering of sacrificial animals (i.e., chickens, pigs, and fish) and then offering them with rice and wine on and incense table along with magical scriptures (Figure 1.497). Even today, animal sacrifices still form an integral part of Daoist sorcery and Blood Magic.

In ancient Daoist sacrificial rituals, each of the guardian spirits was ritually "fed" his or her favorite food or sacrifice. The blood of roosters was the most common sacrificial offering. Birds (pigeons, canaries, hens, etc.) were used in rubbing rituals where the afflicted individual was cleansed, and any negative feelings that were caused by evil were passed into the birds. The magical practices of ancient Daoist mysticism were used as a method for believers to gain control over their lives (or the lives of others) by invoking the proper gods who could effect changes.

Remains of sacrificed chickens, roosters, and other animals covered in sacrificial matter have been found in areas such as cemeteries, beaches, near railroad tracks, and other places that have magical significance to the believers. Controversies associated with this practice most often involve misunderstanding of the use of magical spells, amulets, and food offerings, or involve debates surrounding the morality of the practice of animal sacrifice.

Ancient Daoism was essentially based on natural magic, and all of the basic elements of worship can be found in nature. The foundation of ancient Daoist worship can be found in four natural Elements: Fire, Water, Wind, and Earth. The basis of many of the major spells used in ancient Daoism is the evocation of specific powers contained within minerals, plants, and animals, each of which is believed to have a spirit entity that guards it. Each root, flower, tree, or plant is believed to be full of Ling Shen (Magical Spirit), and each belongs to one of the nature spirit guardians who must be asked permission whenever the plant is used.

Figure 1.497. Blood Sacrifices were a common part of both private and public acts of worship in ancient Daoist rituals

The ancient Chinese believed that only animals and humans can intentionally discharge (release) the energetic resonance of the magical spirit (Ling Shen). This discharge of the energy could be captured and harnessed through the sacrificial release of blood. Blood represents life force, and can therefore be used to increase or augment a priest's powerful magic. The price for this power is life, one drop at a time; and the raging torrent of power created by a blood sacrifice is mighty and can be very addictive to some. Blood Magic is therefore intimately connected with life, and with death. Ultimately, Blood Magic is one of the most powerful forms of magic known to man.

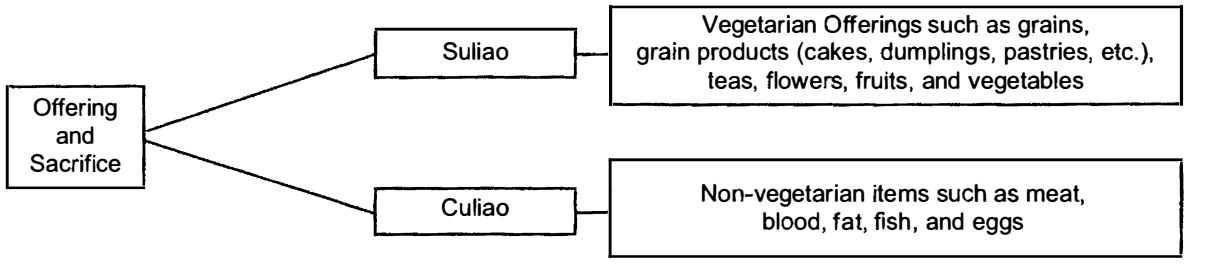


Figure 1.498. There are two types of worship items presented in Daoist Offering and Sacrificial rituals

HISTORY OF OFFERING AND SACRIFICE

Since ancient times, all magical traditions have incorporated the use of Offerings and Sacrifices in order to gain the attention and favor of various powerful spirit entities. Both Offering and Sacrifice are seen as an energetic form of worship and communication, used to catch the attention of a god or powerful spirit entity. In Daoist magic, there are two types of worship items (Bailiao) presented in Offering and Sacrificial rituals. These include Suliao (vegetarian items) and Culiao (non-vegetarian items), described as follows (Figure 1.498):

- **Suliao:** This includes refined or vegetarian Offerings such as grains, grain products (cakes, dumplings, pastries, etc.), teas, flowers, fruits, and vegetables. All vegetarian dishes are presented as non-sacrificial Offerings to vegetarian gods and deities. However, the burning of candles, paper images, incense-paper and joss-sticks (large incense stacks) are considered to be a form of Sacrifice, because it involves the willful destruction of the object offered.
- **Culiao:** This includes gross or non-vegetarian items such as meat, blood, fat, fish, and eggs. Culiao commonly refers to animal sacrifice, especially pigs, ducks, and chickens. Each of these animals are traditionally offered in whole or in parts. When a pig is chosen as the sacrificial animal, one of two colors are chosen: gold or silver. The "gold pig" (Jin Zhu) is roasted first, while the "silver pig" (Yin Zhu) or "white pig" (Bai Zhu) is presented in raw form. Both are classified as sacrificial items (Sheng Liao). However, the cooked pig is only offered to benign or tame non-vegetarian deities, while the uncooked pig is strictly offered to malignant or "wild spirits" (such as Huye, the Tiger deity).

In modern times, magical rituals requiring human sacrifice are replaced by the symbolized burning of images in the form of paper-men and paper-women. These paper images act as energetic portals, enabling the priest to transfer his or her Qi and Shen from the world of the living to the world of the dead. In such magical rituals, living and earthly forms have to be broken or turned into ashes (Huahuo) in order for the transfer of energy to be effective. In Daoist magic, these types of ceremonies are regarded as a form of sacrificial ritual because the religious object is destroyed together with the human image printed on the yellow paper. Daoist priests regard these human sacrificial images as substitutes for other human beings and are commonly used on behalf of victims that have been tormented by health problems, bad luck, etc.

In Daoist magical rituals, the burning of "Incense-paper," paper images, charm papers, papercuttings, and prayer sheets are always offered to gods. These sacrificial offerings allow the priest the magical ability to gain access into the spirit world.

Certain magical traditions still incorporate these methods of sacrifice for both "good" and "evil" purposes. It is common knowledge that Daoist sorcery is comprised of both good and evil uses of magic. There are many different types of magical rituals, including individual acts of piety such as lighting candles for particular spirits or holding large feasts sometimes lasting several days. Initiation, divination, sacrifice, and spirit possession are fundamental types of ancient Daoist rituals.

History of Blood Magic

One of the most powerful ways of gathering animal or human Essence (Jing), Energy (Qi), and Spirit (Shen) is through Blood Magic. This ancient practice has been used by priests of all magical traditions for millennia. In ancient China, human sacrifice was commonly practiced during the Xia (2205-1600 B.C.), Shang (1600-1028 B.C.), Zhou (1028-221 B.C.) Dynasty periods.

The practice of the Blood Sacrifice was developed through the understanding that blood carries the essence of life, and that the spilling of blood demonstrated the ultimate commitment and sacrifice (i.e., when blood was spilled, the creature died). Both blood and breath bridge the realms of spirit and matter, and for this reason they have always been perceived as powerful vehicles of magic.

In ancient Daoist sorcery, Blood Magic was first used during rites involving a blood oath between the initiate and the leaders of secret orders or societies. The blood oaths were used to seal all important agreements. It was believed that the use of these blood oaths strengthened the order's combined magical powers. One example of a blood oath used to bind an initiate to a secret magical sect is as follows:

"My blood contains the light of my soul. I, (name of initiate), swear by the light of this magical blood that I will fulfill the promise and contract of my word, and seal the oaths that I have taken."

Eventually, the use of blood oaths became more popular, even being used to seal common domestic contracts such as marriages. Over time, priests began to pattern their magical rituals after this custom and imbued them with the power of Blood Magic. The ancient Chinese believed that anyone who broke a blood oath was cursed, and doomed to live a life of serious misfortune, disease, and sometimes death.

In order to obtain maximum power, ancient priests thoroughly studied the magic developed while practicing the rituals of blood oaths. They performed experiments incorporating blood sacrifices in order to empower certain magical tools and icons, a practice that gave way to the creation of "blood charms." At the same time, these ancient mystics discovered that blood sacrifices could be used to increase their body's natural magical abilities, and many priests began using Blood Magic to increase their powers and extend the durations of their magical spells.

In ancient China, the placing of blood onto a specific item in order to spiritually awaken it and activate its full power (usually painting its eyes) was known as "lighting the eyes of the dragon." This spiritual initiation was commonly used in ancient times in order to sanctify a person, place, or thing (i.e., a house, icon, magical tool, altar, etc.). Gradually, more and more communities began to rely on Blood Magic rituals for increased protection from spirit entities, mountain demons, and hungry ghosts. Such communities willingly sacrificed the lives of many in order to increase the magical power of the protective rituals. Historically, the most extreme acts of Blood Magic ever performed were multiple sacrifices designed to protect these ancient communities from supernatural terrors.

The Energetic Power of Blood

The Chinese word "Xue" translates as "Blood." Its ancient character is composed of a pictograph representing a small, wide-lipped, clay vessel used for collecting blood. Contained within the bowl is a horizontal line used to represent blood (Figure 1.499). Later, during the Shang Dynasty (1600-1028 B.C.), these ancient vessels were crafted out of bronze.

In ancient China, it was believed the red blood was the seat of the soul, and that magical powers could be imbued into any object that was ritually smeared with blood. This is why when statues or pictures of gods or goddesses are being consecrated, the eyes are painted over with blood. In this way, the picture or statue is energetically animated and given a soul.

Its modern character is composed of two parts. Positioned on the top is a line representing the flow of blood as it pours into a sacrificial vessel. Positioned to the bottom is a radical "Min," meaning a vessel for catching sacrificial blood (Figure 1.500).

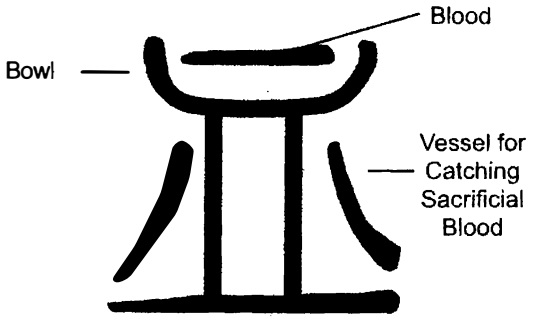


Figure 1.499. Ancient Chinese Character for Blood "Xue"

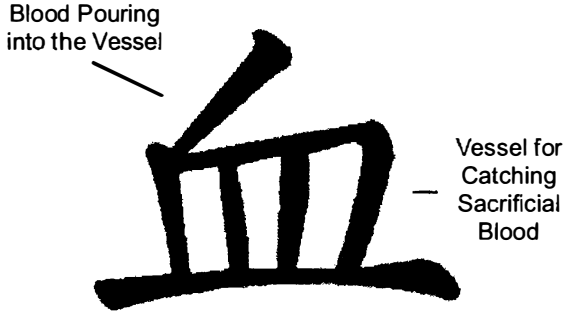


Figure 1.500. Modern Chinese Character for Blood "Xue"

In ancient China, it was believed that the blood becomes red only because the Heart puts its "imperial stamp" onto the liquids, and penetrates the body fluids with the power of the heart's shen. This "imperial" action transforms the liquids into blood. The energetic and spiritual component blood now receives its red color of fire and has the ability to bring life to the body.

Additionally, male semen was believed to be transformed blood, and if too much semen is expended, a man's health suffered. Likewise, a mother's milk is also considered blood in a different form.

It was also believed that, if a demon can be successfully smeared with blood, it was forced to assume its true form.

The ancient Chinese mystics understood that "blood gives power." This is why some priests use blood in their rituals, either by drinking it (mixing it with the altar wine or simply straight), pouring it over themselves (as a form of initiation, consecration, or purification), using it as a spiritual weapon (causing a spirit entity to either transform back into its true form or completely dissolve), making talismans from it (mixed with ash from the altar or simply straight), or for activating deity icons (painting the eyes of various icons or power symbols in order to impregnate them with specific energetic and spiritual powers). However, without a true understanding of the methods and power derived from Blood Magic, the aspiring young mystic will be at the mercy of any seasoned priest who initiates a psychic attack via such powerful practices.

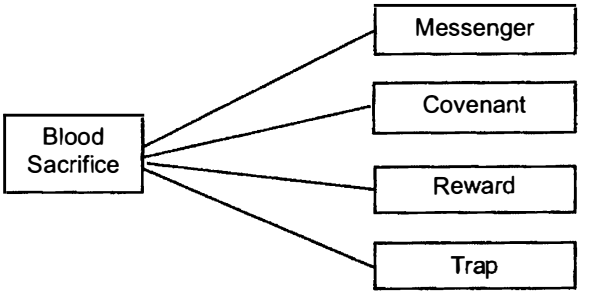


Figure 1.501. Examples of some of the specific purposes used for blood sacrifice rituals.

In occult theory, a living creature is a storehouse of energy, and when it is killed most of this energy is suddenly liberated. The amount of energy released when the victim is killed is very great, completely out of proportion with the animal's size or strength. The killing is done inside the magic circle (or orbit) to keep the animal's energy contained and concentrated. When some person or an animal is about to be sacrificed, for an instant just before they die, they emit their life energy or power. The practice of Blood Magic channels and harnesses this life-force energy either for use as a devotional offering, or as a way of accruing spiritual power.

There are several important applications of blood sacrifices that are still used today in Daoist sorcery. The following are but a few examples of some of the specific purposes used for blood sacrifice rituals according to ancient Daoist traditions (Figure 1.501):

- **To Create a Spirit Messenger:** Some Daoist traditions believe that the soul of the slain

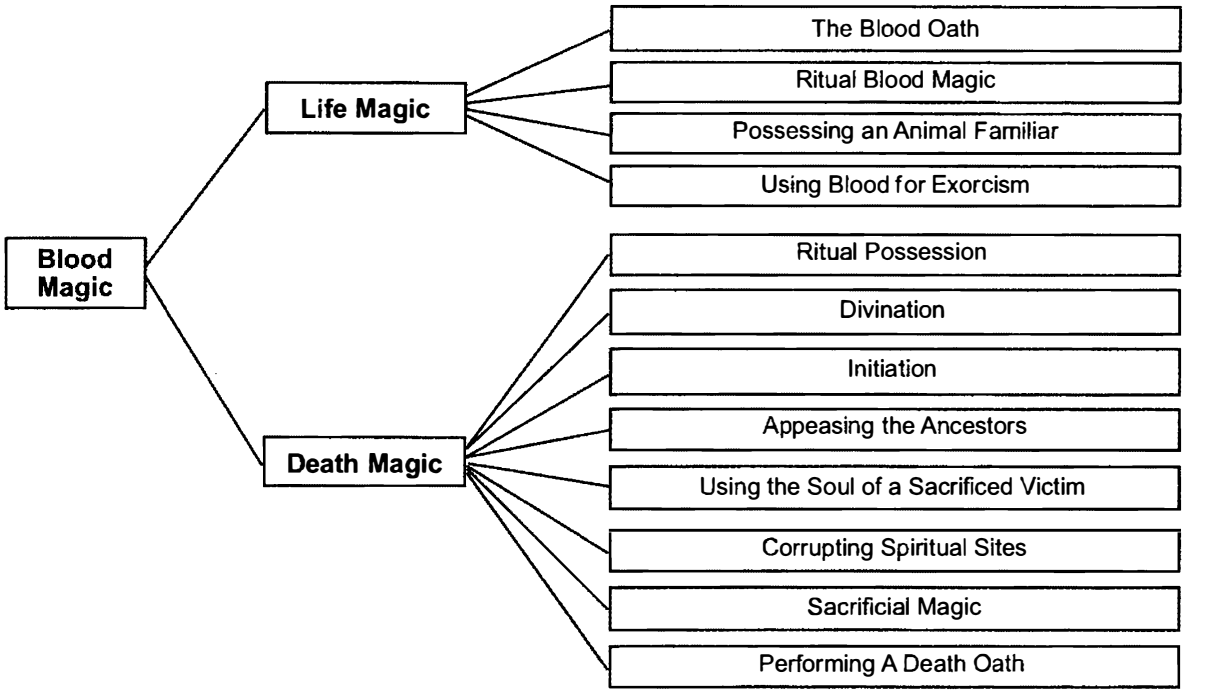


Figure 1.502. The Two Types of Blood Magic

creature can be used as a spirit servant to carry out the priest's wishes (e.g., carry the priest's message straight to the gods, spy on someone, acquire specific powers, etc.).

- **To Use as a Covenant:** Other Daoist traditions teach that the blood sacrifice is a powerful covenant and is used as a magical pact that forever binds the priest to his or her god.
- **To Provide an Offering:** Still other Daoist traditions teach that the blood sacrifice can be used to summon, feed, or reward (bribe) powerful spirit entities. A common practice is the magical offering of "wine-blood" to the Immortal Guardians, Celestial Marshal General, and their terrifying army of demon hoards as a reward for specific services (i.e., protection).

Additionally, when the spirit of the priest of black magic carries out its owner's wishes, he or she traditionally gives it blood as an expression of gratitude. Blood Offerings are also used in the practice in ancestor worship, in which the ancestors or guardians of one's family must be fed periodically.

- **To Set a Trap:** Some Daoist traditions teach that the blood sacrifice is used to call various supernatural beings to the sacrificial area. These energetic vampires could then become trapped by a skilled priest and made to serve him or her in whatever manner the priest wished.

Two Types of Blood Magic

All uses of Blood Magic require an expenditure of life-force energy, either from the practitioner, a willing donor, or a victim (depending on the circumstances and uses warranted). Blood Magic is roughly divided into two distinct practices, Life Magic and Death Magic. In Death Magic rituals, blood is taken, and the victim is sacrificed. In Life Magic rituals, blood is taken, and the individual still lives. Both systems of Blood Magic have many magical applications, described as follows (Figure 1.502):

LIFE MAGIC

As previously mentioned, Blood Magic was originally used in esoteric Daoist sorcery in order to seal oaths, increase the initiate's powers, cast spells, summon deities, and empower blood charms (magical talismans and magical weapons).

The principle of using blood in Life Magic is based on the premise that the priest could willingly sacrifice a small portion of his or her own life-force energy (or that of another) in order to gain greater magical power and influence.

In Daoist sorcery, there are special esoteric tools and magical rituals that require an "extra boost" of magical energy (Ling Shen) in order for them to be effective. To obtain this needed energy, a priest would sometimes drain small amounts of his or her own life-force energy or that of an animal to fuel certain magical talents, items, and abilities.

The following are examples of the various uses of Blood Magic employed by ancient Daoist priests when practicing Life Magic:

- **The Blood Oath:** This type of oath creates an energetic fusion between either two individuals, or between an initiate and the group consciousness of certain secret magical "sects" or "orders." The Blood Oath is a binding agreement between the two individuals or the individual and the sect. The magic of the oath is such that the agreement must be fair (i.e., not obtained through deception), and voluntary (i.e., neither individual may be drunk, or influenced by magical charms or spells). The term of the oath is generally one year and one day, after which it can be renewed. Those who break an oath sealed with Blood Magic are subject to energetic and physical wounding and scars, which can only be healed through the use of magical intervention.

  Swearing a Blood Oath requires an actual amount of blood to be spilled, and according to tradition, the resulting damage cannot be healed until the term of the oath is completed. Blood Oaths, unlike some magic, may be used by non-magicians and non-adepts. A Blood Oath works by using Blood Magic to connect and fuse a binding energetic connection with the individual's Yuan Shen (the original energetic and spiritual patterning of those swearing the oath).

  When the magical pact of a Blood Oath is agreed upon, it must be traditionally sealed by three people (three human wills). The three human wills (San Shen) that participate in creating the pact are bound together and spiritually tied to one another so as to strengthen and maintain the spiritual integrity of the pact.

  In ancient times, a Blood Peace Oath was often used in order to seal a truce between two individuals, families, tribes, or nations. Each of the participants in the Blood Oath drew blood from their dominant weapon arm, and then pressed their bleeding arms together. As the blood dried on the participants' arms, the oath was sworn. The ancients believed that, if this pact was broken, a wound would automatically appear where the oath-breaker drew blood to swear the oath. The exact wording used in these ancient rituals varied according to race and custom. One example is as follows:

  "As the sun shines upon the Earth, so shall light illuminate my deeds. All people shall see that I mean no harm to (--------). I shall take no action to bring harm to him or those of his blood, or by inaction allow harm to befall (--------) or those of his blood. As the moon shines upon the Earth, so shall light illuminate my intent. All people shall see that I honor my word and that my word is true."

- **Ritual Blood Magic:** The use of Ritual Blood Magic (i.e., groups of three or more) is one of the most powerful forms of Blood Magic. Though the details of the ritual change according to its purpose and function, Ritual Blood Magic requires the blood of specific types of donors as well as a lengthy ritual that is needed to activate and achieve the magical effects. In this type of Blood Magic, the ritual is used to create a magical link between the blood donors and the primary priest who is casting a spell, summoning a spirit, or en-

chanting an object. Although this magical link provides an energetic boost to the primary priests' abilities, it can sometimes be costly to sustain this connection for any length of time. It is for this reason that an additional number of participants are required in this type of ritual magic.

Originally, the blood used in Daoist Blood Magic Rituals was taken from the priest himself in order to seal the bond with a spirit entity. This blood was drunk by the priest and the spirit entity in order to make the pact and seal the bond. Later, a common substitute was blood taken from the comb of a white rooster. In either case, the blood was used to represent a concentrated form of Yang life-force energy.

- **Possessing an Animal Familiar:** One way to possess an animal familiar is to swear a Blood Oath with a particular animal or spirit. The priest must first be on good terms with the animal or spirit. The priest then cuts him or herself, and formally "names" the would-be-familiar (or states the spirit's name if the familiar already has one), and then swears a Blood Oath. Generally, a priest energetically and spiritually bonds to only one familiar at a time.

  Traditionally, it is said that any mistreating of the familiar, allowing it to come to harm, neglecting it, starving it, or willingly breaking the Blood Oath, will cause the priest to suffer wounds that cannot be healed for a year and a day. A consequence of practicing this type of Blood Oath is that the priest and the familiar are now energetically fused together and exist as a small energetic microcosm of one another, even if the Blood Oath is broken. It is important to note, that, in this type of Blood Oath, the energetic connection can only be broken if either the animal or the priest dies.
- **Using Blood for Exorcism:** Sometimes, if a powerful demon is encountered while performing an exorcism on an individual, the priest will choose to prick the tip of his or her right middle finger so as to draw blood. The priest will then touch the forehead (Third Eye) of the possessed victim with the drops of blood. According to certain ancient Daoist traditions, this can sometimes be effective in restoring the spirit of the possessed individual, bringing them back to normal consciousness.

  Other priests will construct several altars surrounding the individual who is being exorcised of a malevolent spirit. If these altars are not effective, the priests understand that the forces they are dealing with are unusually strong and of a higher demonic nature. The priest will then retreat for three days of prayer and fasting. After the three day period of spiritual seclusion is complete, the priest will perform blood rituals to summon and dispatch the powerful Thunder Generals in order to remove the demonic entity.

Death Magic

In occult theory, a living creature is a storehouse of energy, and when it is killed most of this energy is suddenly liberated. The amount of energy released when a victim is ritually sacrificed is very great, completely out of proportion with the animal's size or strength. The practice of Death Magic channels and harnesses the total life-force energy of a sacrificed animal or human either for use as a devotional offering, or as a way of accruing spiritual power.

When an individual or an animal is being sacrificed, the exact instant they release their last breath and die, they emit the power of their life-force energy. Priests of black magic believe that this life-force energy can be harnessed and used for their own personal power. This ritual sacrifice is performed inside the Magic Circle in order to keep the victim's energy contained and concentrated.

It is said that using this form of Blood Magic courts destruction, because the priest is literally tapping the vein of life, and the myriad dark feelings aroused by performing the act are like food to the demonic realm. Aside from the ethical concerns regarding this aspect of Blood Magic, it

is said that the powerfully charged negative emotions generated by the act of taking a life draws the parasitic evil spirits of the demonic realm to the priest.

Death Magic invariably involves the deliberate sacrifice of a living animal or human, which allows the priest to temporarily absorb, imprison, and use the victim's life-force energy. The following are examples of the various uses of Blood Magic employed by ancient Daoist priests when practicing Death Magic:

- **Ritual Possession:** In ancient China, ritual sacrifices and ecstatic possession ceremonies were traditionally performed side by side. Daoist ritual masters and spirit mediums often performed animal sacrifices in a Daoist temple's open courtyard. This open area was located between the temple and a stage that was specifically constructed for sacrificial purposes. Offerings of animal and vegetable substances were set out by the community. Thick clouds of smoke caused from the exploding firecrackers and incense, in conjunction with chanting, drumming, and dancing, brought the spirit mediums into an altered state of trance. Possessed by the gods, the ancient priests either cut themselves with swords or skewered their flesh until blood flowed from their bodies, while simultaneously inside the temples Daoist priests would perform elaborate magical rituals.

  In certain Daoist rituals, the possessed priests then activate a newly carved statue of a Daoist god by performing the "Kaiguang Dianyan" ritual. This magical ritual is used for the consecration of the god, and it requires the Daoist priest to dot the eyes of the new statue with the blood of a sacrificed rooster or chicken in order to open the statue's eyes to the light of the Daoist Altar. On such occasions, the young male acolytes were required to carry the newly carved gods of the temple over a pile of glowing coals into the temple. This latter process was known as Guohuo (Crossing the Fire).
- **Divination:** Certain sects of ancient Daoist sorcery used blood sacrifices as a method for obtaining control over their lives (or the lives of others) by invoking certain gods who would reveal the future. In order to obtain information about the approaching energetic shifts that would soon affect the celestial and terrestrial realms, animals were commonly sacrificed to certain gods and the animal's entrails were laid out and studied.
- **Initiation:** In ancient China, ritual Death Magic was sometimes used for initiating disciples into certain esoteric Daoist sects. It was believed that only through the "spilling of blood" could the initiate be magically bonded to the group. In addition to participating in the blood sacrifice of a person or animal, these initiations often required the sponsored initiate to perform a Blood Oath.
- **Appeasing the Ancestors:** One of the strongest tenets in ancient Daoism was the importance of ancestor worship. It was believed that, just as the family's guardian spirits were to be constantly fed and given offerings, so too must the departed in one's family be periodically fed and given offerings. By honoring the ancestors and recognizing them as an essential link between mankind and the spiritual forces of nature, the ancient Chinese believed that they could obtain direct contact and receive gifts from God. This magical contact between God and mankind was believed to be activated and maintained through blood sacrifices. These types of sacrifices were primarily used for the purpose of receiving magical power and spiritual favoritism.
- **Using the Soul of a Sacrificed Victim:** This magical technique requires the skill of capturing a soul (or creating a Blood Spirit) from a being that is sacrificed for this specific purpose. The use of this type of Death Magic is regarded almost universally as corrupt, even by those individuals who know how to use it.

  In certain dark circles of ancient Chinese sorcery, it was sometimes suggested that magical adepts with knowledge of Death Magic could temporarily gain the acquired powers of their victims by sacrificing the life of another rival adept. Should the rival magician

suddenly become a spirit entity, opening the immortal gateway that leads from the physical realm to the spiritual realm, the ingested power would allow the effectiveness of the priest's magic to increase.

- **Corrupting Spiritual Sites:** The forced or untimely death of any living being leaves an energetic stain on the spiritual realm, in the form of a dark spiritual cloudiness. This spiritual cloudiness can sometimes be used in order to inhibit another priest's magical abilities, and this has been used many times in the past by priests of Death Magic in order to corrupt a rival's temple or ritual area.
- **Sacrificial Magic:** In order to accomplish a mighty feat, a priest may choose to completely use all of his or her life-force energy at once, in one powerful discharge of Blood Magic. Such Sacrificial Magic is entirely voluntary, and always ends in the death of the user. No form of resurrection magic has yet been able to revive someone who has died using Sacrificial Magic.

  When performing Sacrificial Magic, the priest focuses all of his or her energies into a final action. Whether he or she succeeds or fails, the priest dies after that single attempt. Should the priest change his or her mind before going through with the action, they will suffer physical, emotional, and mental wounding that will last for a year and a day.

  When performing Sacrificial Magic, the priest will utter a single, mighty curse and then die. The power of the priest's sacrifice empowers the curse, which may linger for years on the person, place, or thing that it was cast onto. Hence, certain family lineages, places, and things sometimes retain powerful curses that last for generations.

  The energy released from this type of Blood Magic, created from the priest's willing sacrifice, is used to bring into effect any powerful energetic pattern that the priest chooses. The priest first decides on the specific energetic curse, then willingly imbues the curse with the totality of his or her life-force energy (Ling Shen) as he or she dies. The magical power of this type of Death Magic becomes created, imprinted, and activated upon the death of the priest.
- **Performing A Death Oath:** This type of Death Magic requires a Blood Oath between two willing individuals. In this case, a dying individual extracts a Blood Oath from a willing individual. The pact is based on a particular task that the willing individual must perform within a year and a day of the agreed contract. The "avenge me" sometimes spoken on an individual's deathbed is a common example of a Death Oath. The individual that initiated the oath then dies, and part of his or her power enters into the oath-bearer to be used as additional magical power in order to fulfill the sworn task. If the task is not fulfilled, the oath-breaker will lose this power, and will be penalized for a year and a day.

The Blood Ritual Altar Table

When performing ritual sacrifices, the altar table is always set up facing the South (i.e., the Daoist priest faces the North when standing in front of the altar). The "sacrificial table" used for holding the "sacrificial offerings" must be set up at the "Gate of Life" (or at the base of the standard used during the magical ritual).

In certain sacrificial rituals, there are sometimes as many as five rows of offerings that must be presented to the Celestial Gods. During these types of powerful magical rituals (for example, the Mao Shan ritual of Summoning the Six Jia Spirits), the layout of the Daoist priest's altar is generally designed according to the following pattern (Figure 1.503):

- **First Row:** Cups of wine.
- **Second Row:** Fruit (sometimes dried fruit)
- **Third Row:** The sacrificed blood and raw meat of animals (i.e., lamb's blood, Hare's blood, dried venison, owl meat, and fox liver)
- **Fourth Row:** The cooked meat of animals (i.e., chicken, carp, deer, lamb, and hare)
- **Fifth Row:** The stone vases, red candles and incense burner.

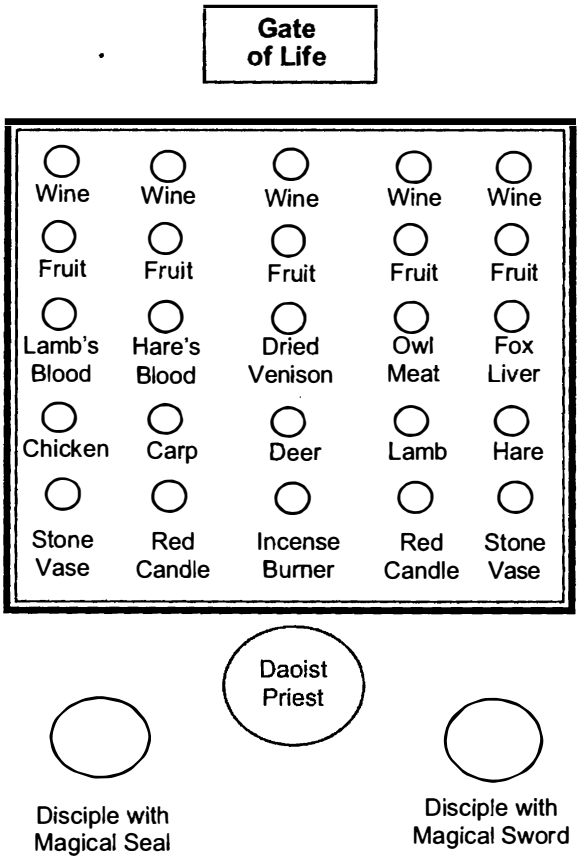


Figure 1.503. The arrangement of the "Altar of Sacrifice"

As the Daoist priest stands facing the altar, he is assisted by two acolytes. The disciple of his left holds the magical seals used for summoning and controlling the spirit entities, and the disciple on his right holds his magical sword.

MAGICAL PROPERTIES OF BODY PARTS

For certain spells to become effective, it is important for the priest to obtain material from the body of the individual whom they wish to magically influence. Certain body parts (i.e., hair, nail clippings, blood, and body fluids) contain particularly strong magical links to an individual's vibrational resonance. In the hands of a skilled practitioner of black magic, such body parts or personal items can become extremely lethal tools. This is common knowledge in all systems of occult magic.

Once a priest obtains a personal item, he or she has a direct link to the individual's body, mind, and spirit. For example, Blood Charms created from part of a victim's body can be used to corrupt the victim's spiritual essence and torment him or her at night through the constant manifestations of reoccurring nightmares.

Menstrual blood and semen are considered to be the most prized personal magical substances, sacred above all other body parts or fluids. These can be used in spells for worship, creating elementals, forming charms or talismans, summoning or dispatching gods or spirit entities, or for releasing devastating magical psychic attacks. Modern sorceresses who practice black magic have sometimes been known to save the collected sperm and prophylactic containers of a lover in order to use its contents to create powerful binding charms of love or servitude. If the lover proves to be unfaithful before the charm goes into effect, the sorceress may then take the sperm filled prophylactic to the graveyard and bury it there while reciting a powerful curse to bring about impotence, ill fortune, or destruction.

Many schools of black magic teach their disciples to use the energetic and spiritual powers contained within the victim's head or heart. For example, in certain magical rituals, the victim's head (skull) is used because it contains the innate spiritual power of the Shen Zhi (Acquired Spirit); the victim's heart is used because it contains the innate spiritual power of the Yuan Shen (Original Spirit or Soul).

Within certain schools of black magic, priests are taught to remove a finger from the left hand of the sacrificed victim. This symbolically represents the "left path," or the "left hand of magic." It is interesting to note that because of this, if there are any markings or tattoos found on the body of a satanist, they is usually located on the left side of his or her body.

Through the use of body parts, a priest of black magic can create powerful rituals that manipulate, captivate, and/or control another person or bloodline. This ancient practice is sometimes used to initiate spells that either bring bad luck to

enemies (i.e., causing injury, illness, or death) or steal power (also known as "transferring riches") in order to obtain wealth.

Priests of black magic can also use an individual's body parts and personal items to create a "spirit slave." For example, in ancient China it was taught that a victim's corpse can be raised from the grave in order to live again as a mindless slave. This was known as "corpse magic." The following magical items that are typically found in a dark priest's apothecary: a human skull, bones, graveyard dust, crossroads dust, branches (i.e., birch, cypress, ebony, elder, hawthorn, holly, or juniper), herbs, insects, animal or bird carcasses, and blood.

Some priests of black magic will cut the reproductive organs out of their victims (animals as well as people) and use them in rituals to summon demonic spirits. Other schools of black magic believe that babies are the best source of sacrifice, because their energetic and spiritual fields are still pure and carry the potential for higher power, much more than adults.

In modern times, some priests of black magic will first hit an animal with an electric probe to stun it. While it is still on its back, freon is sprayed onto the animal's throat. At this point, the animal is in a state of transition, it is living yet it is not living. Next, the black priests will use an embalming tool to retrieve the blood. Often times the eyes, tongue, sex organs (and sometimes the mammary or utter) will be removed. The blood is then used in cult baptisms, and the eyes are boiled and eaten. Usually satanic cults prefer to use dairy cattle when harvesting body parts; however other animals such as bulls or dogs are sometimes used. In some traditions, rituals will call for the use of chickens or goats.

According to certain priests of black magic, the head of a black cat which has been fed on human flesh for five days is one of the most powerful items that can be included in magical circles when conjuring evil forces. Additionally, the burning of the brains of a black cat is produces an odor that is believed to summon up spirit entities connected with the planet Saturn (the planet of Time).

Disposing of the Body

In order to rid themselves of the corpse after the blood sacrifice has been completed, priests of black magic would sometimes perform one of the following procedures:

- Eat the body parts
- Have dogs that will eat the body parts
- Cremate the body and mix the ash with blood to create magical talismans used for summoning demonic spirits
- Dispose the body parts is a secluded area
- Go to a cemetery the day before a funeral and find a grave that has been dug.; then dig about a foot down more. The black priest would then put the body or body parts in it and cover it up lightly.

Sometimes infant bodies are boiled down for the fat, and then used for making "flying ointment." Other schools of black magic use rituals that include leaving animal carcasses (decapitated roosters, dead goats, human skulls, etc.) at the entrance of a business or home, or that involve preparing special hexing dolls stuffed with magical items (bones, pendants, herbs, names of people, etc.) that are kept in the priest's basement.

Using a Cemetery Bone

Practitioners of black magic traditionally use cemetery bones in order to command ghosts and spirits. In this esoteric practice, the priest first procures a miniature coffin in order to store a piece of bone taken from any part of a corpse that has been buried in an unprotected grave site. According to ritual, the cemetery bone must come from a deserted grave and must be removed secretly. A magical ritual is then performed in the cemetery in order to invoke and attach any wandering spirits that are currently lost within the cemetery compound.

Once the ritual is completed the miniature coffin is brought back to the priest's altar for forty nine days. Several drops of blood (from the priest's right hand ring finger), are offered in a daily ritual in order to energetically feed the piece of cemetery bone. After the forty nine day ritual, the priest only needs to feed the cemetery bone with blood once a week. The once a week feeding ritual must be consistent; otherwise the ghost will become

unreasonable and angry if no blood offering is presented. In this magical practice, a specific talisman is also placed outside the miniature coffin to prevent the ghost from wandering, and a mantra is recited to bind the ghost should it try to disobey the priest's commands.

It is important to note that when performing these types of Cemetery Bone rituals, priests can choose to use either human or animal bones in order to imprison a wandering spirit. The choice depends on the exact needs of the priest. For example, sometimes animal bones are selected and used for creating powerful spirit guardians and protectors, other times human bones are chosen and used for creating spirit messengers and servants.

CREATING A BLOOD SPIRIT

The use of Blood Charms created from animal sacrifices is still prevalent in China today. The more rare and powerful uses of Blood Magic however, are mainly confined to priests who practice ancient Chinese Folk Magic. These priests continue to experiment with many forms of Blood Magic, using the energetic properties of Nature Spirits, trees, plants, and certain animals.

In order to energetically alter and increase the power gathered and cultivated through the use of Blood Magic, certain priests will create a Blood Spirit. The creation of a "Blood Spirit" is a powerful ancient magical ritual that was performed in two parts: the Fusion Ritual and the Renaming Ritual. These two rituals used for creating a Blood Spirit are described as follows:

- **The Fusion Ritual:** The "Fusion Ritual" required the priest to use a specific magical spell and incantation that fused the energetic nature of an Elemental Spirit, Animal Spirit, or Human Spirit together with the energetic powers of a Nature Spirit. This energetic fusion was designed in order to transform and unite both spirits into one powerful entity, known as a "Blood Spirit." This new and powerful type of spirit entity would then be charged with protecting the priest from all forms of hostile psychic attacks (i.e., initiated from other powerful priests who might dispatch conjured demonic spirit entities). In order to feed and maintain the immense power of the Blood Spirit, the priest's own blood had to be continuously shed in magical rituals (Blood Spirits use the spiritual power released from blood to rebuild their energetic fields).
- **The Renaming Ritual:** Renaming the Blood Spirit completely and irrevocably changed its original (true) energetic pattern. This allowed the priest to imprint and reprogram the Blood Spirit for its new purpose of existence and bind the spirit into his or her service.

  It is important to note that, although Blood Magic may be used in a Renaming ritual, using Blood Magic on a person, place, or thing that has already received a ritualistic Blood Magic empowering spell will have unpredictable effects. Therefore, renaming a person, place, or thing with a Blood Magic ritual, and then renaming it again with another Blood Magic ritual could be disastrous.

ABORTIONS, BLOOD SACRIFICES, YINGLING, AND SORCERY

Known in modern times as Infanticide (the killing of an infant), the termination of a fetus is generally performed within the first twenty-four weeks of pregnancy. There are even ancient Chinese records found dating as far back as the Zhou Dynasty (1028-221 B.C.) that speak of ingesting certain substances in order to induce an abortion and terminate a fetus.

In the Chinese culture, an individual's age is determined not from the date of birth, but from the date of conception (when the Eternal Soul enters the energetic vortex of the egg and begins to establish its residence). An abortion was therefore considered in ancient China to be a type of blood sacrifice. This is because the energetic act of an abortion immediately releases the spirit soul of the fetus, creating the energetic formation of a Phantom Embryo (see Chinese Medical Qigong Therapy: Volume 4, Chapter 53).

In order to gather the Xiaogui ("Little Ghost") and use it as a "spirit servant," a priest of black magic would wait until after this type of blood sacrifice has been completed, then energetically

capture the victim's discarnate spirit from the tissues of the dead fetus. This type of magical practice was traditionally known as "Fetus-Demon Sorcery," and was a common practice used by ancient priests of Daoist black magic. In ancient China, Fetus-Demon Sorcery was considered to be an unorthodox offshoot of the magical workings involving capturing and utilizing Nature Spirits and Elementals.

The Yingling

The term Yingling (meaning magical spirit/soul of a baby/infant) is sometimes used to describe the ghosts of a fetus, young infant, or small child (up to two years). Yingling is often translated as "Fetus Ghost," or "Phantom Embryo." According to ancient Daoist teachings, the Eternal Soul is drawn to the intense light caused by mortals engaging in sexual intercourse. Once the spirit enters into the mother, it occupies the newly fertilized egg. Because the Jing, Qi, and Shen of both parents are responsible for the physical, energetic, and spiritual construction of the embryo, after an abortion, the Yingling is thought to express concern over the feelings generated from both parents involved in the abortion. The ancient Chinese believed that a Yingling could come from a miscarriage, an abortion, or from a young child who has died in infancy.

Some Yingling will remain and haunt a location (usually the area, clinic, or hospital where they were aborted), rather than a person. This could be either because the mother died during the operation or because the Ming (destiny) with the mother was not strong. This type of fetus ghost is generally considered to be mischievous rather than malevolent.

The ancient Chinese believed that other Yingling became vengeful spirits, angry about being murdered and losing their chance to enter into the physical world. This type of malevolent spirit is highly dangerous, seeking out revenge by causing nightmares, illness (i.e., pain in the stomach, nausea, headaches, etc.), insanity, and sometimes even death.

The ancient Chinese believed that when a woman gets pregnant and then has an abortion, the aborted child's spirit would continue to stay by its mother's side, waiting for the moment when its mother would become pregnant again. At this time, the child's spirit will take the first opportunity to enter its mother's womb to be reborn as her next child.

Traditionally, it was considered to be extremely bad for a victim's health to have a Fetus Ghost "hanging around." It was believed that the Excess Yin constitution of a Fetus Ghost's energetic form could naturally cause severe physical and psychological illness.

After its death, a Fetus Ghosts never remains as a fetus in the afterlife. Instead, it is usually represented as having matured to the physical age of somewhere from one to five years old. Because its mental capabilities reach far beyond the "normal" range of intellectual powers, and it lacks the maturity to balance this knowledge, a Fetus Ghost is considered to be especially dangerous.

Using a Yingling for Sorcery

If a Fetus Ghost is captured by a priest, it can be energetically transformed into a Fetus Demon, and used as a "tool" of black magic. By using the energetic matrix of the Fetus Ghost as a vessel, the priest will now have a means of creating and casting evil spells of great power. Normally, the Fetus Demon is also used as a servant, spy, and spiritual bodyguard.

Once captured, a Fetus Ghost is generally held prisoner by the priest in much the same way that an animal spirit or human spirit is captured and imprisoned. For example, once the energetic form of the Fetus Ghost has been captured, it would then normally be kept in a magical gourd or clay pot and then transformed into a Fetus Demon through Blood Magic. For example, the priest would place (or grind up) specific parts of the fetus's body (i.e., the brains, heart, etc.) and keep it in the clay bottle or gourd. The Fetus Demon is then fed on human blood in order to enslave it. It is then dispatched whenever the priest needs specific errands to be run. For example, if a "client" comes to the priest seeking revenge, the priest will bind the Fetus Demon to that specific task and then release it to fulfill the client's specific desires.

A Fetus Demon was considered to be such a precious spiritual commodity that, in ancient China certain priests would seek out pregnant woman who had died in drowning and other accidents. The primary goal was to harvest the brain fluid and/or blood from the heart of a dead fetus in order to catch the baby spirit's soul. It was believed that with this brain fluid or heart blood the priest could write a powerful magical talisman, and then use it to summon the Fetus Ghost.

Another method used in Fetus Demon Sorcery was to use the physical body of an infant that has been buried for a long time. Since the child's bones had been buried for several years, it was believed that the corpse would naturally absorb the Lingshen (spirit energy) of Heaven and Earth, Sun and Moon, and Soil and Water. Together, the combination of these six spiritual energies (i.e., three Yin and three Yang) allows the magical power of the child's bones to become extremely strong. In order for this esoteric practice to be of any use, the priest could not use just any bone. He or she must harvest only the bones that contained part of the child's 3 Hun and 7 Po (i.e., the skull, sternum, and the pelvic bones of the Three Dantian areas). These bones were thought to contain enough of the child's essence to make the magic possible. Once these bones have been obtained, the priest would present special offerings and blood sacrifices to a specific deity of the Underworld. Only then could the magical spell become fully effective.

Fetus Demons are thought to be extremely powerful. This is because they are believed to exist within an energetic state that allows them to perceive the most subtle energetic sensations and spiritual perceptions. It was believed that, while in this subtle energetic state, the Fetus Demons remained in touch with the secrets of the natural universe, and could commune with the Elements and foundational powers of nature in ways that an adult ghost could not. This magical ability gave the Fetus Demon access to the knowledge of any individual's darkest secrets, as well as the ability to cause problems within any home (i.e., bringing snakes, rats, cockroaches, spiders or mosquitoes into anyone's house).

Because the Fetus Demon are famous for knowing things about the future or about an individual's fate, in Asia today, there are certain spirit mediums (Lingmei) and Daoist priests (Wushi) who will buy the removed remains of a fetus from aborting mothers in exchange for providing memorial plaques for the baby's soul. The spirit medium will then create a Fetus Demon and feed it human blood twice a week. In exchange, the Fetus Demon will work hard for the spirit medium. However, because the fetuses must be reincarnated, this arrangement traditionally lasts only two to four years. At that agreed time of termination, if the priest becomes greedy over the Fetus Demon's power and does not release it, the Fetus Demon would turn on its master, inflicting great harm, or possibly even killing the priest. There is an ancient Chinese saying that states, "the Fetus Demons are dangerous to others if the priest knows what he is doing; but lethal to the priest if he is careless or untrained."

Some ancient Chinese priests used human fetuses for constructing black magic potions. Other priests also used talismanic writings in order to command the Fetus Demon to control a victim's Shen (thoughts and emotions). There are even ancient writings that describe the belief that the bones of dead infants or children could be used by women to magically kill their husbands.

Daoist rituals for expelling Fetus Demons date as far back as the Qin Dynasty (221-206 B.C.). These rituals include scattering yellow soil in order to dispel Fetus Demons.

OTHER METHODS OF GATHERING THE FETUS'S SOUL

Several Chinese mystic scholars have written on the fright syndrome that causes the individual's soul (Hun) to leave their physical body. Newborn infants are considered to be particularly susceptible during the first one hundred days after birth, and for this reason they are sometimes targeted by priests of black magic.

Binding a Fetus's Soul into a Haunted Doll

In ancient China, there were many priests who could summon and command ghosts and spirit entities. Once a priest could command a ghost or spirit, the mystic could then order it to assist him or her in gaining fame, wealth, success, preventing obstacles, defeating enemies, protecting the household, etc. One technique used in Daoist black magic for summoning and commanding the soul of a fetus required binding its spirit to the image of a doll.

The ancient method of creating a Haunted Doll could be terrifying. The priests had to go to the cemetery alone in the night, dig up the corpse of a deceased pregnant woman, cut the corpse's abdomen, remove the dead baby, and then proceed directly to the nearest temple outer area for the roasting processes (the temple was considered to be a place that is so sacred that no ghosts or spirits could enter). The temple's outer area was thought to protect the priest from the ghost mother who might chase after the priest and try to bring her baby back. It was also important to chant a certain sacred mantra in order to invoke the spirit of the baby while roasting its dead body on a fire.

A Haunted Doll, when properly created, would actually contain the spirit soul of a dead infant, which had been transferred into the form of a doll (composed of various materials, such as wood, straw, paper, or clay). The main purpose of creating a Haunted Doll in ancient China was for protection. The ghost trapped within the Haunted Dolls could be activated with a secret mantra to emerge and fight the priest's enemies or act as a guardian that protected the owner's treasures.

When creating Haunted Dolls, some priests would invoke the wandering souls of aborted fetuses. The souls of aborted fetuses are believed to be in great suffering, trapped in limbo as lost earthbound ghosts. By chanting a specific mantra, the priest could invoke and summon the soul of an aborted fetus to the altar area where an idol (i.e. a doll) of a child is placed. The priest then binds the aborted fetus, forcing it to reside within the body of the doll as his or her spirit servant. Offerings are made daily to the doll, including milk, sweets, and other edible foods.

Creating a Willow Doll Spirit

According to certain ancient Daoist Folk Magic Divination practices, capturing and raising spirits was an essential part of the magical teaching. One way through which to capture and control a spirit, and have it work for you, was through creating a Willow Doll Spirit. This secret magical ritual is described as follows:

- This special method of Daoist black magic required a sorcerer to first locate a pregnant women (the spirit of her growing child will become the targeted victim of this magic ritual); and then obtain a fresh raw human placenta.
- Next, the sorcerer will cast a spell on the human-placenta, in order to "draw the living baby's spirit." The time of casting the spell, requires that the spirit baby's Four Pillars be "born" (magically activated) on a Yin-year, Yin-month, Yin-day, and a Yin-hour.
- Because it is magically linked to the supernatural powers of the Moon, the sorcerer will locate a Willow Tree (Figure 1.504) that is facing the Northern direction. It is important that the Willow Tree be able to absorb the energy of both the Sun and the Moon daily. This will ensure that the baby's spiritual energy regenerates, once the raw placenta is buried under the tree.
- A magic talisman is then created and burned, and both the human placenta and a magic talisman ash are planted together under the Willow Tree. The purpose of the magic talisman is to be able to raise the baby's spirit once it has been summoned through the magic ritual; it is also used to empower the Willow Spirit, and enhance the spiritual power of it's Ling Shen (magical spirit).
- Every day, at the hour of "Shen" (sunset: 3p.m. - 5 p.m.), the sorcerer will stand in front of the Willow Tree and present offerings of incense, while reciting a special incantation.
- At the exact location where the placenta and talisman ash was buried, the sorcerer will pour Yin-Yang Water, and continue to recite the special incantation. This part of the ritual must continue for 49-days without stopping.
- During this time period, a red scarf (6 inches wide and 8 feet long) must also be tied onto

Figure 1.504. The WillowTree (Yin)

the tallest branch of the Willow Tree. This is used to bind the energy of the baby spirit to the Willow Tree, and keep it from running out from the ritual boundaries.

- The ritual is performed everyday, for 108 days. During this time period, the placenta will dry up, and part of the baby's soul will remove itself from the mother and begin to merge together as one with the Willow Tree.
- On the last day of ritual, the sorcerer will prepare a large black cloth through which to cover the entire Willow Tree; then, the sorcerer will set up an altar table.
- Next, the sorcerer will present the incense offering, repeat the incantation used to invoke the baby's spirit, and then bind it to the magical talisman created in order to control it.
- During the hour of "Zi" hour (11p.m. - 1a.m.) the sorcerer will go inside the black cloth and look carefully at the tree. He should observe one part of the tree glowing in a bright green color.
- At this point in the magic ritual, the sorcerer will cut the glowing part of willow tree into a three inch block of wood, and immediately carve it into the shape of a human child.
- Next, the sorcerer will magically activate and empower the human-shaped willow carving, by brushing it with a magic brush dipped in the blood of a rooster. This is performed in order to empower and give life to the Willow Tree Dolls internal organs, and magically activate its eyes, ears, mouth, head, hands and feet.
- The sorcerer will then exhale three times, blowing a special Breath Incantation onto the face of the Willow Tree Doll.
- The doll will then be wrapped in black silk and taken home, to the sorcerer's personal altar space, and the bathing in rooster blood and Breath Incantation will be repeated each night for seven more days.
- Once the empowerment and magical activation has been completed, the baby will die inside the womb of pregnant mother, and the new "orphaned" soul, will become spiritually bound and contained inside the Willow Tree Doll.
- The sorcerer must keep his altar area located somewhere in the dark. In this type of black magic ritual, it is important to not allow any sunlight to enter into the altar area.
- Every day, the sorcerer must make offering to the Willow Tree Doll, with blood pricked from the ring finger (a man will use his left hand; a woman will use her right hand). This must be done two times a day, morning and evening, in order to energetically "feed" the doll.

Note: For female practitioners, it is forbidden to go near the altar room during her menstrual cycle. Alternatively, female practitioners can ask for assistance from a male sorcerer to feed the spirit doll with the blood of a bat.

The Sorcerer can begin communicating with the spirit immediately, asking it to perform specific tasks. It is important to not overload the spirit entity, and each time the spirit has completed a given task, it must be rewarded.

USING BABY SPIRIT OIL

Some priests used the practice of containing the spirit of a fetus in what is known as "baby spirit oil." In order to create "baby spirit oil," a bottle was used that contained a small wood carving of a baby's body. The wood was painted half black and half white, and was soaked in a special type of oil that had been extracted from certain magical trees and combined with various types of herbs. The baby spirit's soul was then summoned and made to reside in the bottle. The bottle was then kept inside a miniature Chinese coffin and hidden from the public. This magical practice required the "feeding" of fetus spirit from the blood of the priest's right hand ring finger.

Using Blood Magic for Initiating Family Curses

In ancient China, if a family had been terribly wronged by an individual, the victimized family could hire a Daoist priest to use Blood Magic in order to invoke revenge on the assaulting individual's family for all generations. This type of blood curse was initiated as follows:

- First the priest carved a certain talisman out of wood. The carved talisman would include certain planetary patterns along with special magical characters surrounding the victim's family surname.
- Next, the priest would fill the crevices (spaces carved within the wood) with blood gathered from one of the intended victim's relatives. Generally, a blood sacrifice was also offered to a powerful spirit deity as part of the pact.
- Finally, the priest would place a magical seal over the talisman in order to activate its power. This blood talisman could then be used to affect anyone within the victim's family, tribe, or clan, causing them sickness, disease, injury, or death.

Combining Blood Magic With Sex Magic

The sex organs contain powerful transformational energy; therefore many priests believe that released sexual energy is an excellent way to reach higher states of consciousness. However, Sex Magic can also be used to create powerful energetic forms of spirit entities. For example, priests of black magic believed that the powerful effect of the life-force energy being released during an animal or human sacrifice, combined with the culminated sexual power released during group orgasm, could greatly increase the magical power contained inside the Magic Circle. This combination of Blood Magic and Sex Magic set a foundation for many powerful interactions with demonic entities.

The following are examples of two ancient magical practices that used the combination of Blood Magic and Sex Magic to create the energetic forms of powerful spirit entities used for hexing and psychic attack:

Blood Sacrifices and Sex Magic

When performing "Sex Magic" with a partner, in order to create a more powerful spirit entity used for hexing, a male priest would choose to have sex with a female during the beginning time of her menses. This type of magical ritual is considered to be a dark or sinister form of Blood Magic, and was practiced as follows:

- After summoning all of the various Elemental powers to the altar area, the priest would place the woman supine (on her back) on the Earth altar table. The woman would be completely naked except for a black cape that was draped around her neck and back.
- Next, the priest would draw a talisman on the woman's Lower Dantian (lower abdominal area) with specific Blood Ink and ash while speaking special magical incantations. The Blood Ink was to be gathered from the recent sacrifice of a white rooster.
- The priest would then place a magical talisman that had been written in vermillion ink on yellow paper onto the woman's Lower Dantian (over the skin talisman). The paper talisman (containing planetary icons, special symbols, and magical instructions used for summoning and dispatching the spirit entity) had been previously written in preparation for this magical ritual.
- The priest would then begin to engage in sexual intercourse with the woman. At the height of sexual climax, when both began to achieve orgasm, the priest would immediately remove his penis from the woman's vagina and ejaculate his sperm onto the paper talisman.
- While ejaculating the sperm, the priest would speak a specific summoning breath incantation.
- After wiping the woman's menses blood off of his penis onto the paper talisman, the priest would then spit onto the paper talisman and blow hot air while speaking a sealing incantation into the combined mixture of body fluids.
- Next, the priest would wad-up the paper talisman (now containing blood, semen, saliva, and breath) and burn it over the alter candle

fire. These candles were not the traditional red (used in Daoist magical rituals for summoning the celestial gods), but were instead white (used in Daoist magical rituals for summoning the spirits of the dead and gods of the Underworld). It is important to note that some systems of western sorcery use black candles when performing this type of magical ritual. The candles were to be lit and positioned to the right and left of the woman's body during the entire ritual. The candle fire was used to complete the final act of the "creation" and energetic "activation" of the magical talisman to summon the spirit entity.

- The priest would then give the spirit entity a "summoning name" and initiate a specific magical Hand Seal with which to summon it.
- The spirit entity was then given a specific function (its "task" and purpose of existence). At this time, the priest would also describe how the spirit entity would energetically "feed" itself (e.g., attach itself to the victim's Wei Qi field, etc.). If the spirit entity is not given specific instructions in how to replenish its energetic form, it would naturally choose to energetically sustain itself by "vampiring" the priest's Wei Qi fields at night when he or she slept. In ancient Chinese sorcery this act was known as "the child feeds from its mother."
- Once the spirit entity was dispatched, the karma created from the hexing was finally set into motion.

BLOOD SACRIFICES AND GROUP SEX MAGIC

Performing Blood Magic as a group in order to summon and dispatch an extremely powerful spirit entity required the orchestration of usually four to five couples (i.e., eight to ten priests). The magical ritual was performed in conjunction with a grandmaster responsible for leading the group and personally performing the Blood Sacrifice. When performing this type of magical ritual, the priest who leads the group (either a male or female) would usually proceed as follows:

- After drawing the Magic Circle and placing the four couples on stools (each stool is positioned in one of the four directions), the priest leading the ritual would begin to summon all of the various powers to the altar area. The male priests would be completely naked except for a brightly colored silk cape. Each cape is used to represent one of the four specific Element colors and their directions of power (Red-South, Black-North, Green-East, and White-West), although in certain magical traditions, sometimes only four black silk capes are used when performing this type of magical ritual. All of the men should be facing the center of the circle, with the women (who are to be completely naked), straddling the men on the stools.
- At the direction of the priest leading the ritual, all four couples would begin performing sex, using forceful sound exhalations generated to a specific cadence. Performed properly, this rhythm resembled that of a strong group panting. The resonating sound of this group interaction would allow the sexual energy to gather greater momentum and would facilitate a powerful energetic release from the four couples inside the Magic Circle. As the sexual energy gathered momentum, a thick energetic mist was generated inside the Magic Circle.
- As all four couples continued to engage in sexual intercourse, the lead priest (positioned in the center of the magic circle) would approach the Earth Altar with an animal to sacrifice (usually a rooster or chicken is sacrificed, however certain schools of black magic would use a snake or a human). There would also be an Altar Cup filled with red wine positioned on the center on the table.
- The priest directing the magical ritual would continue speaking certain incantations, allowing the sexual energy to build. The lead priest would wait until the couples begin to energetically discharge the sexual Qi during orgasm before slicing the animal's neck.
- At the point when all four couples simultaneously climaxed, the animal's neck (or human's neck) was immediately slashed and the animal's or human's released spirit, blood, and sexual energy (Shen, Qi, and Jing) were combined into the cup of red wine placed on the Earth Altar table.

- The priest then offered the blood wine to the specific demonic or underworld deity that he or she was summoning. Then he or she drank the wine and requested the assistance of demonic entity in the accomplishment of the desired task.

Using Blood Magic for Training Plant Spirits

In ancient China, a priest living in the deep forest or jungles would sometimes use blood magic in order to create an enchanted black bush (Figure 1.505). A full grown enchanted black bush serves as a powerful magic tool for the priest. This is because when you charm a black bush, it develops an animal soul. As it matures, the animal soul contained within the plant begins to crave meat.

Enchanting a black bust requires the priest to patiently work with the plant in progressive magical applications. This is described as follows:

- First, the priest must travel into the forest or jungle and find a black bush.
- Next, he must dig it up, bring it home and then transplant it in a safe location.
- Then, the priest must draw a magic charm over it and say a special incantation once a month for a year.
- The priest must draw the same charm twice a month for the second year.
- The priest must draw the same charm every other week for the second year.
- The priest must draw the same charm once a week for the third year.
- The priest must draw the same charm three times a week for the fourth year.
- The priest must draw the same charm every night for the fifth year.
- During the sixth year, the priest will start to give the enchanted black bush an egg to eat. Little by little the leaves start to move towards the direction of the egg, Eventually, one day, the leaves will wrap themselves around the egg and begin to eat it in its entirety.
- During the seventh year, the priest will begin to feed it baby chicks.
- During the eighth year, it can be fed a young chicken.
- By the tenth year, it will be able to eat a full grown chicken. By then, the enchanted black bush is extremely powerful and can be used for many kinds of magic (i.e., countering spells, paralyzing spirits, etc.).

Figure 1.505. An Enchanted Black Bush

When the priest is feeding the enchanted black bush a full grown chicken, as soon as the chicken hits the center of the plant, it immediately becomes paralysed. Although the chicken will continue to make noise, it cannot move. Additionally, there is generally a strange sound (like hissing) that come from the bush as it consumes the chicken. If you look into the center of the enchanted black bush as it eats, you can actually see its leaves rippling, moving, and wrapping around the motionless body of the chicken. By morning, all that will be left is a pile of feathers.

It is important to note, that if you don't feed the enchanted black bush a chicken once a week, it gets vary hungry, and can become extremely dangerous. If it is hungry and you forget to feed the plant, it could potentially burn your flesh down to the bone on the spot where you touch it. In this type of enchantment, and you cannot wash the poison off.

ANIMAL BLOOD SACRIFICE RITUAL

According to ancient Daoist teachings on Thunder Magic, when prayers and requests are made in order to crusade against an "Evil Temple," and expel any and all wicked and cruel elements created by such a place, the priest must use Blood Sacrifices in order to appease the Thunder Generals and achieve a fast response.

The method of "Sacrificing in Open Air," is traditionally used when performing this type of Blood Magic, and can be successfully employed in order to initiate the appropriate response of the lower Thunder Generals, who are wild and fierce.

The Blood Sacrifice has to be presented in open air, located on top of a high mountain, in a secluded place. According to ancient Daoist teaching, if the magic ritual must be performed within a market place, the priest must then choose a separate, single room, in the position of the South-East. The private room must be locked, and the blood sacrifice secretly presented inside.

- According to ancient Daoist tradition, when setting up the sacrificial altar, the priest must first take white chalk and mark out the altar space on the floor. When marking the altar space, it is important for the priest to create three Terraces (corresponding to three celestial platforms or stairs) facing the direction of the Xun Trigram (Human Door).

  The upper platform of the altar should be broad, about 9 feet in dimension; the middle platform of the altar should also be broad, about 12 feet in dimension; and the lower platform of the altar should additionally be broad, about 15 feet in dimension (Figure 1.506).
- Next, the priest must take one white rooster and firmly bind its legs with a dark red silk string or cord.
- Then, the priest will take 5 big wine cups, one bottle of wine, five thousand pieces of golden spirit money, five colored Command Flags (i.e., green, red, yellow, white, and black), one sharp-edged Magic Sword, and Frankincense powder (to be used inside the incense burner).

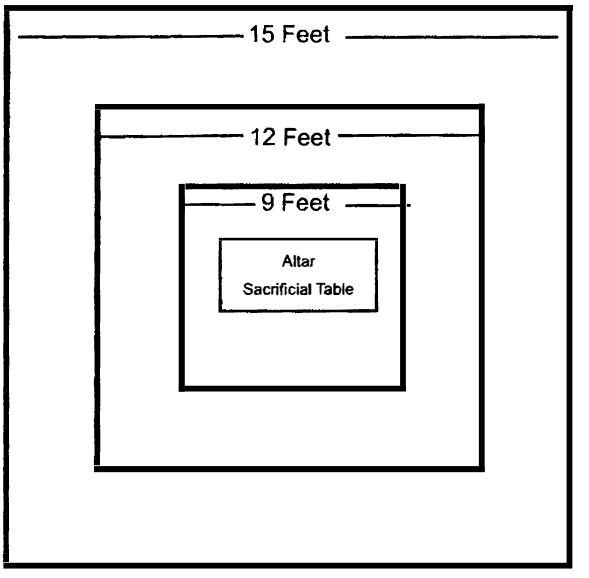


Figure 1.506. The Dimensions of the White Chalk marks of the Open Air Blood Sacrafice Altar

- When it is time to perform the magic ritual, the priest will wear his hair in a dishevelled manner, and look towards the direction of the South-East. While barefooted, the priest will perform the "Crush the Earth and Summon Magical Forces" Star Stepping.
- Next, the priest will ascend to the altar and present the incense.
- With his left hand forming the "Summon the Thunder Emissaries" Hand Seal, and his right hand holding the Magic Sword, the priest will look towards the South-East direction and say in a loud voice:

"I-------(Daoist Name)---, Your Disciple,
Respectfully receive the decree
by the God-Emperors,
to summon the Thunder Emissaries of
Barbarian Thunder of the Five Directions!

I request that they quickly approach
the ---------- location,
to punish and behead
all evil spirits and demonic thieves
at that location!

Quickly, Quickly in accordance
to all laws and statutes!

- Next, the priest will say the following:

**"I call to the Heavens,
to send down its sweet rain,
and order Wind and Fire
to come quickly!**

**Today I have prepared,
heeding the Rules,
the blood of a White Rooster,
wine, Sacrificial Money, Bright Incense,
Sacrificial presents and other items!**

**The time has come,
and nobody must challenge my orders!"**

- After speaking the incantation, the priest will stab the white rooster and let the fresh blood drip into the 5 wine cups. The 5 wine cups are to be placed according to the magical pattern of the five directions (North, South, East, West, and Center).
- Next, the priest will pour wine into the 5 cups and use his Magic Sword to stir the wine, mixing it with the rooster blood inside to five cups.
- Then, the priest will burn all of the Spirit Money.
- Next, the priest will take the sacrificial offering (i.e., the Spirit Money ash, Blood Wine, the body of the white rooster, etc.) and bury them all inside a three feet deep hole, dug into the Earth, at the South-East direction (Human Door) of the altar table.
- Then, the priest will say the following:

**"I am in front of the altar,
and my Magical Sword is ready!**

- Next, the priest will take his Magic Sword and thrust it upright into the Earth, where the sacrificial items were buried.
- The priest will now slowly back away from the Magic Sword, and again approach the altar table. According to ancient Daoist teachings on Thunder Magic, at this time in the magic ritual, storm clouds will immediately begin to come to the altar area, and rain will start to fall.

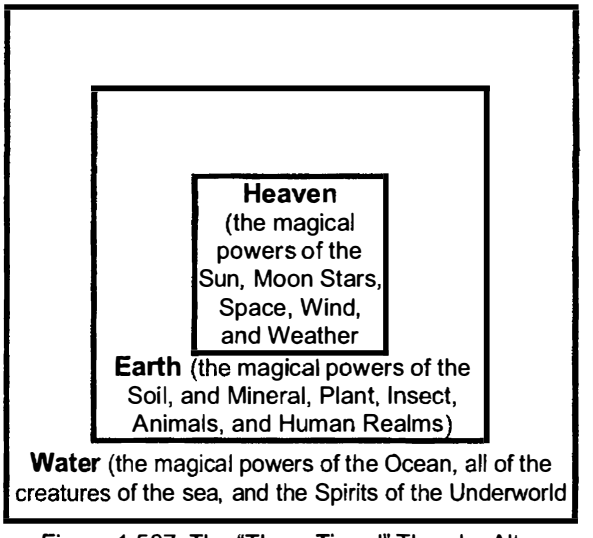


Figure 1.507. The "Three-Tiered" Thunder Altar

According to my teacher, you must not often perform these type of Blood Magic Sacrifices. When performing this magic ritual, however, it is important to have a magical protection talisman fastened at the center of the altar table. When burying the sacrificial items in the Earth, the magical protection talisman must also be buried along with the other sacrificial items.

Additionally, when performed in a secluded space outside, a second type of altar, called the "Altar of the Eight Trigrams, Nine Palaces, and Ten Directions" can also be used for this type of magical ritual (Figure 1.507). This sacred altar can be constructed of three superimposed square mounds of Earth. The three mounds represent Heaven (the magical powers of the Sun, Moon and Stars, as well as Space, Wind, and Weather), Earth (the magical powers of the Soil, as well as the Mineral, Plant, Insect, Animal, and Human Realms), and Water (the magical powers of the Ocean and all of the creatures of the sea, as well as the spirits of the Underworld). In ancient China, these three magical realms were considered to be the Three Worlds.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

- **Zhuchi (Senior Abbot) of Tian Yun Gong:**
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Background

Professor Jerry Alan Johnson was ordained and licensed at the Celestial Masters Mansion in the Longhu Shan Zhengyi Monastery in Jiangxi Province, through the Peoples Republic of China's Ministry of Religion. He is currently the Senior Abbot (Zhuchi) of Tian Yun Gong (The Temple of the Celestial Cloud), located in Monterey California. As of November 2011, the Monastery at the Celestial Master's Mansion has ordained more then 38 Tudi (Apprentices), 48 Daoshi (Priests), and 8 Daozhang (Abbots) from the Tian Yun Gong, under the special teachings of Senior Abbot Luo Sheng (Dr. Jerry Alan Johnson).

To date, he has been studying Daoist Mysticism for over 40 years, including the Shang Qing Pai, Tian Shi Pai, Ling Bao Pai, Bai Ji Pai, and Long Men Pai systems of esoteric magic.

He has written over 7 instructional books on Daoist Magic, including:

The 65th Celestial Master Zhang Jing Tao and Senior Abbot Dr. Jerry Alan Johnson (Author) at the Celestial Master's Mansion in Jiangxi Province

- **Daoist Magical Incantations, Hand Seals, and Star Stepping**
- **Magical Tools and the Daoist Altar**
- **Daoist Exorcism: Encounters With Sorcerers, Ghosts, Spirits, And Demons**
- **Daoist Mineral, Plant, and Animal Magic**
- **Daoist Weather Magic and Feng Shui**
- **Daoist Magical Transformation Skills, Dream Magic, Shape-Shifting, Soul Travel, & Sex Magic**
- **Daoist Magical Talismans**

Doctor Johnson is also a Professor of Traditional Chinese Medicine, licensed through the Peoples Republic of China's Ministry of Health, and is internationally renowned as a Shifu (Master Instructor) in several styles of Chinese Wudang Martial Arts.

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